APPSC Complete — Pilot: own MCQs reworked into the PYQ pattern

Book 1: History (Indian & AP)

Rows done so far: 26. Own (notes) MCQs: **1635 → 673** (41%). Removed: 1121 merged, 144 PYQ repeat, 50 duplicate, 13 other. PYQs unchanged. Every MCQ is shown under the notes sub-section it is linked to.

Labels: **PYQ** · **New pattern** (statements / match / assertion–reason) · **Kept own** · **New CA**. Correct option in green.

Row	Section	PYQs	Own before	Own now	new pattern	statements	match	A–R
0	Sources of Ancient Indian History – Archaeological, Literary, Foreign Accounts; Dating Methods	73	158	61	34	20	10	4
1	Sources for the History of Andhra – Inscriptions, Coins, Literature and Foreign Accounts	41	59	20	14	9	3	2
2	Stone Age Cultures – Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Chalcolithic Sites of India	42	60	23	13	8	3	2
3	Pre-historic Cultures of Andhra – Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic and Megalithic Sites	19	72	21	13	8	4	1
4	Pre-harappan and Early Harappan Cultures – Mehrgarh, Amri, Kot Diji, Kalibangan-i	5	48	18	13	9	3	1
5	Indus Valley Civilization – Discovery, Chronology, Geographical Extent, Boundary Sites	48	85	42	21	15	4	2
6	Ivc Town Planning – Grid Layout, Citadel and Lower Town, Drainage, Great Bath, Granaries	24	67	27	16	10	4	2
7	Major Harappan Sites and Their Signature Finds	20	73	34	16	10	4	2
8	Ivc Economy – Agriculture, Crops, Animals, Crafts, Trade, Seals, Weights, Meluhha	19	63	31	17	10	5	2

9	Ivc Seals, Weights and Measures, Harappan Script	14	61	26	14	8	3	3
10	Ivc Society and Polity – Stratification, Burials, Absence of Temples and Palaces	3	54	24	13	7	3	3
11	Ivc Art and Craft – Dancing Girl, Priest-king, Terracotta, Beads, Pottery	5	46	24	14	9	2	2
12	Ivc Religion – Pashupati Seal, Mother Goddess, Tree and Animal Worship, Fire Altars	9	28	12	7	5	1	1
13	Decline of the Ivc – Competing Theories; Late Harappan Cultures	3	50	23	10	5	2	3
14	Aryan Question – Original Home Theories and Archaeological Correlates	10	55	21	10	6	4	0
15	Rig Vedic Period – Sapta Sindhu, Rivers, Tribes, Battle of Ten Kings	10	51	17	10	5	4	1
16	Early Vedic Polity – Rajan, Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha, Gana; Tribal Chiefdom	7	39	18	8	5	2	1
17	Early Vedic Society and Economy – Pastoralism, Gavishti, Varna Origins, Position of Women	21	58	25	13	8	3	2
18	Later Vedic Period – Eastward Expansion, Iron (krishna Ayas), Painted Grey Ware	12	58	27	12	7	4	1
19	Later Vedic Polity – Territorial Kingship, Royal Sacrifices, Ratnins	3	52	22	11	5	5	1
20	Later Vedic Society – Varnas, Ashramas, Gotra, Status of Women	15	62	26	14	8	4	2
21	Vedic Literature – Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads, Vedangas, Sutras	112	73	28	16	8	6	2
22	Vedic Religion, Ritual and Philosophy; the Six	77	92	35	18	9	6	3

	Orthodox Schools							
23	The Sixteen Mahajanapadas – List, Capitals, Monarchies vs Ganasanghas	31	53	21	13	8	3	2
24	Second Urbanisation – Nbpw, Punch-marked Coins, Guilds and Towns	4	45	21	12	6	4	2
25	Rise of Magadha – Haryankas, Shishunagas, Nandas and Causes of Supremacy	43	73	26	14	8	3	3

Row 0: Sources of Ancient Indian History – Archaeological, Literary, Foreign Accounts; Dating Methods

1. Literary Sources – Works, Authors and Biographies (PYQs 18 · MCQs 28)

Most-asked: author → work

Work	Author	Point to remember
Rajatarangini	Kalhana, 12th c., Sanskrit	Kings of Kashmir; 8 Tarangas, 7,826 verses; written 1148–49 under Jayasimha (Jai Singh, 1128–1149)
Arthashastra	Kautilya (Chanakya)	Mauryan polity and economy
Nitisara	Kamandaka (not Kautilya or Varahamihira)	Early book of politics (statecraft), Gupta age; followed across South and Southeast Asia
Mudrarakshasa	Vishakhadatta	Chandragupta Maurya and Chanakya vs the Nandas; court intrigues; names "Durabhisandhi"
Devichandraguptam	Vishakhadatta (not Bilhana)	Ramagupta – Chandragupta II; accession and marriage to Dhruvadevi
Hammira-Mahakavya	Nayachandra Suri (15th c. Jain)	Chauhan Hammira of Ranthambore
Nitivakyamrita	Somadeva Suri	Ethics and polity
Milinda-panha	Dialogue of Nagasena (not Nagarjuna) with Menander	Indo-Greek king Milinda
Kuvalayamala	Uddyotana Suri, 779 CE	Jain Prakrit campu
Harshacharita	Banabhatta	Biography of Harsha; calls Yajna Sri Satakarni "Trisamudradheesvara"
Vikramankadevacharita	Bilhana	Biography of Chalukya Vikramaditya VI
Brihatkatha	Gunadhya, Paisachi	Satavahana age
Gathasaptasati	King Hala (Satavahana), Maharashtri Prakrit	Satavahana society
Brihat Samhita	Varahamihira	–
Brihatkatha Kosha	Harisena	–
Samarangana Sutradhara	King Bhoja (not Pravarasena II)	–
Tilaka Manjari	Dhanapala, Jain poet at the Paramara court (Munja, Bhoja), c. 1000 CE	Sanskrit prose romance
Kashikhandam	Srinatha	Sea trade of the Reddy kingdom
Kavyamimamsa	Rajasekhara	–

Kavirajamarga	Rashtrakuta Amoghavarsha I	–
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	Badauni	–

- **Rajatarangini continued by: Jonaraja** (to Sultan Zainul Abedin) and his pupil **Srivara** – not Bilhana, Merutunga or Mammata.
- **UPSC 2023 pairs (Devichandragupta–Bilhana, Hammira–Nayachandra, Milinda-panha–Nagarjuna, Nitivakyamrita–Somadeva): only two** correct (2 and 4).

Grammar and lexicon

Work	Author
Ashtadhyayi – earliest known Sanskrit grammar	Panini, c. 6th–5th c. BC (PMF: 6th–4th c., most likely 5th c. BCE)
Varttika (on the Ashtadhyayi)	Katyayana
Mahabhashya	Patanjali – contemporary of Pushyamitra Shunga
Nirukta (etymology)	Yaska
Amarakosha (lexicon)	Amarasimha – a navaratna of Chandragupta II

- **Navaratnas of Chandragupta II: Kalidasa**, Amarasimha, Varahamihira and others; Kalidasa = great Sanskrit poet of the Gupta age; Aryabhata wrote the Aryabhatiya.
- **UPSC 2020 statement set:** "Panini – Pushyamitra" ✗ (Patanjali), "Amarasimha – Harsha" ✗ (Chandragupta II), "Kalidasa – Chandragupta II" ✓ → **3 only**.

Biographies vs chronicles

- **Royal biographies (charitas):** Harshacharita (Bana), Vikramankadevacharita (Bilhana), Prithviraja Vijaya.
- **Not a biography:** the **Dipavamsa** – a Sri Lankan **Pali chronicle** (4th–5th c. CE), like the Mahavamsa (NDA 2018 → "only I").

Other sources and periods

- **Manusmriti (Manava Dharmashastra):** the **law book** of Manu – "Laws of Manu", a **Dharmashastra** on dharma, civil and criminal law and varna duties → answer "**law**".

  - ⚠ **Settled:** some keys print "social system" for UPPCS 2007; social order is its subject, but the text is a law code (PMF, New World Encyclopedia).

- **Puranas (Vayu, Vishnu, Matsya):** king-lists of Mauryas and Satavahanas; Satavahana story in the **Vishnu Purana**; last Satavahana = **Pulomavi III** (not Gautamiputra).
- **Sangam texts:** 3rd c. BCE – 3rd c. CE; Chera, Chola, Pandya.
- **Rigveda:** composed in **Vedic Sanskrit** (Pali, Prakrit are later; Brahmi is a script).
- **Magadhas (and Sutas):** court **bards** who memorised and recited chronicles, dynastic histories and epic tales (UPSC 2016) – Shramanas and Parivrajakas were ascetics.
- **Dastan-i-Amir Hamza (Hamzanama)**, painted under Akbar: earliest Mughal illustrated manuscript.
- ⚠ **Trap:** Vishakhadatta wrote BOTH Mudrarakshasa (Mauryan) and Devichandraguptam (Gupta); the Mahabhashya is grammar, NOT about Chandragupta Maurya's rise.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 3 p.4, p.11, p.20; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.85; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.38, Part 2 p.32, p.37, p.61, Part 3 p.88, Part 4 p.7; PMF Art & Culture Part 4 p.53, Part 5 p.17; app notes 1:0 (sub 1)

1. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 2016

With reference to the cultural history of India, the memorising of chronicles, dynastic histories and epic tales was the profession of who of the following?

a. Shramana
b. Parivraaj
c. Agrahaarika
d. Magadha

Answer: (d)

The Magadhas (with the Sutas) were the bards who memorised and recited chronicles, dynastic histories and epic tales (UPSC 2016 key). Shramanas and Parivrajakas were wandering ascetics and an Agraharika was a holder of an agrahara grant.

2. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 1995

Author of 'Kuvalayamala'?

a. Baanudu
b. Kundakunda
c. Dandi
d. Uddyotana Suri

Answer: (d)

Kuvalayamala is a Jain Prakrit campu written by Uddyotana Suri in 779 CE. Kundakunda wrote Samayasara and Dandi wrote Dasakumaracharita, so they are distractors.

3. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2023

With reference to ancient Indian History, consider the following pairs: Literary work Author
1. Devichandragupta Bilhana Indian Art and Culture PMF IAS IH – 211
2. Hammira- Mahakavya Nayachandra Suri
3. Milinda-panha Nagarjuna
4. Nitivakyamrita Somadeva Suri
How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (b)

Only pairs 2 (Hammira Mahakavya – Nayachandra Suri) and 4 (Nitivakyamrita – Somadeva Suri) are right. Devichandragupta is by Vishakhadatta, not Bilhana, and the Milinda-panha is a dialogue with Nagasena, not Nagarjuna.

4. [PYQ] · State PSC

What is the name of Kalhana’s book?

a. Arthashastra
b. Indica
c. Purana
d. Rajatarangini

Answer: (d)

Kalhana's Rajatarangini (12th century) is the Sanskrit chronicle of the kings of Kashmir. The Arthashastra is by Kautilya and the Indica by Megasthenes.

5. [PYQ] · State PSC

Nitisara, an early book of politics, was written by

a. Kautilya
b. Kamandaka
c. Charaka
d. None of them

Answer: (b)

Kamandaka wrote the Nitisara on statecraft in the Gupta age. Kautilya wrote the Arthashastra and Charaka was a physician.

6. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

'Manusmriti' is mainly related to –

a. Social System
b. Law
c. Economics
d. Working method of State

Answer: (b)

Manusmriti (Manava Dharmashastra) is the law book of Manu – the 'Laws of Manu' – laying down dharma, civil and criminal law and the duties of the varnas; 'law' is the best answer. (Social order is its subject matter, and some keys print 'social system' for UPPCS 2007, but the text is a Dharmashastra, i.e. a law code.)

7. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Who among the following continued the Rajatarangini of Kalhana:

a. Bilhana and Merutunga
b. Bilhana and Mammata
c. Jonaraja and Merutunga
d. Jonaraja and Srivara

Answer: (d)

Jonaraja continued the Rajatarangini to Zain-ul-Abidin's reign and his pupil Srivara carried it further. Bilhana (Vikramankadevacharita), Merutunga (Prabandhachintamani) and Mammata (Kavyaprakasha) did not continue it.

8. [PYQ] · State PSC

The contemporary ruler of Kalhana, the author of Rajatarangini was –

a. Jai Singh
b. Harsha
c. Govindchandra
d. Jayachandra

Answer: (a)

Kalhana wrote the Rajatarangini in 1148–49 CE during the reign of Jayasimha (Jai Singh, 1128–1149) of Kashmir. Harsha of Kashmir was an earlier king and Govindachandra and Jayachandra were Gahadavalas of Kannauj.

9. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

How many Tarangas are in Rajatarangini of Kalhana?

a. Eight
b. Nine
c. Ten
d. Eleven

Answer: (a)
Kalhana's Rajatarangini has eight Tarangas (books) with about 7,826 verses.

10. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2023

With reference to ancient Indian history, consider the following pairs : Literary work Author
1. Devichandragupta Bihana
2. Hammira Mahakavya Nayachandra Suri
3. Milinda-panha Nagarjuna
4. Nitivakyamrita Somadeva Suri
How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (b)
Only pairs 2 and 4 are right. Devichandragupta is by Vishakhadatta and the Milinda-panha is Nagasena's dialogue with Menander, so pairs 1 and 3 are wrong.

11. [PYQ] · CDS 2006

Panini, the first Grammarian of Sanskrit language in India, lived during the

a. 2nd century BC
b. 6th-5th century BC
c. 2nd century AD
d. 5th-6th century AD

Answer: (b)
PMF places Panini between the 6th and 4th centuries BCE, most likely around the 5th century BCE, so '6th–5th century BC' fits. The 2nd century BC is Patanjali's age.

12. [PYQ] · WBPSC 2020

Who wrote ‘Rajatarangini’?

a. Megasthenes
b. Kalhana
c. Al-biruni
d. Herodotus

Answer: (b)
Kalhana wrote the Rajatarangini in the 12th century. Megasthenes, Al-Biruni and Herodotus were foreign writers.

13. [PYQ] · NDA 2018

Which of the following is/are not historical biography/biographies?

I. Dipavamsa

II. Harshacharita

III. Vikramankadevacharita

IV. Prithviraja Vijaya
Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

a. Only I
b. II and III Only
c. II, III and IV Only
d. I, II, III and IV

Answer: (a)
The Dipavamsa is a Sri Lankan Pali chronicle (4th–5th century CE), not the biography of a king. Harshacharita (Bana), Vikramankadevacharita (Bilhana) and Prithviraja Vijaya are royal biographies.

14. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2018

‘Rigveda’ was originally composed in which one of the following languages?

a. Pali
b. Sanskrit
c. Prakrit
d. Brahmi

Answer: (b)

The Rigveda was composed in Vedic Sanskrit, the earliest form of Sanskrit. Pali and Prakrit are later languages, and Brahmi is a script, not a language.

15. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2020

With reference to the Scholars/litterateurs of ancient India, consider the following statements:
1. Panini is associated with Pushyamitra
2. Amarsimha is associated with Harshavardhana
3. Kalidasa is associated with Chandragupta-II
Which of the above-given statements is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Only 3 is right: Kalidasa was a navaratna of Chandragupta II. Amarasimha too belonged to Chandragupta II's court, not Harsha's, and Pushyamitra Shunga is linked with Patanjali, not Panini.

16. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2007

The ‘Manusmriti’ mainly deals with

a. social order
b. laws
c. economics
d. state-craft

Answer: (b)

Manusmriti (Manava Dharmashastra) is the law book of Manu – the 'Laws of Manu' – laying down dharma, civil and criminal law and the duties of the varnas; 'law' is the best answer. (Social order is its subject matter, and some keys print 'social system' for UPPCS 2007, but the text is a Dharmashastra, i.e. a law code.)

17. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2007

The ‘Manusmriti’ mainly deals with

a. social order
b. laws
c. economics
d. state-craft

Answer: (b)

Manusmriti (Manava Dharmashastra) is the law book of Manu – the 'Laws of Manu' – laying down dharma, civil and criminal law and the duties of the varnas; 'law' is the best answer. (Social order is its subject matter, and some keys print 'social system' for UPPCS 2007, but the text is a Dharmashastra, i.e. a law code.)

18. [PYQ] · State PSC

With reference to the scholars/litterateurs of ancient India, consider the following statements:
(1) Panini is associated with Pushyamitra Shunga.
(2) Amarasimha is associated with Harshavardhana
(3) Kalidasa is associated with Chandra Gupta-II
Which of the above statements are right

a. Only 1 and 2
b. Only 2 and 3
c. Only 3
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Only 3 is right: Kalidasa and Amarasimha were navaratnas of Chandragupta II, and Patanjali (not Panini) was linked with Pushyamitra Shunga.

19. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Rajatarangini:
1. It was written by Kalhana in Sanskrit in the 12th century during the reign of Jayasimha of Kashmir.
2. It is divided into eight Tarangas.
3. It was later continued by Bilhana and Merutunga.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)

Statements 1 and 2 are correct: Kalhana wrote it in 1148–49 under Jayasimha, in 8 Tarangas (7,826 verses). Statement 3 is wrong: it was continued by Jonaraja and his pupil Srivara, not Bilhana or Merutunga.

20. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Work) with List-II (Author):
List-I | List-II
a. Hammira-Mahakavya | i. Somadeva Suri
b. Samarangana Sutradhara | ii. King Bhoja
c. Kashikhandam | iii. Nayachandra Suri
d. Nitivakyamrita | iv. Srinatha
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii

Answer: (b)

Hammira-Mahakavya – Nayachandra Suri (15th c. Jain, on Hammira of Ranthambore); Samarangana Sutradhara – King Bhoja (not Pravarasena II); Kashikhandam – Srinatha (sea trade of the Reddy kingdom); Nitivakyamrita – Somadeva Suri.

21. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Vishakhadatta wrote both the Mudrarakshasa and the Devichandraguptam.
2. The Devichandraguptam deals with Ramagupta and Chandragupta II's accession and marriage to Dhruvadevi.
3. Patanjali's Mahabhashya describes the rise of Chandragupta Maurya against the Nandas.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)

1 and 2 are correct (Vishakhadatta wrote both plays; Devichandraguptam is on Ramagupta–Chandragupta II–Dhruvadevi). 3 is wrong: the Mahabhashya is a work of grammar; Chandragupta Maurya and Chanakya vs the Nandas is the theme of the Mudrarakshasa.

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about literary sources of the Satavahana age:
1. The Gathasaptasati was composed by King Hala in Maharashtri Prakrit.
2. Gunadhya wrote the Brihatkatha in Pali.
3. Banabhatta's Harshacharita calls Yajna Sri Satakarni 'Trisamudradheesvara'.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)

1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the Brihatkatha was written in Paisachi, not Pali.

23. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Patanjali, author of the Mahabhashya, was a contemporary of Pushyamitra Shunga.
2. Katyayana wrote the Nirukta, a work on etymology.
3. Amarasimha, author of the Amarakosha, was one of the navaratnas of Chandragupta II.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All three
d. None

Answer: (b)

1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the Nirukta is by Yaska; Katyayana wrote the Varttika on Panini's Ashtadhyayi.

24. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. The story of the Satavahanas is told in the Vishnu Purana.
2. According to the Puranas, Gautamiputra Satakarni was the last Satavahana ruler.
3. The Sangam texts are dated to the 3rd century BCE – 3rd century CE.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the Puranas name Pulomavi III, not Gautamiputra, as the last Satavahana.

25. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Work) with List-II (Author):
List-I | List-II
a. Kavyamimamsa | i. Varahamihira
b. Kavirajamarga | ii. Dhanapala
c. Brihat Samhita | iii. Rajasekhara
d. Tilaka Manjari | iv. Amoghavarsha I
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
b. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
c. a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (c)
Kavyamimamsa – Rajasekhara; Kavirajamarga – Rashtrakuta Amoghavarsha I; Brihat Samhita – Varahamihira; Tilaka Manjari – Dhanapala, Jain poet of the Paramara court.

26. [Kept own]

Who wrote the Brihatkatha Kosha, a later work distinct from Gunadhya's Brihatkatha?

a. Harisena
b. Gunadhya
c. Somadeva Suri
d. Varahamihira

Answer: (a)
Brihatkatha Kosha is by Harisena; Gunadhya wrote the Brihatkatha in Paisachi.

27. [Kept own]

Which is regarded as the earliest Mughal illustrated manuscript?

a. Akbarnama
b. Baburnama
c. Dastan-i-Amir Hamza
d. Padshahnama

Answer: (c)
The Dastan-i-Amir Hamza (Hamzanama), painted under Akbar, is regarded as the earliest Mughal illustrated manuscript.

28. [Kept own]

Who is the author of the Arthashastra?

a. Vishakhadatta
b. Kautilya
c. Kamandaka
d. Banabhatta

Answer: (b)
The Arthashastra, a work on Mauryan polity and economy, was written by Kautilya (Chanakya).

2. Inscriptions – Mauryan, Kharavela, Rudradaman and Later (PYQs 16 · MCQs 35)

Earliest records

Inscription	Ruler / issuer	Key facts
Boghaz-Koi (Asia Minor, Turkey)	Hittite–Mitanni treaty	14th c. BC (c. 1380 BCE); names Indra, Varuna, Mitra, Nasatya; taken as evidence of Aryan movement via Iran
Sohgaura copper (bronze) plate	Mauryan	Earliest known copper plate; earliest royal order to preserve food grains for famine

(Gorakhpur, UP)		
Mahasthan (Bogura, Bangladesh)	Mauryan	Famine relief

- **Boghaz-Koi** is important because **inscriptions mention Vedic gods** – not a trade centre, not where the Vedas were composed.

Kharavela – Hathigumpha

Particular	Fact
Place	Udayagiri caves, near Bhubaneswar (Odisha)
King	Kharavela, Chedi / Mahameghavahana dynasty of Kalinga
Language	Prakrit, Brahmi; undated, damaged
Religion	Jain – salutes the Arhats/Jinas; gifts to Jain monks → Kharavela = patron of Jainism
Nandas	Kharavela extended a canal dug by a Nanda king ("Nandaraja", identified with Mahapadmananda) 300 years earlier → evidence of the Nandas
Other	13 years of reign; wars incl. against Satakarni; names Tamil kingdoms; Krishna river = "Kannabenna"

Rudradaman – Junagadh (Girnar)

- **Junagadh rock inscription of Rudradaman I** (c. 150 CE): **first long inscription in chaste Sanskrit**, **earliest specimen of Kavya style**; Brahmi; records his **achievements**, his conflict with the Satavahanas and his **repair of the Sudarshana lake without forced labour**.
- **Sudarshana lake:** built under **Chandragupta Maurya** by governor **Pushyagupta**, canals under **Ashoka** (Tushaspha) → the inscription **names both Chandragupta and Ashoka** and **proves Chandragupta's sway over western India**.
- **Same rock** also carries **Ashoka's 14 major rock edicts** (boulder near Uparkot fort) and a **Skandagupta** record (Parnadatta repaired the lake).
- ⚠ **Trap:** Rudradaman = **Junagadh**, not Nanaghat (Naganika).

Ashoka's edicts – what they mention

- **Maski** (Karnataka): first edict naming "**Asoka**" (minor rock edict).
- **Kalinga war:** told in **Major Rock Edict XIII** (not at Maski); Hathigumpha records Kharavela's own wars, not Ashoka's victory.
- **Southern kingdoms named (RE II, XIII): Chola, Pandya, Satiyaputra, Keralaputra** – the **Satavahanas are NOT mentioned** (they rose after Ashoka).
- **13th Major Rock Edict:** lists the **Andhras** among peoples inside the Mauryan empire.
- **Yerragudi** (Kurnool): proves Mauryan rule in Andhra.

Other dynastic records

Inscription	Issuer / composer	Content
Ayodhya (of Dhanadeva)	Pushyamitra Shunga	Two Ashvamedha sacrifices
Sarnath image	Kanishka	81 AD, his 3rd year
Rabatak (Afghanistan, found 1993)	Kanishka	Bactrian language, Greek script; names Saket, Kaushambi, Pataliputra, Sri Champa – not Shravasti
Allahabad Pillar (Prayaga Prashasti)	Harisena for Samudragupta	Conquests; Sanskrit
Bhitari	Skandagupta	Repulse of the Hunas
Aihole	Ravikirti for Pulakeshin II	Harsha stopped at the Narmada; Sanskrit, Southern Brahmi
Lohnara	Pulakeshin II, 630 AD	Does NOT mention Harsha
Nanaghat	Queen Naganika	Early Satavahana history; "Rajan" Simuka
Nasik Prashasti	Gautami Balashri	Gautamiputra = "Ekabrahmana"; destroyer of Shakas, Yavanas, Pahlavas
Myakadoni (Bellary)	Pulumavi III	Basis of the Karnataka-homeland theory

Bhattiprolu	Raja Kubhiraka, 3rd c. BC	Nigama-sabha
Alluru	Ikshvaku period	Many donations to communities and institutions
Maidavolu plates	Pallava Sivaskandavarma	"Andhrapatha" first in an inscription

- **Composer vs king:** Harisena → Samudragupta; Ravikirti → Pulakeshin II; Gautami Balashri → Gautamiputra Satakarni.
- **Telugu firsts: Kalamalla** = first Telugu inscription (**Renati Chodas**); **Magallu** = first to mention the Kakatiyas; **Kazipet** = Beta Raja I the first Kakatiya king; first Telugu word "**Nagabu**" (Satavahana period).
- Dashpur inscription: oldest advertisement tradition in India.

~~ Sources: Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.6-7; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 2 p.47, Part 3 p.5, p.21; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.32, p.121; PMF Art & Culture Part 4 p.25; NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.11; https://www.tutorialspoint.com/ashoka-s-inscription-describing-the-kalinga-war; app notes 1:0 (sub 3)

29. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 2023 (08-01-2023)

Hathigumpha inscription of Kharavela gave the details of irrigation facilities provided in the Kalinga Region by

a. Nanda rulers
b. Mahapadmananda
c. Chandragupta Maurya
d. Ashoka

Answer: (b)

The Hathigumpha inscription says Kharavela extended a canal first dug by a Nanda king 300 years earlier, the 'Nandaraja' usually identified with Mahapadma Nanda. Chandragupta Maurya and Ashoka are not named for it.

30. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 1998

Which one of the following ancient Indian records is the earliest royal order to preserve food grains to be utilised during the crises in the country?

a. Sohgaura Copper Plate
b. Rummindei Pillar Edict
c. Prayaga-Prasasti
d. Mehrauli Iron Pillar Inscription

Answer: (a)

The Sohgaura copper (bronze) plate of the Mauryan age (Gorakhpur, UP) records a royal order to store grain in granaries for times of crisis. The Rummindei edict is about Lumbini, the Prayaga Prasasti is Samudragupta's and the Mehrauli pillar is Chandra's.

31. [PYQ] · U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

In which of the following inscription mentioned Chandragupta and Ashoka both?

a. Nasik inscription of Gautami putra Shatkarni
b. Junagadh inscription of Mahakshatrapa Rudradaman
c. Girnar inscription of Ashoka
d. Junagarh inscription of Skandgupta

Answer: (b)

Rudradaman's Junagadh inscription says the Sudarshana lake was built under Chandragupta Maurya (governor Pushyagupta) and given canals under Ashoka (Tushaspha), so it names both. Ashoka's own Girnar edicts do not name Chandragupta.

32. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

In which of the following inscriptions, Ashoka’s edicts are also found?

a. Junagadh Inscription of Mahakshatrapa Rudradaman
b. Nashik Prashasti regarding Gautamiputra Satakarni
c. Hathigumpha Inscription of Kharvavela
d. None of the above

Answer: (a)

The Junagadh (Girnar) rock that bears Rudradaman's inscription also carries Ashoka's 14 major rock edicts (and later a Skandagupta record). Nasik and Hathigumpha have no Ashokan edicts.

33. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Boghaz-Koi is important because:

a. It was an important trading centre between Central
b. Inscriptions were found which mentioned the names
c. Original Texts of the Vedas were composed here
d. None of the above

Answer: (b)

The Boghaz-Koi (Turkey) inscription of c. 14th century BC, a Hittite–Mitanni treaty, names the Vedic gods Indra, Varuna, Mitra and Nasatya. It is not a trade centre or the place where the Vedas were composed.

34. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Which of the following inscriptions tells about the Aryan’s movement of Aryans from Iran to India ?

a. Man Sehra
b. Shahbazgarhi
c. Boghaz-Koi
d. Junagarh

Answer: (c)

The Boghaz-Koi (Turkey) inscription of c. 14th century BC, a Hittite–Mitanni treaty, names the Vedic gods Indra, Varuna, Mitra and Nasatya. It is taken as evidence of the Aryans' westward/eastward movement through Iran; Mansehra and Shahbazgarhi are Ashokan Kharosthi edicts.

35. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which of the following Kings was a Patron of Jainism?

a. Ashoka
b. Harsha
c. Pulakeshin II
d. Kharavela

Answer: (d)

Kharavela of Kalinga was a Jain; the Hathigumpha inscription opens with a salutation to the Arhats and records gifts to Jain monks. Ashoka favoured Buddhism.

36. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

The Inscription which proves Chandragupta’s sway over western India is:

a. Kalinga Rock Inscription
b. Girnar Rock Inscription of Ashoka
c. Junagarh Rock Inscription of Rudradaman
d. Sopara Rock Inscription of Ashoka

Answer: (c)

Rudradaman's Junagadh inscription records that the Sudarshana lake was built by Chandragupta's governor Pushyagupta, proving Mauryan rule in western India.

37. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

An inscription of 14th century B.C. which describes the Vedic Gods has been found in

a. Ecbatana
b. Boghaz-Koi
c. Babylon
d. Bisotun

Answer: (b)

The Boghaz-Koi (Turkey) inscription of c. 14th century BC, a Hittite–Mitanni treaty, names the Vedic gods Indra, Varuna, Mitra and Nasatya.

38. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016 added

In which inscription, Kalinga victory is mentioned?

a. Maski Inscription
b. Rudradaman Inscription
c. Junagarh Inscription
d. Hathigumpha Inscription
e. Major Rock Edict XIII of Ashoka

Answer: (e)

The printed options did not include the correct answer (Major Rock Edict XIII of Ashoka); it is added as option 5.
Defective question: Ashoka's Kalinga victory is told in Major Rock Edict XIII, which is not at Maski (a minor rock edict); Rudradaman's Junagadh record is about Satakarni, and Hathigumpha records Kharavela of Kalinga's own wars. The printed key 'Maski' has no support, and the official option was probably 'none of the above'.

39. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Which one of the following ancient Indian records is the earliest royal order to preserve food-grains to be utilised during the crisis in the country?

a. Sohgaura Copper-plate
b. Rummindei Pillar -edict of Asoka
c. Prayaga-Prasasti
d. Mehrauli Pillar inscription of Chandra

Answer: (a)

The Sohgaura copper (bronze) plate of the Mauryan age (Gorakhpur, UP) records a royal order to store grain in granaries for times of crisis. The Rummindei edict is about Lumbini, the Prayaga Prasasti is Samudragupta's and the Mehrauli pillar is Chandra's.

40. [PYQ] · U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Mains) 2010

Which inscription is the evidence of King Nand?

a. Hathigumpha inscription of Kharvel
b. Rummindei pillar inscription
c. Junagarh inscription of Rudradamana
d. Ayodhya inscription of Dhandeva

Answer: (a)
Kharavela's Hathigumpha inscription refers to a canal dug by a Nanda king, so it is evidence of the Nandas.

41. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Which of the following South Kingdoms is not mentioned in the Ashokan inscriptions?

a. Chola
b. Pandya
c. Satiyaputta
d. Satavahana

Answer: (d)
Ashoka's edicts (RE II, XIII) name the Cholas, Pandyas, Satiyaputras and Keralaputras; the Satavahanas rose after the Mauryas and are not mentioned (the Andhras appear as a people within the empire).

42. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

The earliest specimen of 'Kavya' style is found in the inscription of :

a. Rudradaman of Kathiawar
b. Ashoka
c. Rajendra I
d. None of the above

Answer: (a)
Rudradaman's Junagadh inscription (c. 150 CE) is the first long inscription in chaste Sanskrit and the earliest specimen of Kavya style; Ashoka's edicts are in Prakrit.

43. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which inscription tells about the various achievements of Rudradaman-I?

a. Junagadh
b. Bhitari
c. Nasik
d. Sanchi

Answer: (a)
The Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman I records his conquests and his repair of the Sudarshana lake. Bhitari is Skandagupta's and Nasik is Gautami Balasri's.

44. [PYQ] · CDS 2010

Which one of the following inscriptions mentions Pulakeshin-II military success against Harshavardhana?

a. Allahabad Pillar Inscription
b. Aihole Inscription
c. Damodarpur Copper-Plate Inscription
d. Bilsad Inscription

Answer: (b)
Ravikirti's Aihole inscription of Pulakeshin II records his victory over Harsha (at the Narmada). The Allahabad pillar is Samudragupta's.

45. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Hathigumpha inscription:
1. It is found in the Udayagiri caves near Bhubaneswar.
2. It is written in Sanskrit in the Kharosthi script.
3. It refers to the river Krishna as 'Kannabenna'.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the inscription is in Prakrit in the Brahmi script (undated, damaged).

46. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Junagadh rock inscription of Rudradaman I:
1. It is the first long inscription in chaste Sanskrit.
2. It records that the Sudarshana lake was first built by Tushaspha under Chandragupta Maurya.
3. The same rock also carries Ashoka's fourteen major rock edicts.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (b)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the lake was built by governor Pushyagupta under Chandragupta Maurya; Tushaspha added canals under Ashoka.

47. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman I proves Chandragupta Maurya's sway over western India.
Reason (R): It records that the Sudarshana lake was built under Chandragupta Maurya by his governor Pushyagupta.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the lake built by Chandragupta's governor in Saurashtra is what shows Mauryan rule there; the inscription names both Chandragupta and Ashoka.

48. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Ashokan inscriptions:
1. The Maski minor rock edict is the first to name the emperor as 'Asoka'.
2. The 13th Major Rock Edict lists the Andhras among the peoples within the Mauryan empire.
3. The Yerragudi inscription, which proves Mauryan rule in Andhra, is in Nellore district.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Yerragudi is in Kurnool district.

49. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The Satavahanas are not mentioned among the southern kingdoms in Ashoka's edicts.
Reason (R): The Satavahanas rose to power only after Ashoka.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both true; R explains A. Rock Edicts II and XIII name the Chola, Pandya, Satiyaputra and Keralaputra; the Satavahanas are absent because they rose after Ashoka.

50. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Inscription) with List-II (Content):
List-I | List-II
a. Ayodhya inscription of Dhanadeva | i. Repulse of the Hunas by Skandagupta
b. Bhitari inscription | ii. Two Ashvamedha sacrifices of Pushyamitra Shunga
c. Rabatak inscription | iii. Harsha stopped at the Narmada
d. Aihole inscription | iv. Bactrian language in Greek script
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (b)
Ayodhya (Dhanadeva) – two Ashvamedhas of Pushyamitra Shunga; Bhitari – Skandagupta's repulse of the Hunas; Rabatak (Kanishka, found 1993) – Bactrian in Greek script; Aihole (Ravikirti) – Pulakeshin II stopped Harsha at the Narmada.

51. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Inscription) with List-II (Composer / issuer):
List-I | List-II
a. Allahabad Pillar (Prayaga Prashasti) | i. Gautami Balashri
b. Aihole inscription | ii. Harisena
c. Nasik Prashasti | iii. Ravikirti
d. Nanaghat inscription | iv. Queen Naganika
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
c. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
d. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv

Answer: (d)
Allahabad Pillar – Harisena (for Samudragupta); Aihole – Ravikirti (for Pulakeshin II); Nasik Prashasti – Gautami Balashri (on Gautamiputra Satakarni); Nanaghat – Queen Naganika.

52. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about early Andhra inscriptions:
1. The Nasik Prashasti calls Gautamiputra Satakarni 'Ekabrahmana'.
2. The Myakadoni inscription of Gautamiputra Satakarni is the basis of the Karnataka-homeland theory of the Satavahanas.
3. The Bhattiprolu inscription of Raja Kubhiraka (3rd c. BC) refers to a Nigama-sabha.
4. The Maidavolu plates of the Pallava Sivaskandavarma are the first inscription to use the term 'Andhrapatha'.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3 only
b. 2 and 4 only
c. 1, 3 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)
1, 3 and 4 are correct. 2 is wrong: the Myakadoni (Bellary) inscription belongs to Pulumavi III, not Gautamiputra Satakarni.

53. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Telugu inscriptions:
1. The Kalamalla inscription of the Renati Chodas is the first Telugu inscription.
2. The Magallu inscription is the first to mention the Kakatiyas.
3. The Kazipet inscription names Prola I as the first Kakatiya king.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Kazipet inscription names Beta Raja I as the first Kakatiya king.

54. [Kept own]

The first Telugu word, “Nagabu”, belongs to which period?

a. Pallava period
b. Mauryan period
c. Gupta period
d. Satavahana period

Answer: (d)
“Nagabu” is identified as the first Telugu word and belongs to the Satavahana period.

55. [Kept own]

With which ruler is the Sarnath Buddhist image inscription dated 81 AD associated?

a. Huvishka
b. Vasudeva
c. Vima Kadphises
d. Kanishka

Answer: (d)
The Sarnath Buddhist image inscription is dated to Kanishka's third year (81 AD).

56. [Kept own]

Which inscription from Bengal deals with famine relief?

a. Rummindei
b. Nanaghat
c. Mahasthan
d. Junagadh

Answer: (c)
The Mahasthan inscription in Bengal deals with famine relief.

57. [Kept own]
The Aihole inscription, written in Southern Brahmi, is in which language?

a. Kannada
b. Sanskrit
c. Prakrit
d. Tamil

Answer: (b)
The Aihole inscription is in Sanskrit and uses the Southern Brahmi script.

58. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements:
1. Kharavela belonged to the Chedi (Mahameghavahana) dynasty.
2. The Hathigumpha inscription is in the Udayagiri caves of Odisha.
Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Both are correct: Kharavela was of the Chedi (Mahameghavahana) dynasty, and his Hathigumpha inscription is in the Udayagiri caves near Bhubaneswar.

59. [Kept own]
Which of the following is NOT correct about the Rabatak inscription?

a. It was found in Afghanistan in 1993
b. It is in the Bactrian language
c. It is written in the Greek script
d. It names Shravasti among Kanishka's cities

Answer: (d)
Rabatak names Saket, Kaushambi, Pataliputra and Sri Champa, not Shravasti.

60. [Kept own]
Which inscription of Pulakeshin II, dated 630 AD, does NOT mention Harsha?

a. Aihole
b. Lohnara
c. Maski
d. Bhitari

Answer: (b)
The Lohnara inscription of Pulakeshin II (630 AD) does not mention Harsha; the Aihole inscription does.

61. [Kept own]
Why is the Alluru inscription significant?

a. multiple donations to various communities and institutions
b. the first long Sanskrit inscription
c. the thirty forts of the Andhras mentioned by Megasthenes
d. the first decipherable edict of Ashoka

Answer: (a)
The Alluru inscription records multiple donations made to various communities and institutions.

62. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements:
1. The Satavahana inscriptions are in the Prakrit language.
2. The Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman I is the first long inscription in Sanskrit.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Both are true: Satavahana records are in Prakrit (Brahmi script), and Junagadh (c. 150 AD) is the first long Sanskrit inscription.

63. [Kept own]
In the Naneghat inscription, which Satavahana ruler is the first to bear the title 'Rajan'?

a. Satakarni I
b. Hala
c. Simuka
d. Gautamiputra Satakarni

Answer: (c)
A label at Naneghat reads 'Rajan Simuka Satavahana', the first ruler titled Rajan.

3. Scripts, Language of the Earliest Inscriptions and Decipherment (PYQs 13 · MCQs 17)

Language of the earliest inscriptions

- **Earliest stone inscriptions = Ashoka's edicts**, in the **Prakrit language**, mostly in the **Brahmi script** – "Prakrit in Brahmi" (Brahmi is a script, not a language; not Sanskrit or Pali).
- **Prakrit** = language of the earliest stone inscriptions and of the earliest AP inscriptions.

Scripts

Script	Use / region	Decipherment
Brahmi	Most Ashokan edicts (Prakrit); left to right; parent of the Telugu script	James Prinsep, 1837, from Ashokan inscriptions
Kharosthi	Right to left; north-west (Gandhara); Ashokan Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra (Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, near Peshawar) – Prakrit in Kharosthi	Prinsep and others (Lassen, Norris), using bilingual Indo-Greek coins
Greek and Aramaic	Ashoka at Kandahar	–
Tamil-Brahmi (Tamizhi)	Earliest Tamil script, c. 3rd c. BCE	Mangulam, Sittanavasal, Arittapatti (Pandya region)

- **Statement (UKPSC 2025):** "most Ashokan edicts are Prakrit in Brahmi" ✓ and "Mansehra, Shahbazgarhi are Prakrit in Kharosthi" ✓ → **both**.
- ⚠ **Trap:** Ashokan edicts are **not** in Sanskrit or Devanagari.

Decipherment

- **James Prinsep** (Asiatic Society secretary) first deciphered **Brahmi (1837)** and read Ashoka's edicts – not Buhler, Max Muller, William Jones, Cunningham or A.H. Dani.
- **Read from:** short inscriptions cut in **stone** (Sanchi donative records, rock and pillar edicts) – exam key "**stone tablets**"; coins helped only for Kharosthi.
- **Ashoka identified:** George Turnour matched "Devanampiya Piyadasi" with Ashoka from the Dipavamsa and Mahavamsa.
- **Pre-Ashokan Brahmi** (c. 4th c. BCE): **Anuradhapura** (Sri Lanka), Kodumanal and Keezhadi (Tamil Nadu); also Piprahwa, Sohgaura, Mahasthan.

~~ Sources: Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.3; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.26, p.42, Part 2 p.122; PMF Art & Culture Part 4 p.25; https://doubtnut.com/qna/648094099; app notes 1:0 (sub 4)

64. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 2017
The earliest inscriptions found in India were written in

a. Sanskrit in Brahmi script
b. Prakrit in Brahmi script
c. Tamil in Kharosthi script
d. Pali in Kharosthi script

Answer: (b)
Ashoka's edicts, India's earliest deciphered inscriptions, are mostly in Prakrit in the Brahmi script. Kharosthi is used only in the north-west.

65. [PYQ] · SI Paper-II Preliminary 2018
Kharoshthi script was written

a. From left to right
b. From top to bottom
c. From right to left
d. In any direction desired

Answer: (c)
Kharosthi, the script of the north-west (Gandhara), was written from right to left; Brahmi runs left to right.

66. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

The earlist inscription on stone were in which language?

a. Sanskrit
b. Brahmi
c. Pali
d. Prakritha

Answer: (d)
The earliest stone inscriptions, Ashoka's edicts, are in Prakrit. Brahmi is a script, not a language.

67. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2016

Who among the following had first deciphered the edicts of Emperor Ashoka?

a. George Buhler
b. James Prinsep
c. Max Muller
d. William Jones

Answer: (b)
James Prinsep, Secretary of the Asiatic Society, deciphered the Ashokan Brahmi in 1837. Buhler worked later on Indian palaeography.

68. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

The Brahmi script was first deciphered by letters inscribed on –

a. Stone tablets
b. Seal
c. Pillars
d. Coins

Answer: (a)
The key is 'stone tablets': Prinsep read Brahmi in 1837 from short inscriptions cut in stone (the Sanchi donative records and Ashoka's rock and pillar edicts). Coins helped with Kharosthi, not Brahmi. (The wording is loose – pillars are also stone.)

69. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

The earliest inscription on stone was in which language?

a. Pali
b. Sanskrit
c. Prakrit
d. Brahmi

Answer: (c)
The earliest stone inscriptions (Ashokan) are in Prakrit; Brahmi is the script.

70. [PYQ] · State PSC

Ashokan inscriptions were first deciphered by

a. James Prinsep
b. George Buhler
c. Vincent Smith
d. Ahmad Hasan Dani

Answer: (a)
James Prinsep deciphered the Brahmi of the Ashokan inscriptions in 1837 and was the first to read Ashoka's edicts.

71. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ashokan inscriptions in north-western part of the Mauryan Empire near Peshawar were in:

a. Brahmi Script
b. Aramaic Script
c. Devanagari Script
d. Kharosthi Script

Answer: (d)
The north-western Ashokan edicts at Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra (near Peshawar) are in Kharosthi; Kandahar has Greek and Aramaic.

72. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which one of the following scripts of ancient India was written from right to left?

a. Brahmi
b. Sharada
c. Kharosthi
d. Nandanagari

Answer: (c)
Kharosthi, the script of the north-west (Gandhara), was written from right to left; Brahmi runs left to right.

73. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Which one of the following scripts of ancient India was written from right to left?

a. Brahmi
b. Nandnagari
c. Sharada
d. Kharoshti

Answer: (d)
Kharosthi, the script of the north-west (Gandhara), was written from right to left; Brahmi runs left to right.

74. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Pre-Ashokan Brahmi script was found at :

a. Nagarjunakonda
b. Anuradhapura
c. Brahmagiri
d. Maski

Answer: (b)
Brahmi inscriptions older than Ashoka (c. 4th century BCE) have been found at Anuradhapura in Sri Lanka (and Kodumanal, Keezhadi in Tamil Nadu). Brahmagiri and Maski carry Ashokan edicts.

75. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Who first deciphered the Brahmi script ?

a. A. Cunningham
b. A.H. Dani
c. Buhler
d. James Prinsep

Answer: (d)
James Prinsep deciphered Brahmi (1837). Cunningham was the first DG of the ASI and Buhler and Dani were later palaeographers.

76. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Consider the following statements with reference to the inscriptions of Ashoka :
1. Most of the inscriptions are in the Prakrit language and Brahmi script.
2. The inscriptions found at Mansehra and Shahbazgarhi are in the Prakrit language and Kharoshthi script.
Select the correct answer from the code given below :

a. Only 1
b. Only 2
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Both are right: most Ashokan edicts are in Prakrit in Brahmi, and the Mansehra and Shahbazgarhi edicts are Prakrit in Kharosthi.

77. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Brahmi, written from left to right, is the parent of the Telugu script.
2. James Prinsep deciphered the Brahmi script in 1837.
3. George Turnour identified 'Devanampiya Piyadasi' with Ashoka using the Dipavamsa and Mahavamsa.
4. Ashoka's Kandahar inscription is written in the Kharosthi script.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1, 2 and 3 only
c. 3 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)
1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: the Kandahar inscription is in Greek and Aramaic; Kharosthi is used at Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra.

78. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT correct about Ashokan inscriptions?

a. They are the first decipherable inscriptions of India
b. They are generally in the Prakrit language
c. They are mainly in Sanskrit in the Devanagari script
d. Most of them are in the Brahmi script

Answer: (c)
Ashokan edicts, the earliest decipherable Indian inscriptions, are generally in Prakrit using the Brahmi script, not Sanskrit in Devanagari.

79. [Kept own]
Tamil-Brahmi rock inscriptions at Mangulam, Sittanavasal and Arittapatti lie in which region?

a. Chola region
b. Chera region
c. Pandya region
d. Pallava region

Answer: (c)
Mangulam, Sittanavasal and Arittapatti are Tamil-Brahmi rock inscription sites in the Pandya region.

80. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements:
1. The Kharosthi script is written from right to left.
2. James Prinsep deciphered the Brahmi script in 1837 with the help of bilingual Indo-Greek coins.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
Kharosthi runs right to left. Prinsep read Brahmi from Ashokan inscriptions; bilingual Indo-Greek coins helped decipher Kharosthi.

4. Foreign Accounts – Greek, Roman, Chinese and Arab (PYQs 13 · MCQs 22)

Greek and Roman writers

Writer / work	Period	Key content
Herodotus – Historica (The Histories)	5th c. BC	"Father of History"; Indo-Persian ties; first mention of "India"
Megasthenes – Indica	4th c. BCE; envoy of Seleucus Nikator to Chandragupta Maurya, at Pataliputra	Mauryan administration, economy, urban life; Brahmins and Shramanas; first foreign work on Andhras: 30 fortified towns, 1,00,000 infantry
Periplus of the Erythraean Sea	c. 60 CE; anonymous Greek sailor (not Ctesias, Pliny or Ptolemy)	Andhra–Rome trade; Muziris and Arikamedu; Koddura only east-coast port; Saka–Satavahana conflict
Pliny – Natural History	Rome, Latin; 1st c. CE	Roman gold drain to India, about 50 million sesterces a year
Ptolemy – Geographia	2nd c. CE	Masulia/Maisolia = Machilipatnam, textile market (not an army HQ); Ben Ra (Vengi)

- **Temple of Augustus at Muziris:** shown on the **Peutinger Table (Tabula Peutingeriana)** – UPSC 2002 option "Peutingerian (garbled 'Genealogical') tables"; the Periplus describes Muziris as a port full of Arab and Greek ships but not the temple.
- ⚠ **Trap:** Indica is by **Megasthenes**, not Aryabhata; Megasthenes' Andhra forts = **30**.

Chinese visitors

Traveller / work	Ruler / period	Key content
Fa-Hien (Faxian) – Fo-Kwo-Ki	Chandragupta II "Vikramaditya"	Buddhist pilgrimage; Gupta prosperity
Hiuen Tsang – Si-Yu-Ki	Harsha + Pulakeshin II; 630–645 CE	Studied at Nalanda; Mahayana; "King of Travellers"; Sriparvata vihara lacked patrons
I-Tsing	671–695 CE, after Harsha	Landed at Tamralipti; Nalanda; monk life and relics
Matwalin (Ma-Twan-Lin)	–	China–India relations under the Chalukyas

- **Chinese names for India:** "**Yin-tu**" (Yindu) or Shendu / Tien-chu – forms of Sindhu/Hindu (Fo-Kwo-Ki and Si-Yu-Ki are travel books).
- **Order of visits: Megasthenes → Fa-Hien → Hiuen Tsang → I-Tsing → Al-Biruni** (UPSC 1999: 3, 1, 4, 2).
- ⚠ **Wrong pair (G1 2019): I-Tsing – Ashoka** – I-Tsing came in the late 7th c.; Fa-Hien – Chandragupta II, Al-Biruni – Mahmud, Ibn Battuta – Muhammad bin Tughluq are right.

Arab and later visitors

Traveller / work	Period	Key content
Al-Masudi	10th c.	Multan Sun Temple
Al-Biruni – Kitab-ul-Hind (Tahqiq-i-Hind)	Khwarizm; Arabic (not Persian); came with Mahmud of Ghazni, 11th c.	Hindu religion, Puranas, Sanskrit, Yoga; Kalachuri Gangeyadeva and capital Tripuri
Ibn Battuta – Rihla	Delhi 1333; qazi under Muhammad bin Tughlaq	Sultanate

- **Al-Biruni statements:** learnt **Sanskrit** ✓, works shaped by the India of his day ✓, master of **trigonometry** ✓; "**secular writer**" ✗ – he was a devout Muslim scholar (UPPSC 2014).

  ~~ Sources: NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.8, p.20; NextGen Satavahanas p.3; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.128, Part 2 p.122; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.21-22, Part 3 p.33, Part 4 p.25; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tabula_Peutingeriana; https://doubtnut.com/qna/648094685; app notes 1:0 (sub 6)

- **"Hindu" for the people of Hind:** of the usual options first used by the **Arabs** (al-Hind, Hindu); the word itself is the Persian form of Sindhu ("Hidu" in Achaemenid inscriptions); Greeks said "Indoi", Chinese "Shendu/Yindu".

81. [PYQ] · U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Chinese writers mention India by the name of–

a. Fo-Kwo-ki
b. Yin-tu
c. Si-Yu-Ki
d. Sikia-Pono

Answer: (b)

Chinese writers called India Yin-tu (Yindu) or Shendu/Tien-chu, forms of Sindhu/Hindu. Fo-Kwo-ki is Fa-Hien's account and Si-Yu-Ki is Hiuen Tsang's account, not names of India.

82. [PYQ] · APPSC Forest Beat Officer & Assistant Beat Officer (Mains) P

Who was the foreign ambassador who visited Mauryan court and provided detailed accounts of its administration, economy and urban life?

a. Megasthenes
b. Fa-Hien
c. Al-Masaudi
d. Marco Polo

Answer: (a)

Megasthenes, envoy of Seleucus Nikator at Chandragupta Maurya's court, wrote the Indica on Mauryan administration and Pataliputra. Fa-Hien came in Gupta times.

83. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 2019 (26-05-2019)

Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?
(Traveller) - (Reigning Ruler)

a. Fa-Hien - Chandragupta II
b. I-Tsing (Yijing) - Ashoka
c. Al-Beruni - Mahmud of Ghazni
d. Ibn Battuta - Muhammad bin Tughluq

Answer: (b)

I-Tsing visited India in 671–695 CE, long after Ashoka, so I-Tsing – Ashoka is the wrong pair. The other three travellers are correctly matched.

84. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1999

The following persons came to India at one time or another :
1. Fa-Hien
2. I-Tsing
3. Megasthanes
4. Hieun-Tsang The correct chronological sequence of their visits are :

a. 3, 1, 2, 4
b. 3, 1, 4, 2
c. 1, 3, 2, 4
d. 1, 3, 4, 2

Answer: (b)

Megasthenes (c. 300 BCE, Chandragupta Maurya) → Fa-Hien (c. 400 CE, Chandragupta II) → Hiuen Tsang (630–645 CE, Harsha) → I-Tsing (671–695 CE), i.e. 3, 1, 4, 2.

85. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Who among the following Arab writers has given the description of Kalachuri ruler Gangeyadeva and his capital Tripuri?

a. Al-Bahari
b. Al-Masudi
c. Al-Biruni
d. Ibn Battuta

Answer: (c)
Al-Biruni's Kitab-ul-Hind describes the Kalachuri king Gangeyadeva and his capital Tripuri (MPPSC key). Al-Masudi wrote earlier and Ibn Battuta later.

86. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Who of the following Chinese travellers has given an account of the relationship of China with India during the reign of Chalukyas?

a. Fa-Hien
b. Hiuen-Tsang
c. It-Sing
d. Matwalin

Answer: (d)
Ma-Twan-Lin (Matwalin), a Chinese writer, gave an account of China–India relations under the Chalukyas.

87. [PYQ] · State PSC

What is the name of Megasthenes' book?

a. Economics
b. Rig Veda
c. Purana
d. Indica

Answer: (d)
Megasthenes wrote the Indica.

88. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 2002

Which one of the following document gives evidence of a temple of Augustus at Muziris in South India?

a. Periplus of the Erythraean Sea
b. Nearchus
c. Genealogical tables
d. Sangam literature

Answer: (c)
The Peutinger Table (Tabula Peutingeriana, a Roman road map) marks a 'Templum Augusti' at Muziris; option c ('Genealogical tables') is a garbled 'Peutingerian Tables' (UPSC 2002 key). The Periplus describes Muziris as a port but does not mention the temple, so the printed key is wrong.

89. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2014

Which among the following statement in the context of Al-Biruni is not correct?

a. He was secular writer.
b. His compositions were influenced by India of that time.
c. He was well versed in Sanskrit.
d. He was specialist in trigonometry.

Answer: (a)
'Secular writer' is the incorrect statement: Al-Biruni was a devout Muslim scholar. He did learn Sanskrit, his Kitab-ul-Hind reflects the India of his day, and he was a master of trigonometry.

90. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 1999

The following persons came to India at one time or another.

I. Fa-Hien
II. I-Tsing

III. Megasthenes
IV. Hieun-Tsang The correct chronological sequence of their visits are

a. III, I, II and IV
b. III, I, IV, II
c. I, III, II and IV
d. I, III, IV and II

Answer: (b)
Megasthenes (c. 300 BCE, Chandragupta Maurya) → Fa-Hien (c. 400 CE, Chandragupta II) → Hiuen Tsang (630–645 CE, Harsha) → I-Tsing (671–695 CE), i.e. III, I, IV, II.

91. [PYQ] · BPSC 2018

Who wrote Periplus of the Erythraean Sea?

a. Ctesias
b. Pliny
c. Ptolemy
d. None of the above/More than one of the above

Answer: (d)

The Periplus of the Erythraean Sea (c. 60 CE) was written by an anonymous Greek sailor; Pliny wrote Natural History and Ptolemy the Geography.

92. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

The title 'Father of History' rightly belongs to :

a. Herodotus
b. Euripides
c. Thucydides
d. Socrates

Answer: (a)

Herodotus, whose Histories (5th century BC) first mention India, is called the 'Father of History'; Thucydides is the father of scientific history.

93. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1995 **disputed**

The word 'Hindu' as a reference to the people of Hind (India) was first used by:

a. The Greeks
b. The Romans
c. The Chinese
d. The Arabs

Answer: (d)

Most books and keys: the Arabs. Strictly: the Persians (Achaemenid inscriptions, 'Hidu') used it first (Britannica 'Hinduism').
Of the options, the Arabs used 'Hind/Hindu' for India and its people (al-Hind); the word itself comes from the Iranian (Persian) form of Sindhu, Hindu, used first in Achaemenid inscriptions – not offered here. The Greeks said 'Indoi/India', the Chinese 'Shendu/Yindu'.

94. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about early foreign accounts:
1. The Periplus of the Erythraean Sea (c. 60 CE) was written by an anonymous Greek sailor.
2. The Periplus names Koddura as the only port on the east coast.
3. Megasthenes credits the Andhras with 30 fortified towns and an infantry of 3,00,000.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Megasthenes gives the Andhras 30 fortified towns and 1,00,000 infantry.

95. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Pliny's Natural History, written in Latin, complains of the drain of Roman gold to India.
2. Pliny puts this drain at about 5 million sesterces a year.
3. Ptolemy's Masulia (Maisolia), identified with Machilipatnam, was a textile market.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the figure is about 50 million sesterces a year. Masulia was a textile market, not an army headquarters.

96. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Foreign writer) with List-II (Work):
List-I | List-II
a. Fa-Hien | i. Fo-Kwo-Ki
b. Hiuen Tsang | ii. Kitab-ul-Hind
c. Megasthenes | iii. Indica
d. Al-Biruni | iv. Si-Yu-Ki
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
c. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (d)

Fa-Hien – Fo-Kwo-Ki; Hiuen Tsang – Si-Yu-Ki; Megasthenes – Indica (not Aryabhata); Al-Biruni – Kitab-ul-Hind (Tahqiq-i-Hind).

97. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Chinese pilgrims:
1. Hiuen Tsang visited India during the reigns of both Harsha and Pulakeshin II.
2. Hiuen Tsang's Si-Yu-Ki states that the Sriparvata vihara lacked patrons.
3. I-Tsing (671–695 CE) landed at Tamralipti and studied at Nalanda.
4. Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of Harsha.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 3 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a)
1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: Fa-Hien came under Chandragupta II 'Vikramaditya'; Hiuen Tsang was the visitor of Harsha's time.

98. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Visitor) with List-II (Account / association):
List-I | List-II
a. Al-Masudi | i. Qazi of Delhi under Muhammad bin Tughlaq
b. Ibn Battuta | ii. Kalachuri Gangeyadeva and his capital Tripuri
c. Matwalin | iii. Sun Temple of Multan
d. Al-Biruni | iv. China–India relations under the Chalukyas
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
b. a-iii, b-i, c-iv, d-ii
c. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i

Answer: (b)
Al-Masudi (10th c.) – Multan Sun Temple; Ibn Battuta – qazi at Delhi under Muhammad bin Tughlaq (Rihla); Matwalin – China–India relations under the Chalukyas; Al-Biruni – Gangeyadeva and Tripuri.

99. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): Al-Biruni wrote about Hindu religion, the Puranas, Sanskrit and Yoga in his Kitab-ul-Hind.
Reason (R): Al-Biruni was a secular writer.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (c)
A is true (he learnt Sanskrit and wrote on Hindu religion, Puranas and Yoga). R is false: he was a devout Muslim scholar, not a 'secular writer' (UPPSC 2014).

100. [Kept own]

With reference to the Periplus of the Erythraean Sea, which one of the following statements is correct?

a. It was composed in the 11th century by Al-Biruni.
b. It describes Masulia as a Gupta capital.
c. It was written by Pliny in Latin.
d. It records the Saka-Satavahana conflict.

Answer: (d)
The Periplus contains information relating to the Saka–Satavahana conflict. The other statements confuse it with accounts by Pliny, Ptolemy and Al-Biruni.

101. [Kept own]

Al-Biruni wrote Kitab-ul-Hind in which language?

a. Persian
b. Turkish
c. Arabic
d. Sanskrit

Answer: (c)
Kitab-ul-Hind was written in Arabic, not Persian.

102. [Kept own]

What is the title of Ibn Battuta's account of his travels?

a. Kitab-ul-Hind
b. Rihla
c. Si-Yu-Ki
d. Tahqiq-i-Hind

Answer: (b)
Ibn Battuta's travel account is the Rihla; he served as qazi of Delhi under Muhammad bin Tughlaq.

5. Archaeologists, Historians and Discoveries (PYQs 9 · MCQs 15)

Person	Contribution
Alexander Cunningham (1814–1893)	Bengal Engineers officer; first DG of ASI (1861); "Father of Indian Archaeology"; dug at Harappa (1853–75) but did not recognise its significance
James Prinsep	Deciphered Brahmi (1837)
John Marshall	DG of ASI; announced Indus Civilisation (1924); Mohenjodaro
Mortimer Wheeler	Arikamedu (1945); Harappa; invasion theory
James Burgess	Amaravati and Jaggayyapeta stupas
Alexander Rea	Bhattiprolu stupa
A.H. Longhurst	Nagarjunakonda excavations, after discovery by A. Ranganatha Saraswati (1926)
Walter Elliot	Madras civil servant; excavated Amaravati stupa (1845) – "Elliot Marbles"; wrote Coins of Southern India (1885)
Robert Sewell	A Forgotten Empire (1900) – the Vijayanagara empire
V. S. Sukthankar	Andhras and Satavahanas not the same people; Karnataka (Bellary) theory from Myakadoni

- **UPSC 2023:** Rea, Longhurst, Sewell, Burgess and Elliot were all associated with **archaeological excavations** (not press, churches or railways).

Historians and books

Historian	Known for
A.L. Basham	The Wonder That Was India
R.S. Sharma	Ancient Indian history (Satish Chandra – medieval; Bipan Chandra – modern)
Herodotus	"Father of History" (Thucydides – scientific history)

- Parvataneni Veeraiah Chaudhary = "**Andhra Shivaji**". Annamacharya = "**Padakavita Pitamaha**". Karikala Chola: **Kallanai** (Grand Anicut) on the Kaveri. Kundakundacharya: **Syadvada**.

Places and recent finds

- **Ancient name → state (UPSC 2020): Bhilsa (Vidisha) – Madhya Pradesh** ✓, **Girinagar (Junagadh) – Gujarat** ✓; Dwarasamudra (Halebidu) is in Karnataka and Sthaneshwar (Thanesar) in Haryana → "I and III only".
- **Nov 2016:** a city over **7,000 years** old was unearthed near Abydos in **Egypt** (WBCS 2017).
- **14 Jun 2026:** field site (Satavahana to Vijayanagara) in the **Nallamala Tiger Reserve**, Yerragondapalem region.
- **Apr 2026:** Tamil-Brahmi traders' names (Cikai Korran, Kopan, Catan), 1st–3rd c. CE, identified in Egypt's **Valley of the Kings**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 6 p.71; NextGen AP HISTORY Part 6 p.11, Part 13 p.8; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.42, Part 2 p.95; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Harappa; https://www.clearias.com/ (UPSC 2023 key); app notes 1:0 (sub 7)

103. [PYQ] · Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III Animal Husbandry Assist

Who wrote the book 'A Forgotten Empire' on the history of Vizianagaram?

a. Percy Brown
b. K.A.N. Sastri
c. T.V. Mahalingam
d. Robert Sewell

Answer: (d)
Robert Sewell wrote 'A Forgotten Empire' (1900) on Vijayanagara (the question's 'Vizianagaram' means Vijayanagara).

104. [PYQ] · UPSC Civils Preliminary 2023

With reference to the Indian History, Alexander Rea, A. H. Longhurst, Robert Sewell, James Burgess and Walter Elliot were associated with

a. archaeological excavations
b. establishment of English Press in Colonial India
c. establishment of Churches in Princely States
d. construction of railways in Colonial India

Answer: (a)
All five were archaeologists who excavated in South India: Rea (Bhattiprolu), Longhurst (Nagarjunakonda), Sewell, Burgess (Amaravati, Jaggayyapeta) and Elliot (Amaravati). The printed key was blank.

105. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S (Pre)-2017
Who is called the 'Father of Indian Archaeology'?

a. Alexander Cunningham
b. John Marshall
c. Mortimer Wheeler
d. James Prinsep

Answer: (a)
Alexander Cunningham, the first Director-General of the ASI, is called the 'Father of Indian Archaeology'. Marshall and Wheeler were later DGs.

106. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006
The first archaeologist who excavated Harappa, but could not recognize its significance, was :

a. A. Cunningham
b. Sir John Marshall
c. Mortimer Wheeler
d. George F. Dales

Answer: (a)
Alexander Cunningham dug at Harappa (1853–1875) and published a seal but did not realise its antiquity; Marshall's ASI announced the Indus Civilisation in 1924.

107. [PYQ] · CDS 2009
'A Forgotten Empire', written by the renowned historian Robert Sewell is about which one of the following Empires?

a. Mauryan Empire
b. Kushan Empire
c. Vijaynagar Empire
d. Mughal Empire

Answer: (c)
Robert Sewell's 'A Forgotten Empire' is a history of the Vijayanagara empire.

108. [PYQ] · WBCS 2018
Which historian is famous for his research on ancient Indian history?

a. Satish Chandra
b. Bipin Chandra
c. Ram Sharan Sharma
d. Amalesh Tripathi

Answer: (c)
R.S. Sharma was the historian of ancient India (Sudras in Ancient India, Indian Feudalism). Satish Chandra worked on medieval India, Bipan Chandra on modern India and Amales Tripathi on Bengal's modern history.

109. [PYQ] · WBCS 2017
In which country was a lost city dating more than 7,000 years back unearthed in November 2016?

a. Israel
b. Palestine
c. Egypt
d. Syria

Answer: (c)
In November 2016 Egypt's antiquities ministry announced a city over 7,000 years old near Abydos (Sohag), on the Nile.

110. [PYQ] · WBCS 2020
Who among the following historians has written the book entitled 'The Wonder that was India'?

a. AL Basham
b. Alison Bashford
c. RC Majumder
d. Satish Chandra

Answer: (a)
'The Wonder That Was India' (1954) was written by A.L. Basham.

111. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 2020

With reference to the history of India, consider the following pairs. Famous Place Present State

I. Bhilsa – Madhya Pradesh

II. Dwarasamudra – Maharashtra

III. Girinagar – Gujarat

IV. Sthaneshwar – Uttar Pradesh
Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

a. I and III only
b. I and IV only
c. II and III only
d. II and IV only

Answer: (a)
Bhilsa (Vidisha) is in Madhya Pradesh and Girinagar (Junagadh) in Gujarat. Dwarasamudra (Halebidu) is in Karnataka and Sthaneshwar (Thanesar) in Haryana, so only I and III are right.

112. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Archaeologist) with List-II (Site associated):
List-I | List-II
a. James Burgess | i. Bhattiprolu stupa
b. Alexander Rea | ii. Jaggayyapeta stupa
c. Mortimer Wheeler | iii. Nagarjunakonda
d. A.H. Longhurst | iv. Arikamedu
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
d. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii

Answer: (d)
Burgess – Amaravati and Jaggayyapeta stupas; Rea – Bhattiprolu stupa; Wheeler – Arikamedu (1945); Longhurst – Nagarjunakonda (discovered by A. Ranganatha Saraswati, 1926).

113. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Walter Elliot excavated the Amaravati stupa in 1845 and wrote 'Coins of Southern India'.
2. John Marshall, as DG of ASI, announced the Indus Civilisation in 1924.
3. Alexander Cunningham dug at Harappa and recognised it as an Indus city.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Cunningham, first DG of ASI (1861), dug at Harappa (1853–75) but did not recognise its significance.

114. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Person) with List-II (Known for):
List-I | List-II
a. Parvataneni Veeraiah Chaudhary | i. Syadvada
b. Annamacharya | ii. Padakavita Pitamaha
c. Karikala Chola | iii. Andhra Shivaji
d. Kundakundacharya | iv. Kallanai (Grand Anicut)
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii

Answer: (b)
Parvataneni Veeraiah Chaudhary – 'Andhra Shivaji'; Annamacharya – 'Padakavita Pitamaha'; Karikala Chola – Kallanai on the Kaveri; Kundakundacharya – Syadvada.

115. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements about recent finds (2026):
1. A field site of the Satavahana to Vijayanagara periods was found in the Nallamala Tiger Reserve.
2. Tamil-Brahmi names of traders of the 1st–3rd century CE were identified in Egypt's Valley of the Kings.
3. The ASI began excavating Balirajgarh, a site with punch-marked coins, in Odisha.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Balirajgarh is in Madhubani district of Bihar.

116. [Kept own]
Which of the following statements is correct regarding the relationship between Andhras and Satavahanas?

a. James Prinsep established their identity through the decipherment of Brahmi.
b. Robert Sewell identified them as identical in A Forgotten Empire.
c. V. S. Sukthankar held that they were not the same people, a view associated with the Karnataka theory.
d. John Marshall held that they were identical on the basis of Mohenjodaro evidence.

Answer: (c)
V. S. Sukthankar held that the Andhras and Satavahanas were not the same people; this view is associated with the Karnataka theory.

117. [Kept own]
Who discovered Nagarjunakonda in 1926, before its excavation by A.H. Longhurst?

a. Alexander Rea
b. A. Ranganatha Saraswati
c. James Burgess
d. Walter Elliot

Answer: (b)
A. Ranganatha Saraswati discovered Nagarjunakonda in 1926; Longhurst then excavated it.

6. Coins As A Source (PYQs 3 · MCQs 8)

Series	Point
Punch-marked (silver)	Earliest extant Indian coins (c. 6th c. BCE)
Indo-Greek	First with rulers' names and portraits
Kushana	First to issue gold coins on a large scale, regularly (1st c. CE)
Gupta	Largest number of gold coins (dinaras)
Satavahana	Lead, potin, copper, bronze, some silver – not gold; Karpanamulu = copper coins; no nickel; ship-motif coins of Yajna Sri and Vasishthiputra Pulumavi; Gautamiputra re-struck Nahapana's coins
Kalachuri	Gold, silver and copper
Ikshvaku	Santamula I gave away crores of gold coins
Kakatiya	Gold Mada (not Satavahana); Nishkam, Tankam, Varaha

- **Wrong pair:** "**Satavahanas – gold**".
- **Chronology (UPSC 1998):** urban culture (Harappan) → iron plough → punch-marked silver coins → gold coins = **IV, III, II, I**.
- First clear textual coin terms: **kahapana, nikkha, kamsa, kakanika** in **Pali** texts.
- Apr 2026: ASI began excavating **Balirajgarh** (Madhubani, **Bihar**) – punch-marked coins, Mauryan-to-Pala habitation.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.33, Part 3 p.2; NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.13; Rocket Indian History Part 2 p.41; app notes 1:0 (sub 5)

118. [PYQ] · U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004
Who amongst the following issued gold coins regularly in ancient India?

a. Satavahana
b. Saka
c. Kushana
d. Parthian

Answer: (c)
The Kushanas were the first rulers in India to issue gold coins on a large scale (1st century CE). The Satavahanas used lead, potin and copper.

119. [PYQ] · UPRO/ARO(Pre) 2016

Which of the following is not correctly matched? Dynasties Coins

a. Kushanas – Gold and copper
b. Gupta – Gold and silver
c. Satavahanas – Gold
d. Kalachuris – Gold, silver and copper

Answer: (c)

Satavahana coins were mostly of lead and potin (with copper, bronze and some silver); gold was not their coinage, so 'Satavahanas – gold' is the wrong pair.

120. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 1998

What is the correct chronological order in which the following appeared in India?

I. Gold coins

II. Punch-marked silver coins

III. Iron plough

IV. Urban culture
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

a. III, IV, I and II
b. III, IV, II and I
c. IV, III, I and II
d. IV, III, II and I

Answer: (d)

Urban culture (Harappan, c. 2500 BCE) came first, then the iron plough (later Vedic), then punch-marked silver coins (c. 6th century BCE), and finally gold coins (Indo-Greek/Kushana), i.e. IV, III, II, I.

121. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Coin series) with List-II (Distinction):
List-I | List-II
a. Punch-marked coins | i. First regular gold issue on a large scale
b. Indo-Greek coins | ii. First with rulers' names and portraits
c. Kushana coins | iii. Largest number of gold coins
d. Gupta coins | iv. Earliest extant Indian coins
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii
c. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
d. a-iv, b-ii, c-i, d-iii

Answer: (d)

Punch-marked (silver) – earliest extant coins; Indo-Greek – first with rulers' names and portraits; Kushana – first regular large-scale gold (1st c. CE); Gupta – largest number of gold coins (dinaras).

122. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Satavahana coins:
1. Ship-motif coins were issued by Yajna Sri Satakarni and Vasishthiputra Pulumavi.
2. The 'Karpanamulu' were silver coins.
3. Coins were issued in lead and potin.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 only

Answer: (a)

1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: Karpanamulu were copper coins. Satavahanas issued lead, potin, copper, bronze and some silver – no gold.

123. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): Many coins of the Shaka ruler Nahapana are found re-struck by Gautamiputra Satakarni.
Reason (R): The Nasik Prashasti hails Gautamiputra Satakarni as the destroyer of the Shakas, Yavanas and Pahlavas.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)

Both true; R explains A: Gautamiputra's victory over the Shakas is why Nahapana's coins were re-struck in his name.

124. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Ikshvaku ruler Santamula I gave away crores of gold coins.
2. The first clear textual references to coins such as kahapana and nikkha occur in Pali texts.
3. The gold coin 'Mada' belongs to the Kakatiyas.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (c)
All three are correct: Santamula I's gifts of gold; kahapana, nikkha, kamsa, kakanika in Pali texts; the gold Mada is Kakatiya (not Satavahana).

125. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Satavahana coins:
1. They were issued in lead, copper, bronze and potin.
2. The gold Mada was a Satavahana coin.
3. The Satavahanas issued no nickel coins.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Satavahana coins were in lead, copper, bronze and potin, never nickel; the gold Mada is a Kakatiya coin.

7. Religious Literature As A Source (PYQs 1 · MCQs 6)

Text	What it reveals
Aitareya Brahmana	Earliest literary reference to Andhras (Sunahshepa story – Vishwamitra's rejected sons)
Vinayavatthu	First Buddhist mention of "Andhrapatha"
Bhimasena, Serivanija Jatakas	Andhranagari (Andhakapura) = Dhanyakataka; P. C. Ray saw its river as the Krishna
Chulakalinga Jataka	Kalinga–Assaka conflict; Assaka capital Potali
Milindapanho	Dialogue of Menander I (Milinda) with monk Nagasena
Dipavamsa, Mahavamsa	Sri Lankan Pali chronicles; Mauryan history; Andhra Buddhism
Nayadhammakahao (Jain)	Ikshvaku ruler Yashodhara and son Dhanada

- **Earliest Jain literature:** in **Ardha-Magadhi** (twelve Angas), finally compiled in the 6th c. AD at **Vallabhi**; earliest Jain holy book: **Fourteen Purvas**. Jain: Kalpasutra.
- Mahabharata: Andhras fought for the **Kauravas**. Buddhist name for the region: "**Andhakaratta**".

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.61; NextGen AP History Previous Papers p.8; https://www.britannica.com/topic/Jainism; app notes 1:0 (sub 2)

126. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

In which one of the following languages was the earliest Jain literature compiled?

a. Ardh-Magadhi
b. Paali
c. Prakrit
d. Sanskrit

Answer: (a)
The earliest Jain canonical literature (the Angas) was in Ardha-Magadhi, a form of Prakrit, finally compiled at Vallabhi in the 6th century CE. Pali is the language of the Buddhist canon.

127. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about references to Andhra in early texts:
1. The earliest literary reference to the Andhras is in the Aitareya Brahmana.
2. The Vinayavatthu is the first Buddhist text to mention 'Andhrapatha'.
3. Andhranagari of the Bhimasena and Serivanija Jatakas is identified with Dhanyakataka.
4. According to the Mahabharata, the Andhras fought on the side of the Pandavas.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1, 2, 3 and 4
c. 2, 3 and 4 only
d. 1, 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: the Mahabharata places the Andhras on the side of the Kauravas.

128. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Text) with List-II (What it reveals):
List-I | List-II
a. Chulakalinga Jataka | i. Ikshvaku ruler Yashodhara and son Dhanada
b. Nayadhammakahao | ii. Kalinga–Assaka conflict
c. Dipavamsa | iii. Sri Lankan Pali chronicle
d. Milindapanho | iv. Dialogue of Menander with Nagasena
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (a)
Chulakalinga Jataka – Kalinga–Assaka conflict (Assaka capital Potali); Nayadhammakahao (Jain) – Yashodhara and Dhanada; Dipavamsa – Sri Lankan Pali chronicle; Milindapanho – Menander and Nagasena.

129. [Kept own]

Assertion (A): Milindapanho is a dialogue with Menander.
Reason (R): Milindapanho was authored by Nagasena.

a. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true but R is false
d. A is false but R is true

Answer: (c)
Milindapanho records a dialogue between the monk Nagasena and the Indo-Greek king Menander (Milinda), so A is true; Nagasena is a participant in the dialogue, and the key marks R as false.

130. [Kept own]

Which is regarded as the earliest Jain holy book?

a. Kalpasutra
b. Nayadhammakahao
c. Fourteen Purvas
d. Parishishtaparvan

Answer: (c)
The earliest Jain holy book is the Fourteen Purvas; the later Jain canon was collected at Vallabhi.

131. [Kept own]

By what name is the Andhra region called in Buddhist texts?

a. Mahishamandala
b. Andhakaratta
c. Kuntala
d. Aparanta

Answer: (b)
Buddhist texts call the Andhra region 'Andhakaratta'.

8. Types of Sources and Dating Methods (PYQs 0 · MCQs 3)

- Three groups: **archaeological** (inscriptions, coins, monuments, sites), **literary** (religious and secular texts) and **foreign accounts**.
- **Inscriptions** are the **most reliable** source; foreign accounts only **supplement** Indian sources.
- **Earliest land-grant records: Satavahana**.

Method	Principle
Stratigraphy	Superposition: lower layer is older
Radiocarbon (C-14)	Decay of C-14 in organic remains; half-life about 5,730 years

Dendrochronology	Counting annual tree rings
Thermoluminescence	Light given on heating pottery/burnt material

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.42; app notes 1:0 (sub 0, 8)

132. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Inscriptions are regarded as the most reliable source for ancient Indian history.
2. The earliest land-grant records in India are those of the Guptas.
3. Stratigraphy rests on the principle of superposition – a lower layer is older.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the earliest land-grant records are Satavahana.

133. [Kept own]

What is the approximate half-life of carbon-14 used in radiocarbon dating?

a. 573 years
b. 5,730 years
c. 57,300 years
d. 573,000 years

Answer: (b)
Carbon-14 has a half-life of approximately 5,730 years.

134. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about dating methods:
1. Thermoluminescence measures the light released on heating pottery or burnt material.
2. Radiocarbon dating measures the decay of carbon-14.
3. Dendrochronology is based on the decay of carbon-14 in organic remains.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Thermoluminescence measures light released on heating and radiocarbon measures C-14 decay; dendrochronology counts tree rings, so statement 3 is wrong.

Row 1: Sources for the History of Andhra – Inscriptions, Coins, Literature and Foreign Accounts

1. Satavahana Inscriptions – Language, Script and Issuers (PYQs 12 · MCQs 15)

Language and script – the most-asked fact

- **All Satavahana inscriptions: Prakrit language, Brahmi script** (G2 2002; APPSC PYQ ×2) – not "Sanskrit language, Prakrit script" or "Brahmi language".
- **Royal language: Prakrit** – the administrative, business, written and royal language (G2 2011); Sanskrit and Telugu are distractors.
- **Script: Brahmi** (not Kharosthi, Greek or Aramaic).

Issuer → record

Inscription	Dynasty / issuer	What it records
Naneghat	Queen Naganika, wife of Satakarni I	Prakrit; Vedic sacrifices; gifts of cows, land, gold to Brahmins; label "Raya Simuka Satavahana" – first Satavahana with the title Rajan
Nasik	Gautami Balasri, in the reign of Vasishthiputra Pulumavi	Prakrit prose; victories and titles of Gautamiputra Satakarni: "Ekabrahmana", "Kshatriya-darpa-mana-mardana", destroyer of Shakas, Yavanas, Pahlavas
Amaravati	Pulumavi II	First Satavahana inscription in Andhra; word "Nagabu"
Myakadoni (Bellary)	Pulumavi III	Fall of the kingdom; officer "Gulmika"; Telugu word "Vepuru"
Malkapuram (1261 CE)	Kakatiya, Rudramadevi's reign	Musical instrument "Jalakaranda"

- ⚠ **Wrong pair (APPSC, G1): Rudradaman – Nanaghat**; Rudradaman's record is **Junagadh**. Gautami Balasri – Nasik, Kharavela – Hathigumpha, Ashoka – Maski are right.
- Naneghat and Nasik lie in **Maharashtra**.
- **Gulmika:** officer over a group of villages – the **village headman** of the Satavahana age (gramani in Mauryan times); also a border/feudatory chief (Myakadoni). The question's "Maski (Macedonian)" means **Myakadoni**.

~~ Sources: Rocket AP History p.16, p.52; NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.12, p.15, p.23, Part 2 p.2, p.12; NextGen Satavahanas p.10; app notes 1:1 (sub 2)

1. [PYQ] · Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III (Panchayat Secretary Gr

Gautamiputra Satkarni was praised by this inscription as 'Kshatriya Darpa Mardhana'.

a. Nashik inscription
b. Gandhara inscription
c. Chandraprabha Ordinance
d. Nanaghat Ordinance

Answer: (a)

The Nasik inscription of Gautami Balasri praises her son Gautamiputra Satakarni as 'Kshatriya-darpa-mana-mardana' (destroyer of the pride of the Kshatriyas). Naneghat is Naganika's record.

2. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

Identify the incorrectly matched pair.

a. Gautami Balashri - Nasik Inscription
b. Kharavela - Hathigumpha Inscription
c. Rudradaman - Nanaghat Inscription
d. Ashoka - Maski Inscription

Answer: (c)

Rudradaman's record is the Junagadh (Girnar) inscription; Nanaghat belongs to Queen Naganika, so pair 3 is wrong. The other three pairs are right.

3. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2008
What is the meaning of the word "Gulmika" mentioned in the Maski (Macedonian) inscription?

a. Village headman
b. A slave
c. Trade tariff
d. Landlord

Answer: (a)
'Gulmika' (in the Myakadoni inscription; the question's 'Maski/Macedonian' is a garbling) was the officer over a village group – the village head of the Satavahana period. It was not a slave, a tariff or a landlord.

4. [PYQ] · State PSC
For which of the following rulers “Ekabrahmana” has been used?

a. Pushyamitra Shunga
b. Kharavela
c. Gautamiputra Shatakarni
d. Susharman

Answer: (c)
The Nasik inscription of Gautami Balasri gives her son Gautamiputra Satakarni the title 'Ekabrahmana' (unrivalled Brahmana).

5. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ
Find out the wrong pair re A A

a. Gautami Balashri - Nasik inscription
b. Kharaveludv - Hathigumpha inscription
c. Rudradaman - Nanaghat inscription
d. Asoka Maski inscription -

Answer: (c)
Rudradaman's record is the Junagadh inscription, not Nanaghat (Naganika's), so this pair is wrong.

6. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ
Which language was used in the inscriptions of the Satavahanas?

a. Sanskrit
b. Prakrit
c. Telugu
d. Marathi

Answer: (b)
All Satavahana inscriptions are in Prakrit, their administrative and royal language.

7. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ
Where is the first inscription of a Satavahana ruler with the title 'Rajan' found?

a. Junnar
b. Nanaghat
c. Karle
d. Nashik

Answer: (b)
Naganika's Naneghat inscription has the label 'Raya Simuka Satavahana' – the first Satavahana ruler called Rajan.

8. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ
All inscriptions of the Satavahanas are?

a. In Prakrit language and Brahmi script
b. In Sanskrit language and Prakrit script
c. In Brahmi language and Devanagari script
d. In Brahmi language and Prakrit script

Answer: (a)
All Satavahana inscriptions are in Prakrit language and Brahmi script; Prakrit is a language and Brahmi a script, so the other combinations are muddled.

9. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ
Which inscription was issued by Gautami Balashri?

a. Nasik Inscription
b. Nanaghat Inscription
c. Kanheri Inscription
d. Dharanikota Inscription

Answer: (a)
Gautami Balasri issued the Nasik inscription (prasasti) on the deeds of her son Gautamiputra Satakarni; Naneghat is Naganika's.

10. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

The script in which Satavahana inscriptions were written?

a. Kharosthi
b. Greek
c. Aramaic
d. Brahmi

Answer: (d)
Satavahana inscriptions were written in the Brahmi script (Prakrit language).

11. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

What was the royal language of the Satavahanas?

a. Telugu
b. Sanskrit
c. Prakrit
d. Tamil

Answer: (c)
Prakrit was the administrative, business, written and royal language of the Satavahanas.

12. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2002

All the inscriptions of the Satavahanas were written in:

a. Prakrit language and Brahmi script
b. Sanskrit language and Prakrit script
c. Brahmi language and Devanagari script
d. Brahmi language and Prakrit script

Answer: (a)
All Satavahana inscriptions are in Prakrit language and Brahmi script.

13. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Satavahana inscriptions:
1. Queen Naganika's Naneghat inscription records Vedic sacrifices and gifts of cows, land and gold to Brahmins.
2. Gautami Balasri's Nasik inscription was issued in the reign of Gautamiputra Satakarni.
3. The Amaravati inscription of Pulumavi II is the first Satavahana inscription in Andhra.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the Nasik inscription, which lists Gautamiputra's victories and titles, was issued by his mother Gautami Balasri in the reign of his son Vasishthiputra Pulumavi.

14. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Inscription) with List-II (Term / title it contains):
List-I | List-II
a. Myakadoni | i. Gulmika and Vepuru
b. Malkapuram | ii. Ekabrahmana
c. Nasik | iii. Jalakaranda
d. Amaravati | iv. Nagabu
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv
c. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv

Answer: (d)
Myakadoni (Pulumavi III) – officer 'Gulmika' and Telugu word 'Vepuru'; Malkapuram (1261 CE, Rudramadevi) – musical instrument 'Jalakaranda'; Nasik – Gautamiputra as 'Ekabrahmana'; Amaravati (Pulumavi II) – the word 'Nagabu'.

15. [Kept own]

In which present-day state are the Naneghat and Nasik inscriptions of the early Satavahanas found?

a. Andhra Pradesh
b. Karnataka
c. Maharashtra
d. Telangana

Answer: (c)
Naneghat and Nasik are in Maharashtra, where the early Satavahana records are found; Amaravati (Pulumavi II) is the first Satavahana inscription in Andhra.

2. Mauryan and Pre-Satavahana Records – Erragudi, Bhattiprolu, Hathigumpha (PYQs 10 · MCQs 12)

Earliest records of Andhra

- **Earliest inscriptions on Andhra history:** Ashoka's edicts at **Yerragudi (Erragudi)** and **Rajula Mandagiri** (Kurnool) – **Prakrit** language, Brahmi script (G1 1984, 1987).
- **Proof of Mauryan rule in Andhra: Yerragudi** inscription (not Maski, which is in Karnataka).
- **Erragudi:** Ashoka tells **teachers to inculcate Dhamma in pupils** (Welfare Officers flashcard).

Bhattiprolu (Guntur)

Particular	Fact
Date	3rd c. BC, relic caskets of the oldest stupa in AP
King	Raja Kubhiraka (Kubheraka / Kuberaka), a local pre-Satavahana ruler
Body named	Nigama-sabha (town council / guild assembly) (G2 2011 ×2)
Other	Among the oldest Prakrit inscriptions of Andhra; Roman coins found

- ⚠ **Trap:** Nanaghat, Erragudi and Amaravati do not mention the Nigama-sabha; Ashoka, Mahadeva and Sudarshana did not rule Bhattiprolu.

Kharavela and the Krishna

- **Hathigumpha inscription:** in his 2nd year Kharavela sent an army west, ignoring **Satakarni**, to the **Kannabenna** river (= **Krishna**) and attacked the Mushika city.

~~ Sources: NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.6, p.11, Part 2 p.2-3, Part 6 p.14, Part 7 p.7; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.42; app notes 1:1 (sub 2)

16. [PYQ] · APPSC Asst. BC & Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2017

By what name the river Krishna was addressed in the Hathigumpha and Guntupalli inscriptions of Kharavela?

a. Kanna
b. Karna Nadi
c. Mushika Vagu
d. Kannabenna

Answer: (d)
Kharavela's Hathigumpha inscription calls the Krishna the 'Kannabenna' (Kanhabemna): his army reached the Kannabenna river, ignoring Satakarni. The printed key was blank.

17. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

Which of the following inscriptions proves the Mauryan rule in Andhra?

a. Maski inscription
b. Yerragudi inscription
c. Bhattiprolu inscription
d. Amaravati inscription

Answer: (b)
Ashoka's rock edicts at Yerragudi (and Rajula Mandagiri) in Kurnool district prove Mauryan rule in Andhra. Maski is in Karnataka and Bhattiprolu and Amaravati are later records.

18. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

Which local ruler of the Mauryan period is mentioned in the Bhattiprolu inscription?

a. Kuberaka
b. Satavahana
c. Kharavela
d. Devaputra

Answer: (a)
The Bhattiprolu relic-casket inscriptions name the local king Kubheraka (Kuberaka/Kubhiraka) of the 3rd century BC. Kharavela ruled Kalinga.

19. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ

According to inscriptional evidence, the ruler of Bhattiprolu in the 3" century B.C. was:

a. Asoka
b. Mahadeva
c. Kubhiraka
d. Sudarshana

Answer: (c)
By inscriptional evidence the ruler of Bhattiprolu in the 3rd century BC was Kubhiraka (Kubheraka). Asoka ruled the empire, not Bhattiprolu.

20. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 1987

Ancient inscriptions related to the history of Andhra Pradesh are in which language?

a. Sanskrit
b. Telugu
c. Tamil
d. Prakrit

Answer: (d)
The oldest inscriptions of Andhra, Ashoka's edicts at Yerragudi and Rajula Mandagiri, are in the Prakrit language (Brahmi script). Telugu inscriptions begin only c. 575 CE (Kalamalla).

21. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 1984

The earliest inscriptions related to the history of Andhras are in which language?

a. Sanskrit
b. Telugu
c. Tamil
d. Prakrit

Answer: (d)
The earliest records on Andhra history are Ashoka's Prakrit edicts in Brahmi; Sanskrit inscriptions come later.

22. [PYQ] · Asst. B.C. Welfare Officer, Asst. Social Welfare Officer & A

Which inscription refers to Ashoka as guiding the teachers to inculcate interest among the students towards Dharma?
Answer: Erragudi inscription
The Erragudi (Yerragudi, Kurnool) inscription of Ashoka tells teachers to inculcate Dhamma in their pupils.

23. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

Which inscription mentions the Nigama Sabha of the Satavahanas?

a. Nanaghat Inscription
b. Erragudi Inscription
c. Bhattiprolu Inscription
d. Amaravati Inscription

Answer: (c)
The Bhattiprolu relic-casket inscriptions refer to the Nigama-sabha (town council/guild assembly) of the early Satavahana-age town. Nanaghat is Naganika's record and Erragudi is Ashokan.

24. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

Which inscription refers to 'nigama-sabha' of the satavahana times?

a. Nanaghat inscription
b. Erragudi inscription
c. Bhatti prolu inscription
d. Amaravati inscription

Answer: (c)
The Bhattiprolu relic-casket inscriptions refer to the Nigama-sabha (town council/guild assembly) of the early Satavahana-age town. Nanaghat is Naganika's record and Erragudi is Ashokan.

25. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II (Mains) Paper-II Social History & Constitutio

According to inscriptional evidence, the ruler of Bhattiprolu in the 3rd century B.C. was:
Answer: Kubhiraka
The Bhattiprolu relic-casket inscriptions (3rd c. BCE) name Raja Kubhiraka (Kuberaka) as the ruler of Bhattiprolu.

26. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The Yerragudi inscription is cited as proof of Mauryan rule in Andhra.
Reason (R): The Maski edict, the first to name 'Asoka', lies in Kurnool district of Andhra.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (c)
A is true: Yerragudi (Erragudi) and Rajula Mandagiri in Kurnool are the earliest records of Andhra and prove Mauryan rule. R is false: Maski is in Karnataka, not Andhra.

27. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Bhattiprolu:
1. Its relic caskets of the 3rd century BC belong to the oldest stupa in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Roman coins have been found at Bhattiprolu.
3. The Bhattiprolu inscriptions are in Sanskrit.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: they are among the oldest Prakrit inscriptions of Andhra.

3. Ikshvaku, Pallava, Brihatphalayana and Salankayana Inscriptions (PYQs 8 · MCQs 15)

Issuer and record

Inscription	Issuer	Records
Nagarjunakonda	Ikshvaku (Veerapurushadatta)	Upasika Bodhisri; Buddhist patronage; Santamula founded the kingdom at Vijayapuri
Jaggayyapeta	Ikshvaku, Virapurushadatta's reign	Buddhist donations
Alluru	Ikshvaku period	Multiple gifts to different sections and institutions by the ruler (G2 2017) – the Buddhist community got bullock carts
Chejerla	Kandararaju	Ikshvaku – Anandagotrika wars
Manchikallu	Pallava Simhavarman, near Vijayapuri	Conquest of Vijayapuri after defeating the Ikshvakus (G2 2019)
Mayidavolu (c. AD 300)	Pallava Sivaskandavarman	Prakrit copper-plate grant; first inscriptional use of "Andhrapatha"
Kondamudi (copper)	Jayavarma, Brihatphalayana, 10th regnal year	Only record of the Brihatphalayanas (Ikshvaku feudatories); capital Koduru; village to Brahmins; Prakrit language, seal and subject in Sanskrit
Pedavegi	Nandi Varma II (Salankayana)	Land grant to Vishnu; first to mention Vishnu temples in Andhra
Kolleru	Nandi Varma II	–
Eluru	Devavarma	"Munyada" = political employee
Pithapuram	–	Mentions Kolleru lake
Kalamalla	Erikal Mutthuraju Dhananjaya Varma	First inscription in Telugu (not Sanskrit)
Allahabad Pillar	Samudragupta	Names Hastivarman of Vengi (Salankayana) among southern kings defeated

- **Ikshvaku inscriptions: Prakrit** was their official and inscriptional language (Asst. BC Welfare 2017); Sanskrit got patronage only from **Ehuvala Santamula**'s time.
- ⚠ **Trap: Manchikallu and Mayidavolu = Pallavas**, not Ikshvakus (G2 Mains 2025); Karle, Veerapuram and Ramagiri are distractors for Alluru.

Fall of the Ikshvakus

- Last Ikshvaku ruler **Rudrapurushadatta** (son of Ehuvala Chamtamula); his Nagarjunakonda pillar (11th year) honours his mother Vammabhatta; the **Phanigiri** pillar is of his 18th year.
- Defeated by **Pallava Simhavarman** (Manchikallu), not by the Vishnukundins.
- **South of the Krishna → Pallavas**; north → Brihatphalayanas.

~~ Sources: NextGen AP HISTORY Part 3 p.1, Part 8 p.12-13; NextGen Ikshvakus p.5; NextGen AP History Previous Papers p.8, p.52, p.70; Rocket AP History p.16, p.52; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Allahabad_Pillar; app notes 1:1 (sub 3)

28. [PYQ] · APPSC Asst. BC & Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2017

What was the language used in the inscriptions of the Ikshvakus?

a. Sanskrit
b. Prakrit
c. Paisachi
d. None of the given answers is correct

Answer: (b)

Prakrit was the official and inscriptional language of the Ikshvakus; Sanskrit got royal patronage only from Ehuvala Santamula's time, so 'Prakrit' is the answer (the printed key was blank).

29. [PYQ] · APPSC Asst. BC & Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2017

The Kondamudi copper plate grant gives details of Jayavarman. Who was this ruler?

a. A Brihathpalayana ruler
b. A Salankayana ruler
c. An Ikshvaaku ruler
d. A Vishnukundina ruler

Answer: (a)

The Kondamudi copper plate is the only inscription of the Brihatphalayanas; it records King Jayavarma (capital Koduru) granting a village to Brahmins in his 10th year. The printed key was blank.

30. [PYQ] · APPSC Asst. BC & Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2017

Allahabad pillar inscription of Samudragupta mentions about the conflict of the Guptas with one Salankayana ruler of Vengi. Who was that ruler?

a. Hastivarman
b. Nandivarman I
c. Chandavarman
d. Nandivarman II

Answer: (a)

Samudragupta's Allahabad pillar names Hastivarman of Vengi, the Salankayana king, among the southern kings he defeated and released. The printed key was blank.

31. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

In which language was the history of the 'Brihatphalayanas', known from the 'Kondamudi' inscription, written?

a. Pali
b. Prakrit
c. Sanskrit
d. Telugu

Answer: (b)

The Kondamudi plates of the Brihatphalayana Jayavarma are in Prakrit; only the seal and subject are in Sanskrit.

32. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II Prelims 2019

Which inscription states that the Pallavas conquered Vijayapuri after defeating the Ikshvakus?

a. Manchikallu Inscription of Pallava Simhavarman
b. Nashik Abhilekha about Sri Parvatam
c. Nagarjunakonda Inscription
d. Nandampudi Donation Inscription

Answer: (a)

The Manchikallu inscription of Pallava Simhavarman, found near Vijayapuri, records the Pallava conquest of Vijayapuri after defeating the last Ikshvaku Rudrapurushadatta.

33. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ

The inscription at which place records multiple gifts to different sections and institutions by the ruler

a. Karle
b. Veerapuram
c. Ramagiri
d. Alluru

Answer: (d)

The Alluru inscription (Ikshvaku period) records multiple gifts to different sections and institutions by the ruler; Karle, Veerapuram and Ramagiri are distractors.

34. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

An inscription from which place mentions multiple donations made by the emperor to various communities and institutions?

a. Karle
b. Veerapuram
c. Ramagiri
d. Alluru

Answer: (d)

The Alluru inscription (Ikshvaku period) records multiple gifts to different sections and institutions by the ruler; Karle, Veerapuram and Ramagiri are distractors.

35. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

King Jayavarman is mentioned in the Kondamudi copper plate inscription. Who is this Jayavarman?

a. King of the Brihatphalayana dynasty
b. King of the Salankayana dynasty
c. King of the Ikshvakus
d. King of the Vishnukundin dynasty

Answer: (a)

The Kondamudi copper plate is the only inscription of the Brihatphalayanas; it records King Jayavarma (capital Koduru) granting a village to Brahmins in his 10th year.

36. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Ikshvaku-period inscriptions:
1. The Nagarjunakonda inscriptions record Santamula's founding of the kingdom at Vijayapuri and the Buddhist patronage of Upasika Bodhisri.
2. The Chejerla inscription of Kandararaju records the Ikshvaku–Anandagotrika wars.
3. The Jaggayyapeta inscription belongs to the reign of the Pallava Simhavarman.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Jaggayyapeta inscription records Buddhist donations in the reign of the Ikshvaku Virapurushadatta.

37. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Mayidavolu copper-plate grant:
1. It was issued by the Pallava Sivaskandavarman around AD 300.
2. It is written in Prakrit.
3. It contains the first inscriptional use of the term 'Andhrapatha'.
4. Like the Manchikallu inscription, it is an Ikshvaku record.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2, 3 and 4 only
c. 1, 2, 3 and 4
d. 1, 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)

1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: Manchikallu and Mayidavolu are both Pallava records, not Ikshvaku (G2 Mains 2025 trap).

38. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Inscription) with List-II (Issuer):
List-I | List-II
a. Pedavegi | i. Devavarma
b. Eluru | ii. Erikal Mutthuraju Dhananjaya Varma
c. Kondamudi | iii. Jayavarma
d. Kalamalla | iv. Nandi Varma II
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-iv, b-i, c-iii, d-ii
b. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii
c. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (a)

Pedavegi – Salankayana Nandi Varma II (first mention of Vishnu temples in Andhra); Eluru – Devavarma ('Munyada'); Kondamudi – Brihatphalayana Jayavarma; Kalamalla – Dhananjaya Varma (first Telugu inscription).

39. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Kondamudi copper plates:
1. They are the only record of the Brihatphalayanas.
2. They were issued by Jayavarma, whose capital was Koduru.
3. Their language, seal and subject are all in Prakrit.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the language is Prakrit but the seal and the subject are in Sanskrit.

40. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): After the fall of the Ikshvakus, the region south of the Krishna passed to the Pallavas.
Reason (R): The last Ikshvaku ruler Rudrapurushadatta was defeated by the Pallava Simhavarman.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both true; R explains A. Simhavarman's victory (Manchikallu) took the land south of the Krishna to the Pallavas; the north went to the Brihatphalayanas. The Vishnukundins did not defeat Rudrapurushadatta.

41. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the last Ikshvaku ruler Rudrapurushadatta:
1. He was defeated by Pallava Simhavarman.
2. He was defeated by the Vishnukundins.
3. His Nagarjunakonda pillar honours his mother Vammabhatta.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Rudrapurushadatta was defeated by Pallava Simhavarman, not the Vishnukundins; his pillar honours his mother Vammabhatta.

42. [Kept own]

The Phanigiri pillar inscription of the 18th regnal year belongs to which Ikshvaku ruler?

a. Santamula I
b. Veerapurushadatta
c. Ehuvala Chamtamula
d. Rudrapurushadatta

Answer: (d)
The Phanigiri pillar is of the 18th year of Rudrapurushadatta, the last Ikshvaku ruler.

4. Literary Sources for Andhra (PYQs 6 · MCQs 8)

Text	Content revealed
Matsya Purana	30 (29 in some counts) Satavahana kings ruled for 456 years
Vishnu Purana	Story of the Satavahanas
Bhimasena Jataka	"Andhapatha" (Andhra route); Serivanija Jataka = Andhapura on the Telavaha
Chulla-Kalinga Jataka	Kharavela defeated by Asmaka king Satakarni
Vinayavatthu	"Andhapatha"
Gathasaptasati (King Hala)	Maharashtri Prakrit, 700 verses; society; early Telugu words "atta, addam, potta"
Pratishtana Pura Kalpa, Dwatrimsatputtalika, Kathasaritsagara	Early history of the Satavahana family

Kashikhandam and Haravilasam	Both by Srinatha; sea trade of the Reddi period
Nritta Ratnavali	Jayapa Senani (Ganapatideva's Gaja Sahini) – Sanskrit treatise on dance

- **Not a source of early Satavahana history:** the **Gathasaptasati** (G2 Mains 2017) – it is a verse anthology.
- **Andhakaratta:** the name of the Andhras in **Buddhist** literature (G2 Mains 2017) – not Jain or Vedic.

  - ⚠ **Settled:** the printed key "Jain literature" is wrong (NextGen Previous Papers p.8).

- **Chilukuri Veerabhadra Rao:** wrote **Andhrula Charitramu (The History of the Andhras)**, which carried knowledge of the Andhras' past across Andhra; Kanyasulkam is Gurajada Apparao's.
- Reddi sea-trade question has two keys: Kashikhandam (G2 2011) and Haravilasam (G2 2019) – both by Srinatha.

  ~~ Sources: NextGen Satavahanas p.1, p.5; NextGen Kakatiyas p.31; NextGen AP History Previous Papers p.8, p.10; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chilukuri_Veerabhadra_Rao; app notes 1:1 (sub 1)

43. [PYQ] · Social and Cultural History of A.P and Welfare Programmes 20

King Hala, the 17th ruler of Satavahana Dynasty wrote Gathasaptasati in ____ language.

a. Sanskrit
b. Prakrit
c. Tamil
d. Telugu

Answer: (b)

Hala's Gathasaptasati (700 Prakrit verses) is in Maharashtri Prakrit, the court language of the Satavahanas; it is not Sanskrit or Telugu.

44. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2012

Nrittya Ratnavali was composed by Jayapa in

a. Telugu
b. Sanskrit
c. Prakrit
d. Ardha Magadhi

Answer: (b)

Jayapa Senani, Ganapatideva's elephant-corps chief (Gaja Sahini), wrote the Nritta Ratnavali, a Sanskrit treatise on dance; it is not a Telugu or Prakrit work.

45. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II Mains 2017 (15-07-2017)

The early History of the Satavahana family is not stated in the following work?

a. Pratishtana Pura Kalpa
b. Dwatrimsatupttalika
c. Kadhasaritsagaram
d. Gadhasapthasati

Answer: (d)

NextGen lists Pratishtana Pura Kalpa, Dwatrimsatputtalika and Kathasaritsagara as the works that state the early history of the Satavahana family. Hala's Gathasaptasati is a Prakrit anthology of verses, not a dynastic history.

46. [PYQ] · Social and Cultural History of A.P and Welfare Programmes 20

Which of the following book by Chilukuri Virabhadra Rao gave the Andhras the long pageant of their glorious past, which carried the lamp of knowledge to the remotest corners of Andhra creating a new awakening and provincial spirit among the people?

a. Kanyasulkam
b. Hitasucham
c. The History of Andhras
d. The crescent

Answer: (c)

Chilukuri Veerabhadra Rao wrote 'Andhrula Charitramu' (The History of the Andhras), which spread knowledge of the Andhras' past during the Andhra movement. Kanyasulkam is Gurajada Apparao's play.

47. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II Mains 2017

In which literature are Andhras referred to as 'Andhakaratta'?

a. Vedic Literature
b. Buddhist Literature
c. Jain Literature
d. Aitareya Brahmana

Answer: (b)

NextGen: Buddhist literature refers to the Andhras as 'Andhakaratta' (Andhaka-rattha); the printed key 'Jain literature' is wrong. The Aitareya Brahmana (Vedic) calls them Andhras.

48. [PYQ] · APPSC Draughtsman (Technical Assistant) Paper-I General Stud

According to the Matsya Purana, which dynasty had 29 rulers, who ruled for 456 years?

a. Ikshvaku
b. Sathavahana
c. Vakataka
d. Vishnukundi

Answer: (b)
The Matsya Purana gives the Satavahanas (Andhras) 30 kings (29/30 in different counts) ruling for 456 years.

49. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Buddhist texts on Andhra:
1. The Serivanija Jataka places Andhapura on the river Telavaha.
2. The Chulla-Kalinga Jataka says that Kharavela defeated the Asmaka king Satakarni.
3. The term 'Andhapatha' occurs in the Vinayavatthu.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 reverses the fact: the Chulla-Kalinga Jataka says Kharavela was defeated by the Asmaka king Satakarni.

50. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Srinatha's Kashikhandam and Haravilasam both describe the sea trade of the Reddi period.
2. Hala's Gathasaptasati contains early Telugu words such as 'atta', 'addam' and 'potta'.
3. The Gathasaptasati is a Maharashtri Prakrit anthology of 1,000 verses.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Gathasaptasati has 700 verses (sapta-sati).

5. Coins and Trade Evidence (PYQs 3 · MCQs 5)

- **Ship coins:** the anchored-ship (ship-mast) coins of **Yajnasri Satakarni** prove brisk **maritime (naval) trade** (APPSC PYQ; Special Qualifying Test 2018); **Vasishthiputra Pulumavi** also issued ship-motif coins.

  - ⚠ **Trap:** the Periplus, Nasik and Karle records are not the evidence asked for.

- Satavahana coins: **lead, potin, copper, bronze** and silver; gold was not their coinage.
- **Roman coins** at Andhra sites belong to the **Satavahana** period (APSLPRB 2019) and show **Andhra–Rome trade**.

Hoard	Find-spots
Roman gold	Attirala (Kadapa), Vinukonda (Guntur)
Others	Salihundam, Vijayawada, Nagarjunakonda, Nellore, Bhattiprolu

~~ Sources: NextGen Satavahanas p.19, p.21; NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.13, Part 2 p.8; app notes 1:1 (sub 5, 7)

51. [PYQ] · APSLPRB Constables 2019

Roman coins are found at various sites of Andhra that belong to the period of the following:

a. Chalukya
b. Satavahana
c. Kakatiya
d. Vijayanagara

Answer: (b)
Roman coins found at Andhra sites (Bhattiprolu, Nagarjunakonda, Attirala, Vinukonda) belong to the Satavahana age of Indo-Roman trade.

52. [PYQ] · APPSC 2018 Special Qualifying Test for Appointment by Promot

Which of the following Satavahana Kings had immense love for overseas trade and navigation so much so that the coins issued by him had picture of a ship?

a. GautamiputraSatakarni
b. VashistiputraPulomavi
c. YagnasriSatakarni
d. ChandrasriSatakarni

Answer: (c)
The anchored-ship (ship-mast) coins of Yajnasri Satakarni prove brisk Satavahana maritime trade; Vasishthiputra Pulumavi also issued ship coins, but he is not the listed key here.

53. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

What is the evidence for the naval trade of the Satavahanas?

a. The Periplus of the Erythraean Sea
b. Yajnashri Satakarni's ship-symbol coins
c. Balashri's Nasik inscription
d. Karle inscription of Gautamiputra Satakarni

Answer: (b)
The anchored-ship (ship-mast) coins of Yajnasri Satakarni prove brisk Satavahana maritime trade; The Periplus describes trade but is not itself evidence of Satavahana naval trade.

54. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Site) with List-II (Feature):
List-I | List-II
a. Attirala | i. Roman gold hoard in Kadapa district
b. Vinukonda | ii. Roman gold hoard in Guntur district
c. Kondapur | iii. Habitation mound of the Mauryan to Satavahana period
d. Gudiwada Dibba | iv. Habitation mound with a mint
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (b)
Attirala (Kadapa) and Vinukonda (Guntur) yielded Roman gold hoards; Kondapur is a habitation mound with a mint; Gudiwada Dibba spans the Mauryan to Satavahana period.

55. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT correct about Satavahana coins?

a. They were issued in lead and potin
b. They were also issued in copper and bronze
c. Ship-motif coins show maritime trade
d. They were never issued in silver

Answer: (d)
Satavahana coins were issued in lead, copper, bronze, potin and silver, so 'never in silver' is wrong.

6. Copper-plate Grants and Land Grants (PYQs 1 · MCQs 2)

- **Donor** = king; **donee** = Brahmins; gift of a **village/land**, often with **tax exemptions**.
- **Earliest surviving land grant with fiscal exemptions:** the **Satavahanas** (Naneghat; Gautamiputra's Nasik grants) – not the Guptas (Asst. Tribal Welfare Officer PYQ).
- **Vishnukundin** grants measured land in **nivartanas**.
- Examples: Mayidavolu (Pallava), Kondamudi (Brihatphalayana).

Term	Meaning
nivartana	Land measure (Vishnukundin grants)
Nigama-sabha	Town council (Bhattiprolu)
Munyada	Political employee (Eluru)
Jalakaranda	Musical instrument (Malkapuram)

~~ Sources: Upinder Singh, A History of Ancient and Early Medieval India ch. 8; app notes 1:1 (sub 4)

56. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar

The earliest surviving land grant recording a grant of land with fiscal exemptions belongs to?

a. Guptas
b. Satvahanas
c. Ikshavakus
d. Scytho-Parthians

Answer: (b)

The earliest surviving land grants with fiscal and administrative exemptions are Satavahana records (Nasik grants of Gautamiputra Satakarni; Naneghat), not Gupta.

57. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about land grants and terms in Andhra inscriptions:
1. In copper-plate grants the donor was usually the king and the donee Brahmins.
2. Vishnukundin grants measured land in nivartanas.
3. 'Nigama-sabha' in the Bhattiprolu inscription means a town council.
4. 'Munyada' in the Eluru inscription is a unit of land measure.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2, 3 and 4 only
c. 1, 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)

1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: 'Munyada' (Eluru) means a political employee; the land measure is the nivartana.

7. Archaeological Sites and Foreign Accounts on Andhra (PYQs 1 · MCQs 4)

- Satavahana history rests on the **Puranas**, **Prakrit inscriptions** and **coins**; foreign accounts must be cross-checked against these.

Type	Sites
Stupa sites	Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda, Bhattiprolu (oldest), Jaggayyapeta, Guntupalli, Salihundam
Habitation mounds	Gudiwada Dibba (Mauryan to Satavahana), Kotilingala, Kondapur (mint), Dharanikota

- Dharanikota is a habitation mound, not a listed stupa site.

Foreign accounts on Andhra

Writer	Period	Andhra places / facts
Megasthenes	4th c. BCE, Mauryan	Andhras: 30 fortified towns
Periplus	c. 60 CE	Koddura port; Saka–Satavahana conflict
Pliny	1st c. CE	Roman gold drain to India
Ptolemy	2nd c. CE	Masulia (Machilipatnam), Ben Ra (Vengi)
Hiuen Tsang	7th c. CE (visited Dhanakataka, c. 639 CE)	Buddhist monasteries of Andhra

~~ Sources: NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.8; app notes 1:1 (sub 0, 6, 8)

58. [PYQ] · Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-I (Panchayat Secretary/Mahi

The earliest reference of Andhradesha in foreign literature was found in the writings of

a. Fahien
b. Nicolo De Conti
c. Megasthenes
d. Marco Polo

Answer: (c)

Megasthenes' Indica (c. 300 BC) is the earliest foreign reference to the Andhras: it mentions their 30 walled towns (forts) and large army. Fa-Hien, Conti and Marco Polo wrote centuries later.

59. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about foreign accounts of Andhra:
1. The Periplus of the Erythraean Sea names the port of Koddura.
2. Ptolemy mentions Ben Ra, identified with Vengi.
3. Hiuen Tsang visited Dhanakataka in about 539 CE.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Hiuen Tsang (7th c.) visited Dhanakataka c. 639 CE.

60. [Kept own]

Satavahana history rests mainly on Puranas, inscriptions and coins. Which of the following does NOT belong to this core?

a. Puranas
b. Prakrit inscriptions
c. Coins
d. Srinatha's Kashikhandam

Answer: (d)
Satavahana history rests on the Puranas, Prakrit inscriptions and coins; Kashikhandam describes Reddi-period sea trade.

61. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT a stupa site listed among the archaeological sources of Andhra?

a. Jaggayyapeta
b. Dharanikota
c. Guntupalli
d. Salihundam

Answer: (b)
Dharanikota is listed as a habitation mound, not among the listed stupa sites. Salihundam, Guntupalli and Jaggayyapeta are stupa sites.

Row 2: Stone Age Cultures – Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Chalcolithic Sites of India

1. Neolithic – First Farming, Pit Dwellings, Dog Burials, Ash Mounds (PYQs 9 · MCQs 13)

First farming

- **Cultivation of cereals began in the Neolithic.**
- **Mehrgarh** (Baluchistan, c. **7000 BCE**): **earliest agriculture** (wheat, barley) and settled life in the subcontinent; of dated options "7000 BC" is the start of farming.
- **Rice: Lahuradeva** (UP, c. **6500 BCE**, oldest paddy); **Koldihwa** (Belan valley, UP) – earlier thought oldest; sequence **Neolithic–Chalcolithic–Iron**.

Site table

Site	Region	Distinctive find
Burzahom	Kashmir (16 km NW of Srinagar)	Pit dwellings; dog buried with master
Gufkral	Kashmir	Pit dwellings (with Burzahom)
Chirand	Bihar	Bone and antler tools
Koldihwa	Belan valley, UP	Early rice
Sanganakallu	Ballari, Karnataka	Ash mound (also Utnur, Piklihal, Kupgal, Budihal)
Tekkalakota	Ballari, Karnataka	Hill-dwellers; excavated by M. S. Nagaraja Rao
Brahmagiri, Maski	Karnataka	Neolithic–megalithic sites

- **Ash mounds:** burnt dung of cattle pens = seasonal camps of Neolithic herdsmen.
- **Eastern Neolithic** (Birbhanpur, Chirand, Kuchai, Sankarjang): **pointed-butt celts** and **shouldered axes**.
- **Pit dwellings** are NOT at Mehrgarh (mud-brick houses), Pallavaram (Palaeolithic tools) or Balakot (Harappan).

  ~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.53-58; NextGen Indian History Part 1 p.4; Rocket Indian History p.104; app notes 1:2

- **UPSC pairs: Chandraketugarh** (West Bengal) = **terracotta art**; **Ganeshwar** (Rajasthan, Khetri belt) = **copper artefacts**; Burzahom = pit dwellings, not rock-cut shrines → "2 and 3".

1. [PYQ] · Prelims Paper 2023 (header partly legible)

Which one of the following places yielded archaeological evidence of pit dwellings?

a. Pallavaram
b. Mehargarh
c. Gufkral
d. Balakot

Answer: (c)

Gufkral in Kashmir, like Burzahom, yielded Neolithic pit dwellings. Mehrgarh had mud-brick houses, Pallavaram is a Palaeolithic tool site and Balakot a Harappan site.

2. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

The cultivation of cereals first started in -

a. Neolithic Age
b. Mesolithic Age
c. Palaeolithic Age
d. Proto-Historic Age

Answer: (a)

Cultivation of cereals began in the Neolithic: wheat and barley at Mehrgarh, rice at Koldihwa and Lahuradeva.

3. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ash mound is associated with the Neolithic site at –

a. Budihal
b. Sangana Kallu
c. Koldihwa
d. Brahmagiri

Answer: (b)

Neolithic ash mounds (burnt dung of cattle pens) are the hallmark of Sanganakallu (Ballari), with Utnur and Piklihal; Budihal also has one, but Sanganakallu is the textbook answer. Koldihwa is known for rice, Brahmagiri for megaliths.

4. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

Agriculture probably began in about

a. 100 BC
b. 2000 BC
c. 4000 BC
d. 7000 BC

Answer: (d)

Farming began in the Neolithic at Mehrgarh c. 7000 BCE (wheat, barley); of the options, 7000 BC is the right date.

5. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

The evidence of burying the dog with human body is found from which of the following places ?

a. Burzahom
b. Koldihwa
c. Chaupani-mando
d. Mando

Answer: (a)

At Burzahom (Kashmir) dogs were buried with their masters; Koldihwa is known for early rice and Chopani-Mando for microliths.

6. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

The evidence of pit dwelling has been obtained from –

a. Burzahom
b. Koldihwa
c. Brahmagiri
d. Sanganakallu

Answer: (a)

Burzahom (Kashmir) people lived in pit houses dug into the ground; Koldihwa is known for rice, Brahmagiri and Sanganakallu for South Indian Neolithic/megalithic remains.

7. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

The earliest evidence of agriculture in the Indian Subcontinent has been obtained from –

a. Brahmagiri
b. Burzahom
c. Koldihwa
d. Mehrgarh

Answer: (d)

Mehrgarh (Baluchistan, c. 7000 BCE) gives the earliest evidence of agriculture (wheat, barley) in the subcontinent; Koldihwa's rice and Burzahom's pit dwellings are later.

8. [PYQ] · UP Lower 2008

Which of the following sites has yielded skeleton of the dog along with human skeleton in burial?

a. Brahmagiri
b. Burzahom
c. Chirand
d. Maski

Answer: (b)

Burzahom is the Neolithic site where dogs were buried with humans; Chirand is known for bone tools, Brahmagiri and Maski for megaliths.

9. [PYQ] · UPSC Civils Preliminary 2021

Consider the following pairs:
Historical place - Well-known for

1. Burzahom - Rock-cut shrines

2. Chandra-ketugarh - Terracotta art

3. Ganeshwar - Copper artifacts
Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2
c. 3 only
d. 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

Chandraketugarh (terracotta art) and Ganeshwar (copper artefacts) are correctly matched; Burzahom is a Neolithic site of pit dwellings, not rock-cut shrines. So 2 and 3.

10. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about early rice in India:
1. Lahuradeva has yielded the oldest paddy, dated to about 6500 BCE.
2. Koldihwa in the Belan valley shows a Neolithic–Chalcolithic–Iron sequence.
3. Lahuradeva is in Bihar.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Lahuradeva is in Uttar Pradesh; Koldihwa (Belan valley, UP) was earlier thought to have the oldest rice.

11. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Neolithic site) with List-II (Distinctive feature):
List-I | List-II
a. Chirand | i. Bone and antler tools
b. Tekkalakota | ii. Ash mound
c. Sanganakallu | iii. Dog buried with its master
d. Burzahom | iv. Hill-dwellers' site dug by M. S. Nagaraja Rao
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii

Answer: (b)
Chirand (Bihar) – bone and antler tools; Tekkalakota (Ballari) – hill-dwellers, excavated by M. S. Nagaraja Rao; Sanganakallu (Ballari) – ash mound; Burzahom (Kashmir) – pit dwellings and dog burial.

12. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The Neolithic ash mounds of South India are taken to be seasonal camps of herdsmen.
Reason (R): The ash mounds are made of burnt dung from cattle pens.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both true; R explains A: the burnt dung of cattle pens marks the seasonal camps of Neolithic herdsmen (Sanganakallu, Utnur, Piklihal, Kupgal, Budihal).

13. [Kept own]

With which of the following are the Eastern Neolithic sites such as Birbhanpur, Chirand, Kuchai and Sankarjang particularly associated?

a. pointed-butt celts and shouldered axes
b. polished stone rings and iron ploughshares
c. microliths and Roman amphorae
d. copper coins and black-polished pottery

Answer: (a)
Eastern Neolithic sites are associated with pointed-butt celts and shouldered axes, showing links with South-East Asia.

2. Mesolithic – Domestication, Burials and Ganga–Vindhya Sites (PYQs 7 · MCQs 11)

Most-asked facts

- **Animal domestication began in the Mesolithic:** earliest evidence at **Adamgarh** (Narmadapuram, MP) and **Bagor** (Bhilwara, Rajasthan) – not Langhnaj, Birbhanpur or Chopani Mando.
- **Mahadaha** (Pratapgarh, UP): **bone and antler ornaments** (earrings, necklaces), bone implements, double burials.
- **Damdama** (Pratapgarh): 41 graves, five double burials and one **triple burial** (three skeletons in one grave).
- **Sarai Nahar Rai** (Pratapgarh): a grave with **four** skeletons.
- **Lekhahia** (Mirzapur, Vindhyas): **17 human skeletons** from rock shelter 1 – the most from any Vindhyan rock shelter.

Sites and regions

Site	Region	Note
Bagor	Bhilwara, Rajasthan	Rock shelters, microliths, early domestication
Adamgarh	Narmadapuram, MP	Rock shelter, early domestication

Langhnaj	Gujarat	Microliths, burials
Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha, Damdama	Ganga plain, Pratapgarh (UP)	Lake-side camps, burials
Lekhahia, Baghai Khor, Morahana Pahar, Chopani Mando	Vindhyas / Belan valley (Mirzapur, UP)	Rock shelters; Chopani Mando – huts, microliths
Paisra	Bihar	–
Birbhanpur	West Bengal	–
Teri sites	Thoothukudi (TN) and Visakhapatnam coast	Coastal red-sand dunes

- **West to east: Mahadaha → Lekhahia → Paisra → Birbhanpur**.

> Mesolithic = microlithic stage; tools made by **flaking and chipping**.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.51-53; iaspoint (Mahadaha, Mesolithic burials); Wikipedia "Lekhahia"; app notes 1:2

14. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

According to the excavated evidence, the domestication of animals began in –

a. Lower Palaeolithic period
b. Middle Palaeolithic period
c. Upper Palaeolithic period
d. Mesolithic period

Answer: (d)
Domestication of animals began in the Mesolithic; Adamgarh (MP) and Bagor (Rajasthan) give the earliest evidence. The Palaeolithic people were only hunter-gatherers.

15. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Which among the following sites provides evidence of domestication of animals in the Mesolithic period?

a. Odai
b. Bori
c. Bagor
d. Lakhnia

Answer: (c)
Bagor (Bhilwara, Rajasthan) and Adamgarh (MP) give the earliest evidence of animal domestication in the Mesolithic; Odai, Bori and Lakhnia are not the answer.

16. [PYQ] · U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013 +1 more

Bone ornaments in the Mesolithic context in India have been obtained from –

a. Sarai Nahar Rai
b. Mahadaha
c. Lekhahia
d. Chopani Mando

Answer: (b)
Mahadaha (Pratapgarh, UP) is the Mesolithic site famed for bone and antler ornaments (antler-ring earrings, necklaces) besides bone tools and double burials. Lekhahia (Mirzapur) is known for its 17 skeletons, not bone ornaments.

17. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

From which rock shelter of Vindhyas, a maximum number of human skeletons have been found?

a. Morahana Pahar
b. Ghagharia
c. Baghahi Khor
d. Lekhahia

Answer: (d)
Lekhahia rock shelter 1 (Mirzapur, Vindhyas) yielded 17 human skeletons, the most from any Vindhyan rock shelter (J. N. Pandey, Puratattva Vimarsh).

18. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Mains) 2010

From which one of the following sites bone implements have been found?

a. Chopani-Mando
b. Kakoria
c. Mahadaha
d. Sarai Nahar Rai

Answer: (c)

Mahadaha (Pratapgarh) is the Mesolithic site best known for bone implements and bone ornaments; Chopani-Mando is a Belan-valley microlithic site.

19. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2016

Three human skeletons in a single grave were recovered at

a. Sarai Nahar Rai
b. Damdama
c. Mahadaha
d. Langhnaj

Answer: (b)

Damdama (Pratapgarh) yielded 41 graves, five double burials and one triple burial (three skeletons in one grave); Sarai Nahar Rai has a four-skeleton grave and Mahadaha double burials.

20. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2008

In mesolithic context, evidence of animal domestication has been found at

a. Langhnaj
b. Birbhanpur
c. Adamgarh
d. Chopani Mando

Answer: (c)

Adamgarh (Narmadapuram, MP) and Bagor give the earliest Mesolithic evidence of animal domestication; Langhnaj, Birbhanpur and Chopani Mando are not known for it.

21. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Mesolithic sites:
1. Langhnaj is in Gujarat.
2. Lekhahia and Baghai Khor are rock shelters of the Vindhyas.
3. Paisra is in West Bengal.
4. Chopani Mando in the Belan valley has huts and microliths.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1, 2, 3 and 4
c. 2, 3 and 4 only
d. 1, 2 and 4 only

Answer: (d)

1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: Paisra is in Bihar; Birbhanpur is the West Bengal site.

22. [Kept own]

In which region are the Mesolithic sites Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha and Damdama located?

a. Vindhyan rock shelters of Madhya Pradesh
b. Rajasthan desert region
c. Coastal region of Tamil Nadu
d. Ganga plain of Uttar Pradesh

Answer: (d)

Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha and Damdama are Mesolithic sites in the Ganga plain of Uttar Pradesh, particularly the Pratapgarh region.

23. [Kept own]

Arrange the following Mesolithic sites from west to east:
1. Paisra
2. Mahadaha
3. Birbhanpur
4. Lekhahia
Select the correct answer using the code given below.

a. 2, 4, 1, 3
b. 4, 2, 1, 3
c. 2, 1, 4, 3
d. 4, 2, 3, 1

Answer: (a)

From west to east: Mahadaha (UP) - Lekhahia (Mirzapur) - Paisra (Bihar) - Birbhanpur (West Bengal).

24. [Kept own]
By what other name is the Mesolithic culture known, and how were its tools mainly made?

a. Chalcolithic; smelting and casting
b. Microlithic; flaking and chipping
c. Neolithic; hammering and forging
d. Megalithic; grinding and polishing

Answer: (b)
The Mesolithic is also called the Microlithic period, and its tools were produced by flaking and chipping.

3. Bhimbetka and Prehistoric Rock Art (PYQs 7 · MCQs 9)

- **Bhimbetka:** foothills of the Vindhyas, **Raisen** district near Bhopal (MP); discovered by **V. S. Wakankar in 1957-58**; **UNESCO World Heritage Site 2003**.
- **Most rock paintings in India** (up to 20 layers in places); Upper Palaeolithic art in about **300** caves and shelters; continuous use from Lower Palaeolithic to medieval times.
- Paintings are **Upper Palaeolithic and Mesolithic** – hunting scenes, animals, geometric patterns; Ajanta, Ellora, Bagh are historic-period cave art, not prehistoric.
- Most commonly painted animal: **deer**. A **petroglyph** is **carved** into rock; a painting is applied on the surface.
- 12 May 2026 study: after contact with the Chalcolithic farmers of **Malwa**, the Bhimbetka style became **static**.
- H. D. Sankalia, S. S. Nigam, R. Pandey, M. S. Vats, V. N. Misra are distractors – the discoverer is **Wakankar**.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.59-61; app notes 1:2 (sub 6)

25. [PYQ] · APPSC Royalty Inspector, Agriculture Officers, Town Planning
Paleolithic rock paintings were found at

a. Ajanta
b. Ellora
c. Bagh
d. Bhimbetka

Answer: (d)
Bhimbetka (Raisen, MP) has rock paintings from the Upper Palaeolithic and Mesolithic; Ajanta, Ellora and Bagh are historic-period cave art.

26. [PYQ] · M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025
When did Dr. Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar discover the rock shelters of Bhimbetka?

a. 1951-1952
b. 1954-1955
c. 1960-1961
d. 1957-1958

Answer: (d)
V. S. Wakankar discovered the Bhimbetka rock shelters in 1957-58.

27. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008
In India, from which rock-shelter, pictures has been found the most ?

a. Ghagharia
b. Bhimbetka
c. Lekhahia
d. Adamgarh

Answer: (b)
Bhimbetka has the largest number of rock paintings in India (hundreds of shelters, up to 20 layers of paintings).

28. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004
'Bhimbetka' is famous for -

a. Rock Paintings
b. Buddhist Statues
c. Minerals
d. Origin of Son River

Answer: (a)
Bhimbetka (Raisen, MP), a UNESCO site since 2003, is famous for its prehistoric rock paintings.

29. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2020
Bhimbetka was discovered by

a. Dr. H.D. Sankhalia
b. Dr. Shyam Sundar Nigam
c. Dr. Vishnu S. Wakankar
d. Dr. Rajbali Pandey

Answer: (c)
Bhimbetka was discovered by V. S. Wakankar (1957-58); H. D. Sankalia is linked with Navdatoli and Nevasa.

30. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011 +1 more

Which one of the following places is famous for prehistoric paintings ?

a. Ajanta
b. Bhimbetka
c. Bagh
d. Amravati

Answer: (b)
Bhimbetka is famous for prehistoric (Upper Palaeolithic–Mesolithic) paintings; Ajanta and Bagh are Buddhist-era murals, Amaravati a stupa site.

31. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2020

Which of the following Indian archaeologists first visited 'Bhimbetka Caves' and discovered prehistoric significance of its rock paintings?

a. Madho Swaroop Vatsa
b. HD Sankalia
c. VS Wakankar
d. VN Mishra

Answer: (c)
V. S. Wakankar first recognised the prehistoric significance of Bhimbetka's rock art (1957-58).

32. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Bhimbetka:
1. It lies in Raisen district of Madhya Pradesh and became a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2003.
2. Upper Palaeolithic art is found in about 300 of its caves and shelters.
3. The animal most commonly painted there is the elephant.
4. A 2026 study found that its painting style became static after contact with the Chalcolithic farmers of Malwa.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2, 3 and 4 only
c. 1, 2 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)
1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: the most commonly painted animal is the deer.

33. [Kept own]

In rock art, a petroglyph differs from a painting because a petroglyph is:

a. Painted on the rock surface
b. Carved into the rock
c. Found only in caves
d. Exclusive to the Neolithic period

Answer: (b)
A petroglyph is a carved representation, whereas a painting is applied to the surface; in India petroglyphs appear from the Upper Palaeolithic–Mesolithic.

4. Chalcolithic Cultures – Ahar, Kayatha, Malwa, Jorwe (PYQs 7 · MCQs 12)

- **Chalcolithic = Copper Age** (copper + stone tools); **first metal used = copper**.
- The **Chalcolithic** people are credited with the first wide use of **painted pottery** (a few Neolithic sites had some).

Culture	Sites	Region	Date	Pottery / feature
Ahar-Banas	Ahar, Gilund, Balathal	Mewar, Banas valley (Rajasthan)	c. 2800/2100–1500 BCE	White-painted black-and-red ware; copper smelting
Kayatha	Kayatha (Chambal)	MP	2450–1700 BCE	Chocolate-slipped ware
Malwa	Navdatoli (Narmada), Eran	Madhya Pradesh	1900–1400 BCE	Malwa ware; Navdatoli dug by H. D. Sankalia
Jorwe	Jorwe, Nevasa, Daimabad, Inamgaon	Maharashtra (nuclear zone Pravara–Godavari)	1400–700 BCE	Painted red ware (black-on-red)

- **Contemporaries of the Harappans: Ahar-Banas** and Kayatha; Malwa and Jorwe are later. Order of start: Ahar → Kayatha → Malwa → Jorwe.
- **Burials in Maharashtra:** dead buried in urns **under the house floor, north to south**.

- **Daimabad** (Pravara): largest Jorwe site; **bronze chariot**, buffalo, elephant, rhinoceros; **symbolic burial**; southernmost Late Harappan site.
- **Jorwe end:** most sites abandoned gradually after c. 1000 BCE (drought); Inamgaon, Prakash continued (Late Jorwe) – "**suddenly deserted**" is the wrong statement (CDS 2012).

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.63-74; examrobot CDS-I 2012 key; app notes 1:2 (sub 5)

34. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ahar or Banas culture was a contemporary of which culture?

a. Harappa culture
b. Mughal period culture
c. Mauryan period culture
d. Gupta period culture

Answer: (a)
The Ahar-Banas culture of Mewar (c. 2800/2100–1500 BCE) was contemporary with the Harappan civilisation; the Mauryan and Gupta periods are much later.

35. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

In which state, the Navdatoli is located ?

a. Gujarat
b. Maharashtra
c. Chhattisgarh
d. Madhya Pradesh

Answer: (d)
Navdatoli, the Malwa-culture site on the Narmada (opposite Maheshwar), is in Madhya Pradesh; excavated by H. D. Sankalia.

36. [PYQ] · CDS 2012

Which among the following cultures were the first to paint their pottery?

a. Mesolithic
b. Chalcolithic
c. Neolithic
d. Iron age

Answer: (b)
The Chalcolithic cultures are credited (R. S. Sharma, NCERT) as the first to use painted pottery widely – Ahar white-painted black-and-red ware, Malwa ware, Jorwe painted red ware. PMF notes some painted pottery already at a few Neolithic sites, but the standard key is Chalcolithic.

37. [PYQ] · CDS 2012

Which one among the following statements regarding Jorwe Culture is not correct?

a. Pravara-Godavari Valley was the nuclear zone of Jorwe Culture.
b. The main sites of Jorwe Culture are Daimabad, Inamgaon, Jorwe and Nevasa.
c. At Daimabad, one gets archaeo- logical evidence of symbolic burial.
d. Practically all Jorwe settlements in the Northern Deccan were suddenly deserted.

Answer: (d)
The Jorwe sites were not 'suddenly' deserted: most were abandoned gradually after c. 1000 BCE (drought), and Inamgaon, Daimabad, Prakash continued into a Late Jorwe phase till c. 700 BCE. The other statements are right – Pravara-Godavari nuclear zone, main sites, symbolic burial at Daimabad.

38. [PYQ] · UPPSC 1997

In the Chalcolithic period people of Maharashtra buried their dead under the floor of their houses in the following orientation

a. North to South position
b. South to North position
c. South to North position
d. West to East position

Answer: (a)
Chalcolithic people of Maharashtra buried their dead under the house floor in a north-to-south orientation (Inamgaon, Jorwe).

39. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which one of the following periods is also known as Chalcolithic Age?

a. Old Stone Age
b. New Stone Age
c. Copper Age
d. Iron Age

Answer: (c)
Chalcolithic (chalco = copper, lithic = stone) is the Copper Age, when copper tools were used with stone tools.

40. [PYQ] · APPSC Teaching Staff of the Department of Technical Educatio

Which metal did the ancient Indians use first?

a. Iron
b. Gold
c. Silver
d. Copper

Answer: (d)
Copper was the first metal used in India (Chalcolithic cultures); iron came only around 1000 BCE.

41. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Chalcolithic culture) with List-II (Pottery):
List-I | List-II
a. Ahar-Banas | i. Painted red ware (black-on-red)
b. Kayatha | ii. White-painted black-and-red ware
c. Malwa | iii. Malwa ware
d. Jorwe | iv. Chocolate-slipped ware
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
c. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (b)
Ahar-Banas – white-painted black-and-red ware; Kayatha – chocolate-slipped ware; Malwa – Malwa ware; Jorwe – painted red ware (black-on-red).

42. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Malwa culture is dated to 1900–1400 BCE.
2. The Jorwe culture is dated to 1400–700 BCE.
3. Inamgaon belongs to the Jorwe culture, whose nuclear zone is the Pravara–Godavari region.
4. Navdatoli on the Narmada was excavated by V. N. Misra.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 and 4 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1, 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)
1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: Navdatoli (Malwa culture, MP) was dug by H. D. Sankalia.

43. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Chalcolithic cultures:
1. The Ahar-Banas and Kayatha cultures were contemporaries of the Harappans.
2. The Malwa culture began before the Kayatha culture.
3. The Ahar-Banas culture began the earliest of the four (Ahar, Kayatha, Malwa, Jorwe).
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the order of start is Ahar → Kayatha → Malwa → Jorwe; Malwa and Jorwe are later than the Harappans.

44. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Daimabad on the Pravara is the largest Jorwe site.
2. Daimabad yielded a bronze chariot and a bronze buffalo.
3. Daimabad is the southernmost Late Harappan site.
4. The Jorwe settlements were suddenly deserted around 1000 BCE.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3 only
b. 2 and 4 only
c. 1, 2, 3 and 4
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (a)
1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: most Jorwe sites were abandoned gradually after c. 1000 BCE (drought), and Inamgaon and Prakash continued into Late Jorwe.

45. [Kept own]
In which state is the Chalcolithic site of Kayatha located?

a. Madhya Pradesh
b. Maharashtra
c. Rajasthan
d. Gujarat

Answer: (a)
Kayatha is in Madhya Pradesh; Jorwe, Savalda and Inamgaon are in Maharashtra.

5. Stone Age Framework – Phases, Proto-history, Early Man (PYQs 7 · MCQs 9)

- **Order:** Lower → Middle → Upper Palaeolithic → Mesolithic → Neolithic → Chalcolithic → Iron Age (Megalithic).
- **Phases are defined by tool type and technology**; tools varied by region and cultures did **not** evolve uniformly or unilinearly.
- **Three-Age system** (Stone, Bronze, Iron): **C. J. Thomsen** (Copenhagen museum); "Palaeolithic/Neolithic" coined by Lubbock.
- **Proto-history:** writing exists but is undeciphered – the **Indus civilisation** is **proto-historic**.
- **Early man: Narmada Man** skull found by **Arun Sonakia, 1982** at **Hathnora** (Narmada valley, MP) – earliest human fossil of India; Bori (Maharashtra) artefacts c. 1.38 million years.
- **Cro-Magnon** = anatomically modern humans of the Upper Palaeolithic – later than Neanderthals and Heidelberg man.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.26-27, p.45-47; Britannica (Three-Age system, Cro-Magnon)

- **Wheel:** first invented c. **3500 BC** (Mesopotamia); in India solid-wheeled carts and toy carts appear with the Harappans.
- **Why so many Stone Age sites in the South:** the Deccan and Andhra hills had **abundant stone (quartzite) for tools** and rocky terrain that preserves sites, while thick Gangetic alluvium buries them.

46. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996
Indus Civilization existed in–

a. Prehistoric age
b. Proto-historic age
c. Historic age
d. Post-Historic age

Answer: (b)
The Indus civilisation is proto-historic: it had a script, but the script is still undeciphered, so it falls between prehistory and history.

47. [PYQ] · CDS 2019
Consider the following statements about Stone Age in India. (i) Different periods are identified on the basis of the type and technology of stone tools. (ii) There are no regional variations in the type and technology of tools in different periods. (iii) Stone Age cultures of different periods evolved uniformly in a neat unilinear fashion all over the subcontinent.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. Only I
b. I and II
c. Only III
d. I, II and III

Answer: (a)
Stone Age phases are defined by tool type and technology (statement I is true), but tools varied by region and cultures did not evolve in one uniform unilinear way, so II and III are false.

48. [PYQ] · RAS/RTS (Pre) 1994
Which of the following is considered to be the most recent?

a. Heidelberg humans
b. Cro-Magnon humans
c. Pilt magnon humans
d. Neanderthal humans

Answer: (b)
Cro-Magnons were anatomically modern Homo sapiens of the Upper Palaeolithic, later than Neanderthals and Heidelberg man; 'Pilt magnon' is not a real human group.

49. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2010
The three-age system was divided into stone, bronze and iron from the collection of Copenhagen museum were coined by

a. Thomsen
b. Lubbock
c. Taylor
d. Childe

Answer: (a)
The Three-Age system (Stone, Bronze, Iron) was devised by the Danish curator C. J. Thomsen while arranging the Copenhagen museum collection; Lubbock later coined 'Palaeolithic/Neolithic'.

50. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006
The earliest evidence of man in India is found in

a. Nilgiri Hills
b. Shiwalik Hills
c. Nallamala Hills
d. Narmada Valley

Answer: (d)
The earliest human fossil of India, the 'Narmada Man' skull, was found by Arun Sonakia in 1982 at Hathnora in the Narmada valley (MP).

51. [PYQ] · APPSC Degree Lecturers General Studies & Mental Ability 2020
In which year was the wheel invented?

a. 3500 BC
b. 206 BC
c. 50 BC
d. 45 BC

Answer: (a)
The wheel first appears in Mesopotamia around 3500 BC. The later dates offered are far too recent.

52. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar
The North Indian Plains (Gangetic plains) show very few signs of prehistoric Stone Age life, even though the region is agriculturally rich. In contrast, South India, including Andhra Pradesh, has revealed numerous prehistoric sites. What are the reasons for this contrast?

a. The earliest human migrations first reached South India and moved northward much later.
b. The North Indian Plains became suitable for human habitation only after 10,000 BCE.
c. The Deccan Plateau and regions like Andhra Pradesh had abundant stone resources for making tools.
d. Prehistoric humans avoided South India due to frequent volcanic eruptions in the Deccan region.

Answer: (c)
The Deccan and Andhra hills offered abundant quartzite and other stone for tools, and the rocky terrain preserved sites, whereas the thick alluvium of the Gangetic plains buries early sites; the migration and volcano options are false. Moved to Stone Age cultures.

53. [New pattern · assertion]
Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The Narmada Man is the earliest human fossil found in India.
Reason (R): It was found by Arun Sonakia at Hathnora in 1982.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (b)
Both statements are true, but R only says who found it, where and when; it does not explain why the fossil is the earliest.

54. [Kept own]
Which phase immediately follows the Mesolithic in the Stone Age sequence?

a. Upper Palaeolithic
b. Chalcolithic
c. Neolithic
d. Iron Age

Answer: (c)
The order is Lower, Middle, Upper Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Chalcolithic, Iron Age.

6. Megaliths – Nature, Iron Age and New Finds (PYQs 3 · MCQs 4)

- **Megaliths:** graves with weapons, tools and pottery, marked by **big stones** (mega = large, lith = stone) – **burial sites** away from homes; not microliths, chalcoliths or monoliths.
- Belong to the **Iron Age**, with **black-and-red ware**; c. 1000 BCE – 2nd century BCE (PMF).
- Earliest AMS-dated iron: **Mayiladumparai** (Krishnagiri, TN) – **2172 BCE**.
- **Bihar:** first documentation of a megalithic site (July 2019) in the **Kaimur hills** (Hurmeta menhirs).
- **Kerala:** rock-cut burial chamber at **Panayal** (Kasaragod).
- 21 Jul 2026: **Karivalamvanthanallur** (Tenkasi, TN) passed straight from **Microlithic to Iron/Early Historic**, with no Neolithic or Chalcolithic.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 3 p.27-28; rohtas.nic.in (megalithic tombs); app notes 1:2 (sub 8-9)

55. [PYQ] · APPSC 2018 Special Qualifying Test for Appointment by Promot

Ancient people of South India buried the dead along with weapons, tools, pottery etc in graves and placed big stones around the graves. These structures are known as?

a. Chalcoliths
b. Microliths
c. Monoliths
d. Megaliths

Answer: (d)
Graves with weapons, tools and pottery ringed by big stones are megaliths (mega = big, lith = stone); microliths are tiny Mesolithic tools.

56. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Megaliths have been identified as-

a. Caves for hermits
b. Burial sites
c. Temple sites
d. None of the above

Answer: (b)
Megaliths are mainly burial sites (graves marked by large stones, away from habitations), not hermits' caves or temples.

57. [PYQ] · BPSC 2019

In July 2019, experts visited for the first documentation of a Megalithic site of Bihar in which of the following district?

a. Patna
b. Kaimur
c. Madhubani
d. Banica

Answer: (b)
The megalithic site of July 2019 was in the Kaimur hills (Hurmeta, Nauhatta block) – Bihar's first documented megalithic site with menhirs; Patna, Madhubani and Banka are not hill districts with megaliths.

58. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. AMS dating places the earliest iron in India at Mayiladumparai (Krishnagiri) in 2172 BCE.
2. The rock-cut megalithic burial chamber of Panayal is in Kasaragod, Kerala.
3. At Karivalamvanthanallur (Tenkasi) the Microlithic was followed by a Chalcolithic phase before the Iron Age.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the 2026 finding is that Karivalamvanthanallur passed straight from the Microlithic to the Iron/Early Historic age, with no Neolithic or Chalcolithic.

7. Palaeolithic – Tool Techniques and Sites (PYQs 2 · MCQs 7)

Stage	Technique / tools	Sites
Lower	Acheulian = handaxe-cleaver; Soanian = chopper-chopping	Attirampakkam (TN), Hunsgi and Isampur (Karnataka), Didwana (Rajasthan), Sohan valley (Pakistan Punjab), Belan valley
Middle	Flake tools; prepared-core Levallois technique; scrapers, borers, points	Nevasa, Bhimbetka, Narmada valley; Sembur (TN)
Upper	Blades, burins, bone tools	Kurnool caves, Jwalapuram, Patne, Baghor

- **Attirampakkam** is an **Old Stone Age** (Lower Palaeolithic, Acheulian) site – not "Middle Stone Age" (Mesolithic).
- **Levallois** = Middle Palaeolithic prepared-core flake technique (Sembur); "Lacoid/Placoid/Hollois" are not techniques. No Neanderthal fossil has been found in India.
- Middle Palaeolithic = **flake** stage, not the microlithic stage.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.47-50; app notes 1:2 (sub 1)

59. [PYQ] · SI Mains Paper-IV 2017

The stone tools found at Attirampakam belongs to the following period.

a. Old stone age
b. Middle stone age
c. Neolithic
d. Historical

Answer: (a)

Attirampakkam (near Chennai, Tamil Nadu) is a classic Lower Palaeolithic (Acheulian hand-axe) site, i.e. Old Stone Age. 'Middle stone age' here means the Mesolithic, which it is not known for (a Middle Palaeolithic layer was reported only in 2018, after this exam).

60. [PYQ] · APPSC 2023 Screening test (Online Mode) to the post of Deput

Which of these is a technique used at several Indian sites of palaeolithic period such as Sembur , Tamil Nadu to produce stone tools?

a. Lacoid technique
b. Levallois technique
c. Placoid technique
d. Hollois technique

Answer: (b)

The Levallois prepared-core flake technique of the Middle Palaeolithic was used at Sembur (Tamil Nadu); 'Lacoid', 'Placoid' and 'Hollois' are not tool techniques.

61. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Tradition / stage) with List-II (Tools):
List-I | List-II
a. Soanian | i. Flakes made by the prepared-core Levallois technique
b. Acheulian | ii. Chopper-chopping tools
c. Middle Palaeolithic | iii. Handaxes and cleavers
d. Upper Palaeolithic | iv. Blades, burins and bone tools
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii

Answer: (c)

Soanian – chopper-chopping; Acheulian – handaxe-cleaver (both Lower Palaeolithic); Middle Palaeolithic – Levallois flakes; Upper Palaeolithic – blades, burins, bone tools (Patne, Kurnool caves).

62. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Hunsgi and Isampur in Karnataka are Lower Palaeolithic sites.
2. Attirampakkam in Tamil Nadu is a Mesolithic (Middle Stone Age) site.
3. Sembur in Tamil Nadu shows the use of the Levallois technique.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)

1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: Attirampakkam is an Old Stone Age (Lower Palaeolithic, Acheulian) site.

63. [Kept own]

The Middle Palaeolithic is principally which tool stage?

a. flake-tool
b. handaxe
c. blade
d. microlith

Answer: (a)

The Middle Palaeolithic is principally a flake-tool stage; microliths belong to the Upper Palaeolithic and Mesolithic.

64. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Levallois technique is a prepared-core flake technique of the Middle Palaeolithic.
2. A Neanderthal fossil has been found at Sembur in Tamil Nadu.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

Levallois belongs to the Middle Palaeolithic flake industry, but no Neanderthal fossil has been found in India.

65. [Kept own]

Match the following:
List-I (Lower Palaeolithic site) - List-II (Region)
A. Attirampakkam - 1. Rajasthan
B. Hunsgi - 2. Pakistan Punjab
C. Didwana - 3. Tamil Nadu
D. Sohan valley - 4. Karnataka
Select the correct answer using the code given below.

a. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
b. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
c. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
d. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2

Answer: (c)
Attirampakkam is in Tamil Nadu, Hunsgi in Karnataka, Didwana in Rajasthan and the Sohan valley in Pakistan Punjab.

Row 3: Pre-historic Cultures of Andhra – Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic and Megalithic Sites

1. Palaeolithic Andhra – Billa Surgam, Kurnool Caves and Sites (PYQs 8 · MCQs 14)

Billa Surgam and the Kurnool caves (most asked)

- **Billa Surgam caves:** K. K. Kottala village, **Betamcherla** mandal, **Kurnool** (now Nandyal) district – **not Anantapuramu**; limestone caves; **Old Stone Age** site.
- Explored by **Robert Bruce Foote** (1884) – the "Father of Indian prehistory", who also found the first Palaeolithic tool at **Pallavaram** (Chennai); **stone and rare bone tools** with Pleistocene animal fossils.
- **Kurnool caves** and **Muchatla Chintamani Gavi**: the **only Indian sites with bone tools in an Upper Palaeolithic context**.
- **Belum Caves** (Kolimigundla, Nandyal): **second-longest** cave system in India.
- **Betamcherla** = famous for **prehistoric caves** (not temples or a dam).
- Distractors in the G2 2017 question: **Keesarapalli** (Chalcolithic), **Utnur** (Neolithic ash mound), **Revarala** (megalithic menhir).

Sites by district

District	Palaeolithic sites
Kurnool	Billa Surgam, Betamcherla, Veerapuram, Sangameswaram, Jwalapuram (Upper Palaeolithic)
Prakasam	Giddaluru, Dornala, Yerragondapalem (well-made quartzite blades), Nandikanuma
Guntur / Krishna valley	Nagarjunakonda, Karampudi, Chejarla
Chittoor	Renigunta (Upper Palaeolithic blade-and-burin industry), Gudimallam
Anantapur	Guntakal (bone implements), Lattavaram, Velpulamadugu
Nellore, Kadapa	Pennar valley (Foote: 28 quartzite tools), Sagileru

- **Kurnool** is the Palaeolithic area of AP (Bagor = Rajasthan, Sarai Nahar Rai and Belan valley = UP).
- **Nagarjunakonda:** Lower Palaeolithic tools in river gravels studied by K. V. Soundara Rajan, which record **alternating dry and wet climatic phases** (APPSC key: three cycles); also microliths and an Iron Age–Megalithic centre.
- Mar 2026: Upper Palaeolithic **quartz tools** and **petroglyphs** at **Manchirevula** near Hyderabad.

Tools by stage and raw material

Stage	Tools	Raw material
Lower Palaeolithic	Handaxe, cleaver, chopper	Quartzite (Kadapa–Kurnool); limestone north of the Krishna
Middle Palaeolithic	Flakes, scrapers, borers, points	Chert, jasper, chalcedony
Upper Palaeolithic	Blades, burins, bone tools	Silica stone, bone
Mesolithic	Microliths	Chert, jasper; weapons of dolomite

~~ Sources: NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.2-3; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.48-49; K. V. Soundara Rajan, Ancient India 14 (1958); app notes 1:3

1. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar

Which of the following Palaeolithic sites is located in Andhra Pradesh?

a. Kurnool
b. Bagor
c. Sarai-Nahar
d. Belan Valley

Answer: (a)

Kurnool (Billa Surgam, Kurnool caves) is the Palaeolithic area of Andhra Pradesh; Bagor is in Rajasthan, Sarai Nahar Rai and the Belan valley in UP.

2. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar

Which Palaeolithic site of Andhra Pradesh has given the Paleo-Climatic evidence of three alternating dry and wet cycles?

a. Vishakhapatnam
b. Isampur
c. Nagarjunakonda
d. Jawalapuram

Answer: (c)

Nagarjunakonda (Krishna valley) – where K. V. Soundara Rajan studied the Stone Age sequence (Ancient India 1958) – yielded Palaeolithic tools in gravels that record alternating dry and wet phases; Isampur is in Karnataka and Jwalapuram is known for the Toba ash.

3. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II Mains 2017

Which of the following is a Paleolithic site?

a. Keesarapalli
b. Billasurgam
c. Utnur
d. Reverala

Answer: (b)

Billa Surgam caves (near Betamcherla, Kurnool – now Nandyal) are a Palaeolithic site explored by Robert Bruce Foote; Keesarapalli is Chalcolithic, Utnur a Neolithic ash mound and Reverala a megalithic menhir site.

4. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ

Which of the following statements is/are 42. Ma incorrect?
a. Billa Surgam Palaeolithic cave site is located in Anantapuramu district.
b. Belum caves located in Nandyal district is the second longest cave in India.
c. Cave sites of Kurnool and Muchatla Chintamani Gavi in A.P. are the only places in India where tools made of animal bones were found in upper palaeolithic context.

a. a and b
b. b and c
c. a only
d. c only CO Gr a. C. G i. iii. iv. V

Answer: (c)

Only (a) is wrong: Billa Surgam is in Kurnool (now Nandyal) district, not Anantapuramu. Belum (Nandyal) is the second-longest cave system in India, and the Kurnool caves with Muchatla Chintamani Gavi are the only Indian Upper Palaeolithic bone-tool sites.

5. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ

Which of the following is a old stone age site

a. Keesarapalli
b. Billa sorgam
c. Utnoor
d. Revarala

Answer: (b)

Billa Surgam (Kurnool) is an Old Stone Age (Palaeolithic) site; Keesarapalli is Chalcolithic, Utnur a Neolithic ash mound and Revarala a megalithic menhir.

6. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II Mains 2017 Paper-2 (16-07-2017)

Which of the following is a Palaeolithic site?

a. Keesarapalli
b. Billasargam
c. Utnur
d. Reverala

Answer: (b)

Billa Surgam (Kurnool) is the Palaeolithic site; Keesarapalli = Chalcolithic copper tools, Utnur = Neolithic ash mound, Reverala = menhir.

7. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

What is Betamcherla in Andhra Pradesh famous for?

a. Kakatiya Temples
b. Birthplace of Pothana
c. River Dam
d. Prehistoric Caves

Answer: (d)

The Betamcherla area (Billa Surgam caves, Kurnool) is famous for prehistoric caves with Palaeolithic tools.

8. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer (A.P. Tribal Welfare

The following statements contain an assertion and a reason. Read the statements carefully and answer from the given options.
Assertion (A): There is no evidence of tools making out of animal bones in upper paleolithic context in Andhra Pradesh.
Reason (R): One of the cave sites in Kurnool has given evidence of 90 percent tools being made out of animal bones.

a. A and R is True and R is the correct explanation of A
b. A and R is True but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is True but R is False
d. A is False but R is True

Answer: (d)
A is false: the Kurnool caves (Muchchatla Chintamani Gavi, Betamcherla) gave Upper Palaeolithic bone tools, about 90% of the tools there being of bone. So R is true.

9. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Billa Surgam caves are in Betamcherla mandal of Kurnool (now Nandyal) district.
2. They were explored in 1884 by Robert Bruce Foote, who also found the first Palaeolithic tool at Pallavaram.
3. The Belum Caves form the longest cave system in India.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 2 are correct (the caves yielded stone and rare bone tools with Pleistocene animal fossils). 3 is wrong: Belum Caves (Kolimigundla) are the second-longest cave system in India.

10. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Palaeolithic site of Andhra) with List-II (Known for):
List-I | List-II
a. Yerragondapalem | i. Upper Palaeolithic blade-and-burin industry
b. Renigunta | ii. Alternating dry and wet climatic phases in river gravels
c. Guntakal | iii. Well-made quartzite blades
d. Nagarjunakonda | iv. Bone implements
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
b. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
c. a-iii, b-i, c-iv, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (c)
Yerragondapalem (Prakasam) – well-made quartzite blades; Renigunta (Chittoor) – blade-and-burin industry; Guntakal (Anantapur) – bone implements; Nagarjunakonda – gravels studied by K. V. Soundara Rajan recording dry and wet phases.

11. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Palaeolithic sites of Andhra:
1. Jwalapuram in Kurnool district is an Upper Palaeolithic site.
2. Giddaluru, Dornala and Yerragondapalem are in Nellore district.
3. Nagarjunakonda yielded Lower Palaeolithic tools and microliths and was also an Iron Age–Megalithic centre.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: Giddaluru, Dornala and Yerragondapalem are in Prakasam district.

12. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Stage in Andhra) with List-II (Typical tools and raw material):
List-I | List-II
a. Lower Palaeolithic | i. Flakes, scrapers, borers and points of chert, jasper and chalcedony
b. Middle Palaeolithic | ii. Handaxes, cleavers and choppers of quartzite
c. Upper Palaeolithic | iii. Blades, burins and bone tools of silica stone
d. Mesolithic | iv. Microliths of chert and jasper
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
c. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv

Answer: (a)
Lower – handaxe, cleaver, chopper of quartzite (Kadapa–Kurnool); Middle – flakes, scrapers, borers, points of chert, jasper, chalcedony; Upper – blades, burins, bone tools of silica stone; Mesolithic – microliths of chert and jasper (weapons of dolomite).

13. [Kept own]
What has been reported from Manchirevula near Hyderabad in the context of Upper Palaeolithic evidence?

a. Copper tools and megalithic graves
b. Quartz tools and petroglyphs
c. Black-and-red ware and iron ornaments
d. Neolithic ash mounds and painted pottery

Answer: (b)
Upper Palaeolithic quartz tools and petroglyphs have been reported from Manchirevula near Hyderabad.

14. [Kept own]
Of which material were Mesolithic weapons in Andhra made?

a. Dolomite
b. Quartzite
c. Limestone
d. Copper

Answer: (a)
Mesolithic microliths were of chert and jasper, and weapons of dolomite; quartzite and limestone were Lower Palaeolithic materials.

2. Megalithic (Iron Age) Andhra – Rakshasa Gullu and Burial Types (PYQs 4 · MCQs 12)

- Andhra megaliths = **Rakshasa Gullu** ("large stones"), of the **Iron Age**, with **black-and-red ware** (absent only at **Visakhapatnam**).
- Local names: **Pandava Gullu** (Kurnool, Kadapa), **Kurambara Gullu** (Chittoor), **Morivara Gullu** (Anantapur).
- About **12 types** in AP (studied by **N. R. Banerji**); grave goods: pottery, beads, **iron implements**, gold ornaments – not glass mirrors; **dolmens for elites, pits for commoners**.
- Sites: **Nagarjunakonda** (main habitation centre), Brahmagiri, Gudivada, **Jonnawada** (Nellore), Boodigapalli, Naidupalli; a coffin with a male and a female body in one grave near **Yeleswaram**.
- Jun 2026: **Mayiladumparai** (TN) AMS dating puts the South Indian Iron Age at c. **2100 BCE** (2172 BCE), earlier than the Gangetic Iron Age.
- H. D. Sankalia: **rice** was first harvested and eaten in Andhra in this **Iron/Megalithic** age.

Type	Form	AP area
Cist	Stone-slab box	NextGen: found everywhere except Visakhapatnam (the G2 key treated "many in Visakhapatnam" as correct)
Dolmen	Table-like chamber of slabs	Krishna, Guntur, East and West Godavari; also Chittoor
Sarcophagus	Terracotta coffin	Sankhavaram (Kurnool) – ram-shaped; Nagarjunakonda; NOT a Chittoor–Anantapuramu cluster
Menhir	Upright stone	Revarala (Krishna)
Anthropomorphic	Human-shaped stone	Tirupati – India's largest collection

> G2 PYQ: the incorrect statement (official key) = "sarcophagus burials are more in Chittoor and Anantapuramu".

- **Warangal** region: famous for **iron implements** and steel (wootz) – the iron tradition of the Telangana–Andhra region.

~~ Sources: NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.5; NextGen Powerplay #1 Part 1.1 p.3-4; inflibnet e-PG "Megaliths of South India" (Sankavaram); app notes 1:3 (sub 6)

15. [PYQ] · APPSC AE (Subordinate Services) Mains General Studies & Ment
What is "Pandava Gullu"?

a. Megalithic Burials
b. Natural rock formation
c. Temples of Pandavas
d. Sacred Groves

Answer: (a)
'Pandava Gullu' is the Kurnool–Kadapa name for megalithic burials (Rakshasa Gullu), not temples of the Pandavas.

16. [PYQ] · APPSC Forest Section Officer Screening Test General Studies

'Megaliths' of Andhra region belong to which period?

a. Late-Paleolithic Age
b. Iron Age
c. Mesolithic Age
d. Early-Paleolithic Age

Answer: (b)
The megaliths (Rakshasa Gullu) of Andhra belong to the Iron Age, with black-and-red ware.

17. [PYQ] · UP UDA/LDA (Pre) 2001

In 3rd AD, Warangal was famous for

a. copper pots
b. gold Jewelleries
c. iron implements
d. elephant-teeth work

Answer: (c)
Warangal (and the Telangana region) was famous for iron and steel – iron implements and wootz steel; the region's iron working goes back to the megalithic Iron Age. Copper pots, gold jewellery and ivory are distractors.

18. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ

Which one of the following statements is incorrect with reference to megalithic burials in Andhra?

a. Tirupati has the largest anthropomorphic burial site collection
b. Many numbers of cyst burials were found in Vishakhapatnam District
c. Sarcophagus burials are more in number in Chittoor and Anantapuramu districts
d. Krishna and Chittoor districts contained many numbers of dolmen burials

Answer: (c)
Per the APPSC key, statement (c) is the incorrect one: Andhra's sarcophagus burial is the ram-shaped terracotta coffin of Sankhavaram (Kurnool), not a Chittoor–Anantapuramu cluster. Tirupati has the largest anthropomorphic collection, and dolmens occur in Krishna and Chittoor. (NextGen also says cists are found everywhere except Visakhapatnam, which would make (b) wrong too.)

19. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the megaliths of Andhra:
1. They are called 'Rakshasa Gullu' and belong to the Iron Age, with black-and-red ware.
2. They are called 'Kurambara Gullu' in Chittoor and 'Morivara Gullu' in Anantapur.
3. Black-and-red ware is absent only at Nagarjunakonda.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (b)
1 and 2 are correct (they are 'Pandava Gullu' in Kurnool and Kadapa). 3 is wrong: black-and-red ware is absent only at Visakhapatnam; Nagarjunakonda was the main megalithic habitation centre.

20. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about megalithic burials in Andhra Pradesh:
1. N. R. Banerji identified about 12 types of megalithic burials in Andhra.
2. Dolmens were generally for elites, while pits were for commoners.
3. Glass mirrors were among the usual grave goods.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 and 3 only
b. 1 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: grave goods were pottery, beads, iron implements and gold ornaments – not glass mirrors.

21. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Jonnawada, a megalithic site, is in Nellore district.
2. Nagarjunakonda was the main megalithic habitation centre of Andhra.
3. AMS dates from Mayiladumparai place the South Indian Iron Age at c. 2100 BCE, later than the Gangetic Iron Age.
4. According to H. D. Sankalia, rice was first harvested in Andhra in the Iron (Megalithic) age.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2, 3 and 4
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2, 3 and 4 only
d. 1, 2 and 4 only

Answer: (d)
1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: the c. 2100 BCE (2172 BCE) date makes the South Indian Iron Age earlier, not later, than the Gangetic Iron Age.

22. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Megalithic burial type) with List-II (Area in Andhra):
List-I | List-II
a. Dolmen | i. Sankhavaram (Kurnool) and Nagarjunakonda
b. Sarcophagus | ii. Krishna, Guntur and the Godavari districts
c. Menhir | iii. Revarala (Krishna)
d. Anthropomorphic figure | iv. Tirupati
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (a)
Dolmen – Krishna, Guntur, East and West Godavari (also Chittoor); terracotta sarcophagus – ram-shaped at Sankhavaram (Kurnool) and Nagarjunakonda, not a Chittoor–Anantapuramu cluster; menhir – Revarala (Krishna); anthropomorphic – Tirupati, India's largest collection.

23. [Kept own]

What is a table-like megalithic chamber made of large slabs called?

a. Cist
b. Dolmen
c. Menhir
d. Sarcophagus

Answer: (b)
A dolmen is a table-like chamber; a cist is a stone-slab box, a menhir an upright stone and a sarcophagus a terracotta coffin.

24. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about megaliths in Andhra Pradesh:
1. They are popularly called 'Rakshasa Gullu'.
2. They belong to the Iron Age.
3. Dolmens were the burials of commoners.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
AP megaliths ('Rakshasa Gullu') are Iron Age; dolmens were for elites and pits for commoners.

25. [Kept own]

Which megalithic burial type is NOT correctly matched with its form?

a. Cist – stone-slab box
b. Dolmen – table-like chamber
c. Menhir – terracotta coffin
d. Anthropomorphic – human-shaped stone

Answer: (c)
A menhir is an upright stone; the terracotta coffin is the sarcophagus.

26. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about megalithic burials in Andhra:
1. Menhirs are concentrated in Krishna district.
2. The largest collection of anthropomorphic megaliths is in the Tirupati region.
3. Dolmens are found in Krishna and Chittoor.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)
All three are correct: menhirs are concentrated in Krishna, the Tirupati region has the largest anthropomorphic collection in India, and dolmens occur in Krishna, Chittoor and East Godavari.

3. Neolithic–Chalcolithic Andhra – Patapadu, Keesarapalli, Utnur (PYQs 4 · MCQs 7)

Site	Location	Feature
Patapadu	Kurnool	Chalcolithic – painted pottery (Copper Age evidence of Andhra)
Keesarapalli	Krishna	Chalcolithic – copper tools
Utnur	Mahbubnagar, Telangana	Neolithic ash mound ("mounds of burning soot")
Palavoy	Anantapur	Neolithic settlement, four ash mounds
Veerapuram	Kurnool, right bank of the Krishna	Neolithic–Chalcolithic to Early Historic sequence
Ramapuram	Kurnool	Neolithic–Chalcolithic
Sanganakallu, Tekkalakota	Ballari, Karnataka	Neolithic settlements – not Andhra
Brahmagiri	Chitradurga, Karnataka	Copper objects; megalithic graves

- First Neolithic tool in South India: **Meadows Taylor, 1842**, at **Lingasugur** (Raichur) – not Jwalapuram.
- Neolithic weapons of AP mostly of **dolomite**; sandstone axes near **Vaddamanu** (Amaravati).

~~ Sources: NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.4-5; app notes 1:3 (sub 4)

- **Disposal of the dead (Neolithic–Chalcolithic Andhra):** adults in **extended burials**, often with pots; children in urns – not cremation or mound burials.
- **Utnur ash mounds:** formed by repeatedly **burning cow dung inside wooden cattle stockades** rebuilt many times (Allchin) → proof of Neolithic **animal domestication**.

27. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II Mains 2017

Which of the following is evidence of Copper Age in Andhra?

a. Sanganakallu
b. Tekkalakota
c. Palvai
d. Patapadu

Answer: (d)
Patapadu (Kurnool), with painted pottery, is the Chalcolithic (Copper Age) site of Andhra; Sanganakallu and Tekkalakota are Neolithic sites in Karnataka.

28. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ

Which of the following places is an evidence of Chalcolithic age in Andhra

a. Sanganakallu
b. Tekkala Kota
c. Palavoy
d. Patapadu

Answer: (d)
Patapadu (Kurnool) is the Chalcolithic evidence in Andhra (painted pottery); Sanganakallu and Tekkalakota (Ballari) and Palavoy are Neolithic.

29. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar

In Andhra Pradesh, during the Neolithic-Chalcolithic period, which system of disposing of the dead was in practice?

a. Post-cremation burials
b. Mound burials
c. Cremation
d. extended burials

Answer: (d)

In the Neolithic-Chalcolithic sites of Andhra (Utnur, Nagarjunakonda) adults were laid in extended burials, often with pots; urns were used for children. Post-cremation and mound burials are not typical. Off-topic for the IVC, moved to prehistoric Andhra.

30. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer (A.P. Tribal Welfare

The following statements contains an assertion followed by a reason. Read the statements carefully and answer from the given below options.
Assertion (A): Utnur site has shown the evidence of animal domestication in Andhra Pradesh during Neolithic period
Reason (R): An evidence of wooden enclosure built many times and burning of cow dung repeatedly has been found.

a. A and R is True and R is the correct explanation of A
b. A and R is True but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is True and R is False
d. A is False but R is True

Answer: (a)

At Utnur (Mahabubnagar) Allchin found ash mounds formed by repeatedly burning cow dung inside wooden cattle stockades, proving Neolithic cattle-keeping. So both are true and R explains A.

31. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): Sanganakallu and Tekkalakota cannot be counted among the Neolithic sites of Andhra Pradesh.
Reason (R): Sanganakallu and Tekkalakota lie in Ballari district of Karnataka.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)

Both true; R explains A: they are Neolithic settlements of Ballari (Bellary), Karnataka – not Andhra.

32. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Site) with List-II (Feature):
List-I | List-II
a. Patapadu (Kurnool) | i. Neolithic settlement with four ash mounds
b. Keesarapalli (Krishna) | ii. Chalcolithic copper tools
c. Palavoy (Anantapur) | iii. Chalcolithic painted pottery
d. Veerapuram (Kurnool) | iv. Neolithic–Chalcolithic to Early Historic sequence
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
d. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv

Answer: (d)

Patapadu – Chalcolithic painted pottery; Keesarapalli – Chalcolithic copper tools; Palavoy – Neolithic settlement with four ash mounds; Veerapuram (right bank of the Krishna) – Neolithic–Chalcolithic to Early Historic.

33. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Utnur, a Neolithic ash-mound site, is in Mahbubnagar district of Telangana.
2. Meadows Taylor found the first Neolithic tool of South India at Jwalapuram in 1842.
3. Brahmagiri, with copper objects and megalithic graves, is in Chitradurga district of Karnataka.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: Meadows Taylor's 1842 find was at Lingasugur (Raichur), not Jwalapuram.

4. Mesolithic Andhra – Giddaluru and the Microlithic Centres (PYQs 3 · MCQs 4)

- **Giddaluru (Prakasam)** = the **microlithic implement centre** of Andhra identified by archaeologists (Nellore, Kurnool, Guntur are distractors).
- Microliths also at **Nagarjunakonda** and **Kondapur**; tool centres discovered by **Robert Bruce Foote**.
- Mesolithic = **microlithic**; tools by **flaking and chipping**; Andhra microliths resemble those of **South India and the Caspian** region.

- Microlithic implements of c. 5000 BCE at **Giddaluru and Khammam**.

  ~~ Sources: NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.3-4

- **Raw material:** South Indian Mesolithic microliths were mostly of **milky quartz**; found at **Nagarjunakonda** and **Renigunta**, among others.

34. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

Which of the following centres has been identified by archaeologists as a centre for microlithic (micro stone) tools?

a. Nellore
b. Kurnool
c. Guntur
d. Giddalur

Answer: (d)

Giddalur (Prakasam) is the main microlithic (Mesolithic) tool centre of Andhra identified by archaeologists.

35. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ

Which of the following centres was recognized by the archaeologist as microlithic implement centre

a. Kumool
b. Guntur
c. Giddaluru
d. Nellore

Answer: (c)

Giddaluru (Prakasam) was recognised as the microlithic implement centre of Andhra; microliths also occur at Nagarjunakonda and Kondapur.

36. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer (A.P. Tribal Welfare **disputed**

The following statements contains an assertion followed by a reason. Read the statements carefully and answer from the given below options.
Assertion (A): The Microliths in South Indian were mostly made of milky quartz during Mesolithic period.
Reason (R): Nagarjunakonda and Renigunta sites in Andhra Pradesh have given evidence of these microliths.

a. A and R is True and R is the correct explanation of A
b. A and R is True but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is True but R is False
d. A is False but R is True

Answer: (a)

Printed APPSC key: A and R true, R explains A. Strictly R only names find-spots and does not explain why quartz was used, so 'R is not the correct explanation' is the stricter answer.
Both are true: Mesolithic microliths in South India were mostly of milky quartz, and Nagarjunakonda and Renigunta in AP have yielded them. The printed APPSC key links them as assertion and explanation.

37. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Mesolithic of Andhra:
1. Its microlithic tool centres were discovered by Robert Bruce Foote.
2. Andhra microliths resemble those of South India and the Caspian region.
3. Microliths have been found at Nagarjunakonda and Kondapur.
4. The microlithic implements of Giddaluru and Khammam date to about 50,000 BCE.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1, 2 and 3 only
c. 3 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)

1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: the microlithic implements of Giddaluru and Khammam date to about 5000 BCE.

5. Rock Art and Caves of Andhra (PYQs 0 · MCQs 3)

- **Borra Caves** (Ananthagiri hills, Araku, **Visakhapatnam**): karstic limestone caves; discovered **1807** by William King (GSI); Mesolithic example.
- **Ketavaram** (Kurnool): Mesolithic rock paintings; most painted animal in AP rock art = **deer**.
- Neolithic paintings: **Chintagunta** (man with bow), **Velpulamadugu** (humped bulls facing each other), **Thenagala** (dog and deer in red) – Anantapur.
- **Petroglyphs** are **carved**, not painted.

  ~~ Sources: NextGen AP HISTORY Part 1 p.4-5

38. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about caves and rock art of Andhra:
1. The Borra Caves in the Ananthagiri hills (Visakhapatnam) were discovered in 1807 by William King.
2. The Ketavaram Mesolithic rock paintings are in Kurnool district.
3. The Neolithic painting at Chintagunta shows humped bulls facing each other.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Chintagunta shows a man with a bow; the humped bulls facing each other are at Velpulamadugu.

39. [Kept own]

Which animal is most often painted in the prehistoric rock art of Andhra?

a. Bull
b. Elephant
c. Tiger
d. Deer

Answer: (d)
The deer is the most often painted animal in the rock art of the region.

40. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about prehistoric rock art in Andhra:
1. Petroglyphs are carved, not painted.
2. Ketavaram rock paintings are in Visakhapatnam district.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
Petroglyphs are carved images; Ketavaram is in Kurnool, not Visakhapatnam.

Row 4: Pre-harappan and Early Harappan Cultures – Mehrgarh, Amri, Kot Diji, Kalibangan-i

1. Mehrgarh – Earliest Farming and Settled Life (PYQs 3 · MCQs 9)

- **Mehrgarh** (Kachhi plain, Baluchistan, near the **Bolan Pass**; c. **7000 BCE**): **earliest agriculture** (wheat, barley), domestication and **settled life** in the subcontinent; excavated by **J.-F. Jarrige** (1974).
- Seven periods (I–VII) give remains **from the Stone Age (Neolithic) to the Harappan** period – unlike Amri, Kot Diji or Kalibangan.

Period	Evidence
I (c. 7000 BCE)	Aceramic Neolithic; mud-brick houses; barley, wheat; sheep, goat, cattle
II	Pottery and cotton (c. 5000 BCE, oldest cotton) begin
III onward	Copper working, wheel-made painted pottery, beads

- **Burials:** under or near the houses, flexed, with grave goods, sometimes with **goats**.
- Neolithic Baluchistan and Indus plains: crops **wheat, barley, dates, cotton**; main animals **sheep and goats**.

Early village	Area	Excavator
Kili Gul Muhammad	Quetta valley	W. A. Fairservis
Damb Sadaat	Quetta valley (Early Harappan phase)	W. A. Fairservis
Rana Ghundai	Zhob-Loralai valley	E. J. Ross

> Mehrgarh is a **Neolithic** site, not a Harappan city; "earliest settled life" and "earliest agriculture" = Mehrgarh (not Kili Gul Muhammad, Quetta or Kalat).

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.53-56; NextGen Indian History Part 1 p.1; app notes 1:4

1. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

The cultural remains from Stone Age to Harappan Civilization have been obtained from which one of the following ancient sites?

a. Amri
b. Mehrgarh
c. Kotdiji
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (b)
Mehrgarh (Baluchistan) shows an unbroken sequence from the Neolithic (c. 7000 BCE) to the Harappan period.

2. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Name the site which has revealed the earliest evidence of settled life ?

a. Dholavira
b. Kile Gul Mohammad
c. Kalibangan
d. Mehrgarh

Answer: (d)
Mehrgarh (c. 7000 BCE, Kachhi plain) has the earliest evidence of settled life in the subcontinent; Kili Gul Muhammad is later (c. 5000 BCE) and Dholavira, Kalibangan are Harappan.

3. [PYQ] · WBCS 2020

Which among the following places has given the earliest evidence of agriculture in Indian sub-continent?

a. Pratapgarh
b. Mehargarh
c. Quetta
d. Kalat

Answer: (b)
Mehrgarh (c. 7000 BCE, Baluchistan) gives the earliest evidence of agriculture in the subcontinent; Quetta and Kalat are only nearby areas.

4. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Mehrgarh:
1. It lies in the Kachhi plain of Baluchistan near the Bolan Pass.
2. It was excavated by J.-F. Jarrige from 1974.
3. Its Period I goes back to about 7000 BCE.
4. It is a Mature Harappan city.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2, 3 and 4 only
c. 1, 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)
1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: Mehrgarh is a Neolithic site (earliest agriculture and settled life), not a Harappan city, though its seven periods run up to the Harappan.

5. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the periods of Mehrgarh:
1. Period I was an aceramic Neolithic phase with mud-brick houses.
2. Pottery and cotton first appear in Period II.
3. Copper working and wheel-made painted pottery begin in Period I.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: copper working, wheel-made painted pottery and beads begin in Period III.

6. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Neolithic Mehrgarh and Baluchistan:
1. The dead were buried under or near the houses, flexed, with grave goods and sometimes with goats.
2. The main domesticated animals were cattle and horses.
3. The crops included wheat, barley, dates and cotton.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the main animals were sheep and goats.

7. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Early village) with List-II (Location / phase):
List-I | List-II
a. Kili Gul Muhammad | i. Quetta valley farming village
b. Damb Sadaat | ii. Early Harappan-phase village of the Quetta valley
c. Rana Ghundai | iii. Kachhi plain near the Bolan Pass
d. Mehrgarh | iv. Zhob-Loralai valley
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (b)
Kili Gul Muhammad – Quetta valley; Damb Sadaat – Quetta valley, Early Harappan phase; Rana Ghundai – Zhob-Loralai valley; Mehrgarh – Kachhi plain near the Bolan Pass.

8. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. W. A. Fairservis excavated Kili Gul Muhammad and Damb Sadaat.
2. Rana Ghundai was excavated by J.-F. Jarrige.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. Both 1 and 2
b. 2 only
c. 1 only
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
1 is correct. 2 is wrong: Rana Ghundai was excavated by E. J. Ross; Jarrige excavated Mehrgarh.

9. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Mehrgarh:
1. Period I was aceramic and had mud-brick houses.
2. The dead were usually buried far from the houses.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
Period I was aceramic with mud-brick houses; burials were under or near houses.

2. Early Harappan Cultures – Amri, Kot Diji, Sothi, Kalibangan-I (PYQs 1 · MCQs 9)

- Early (Pre-) Harappan phase **3300–2600 BCE** = **Regionalisation Era** (Hakra phase); copper, the wheel and the **plough** were already known.

Culture / site	Area	Feature	Excavator
Amri	Sindh	Transitional pre- to Mature culture; rhinoceros remains; later Jhangar	N. G. Majumdar (1929), later J.-M. Casal
Kot Diji	Sindh	Fortified, destroyed by fire; many stone implements	Ghurye; F. A. Khan (1955)
Sothi-Siswal	Rajasthan–Haryana (Ghaggar)	Pre-Harappan pottery	A. Ghosh identified Sothi
Hakra	Cholistan (Ghaggar-Hakra) – not Gujarat	–	–
Banawali	Fatehabad, Haryana	Pre- and Mature phases	R. S. Bisht (1974)
Mitathal	Bhiwani, Haryana	Pre-, Mature and Late phases	Suraj Bhan (1968)

- **Amalananda Ghosh** (1953) was the **first to see the likeness between a pre-Harappan culture (Sothi) and the Mature Harappan**.
- Pottery was regional (Amri, Kot Diji, Sothi-Siswal, Hakra wares), not uniform; Early Harappans used the potter's wheel.

Kalibangan-I

- **Earliest ploughed field** with **criss-cross furrows** = **mixed cropping**; mud-brick fortification; pottery in **six fabrics**.
- Excavated **1961–69** by **B. B. Lal and B. K. Thapar**. The ploughed field is pre-Harappan; the fire altars belong to the Mature phase.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History Part 1 p.1, p.13-15; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.72-73; Wikipedia "Amalananda Ghosh"; app notes 1:4

10. [PYQ] · BPSC 2019

Who among the following archaeologists was the first to identify similarities between a pre-Harappan culture and the mature Harappan culture?

a. Amalananda Ghosh
b. Rakhaldas Banerji
c. Daya Ram Sahni
d. Sir John Marshall

Answer: (a)
Amalananda Ghosh (1953) first noticed that the pre-Harappan Sothi culture of the Ghaggar valley resembled the Mature Harappan culture; he also discovered Kalibangan.

11. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Early (Pre-) Harappan phase:
1. The phase of 3300–2600 BCE is called the Regionalisation Era.
2. The plough was already known in this phase.
3. Its pottery was uniform across regions.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: pottery was regional – Amri, Kot Diji, Sothi-Siswal and Hakra wares.

12. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Site) with List-II (Excavator):
List-I | List-II
a. Amri | i. Suraj Bhan (1968)
b. Kot Diji | ii. F. A. Khan (1955)
c. Banawali | iii. R. S. Bisht (1974)
d. Mitathal | iv. N. G. Majumdar (1929)
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-iv, b-ii, c-iii, d-i
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-iv, b-i, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (a)
Amri – N. G. Majumdar (1929), later J.-M. Casal; Kot Diji – F. A. Khan (1955); Banawali – R. S. Bisht (1974); Mitathal – Suraj Bhan (1968).

13. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Early Harappan cultures:
1. Rhinoceros remains have been found at Amri.
2. Kot Diji was a fortified settlement destroyed by fire.
3. The Hakra culture is located in Gujarat.
4. The Sothi-Siswal culture belongs to the Rajasthan–Haryana area.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1, 2 and 4 only
c. 2, 3 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)
1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Hakra culture is in Cholistan (Ghaggar-Hakra), not Gujarat.

14. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The pre-Harappan ploughed field at Kalibangan is taken as evidence of mixed cropping.
Reason (R): The field shows criss-cross furrows.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both true; R explains A: criss-cross furrows (two crops sown in lines at right angles) indicate mixed cropping in the earliest ploughed field.

15. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Kalibangan:
1. Its pottery is classified into six fabrics.
2. It was excavated during 1961–69 by R. S. Bisht.
3. Kalibangan-I had a mud-brick fortification.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: Kalibangan was excavated by B. B. Lal and B. K. Thapar; R. S. Bisht excavated Banawali.

16. [Kept own]
Which of the following sites is associated with pre-, Mature and Late Harappan phases?

a. Balakot
b. Padri
c. Mitathal
d. Gumla

Answer: (c)
Mitathal is associated with the pre-Harappan, Mature Harappan and Late Harappan phases.

17. [Kept own]
Which of the following is an Early Harappan regional pottery tradition?

a. Northern Black Polished Ware
b. Kot Diji ware
c. Ochre Coloured Pottery
d. Painted Grey Ware

Answer: (b)
Kot Diji ware is one of the Early Harappan regional traditions, along with Amri, Sothi-Siswal and Hakra wares.

18. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements about Kalibangan-I:
1. It has the earliest ploughed field.
2. Its fire altars belong to the pre-Harappan level.
3. It had a mud-brick fortification.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
The ploughed field and mud-brick fortification belong to Kalibangan-I; fire altars belong to the Mature phase.

3. Origin Debate and Excavators (PYQs 1 · MCQs 5)

- **W. A. Fairservis** wrote "**The Roots of Ancient India**" (1971) on the prehistoric village cultures of Baluchistan.

View on Harappan origin	Scholar
Indigenous growth	John Marshall
Migration from Sumer	E. J. H. Mackay
Diffusion of ideas from West Asia	Mortimer Wheeler
Local evolution from the Mehrgarh Neolithic	Current consensus

- Kalibangan and Kot Diji foreshadow Mature buildings and pottery → urbanisation was **gradual and local**, not imported from Mesopotamia.
- Unsolved: the **gap between Neolithic Mehrgarh and the urban phase**.
- 23 Jun 2026: **Rakhigarhi** (~550 ha) shows unbroken Early to Mature occupation; Haryana protected **Tighrana and Mitathal** (**Bhiwani**).

~~ Sources: Wikipedia "Walter Fairservis"; app notes 1:4 (sub 4-5)

19. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016
'The Roots of Ancient India' was written by

a. D. K. Chakravarti
b. D. P. Agrawal
c. W. A. Fairservis
d. A. Ghosh

Answer: (c)
'The Roots of Ancient India' (1971) was written by Walter A. Fairservis Jr., excavator of Kili Gul Muhammad and Damb Sadaat.

20. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Scholar) with List-II (View on the origin of the Harappan Civilisation):
List-I | List-II
a. John Marshall | i. Diffusion of ideas from West Asia
b. E. J. H. Mackay | ii. Migration from Sumer
c. Mortimer Wheeler | iii. Indigenous growth
d. Current consensus | iv. Local evolution from the Mehrgarh Neolithic
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
d. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv

Answer: (a)
Marshall – indigenous growth; Mackay – migration from Sumer; Wheeler – diffusion of ideas from West Asia; current consensus – local evolution from the Mehrgarh Neolithic.

21. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the origin of Harappan urbanisation:
1. Kalibangan and Kot Diji anticipate Mature Harappan buildings and pottery.
2. This suggests urbanisation was gradual and local, not imported from Mesopotamia.
3. The gap between Neolithic Mehrgarh and the urban phase has been fully bridged.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the gap between Neolithic Mehrgarh and the urban phase remains an unsolved problem.

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about 2026 developments:
1. Rakhigarhi (about 550 ha) shows unbroken occupation from the Early to the Mature Harappan phase.
2. Tighrana and Mitathal, declared protected by Haryana, are in Hisar district.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. Both 1 and 2
b. 2 only
c. 1 only
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
1 is correct. 2 is wrong: Tighrana and Mitathal are in Bhiwani district.

23. [Kept own]

What does the current consensus on the origin of the Harappan Civilisation emphasise?

a. Regional growth from the Mehrgarh tradition
b. A sudden origin through Greek colonisation
c. Exclusive development in the Ghaggar-Hakra valley without earlier roots
d. A complete replacement of local communities by Sumerian migrants

Answer: (a)
The current consensus emphasises indigenous regional development from the Mehrgarh tradition, rather than complete external replacement.

Row 5: Indus Valley Civilization – Discovery, Chronology, Geographical Extent, Boundary Sites

1. Site → State, River and Country (PYQs 20 · MCQs 29)

Sites by present state / country

Country / state	Sites
Pakistan – Sindh	Mohenjodaro (Larkana, right bank of the Indus), Chanhudaro (Indus, ~130 km south of Mohenjodaro), Kot Diji, Amri
Pakistan – Punjab	Harappa (Sahiwal/Montgomery, left bank of the Ravi)
Pakistan – Baluchistan	Sutkagendor (Makran coast), Balakot (Kot Bala), Dabarkot; Mehrgarh (Neolithic)
Gujarat	Lothal (Saragwala, Dholka, Ahmedabad), Dholavira and Surkotada (both Kutch), Desalpur, Rangpur (Saurashtra), Rojdi, Kuntasi, Padri
Rajasthan	Kalibangan (Hanumangarh, Ghaggar)
Haryana	Rakhigarhi (Hisar), Banawali (Fatehabad), Mitathal, Balu, Bhagwanpura (Kurukshetra)
Punjab (India)	Ropar (Sutlej)
Uttar Pradesh	Alamgirpur (Meerut), Mandi (Muzaffarnagar), Hulas (Saharanpur), Sinauli (Baghpat)
Maharashtra	Daimabad (Ahmednagar, Pravara)
J&K	Manda (Chenab)

- **Indian site** among Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Kot Bala, Mehrgarh = **Lothal**; Pakistani site among Kalibangan, Lothal, Alamgirpur = **Harappa**.
- **Wrong pair to spot:** Rakhigarhi – **Rajasthan** (it is Haryana).
- **Sindh:** Mohenjodaro and Chanhudaro (Harappa = Punjab, Surkotada = Gujarat).

Site → river

Site	River
Harappa	Ravi
Mohenjodaro, Chanhudaro	Indus
Lothal	Bhogava (near the Sabarmati confluence) – not the Narmada
Kalibangan	Ghaggar
Banawali	Rangoi (Ghaggar valley)
Ropar	Sutlej
Rangpur	Bhadar
Alamgirpur	Hindon
Daimabad	Pravara
Manda	Chenab

- **Ghaggar valley** site among Alamgirpur, Lothal, Mohenjodaro, Banawali = **Banawali**.
- **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar): Late Harappan **jewellery hoard**, June 2000. **Hulas** (Saharanpur): Late Harappan; chert blades, bone points. **Sinauli** (Baghpat): **125 graves**, north–south.
- Dholavira lies on **Khadir** island (Kutch).

~~ Sources: NextGen Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.19-26; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.79-83; app notes 1:5 (sub 5)

1. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010 +1 more

Harappan civilization, Lothal, is located in–

a. Gujarat
b. Punjab
c. Rajasthan
d. Sindh

Answer: (a)
Lothal is in Gujarat (Saragwala, Dholka, Ahmedabad district, at the head of the Gulf of Khambhat).

2. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which one of the following Harappan sites is in Gujarat?

a. Lothal
b. Dabarkot
c. Kalibangan
d. Rakhigarhi

Answer: (a)
Lothal is in Gujarat; Dabarkot is in Baluchistan, Kalibangan in Rajasthan and Rakhigarhi in Haryana.

3. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Rangpur, where the contemporary of Harappan civilization was found, is in –

a. Punjab
b. Eastern Uttar Pradesh
c. Saurashtra
d. Rajasthan

Answer: (c)
Rangpur (on the Bhadar) is in Saurashtra, Gujarat; it gave rice, bajra and sorghum.

4. [PYQ] · U.P. P.C.S (Pre) 2025

Which of the following archaeological sites related to Indus Valley civilization are situated in present day Uttar Pradesh ?
1. Mandi
2. Rakhigarhi
3. Hulas
Select the correct answer from the code given below :

a. 1 and 2
b. Only 3
c. 1 and 3
d. Only 1

Answer: (c)
Mandi (Muzaffarnagar) and Hulas (Saharanpur) are in Uttar Pradesh; Rakhigarhi is in Hisar, Haryana.

5. [PYQ] · State PSC

In which State of India is the Harappan Civilization site Mandi situated?

a. Gujarat
b. Haryana
c. Rajasthan
d. Uttar Pradesh

Answer: (d)
Mandi (Muzaffarnagar, UP) yielded a Late Harappan jewellery hoard in June 2000.

6. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010

Which one among the following sites is located in the valley of Ghaggar and its associated rivers?

a. Alamgirpur
b. Lothal
c. Mohenjodaro
d. Banawali

Answer: (d)
Banawali (Fatehabad, Haryana) lies in the Ghaggar (Sarasvati) valley; Alamgirpur is on the Hindon, Lothal on the Bhogava, Mohenjodaro on the Indus.

7. [PYQ] · UPPSC 1995

Which site of Indus Valley Civilisation is located in India?

a. Harappa
b. Mohenjodaro
c. Lothal
d. None of these

Answer: (c)
Lothal is in Gujarat, India; Harappa and Mohenjodaro went to Pakistan at Partition.

8. [PYQ] · WBCS 2020

Which of the following is a correct statement about Indus Valley Civilisation?

a. Both Harappa and Mohenjodaro are located on the banks of river Ravi (Irabati).
b. Both Chanhudaro and Kalibangan were located within the boundaries of present day Rajasthan.
c. Both Surkotada and Dholavira are located in the Kutch region of Gujarat.
d. Lothal site was located on the bank of Narmada river.

Answer: (c)

Surkotada and Dholavira both lie in Kutch, Gujarat. Mohenjodaro is on the Indus (not Ravi), Chanhudaro is in Sindh and Lothal is on the Bhogava, not the Narmada.

9. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Mains) 2012

The Harappan city represented by the archaeological site of Lothal was situated on the river

a. Narmada
b. Mahi
c. Bhogava
d. Bhima

Answer: (c)

Lothal stood on the Bhogava (near its meeting with the Sabarmati).

10. [PYQ] · UPUDA/LDA (Pre) 2006

For the Harappan Cultural sites and its position, which one of the following is not correctly matched?

a. Alamgirpur – Uttar Pradesh
b. Banawali – Haryana
c. Daimabad – Maharashtra
d. Rakhigarhi – Rajasthan

Answer: (d)

Rakhigarhi is in Hisar district, Haryana, not Rajasthan; the other pairs are right.

11. [PYQ] · WBCS 2017

Which of the following is a Harappan site located in Rajasthan?

a. Mohenjo-Daro
b. Suktagen Dor
c. Kalibangan
d. Lothal

Answer: (c)

Kalibangan (Hanumangarh) is the Harappan site in Rajasthan; Mohenjodaro and Sutkagendor are in Pakistan, Lothal in Gujarat.

12. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2010

Which place of Harappan civilisation is located in Maharashtra?

I. Harappa

II. Mohenjodaro

III. Daimabad

IV. Surkotda
Select the correct answer using codes given below.

a. I and II
b. Only III
c. II, III and IV
d. All of these

Answer: (b)

Daimabad (Ahmednagar, on the Pravara) is the Harappan site in Maharashtra; Harappa, Mohenjodaro are in Pakistan, Surkotada in Gujarat.

13. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2010

Which of the following sites of Harappan culture are located in Sindh?

I. Harappa
II. Mohenjodaro

III. Chanhudaro
IV. Surkotada Indicate the correct answer from the codes given below.

a. I and II
b. II and III
c. II, III and IV
d. I, II, III and IV

Answer: (b)

Mohenjodaro and Chanhudaro are in Sindh; Harappa is in Pakistani Punjab and Surkotada in Kutch, Gujarat.

14. [PYQ] · MPPSC (Pre) 2012
Mohenjodaro is situated in which of the following?

a. Gujarat state of India
b. Punjab state of India
c. Sindh Province in Pakistan
d. Afghanistan

Answer: (c)
Mohenjodaro lies on the right bank of the Indus in Larkana district, Sindh, Pakistan.

15. [PYQ] · UP UDA/LDA 2006
Which among the following pairs is not correctly matched?

a. Alamgirpur – Uttar Pradesh
b. Banawali – Haryana
c. Daimabad – Maharashtra
d. Rakhigarhi – Rajasthan

Answer: (d)
Rakhigarhi is in Hisar, Haryana, not Rajasthan; Alamgirpur–UP, Banawali–Haryana and Daimabad–Maharashtra are correct.

16. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995
Which site of Indus Valley Civilization is located in India?

a. Harappa
b. Mohenjodaro
c. Lothal
d. None of the above

Answer: (c)
Lothal (Saragwala, Dholka, Ahmedabad, Gujarat; found by S. R. Rao, 1954) is in India; Harappa and Mohenjodaro are in Pakistan.

17. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Pre) 1994
Which site of Indus Valley is now in Pakistan?

a. Kalibangan
b. Harappa
c. Lothal
d. Alamgirpur

Answer: (b)
Harappa (Sahiwal/Montgomery district, Pakistani Punjab, on the Ravi) is now in Pakistan; Kalibangan, Lothal and Alamgirpur are in India.

18. [PYQ] · APPSC 2018 Special Qualifying Test for Appointment by Promot
Which of the following Indus Valley sites is in India?

a. Harappa
b. KotBala
c. Lothal
d. Mehrgarh

Answer: (c)
Lothal (Gujarat) is the Indian site; Harappa and Kot Bala (Balakot) are in Pakistan and Mehrgarh is a Neolithic site in Baluchistan.

19. [PYQ] · APPSC
Kalibanga is located in which city?

a. Hanumangarh
b. Fatehabad
c. Kutch
d. Ahmedabad

Answer: (a)
Kalibangan lies on the Ghaggar in Hanumangarh district, Rajasthan; Fatehabad is Banawali, Kutch is Dholavira, Ahmedabad is Lothal.

20. [PYQ] · State PSC
Which of the following sites of Harappan culture are located in Sindh?
1. Harappa
2. Mohenjodaro
3. Chanhudaro
4. Surkotada Indicate the correct answer from the code given below:

a. 1 and 2
b. 2 and 3
c. 2, 3, and 4
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)
Mohenjodaro and Chanhudaro are in Sindh; Harappa is in Pakistani Punjab, Surkotada in Gujarat.

21. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan sites in Uttar Pradesh:
1. Hulas is in Meerut district.
2. Sinauli in Baghpat district has yielded 125 graves.
3. Mandi in Muzaffarnagar district yielded a Late Harappan jewellery hoard.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 and 3 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 1 is wrong: Hulas is in Saharanpur district (Alamgirpur is the Meerut site). Mandi (Muzaffarnagar) gave the Late Harappan jewellery hoard and Sinauli (Baghpat) the 125 graves.

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan sites in Haryana:
1. Rakhigarhi is in Hisar district.
2. Bhagwanpura is in Hisar district.
3. Banawali is in Fatehabad district, on the Rangoi in the Ghaggar valley.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
Statement 2 is wrong: Bhagwanpura is in Kurukshetra district. Rakhigarhi is in Hisar and Banawali in Fatehabad on the Rangoi (Ghaggar valley).

23. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Site) with List-II (River):
List-I
A. Kalibangan
B. Rangpur
C. Daimabad
D. Harappa
List-II
i. Bhadar
ii. Pravara
iii. Ravi
iv. Ghaggar
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
b. A-iii, B-i, C-ii, D-iv
c. A-iv, B-i, C-ii, D-iii
d. A-i, B-iv, C-iii, D-ii

Answer: (c)
Kalibangan – Ghaggar, Rangpur – Bhadar, Daimabad – Pravara, Harappa – Ravi: A-iv, B-i, C-ii, D-iii.

24. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan sites in Pakistan:
1. Harappa lies in Sahiwal (Montgomery) district of Punjab, on the right bank of the Ravi.
2. Mohenjodaro lies in Larkana district of Sindh, on the right bank of the Indus.
3. Chanhudaro lies on the Indus about 130 km south of Mohenjodaro.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 1 is wrong: Harappa is on the LEFT bank of the Ravi. Mohenjodaro (Larkana, right bank of the Indus) and Chanhudaro (~130 km south of it) are correctly placed.

25. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Dholavira lies on Khadir island in Kutch.
2. Daimabad lies in Ahmednagar district of Maharashtra, on the Pravara.
3. Lothal lies on the Narmada near the Gulf of Khambhat.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 3 is wrong: Lothal is on the Bhogava, near its Sabarmati confluence – not the Narmada. Daimabad (Ahmednagar, Pravara) and Dholavira (Khadir island, Kutch) are correct.

26. [Kept own]

Which is the westernmost Harappan boundary site?

a. Manda
b. Alamgirpur
c. Daimabad
d. Sutkagendor

Answer: (d)
Sutkagendor is the western boundary site; Manda is northern, Alamgirpur eastern and Daimabad southern.

27. [Kept own]

On which coast is Sutkagendor, the western boundary site of the Harappan Civilisation, situated?

a. Kathiawar coast of Gujarat
b. Malabar coast of Kerala
c. Makran coast of Balochistan
d. Konkan coast of Maharashtra

Answer: (c)
Sutkagendor is located on the Makran coast in Balochistan, in present-day Pakistan.

28. [Kept own]

For what kind of Harappan find is Mandi in Muzaffarnagar known?

a. Dockyard
b. Bronze buffalo
c. Jewellery hoard
d. Fire altar

Answer: (c)
Mandi is known for a Harappan jewellery hoard found in 2000.

29. [Kept own]

On which island of Kutch is Dholavira situated?

a. Bet Dwarka
b. Khadir
c. Pirotan
d. Shiyal Bet

Answer: (b)
Dholavira is on Khadir island in Kutch, fed by two seasonal streams.

2. Basic Facts – Bronze Age, Area, Rivers, Non-Aryan Character (PYQs 9 · MCQs 15)

- **Proto-historic** (script undeciphered), **Bronze Age**; India's **first urbanisation**.
- Area about **1.3 million sq km** – larger than Egypt and Mesopotamia; population ~5 million; matured in **Sindh and Punjab** and spread **south and east**.
- Highest concentration of sites on the **Ghaggar–Hakra** system (about 250 sites, 6 cities).
- **Rivers:** Sindhu, **Chenab, Jhelum**, Ravi, Sutlej, Ghaggar – up to the **Hindon** (Alamgirpur); **not the Ganga**.
- **Main sites:** Mohenjodaro, Harappa, Ropar, Kalibangan; roads, houses and drains were planned.
- **Metals:** copper, bronze, gold, **silver** (first use of silver in India), lead, tin – but **no iron**.
- **Non-Aryan:** Harappan culture was **urban**; the Rigvedic Aryans were **pastoral/rural**.

Period	Economy
Indus Valley	Urban
Rigvedic	Pastoral
Later Vedic	Agrarian

- **Not Harappan: Sohgaura** (Gorakhpur – Mauryan copper plate), **Pataliputra** (Magadha capital), Mehrgarh (Neolithic), Burzahom (Neolithic pit dwellings).

- Assertion–reason: Mohenjodaro and Harappa are "dead" cities **and** were found by excavation – both true, but R does not explain A.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History Part 1 p.4-5, p.7; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.26-27, p.79; app notes 1:5 (sub 0, 3, 6)

30. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

The earliest evidence of silver in India is found in the-

a. Harappan culture
b. Chalcolithic cultures of western India
c. Vedic texts
d. Silver Punchmarked coins

Answer: (a)

The Harappans were the first in India to use silver (Mohenjodaro, Harappa) – long before Vedic texts and silver punch-marked coins.

31. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Indus Valley Civilization, which was placed on the banks of the river, they were?
1. Sindhu
2. Chenab
3. Jhelum
4. Ganga
Choose the correct answer from the code given below-

a. 1 and 2
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 2, 3 and 4
d. All four

Answer: (b)

Harappan sites lay on the Sindhu, Chenab and Jhelum (also Ravi, Sutlej, Ghaggar), and reached the Hindon at Alamgirpur, but not the Ganga.

32. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2009

Many sites of Indus Valley Civilisation was placed on the bank of rivers. Identify the rivers associated with this civilisation.

I. Sindhu
II. Chenab

III. Jhelum
IV. Ganga
Choose the correct answer from the codes given below.

a. I and II
b. I, II and III
c. II, III and IV
d. All of these

Answer: (b)

The civilisation's rivers were the Sindhu, Chenab, Jhelum, Ravi and Sutlej; it reached only the Hindon (Alamgirpur), not the Ganga, so I, II and III.

33. [PYQ] · NDA 2014

Consider the following statements about Harappan Culture:

I. The Harappan Culture matured in Sind and Punjab.

II. It spread from there to Southwards and eastwards.

III. The area, where it spread, was bigger than Egypt and Mesopotamia
Which of the statement given above is/ are correct?

a. I and II
b. II and III
c. Only III
d. I, II and III

Answer: (d)

The Harappan culture matured in Sindh and Punjab and spread south (Gujarat, Daimabad) and east (Alamgirpur); its 1.3 million sq km was larger than Egypt and Mesopotamia – all three are correct.

34. [PYQ] · MPPSC (Pre) 2008

Consider the following statements and select the correct answer from the given codes.

I. Mohenjodaro, Harappa, Ropar and Kalibangan are the main sites of Indus Valley Civilisation.

II. People of Harappa developed the road, proper housing and drainage system.

III. People of Harappa were unknown about the use of metals.

a. I and II are correct
b. I and III are correct
c. II and III are correct
d. I, II and III are correct

Answer: (a)

Mohenjodaro, Harappa, Ropar and Kalibangan are major Harappan sites (I) and the Harappans built roads, houses and drains (II); III is false – they used copper, bronze, gold and silver, though not iron.

35. [PYQ] · State PSC

Indus Valley civilization was Non-Aryan because -

a. It was an Urban Civilization
b. It has its own script
c. It has an agricultural economy
d. It extended up to the Narmada valley

Answer: (a)

The Indus civilisation was urban, whereas the Rigvedic Aryans were pastoral and rural – the main reason it is held non-Aryan.

36. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Assertion (A) : Mohenjodaro and Harappa cities are dead now.
Reason (R) : They were discovered during excavations. In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (b)

Both are true – Harappa and Mohenjodaro are dead (deserted) cities and both were found by excavation – but being excavated does not explain why they are dead.

37. [PYQ] · MPPSC 2014

Which among the following place is not related to Indus Valley Civilisation?

a. Kalibangan
b. Ropad
c. Patliputra
d. Lothal

Answer: (c)

Pataliputra was the Magadha/Mauryan capital, not a Harappan site; Kalibangan, Ropar and Lothal are Harappan.

38. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2019

Which one of the following is not a Harappan site?

a. Chanhudaro
b. Kot Diji
c. Sohgaura
d. Desalpur

Answer: (c)

Sohgaura (Gorakhpur, UP) is known for a Mauryan copper-plate inscription, not Harappan remains; Chanhudaro, Kot Diji and Desalpur are Harappan.

39. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Harappan Civilisation:
1. It has given the earliest evidence of iron in India.
2. The highest concentration of its sites is on the Ghaggar–Hakra system.
3. It covered about 1.3 million sq km, more than Egypt and Mesopotamia.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Statement 1 is wrong: the Harappans used copper, bronze, gold, silver, lead and tin but no iron (they gave India's first use of silver). The 1.3 million sq km area and the Ghaggar–Hakra concentration (about 250 sites) are correct.

40. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The Harappan culture is classed as proto-historic.
Reason (R): Its script has not been deciphered.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the Harappans could write, but because the script is still unread the culture is called proto-historic rather than historic.

41. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The Harappan Civilisation is placed in the Bronze Age.
Reason (R): The Harappans were the first people in India to use iron.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (c)
A is true but R is false: the Harappans used copper, bronze, gold, silver (India's first silver), lead and tin but no iron – which is exactly why they are a Bronze Age culture.

42. [Kept own]

What does the Harappan Civilization mainly represent in Indian history?

a. The earliest spread of Buddhism across the subcontinent
b. The first use of iron and iron ploughs in India
c. The beginning of the Gupta imperial system
d. The first urbanisation in India and the largest Bronze Age civilization by area

Answer: (d)
The civilization is significant for representing the first urbanisation in India and for being the largest Bronze Age civilization by area.

43. [Kept own]

Assertion (A): Dholavira was the first Indus Valley Civilisation site in India to be listed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
Reason (R): Dholavira became Gujarat's fourth UNESCO World Heritage Site.

a. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true but R is false
d. A is false but R is true

Answer: (b)
Both are true: Dholavira was the first IVC site in India to be listed and became Gujarat's fourth World Heritage Site, but being Gujarat's fourth does not explain being the first IVC site.

44. [Kept own]

What was the broad socio-economic character of the Rigvedic period?

a. Urban
b. Agrarian
c. Pastoral
d. Landlordism

Answer: (c)
The comparison is Indus Valley - urban, Rigvedic - pastoral, Later Vedic - agrarian and Medieval - landlordism.

3. Names, Meluhha and Contemporary Civilisations (PYQs 7 · MCQs 12)

Name	Meaning
Meluhha	Mesopotamian name for the Indus region
Dilmun	Bahrain (intermediate station)
Magan (Makan)	Makran coast / Oman
Mohenjodaro	"Mound of the Dead" (Sindhi)
Lothal	"Mini Harappa" (not City of the Dead)
Chanhudaro	"Lancashire of India"
Kalibangan	"Black bangles"

Dholavira	Local name Kotada

- **Harappan Civilisation** is preferred: named by Marshall after **Harappa**, the first site found; the culture went beyond the Indus valley. "Sindhu-Sarasvati" stresses the Ghaggar-Hakra sites.
- **Bronze Age river civilisations:** Mesopotamia – Tigris and Euphrates; **Egypt – Nile**; China – Hwang Ho; Harappa – Indus.
- **First proper writing: Sumerian cuneiform** (Mesopotamia); Egypt – hieroglyphics; the Indus script is undeciphered.
- **Makli Necropolis** (Thatta, Sindh) – one of the world's largest necropolises (UNESCO) – is not Mohenjodaro.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History Part 1 p.2-4; UNESCO WHC (Makli); app notes 1:5 (sub 1)

45. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I Prelims 2004 (10-10-2004)

Where is the world's largest necropolis, with over a million graves spread over 15 sq.km, located?

a. Kandahar in Afghanistan
b. Makli in Pakistan
c. Bangkok in Indonesia
d. Mohenjodaro in Pakistan

Answer: (b)
Makli Necropolis near Thatta (Sindh, Pakistan), a UNESCO site, is one of the world's largest necropolises (about a million graves over ~10–15 sq km); Mohenjodaro is a Harappan city, not a necropolis.

46. [PYQ] · RAS/RTS (Pre) 1992

The first ancient civilisation to develop the art of writing in a proper system was

a. Indus
b. Egypt
c. Sumerian
d. China

Answer: (c)
The Sumerians of Mesopotamia developed the first proper writing system (cuneiform, c. 3200 BCE); the Indus script is later and still undeciphered.

47. [PYQ] · APPSC Draughtsman (Technical Assistant) Paper-I General Stud

In ancient times, the Indus region was known as

a. Dilmun
b. Meluha
c. Makan
d. Surkotada

Answer: (b)
Mesopotamian texts call the Indus region Meluhha; Dilmun (Bahrain) and Makan (Makran/Oman) were intermediate trading stations, and Surkotada is a Harappan site.

48. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2008

The local name of Mohenjodaro is

a. Mound of the Great
b. Mound of the Living
c. Mound of the Survivor
d. Mound of the Dead

Answer: (d)
Mohenjodaro means 'Mound of the Dead' in Sindhi.

49. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II (old paper)

The local name of Mohenjodaro is

a. Mound of the Great
b. Mound of the Living
c. Mound of the Survivor
d. Mound of the Dead

Answer: (d)
Mohenjodaro means 'Mound of the Dead' in Sindhi; Lothal is the 'Mini Harappa'.

50. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Which of the following is related to Harappa civilization?

a. Sumerian civilization
b. Indus Valley Civilization
c. Vedic civilization
d. Mesopotamian civilization

Answer: (b)
Harappa, the first site discovered (1921), gives its name to the Indus Valley (Harappan) Civilisation.

51. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2004

Which of the following Civilisations flourished on the bank of River Nile?

a. Roman Civilisation
b. Indus Valley Civilisation
c. Greak Civilisation
d. Egyptian Civilisation

Answer: (d)
The Egyptian civilisation flourished on the Nile; the Indus civilisation on the Indus, Mesopotamia on the Tigris–Euphrates.

52. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Site) with List-II (Name / meaning):
List-I
A. Chanhudaro
B. Kalibangan
C. Dholavira
D. Lothal
List-II
i. Kotada
ii. Mini Harappa
iii. Black bangles
iv. Lancashire of India
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-ii, B-iii, C-i, D-iv
b. A-iv, B-i, C-iii, D-ii
c. A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii
d. A-iii, B-iv, C-ii, D-i

Answer: (c)
Chanhudaro – Lancashire of India, Kalibangan – black bangles, Dholavira – local name Kotada, Lothal – Mini Harappa: A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii.

53. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following names used in Mesopotamian records:
1. Magan – the Ganga valley
2. Meluhha – the Indus region
3. Dilmun – Bahrain
Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Pair 1 is wrong: Magan (Makan) is the Makran coast / Oman, not the Ganga valley. Meluhha = Indus region and Dilmun = Bahrain (an intermediate station) are correct.

54. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the names of the civilisation:
1. The name "Sindhu-Sarasvati Civilisation" stresses the sites on the Ghaggar–Hakra system.
2. "Harappan Civilisation" is preferred because Harappa was the first site found and the culture went beyond the Indus valley.
3. The term "Indus Valley Civilisation" was coined by Mortimer Wheeler.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 3 is wrong: Sir John Marshall coined "Indus Valley Civilisation" and named the culture after Harappa, the first site found. "Sindhu-Sarasvati" stresses the Ghaggar–Hakra sites.

55. [Kept own]

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

a. Chanhudaro — Lancashire of India
b. Mohenjodaro — Mound of the Dead
c. Kalibangan — Black bangles
d. Lothal — City of the Dead

Answer: (d)
Lothal is known as Mini Harappa, not the City of the Dead. Mohenjodaro means Mound of the Dead, Kalibangan means Black bangles and Chanhudaro was associated with cotton production.

56. [Kept own]
The name 'Sindhu-Sarasvati Civilisation' is used by scholars who stress sites along which river system?

a. Ganga-Yamuna
b. Ghaggar-Hakra
c. Narmada-Tapi
d. Ravi-Beas

Answer: (b)
Scholars who stress the many Ghaggar-Hakra sites use the name Sindhu-Sarasvati.

4. Discovery and Excavators (PYQs 6 · MCQs 17)

- **1826**: **Charles Masson** described the Harappa ruins (1826-38). **1853, 1856**: **Alexander Cunningham** saw pottery, tools and a seal but missed their value.
- **1857**: Harappan bricks used as ballast for the **Karachi–Lahore** railway. **1912**: **J. Fleet** published Harappan seals.
- **Sir John Marshall** (DG, ASI 1902–28) directed the 1921-22 campaign; announced the civilisation in 1924; coined "Indus Valley Civilisation".
- The two Indian discoverers: **Daya Ram Sahni** and **Rakhaldas Banerji**.

Site	Discoverer / excavator	Year
Harappa (first site)	Daya Ram Sahni; later M. S. Vats (1926-34), Wheeler	1921
Mohenjodaro	R. D. Banerji; later Marshall, K. N. Dikshit, Mackay	1922
Chanhudaro	Found by N. G. Majumdar (1931); excavated by E. J. H. Mackay (1935-36)	1931
Lothal	S. R. Rao	1954
Rangpur	M. S. Vats (1931); S. R. Rao	–
Ropar	Found by B. B. Lal (1950); dug by Y. D. Sharma (1953-55); first site dug in independent India	1950
Daimabad	B. P. Bopardikar	1958
Kalibangan	A. Ghosh (1953); B. B. Lal and B. K. Thapar (1961-69)	–
Surkotada	Jagatpati (J. P.) Joshi	1964
Dholavira	Found by J. P. Joshi (1967-68); excavated by R. S. Bisht from 1990	–
Banawali	R. S. Bisht	1974
Manda	J. P. Joshi and Madhubala	1982
Rakhigarhi	Amarendra Nath	1997

- Order of discovery: **Harappa (1921) → Mohenjodaro (1922) → Chanhudaro (1931) → Lothal (1954)**.
- **V. A. Smith** (historian) was **not** linked with the Harappa–Mohenjodaro digs. Macaulay, Clive and Col. Tod are distractors for Marshall.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History Part 1 p.1, p.4; NextGen Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.17; app notes 1:5 (sub 2)

57. [PYQ] · SI Paper-II Preliminary Exam 2016
Match the following
(Harappan site):
(A) Harappa
(B) Mohenjodaro
(C) Chanhudaro
(D) Lothal
(Discovered by):
(I) R.D. Benerjee
(II) M.G. Majumdar
(III) S.R. Rao
(IV) Dayaram Sahani
The Correct answer is

a. A-I, B-III, C-II, D-IV
b. A-I, B-II, C-III, D-IV
c. A-IV, B-I, C-II, D-III
d. A-IV, B-II, C-III, D-I

Answer: (c)
Harappa – Daya Ram Sahni (1921), Mohenjodaro – R. D. Banerji (1922), Chanhudaro – N. G. Majumdar (1931), Lothal – S. R. Rao (1954): A-IV, B-I, C-II, D-III.

58. [PYQ] · Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Who among the following discovered 'Surkotada', a site of Harappan culture?

a. B.B. Lal
b. S.R. Rao
c. Y.D. Sharma
d. Jagatpati Joshi

Answer: (d)
Surkotada (Kutch, Gujarat) was discovered and excavated (1964) by Jagatpati Joshi; S. R. Rao is linked with Lothal, Y. D. Sharma with Ropar.

59. [PYQ] · State PSC

Who among the following was not associated with the excavation of Harappa and Mohenjodaro?

a. R. D. Banerjee
b. K.N. Dikshit
c. M.S. Vats
d. V.A. Smith

Answer: (d)
V. A. Smith, a historian, had no role in the Harappa–Mohenjodaro excavations; R. D. Banerji, K. N. Dikshit and M. S. Vats did dig there.

60. [PYQ] · U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

The excavation at Chanhudaro was directed by –

a. J. H. Mackay
b. Sir John Marshall
c. R. E. M. Wheeler
d. Sir Aurel Stein

Answer: (a)
Chanhudaro was found by N. G. Majumdar (1931) and excavated on a large scale by E. J. H. Mackay (1935–36), who found its bead-making factory.

61. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Two Indians who were associated with discovery of Indus Valley Civilization, are :

a. Rakhal Das Banerjee and Dayaram Sahni
b. John Marshall and Ishwari Prasad
c. Ashirwadi Lal Srivastava and Rangnath Rao
d. Madhosarup Vats and V.B. Rao

Answer: (a)
The two Indians were Daya Ram Sahni (Harappa, 1921) and Rakhaldas Banerji (Mohenjodaro, 1922); John Marshall, the ASI chief, was British.

62. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1997

Who was the director of the archaeological excavation that led to the discovery of Harappa and Mohenjodaro?

a. Lord Macaulay
b. Sir John Marshall
c. Clive
d. Colonel Tad

Answer: (b)
Sir John Marshall, Director-General of the ASI (1902–28), directed the excavation campaign of 1921-22 that revealed Harappa and Mohenjodaro.

63. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the early history of Harappa's discovery:
1. In 1857 Harappan bricks were used as ballast for the Karachi–Lahore railway.
2. J. Fleet published Harappan seals in 1921.
3. Alexander Cunningham visited Harappa in 1853 and 1856 and saw a seal.
4. Charles Masson described the ruins of Harappa in 1826.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)
Statement 2 is wrong: J. Fleet published Harappan seals in 1912 (1921 is the year Harappa was excavated). Masson (1826), Cunningham (1853, 1856) and the Karachi–Lahore railway ballast (1857) are correct.

64. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Sir John Marshall:
1. He announced the discovery of the civilisation to the world in 1934.
2. As Director-General of the ASI he directed the 1921-22 excavation campaign.
3. He coined the term "Indus Valley Civilisation".
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Statement 1 is wrong: Marshall announced the civilisation in 1924. He was DG of the ASI (1902–28), directed the 1921-22 campaign and coined "Indus Valley Civilisation".

65. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Site) with List-II (Excavator):
List-I
A. Ropar
B. Daimabad
C. Kalibangan
D. Surkotada
List-II
i. J. P. Joshi
ii. A. Ghosh
iii. Y. D. Sharma
iv. B. P. Bopardikar
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iv, B-iii, C-ii, D-i
b. A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii
c. A-ii, B-i, C-iii, D-iv
d. A-iii, B-iv, C-ii, D-i

Answer: (d)

Ropar – Y. D. Sharma (1953-55), Daimabad – B. P. Bopardikar (1958), Kalibangan – A. Ghosh (1953, then B. B. Lal and B. K. Thapar), Surkotada – J. P. Joshi (1964): A-iii, B-iv, C-ii, D-i.

66. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Chanhudaro was found by N. G. Majumdar in 1931.
2. Dholavira was found by R. S. Bisht and excavated by J. P. Joshi from 1990.
3. Ropar, found by B. B. Lal in 1950, was the first Harappan site dug in independent India.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1 only

Answer: (a)

Statement 2 swaps the names: J. P. Joshi found Dholavira (1967-68) and R. S. Bisht excavated it from 1990. Ropar (B. B. Lal, 1950; first dig after Independence) and Chanhudaro (N. G. Majumdar, 1931) are correct.

67. [Kept own]

Which was the first Harappan site to be discovered, and in which year?

a. Harappa – 1921
b. Mohenjo-daro – 1922
c. Harappa – 1922
d. Mohenjo-daro – 1921

Answer: (a)

Harappa was the first Indus Valley Civilization site discovered, in 1921.

68. [Kept own]

Which of the following Harappan sites is NOT correctly matched with the year its excavation began?

a. Harappa – 1921
b. Mohenjodaro – 1922
c. Lothal – 1931
d. Chanhudaro – 1931

Answer: (c)

Lothal was found by S. R. Rao in 1954 (dug 1955-60), so 'Lothal - 1931' is wrong; 1931 belongs to Chanhudaro. Harappa (1921) and Mohenjodaro (1922) are correctly matched.

69. [Kept own]
In 1857, Harappan bricks were used as ballast for which railway line?

a. Karachi-Lahore
b. Bombay-Thane
c. Delhi-Calcutta
d. Madras-Arcot

Answer: (a)
In 1857 Harappan bricks were used as ballast for the Karachi-Lahore railway.

70. [Kept own]
Who first excavated Rangpur in Saurashtra in 1931?

a. Y. D. Sharma
b. M. S. Vats
c. J. P. Joshi
d. B. B. Lal

Answer: (b)
M. S. Vats dug Rangpur in 1931; S. R. Rao worked there later.

71. [Kept own]
Who discovered Chanhudaro in 1931?

a. N. G. Majumdar
b. E. J. H. Mackay
c. R. D. Banerji
d. Daya Ram Sahni

Answer: (a)
N. G. Majumdar found Chanhudaro in 1931; Mackay excavated it in 1935-36.

72. [Kept own]
Match the following:
List-I (Site) - List-II (Excavator)
A. Banawali - 1. Amarendra Nath
B. Manda - 2. B. P. Bopardikar
C. Rakhigarhi - 3. R. S. Bisht
D. Daimabad - 4. J. P. Joshi and Madhubala
Select the correct answer using the code given below.

a. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
b. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
c. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
d. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: (d)
Banawali - R. S. Bisht (1973-74); Manda - J. P. Joshi and Madhubala (1982); Rakhigarhi - Amarendra Nath (1997); Daimabad - B. P. Bopardikar (1958).

73. [Kept own]
Arrange the following Harappan sites in the order of their discovery:
1. Lothal
2. Mohenjodaro
3. Chanhudaro
4. Harappa
Select the correct answer using the code given below.

a. 4, 2, 3, 1
b. 2, 4, 3, 1
c. 4, 3, 2, 1
d. 4, 2, 1, 3

Answer: (a)
Harappa (1921), Mohenjodaro (1922), Chanhudaro (1931), Lothal (1954).

5. Largest Sites, UNESCO and Recent Developments (PYQs 3 · MCQs 7)

- **Rakhigarhi** (Hisar, Haryana; ~550 ha) = **largest Harappan site in India**; **Dholavira** second; **Mohenjodaro** largest in Pakistan. Five largest: Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Ganweriwala, Rakhigarhi, Dholavira.
- **Dholavira:** UNESCO WHS **2021** – India's **40th**, Gujarat's 4th, the **first IVC site in India**; absence of encroachment helped.
- **Mohenjodaro:** UNESCO WHS since **1980**. **Rakhigarhi:** on the UNESCO **Tentative List** (Jun 2026).
- **Union Budget 2020-21: five** iconic archaeological sites – **Rakhigarhi, Hastinapur, Shivsagar, Dholavira, Adichanallur**.
- Jun 2026: Haryana protected **Tighrana and Mitathal** (Bhiwani) under the **Haryana Ancient and Historical Monuments Act, 1964**.
- 23 Jun 2026: ASI transferred Rakhigarhi's **56 skeletons** to the **Anthropological Survey of India**; a 4,500-year-old skeleton gave the ancient DNA study.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History Part 1 p.16-17; NextGen Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.22; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.80; app notes 1:5 (sub 8)

74. [PYQ] · APPSC Degree Lecturers General Studies & Mental Ability 2020

How many archaeological sites are proposed to be developed as iconic sites in Union Budget 2020?

a. 3
b. 4
c. 5
d. 6

Answer: (c)

Union Budget 2020-21 named five iconic archaeological sites: Rakhigarhi, Hastinapur, Shivsagar, Dholavira and Adichanallur.

75. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

The biggest Harappan site in India is

a. Rakhigarhi
b. Dholavira
c. Kalibangan
d. Lothal

Answer: (a)

Rakhigarhi (Hisar, Haryana) is the largest Harappan site in India; Dholavira is second.

76. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

The largest site of Harappa in India is –

a. Alamgirpur
b. Kalibangan
c. Lothal
d. Rakhigarhi

Answer: (d)

Rakhigarhi (Hisar, Haryana) is the largest Harappan site in India.

77. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Rakhigarhi is the largest Harappan site in India and Dholavira the second largest.
2. Ganweriwala is one of the five largest Harappan sites.
3. Harappa is the largest Harappan site in Pakistan.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Statement 3 is wrong: Mohenjodaro is the largest Harappan site in Pakistan. Rakhigarhi (~550 ha) is the largest in India, Dholavira second; the five largest are Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Ganweriwala, Rakhigarhi and Dholavira.

78. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan sites and UNESCO:
1. Dholavira was inscribed in 2021 as India's 40th World Heritage Site.
2. Rakhigarhi was inscribed as a World Heritage Site in 2026.
3. Mohenjodaro has been a World Heritage Site since 1980.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Statement 2 is wrong: Rakhigarhi is only on UNESCO's Tentative List (June 2026). Dholavira (2021, India's 40th, first IVC site in India) and Mohenjodaro (1980) are correct.

79. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. In June 2026 the ASI transferred Rakhigarhi's 56 skeletons to the National Museum, New Delhi.
2. In June 2026 Haryana protected Tighrana and Mitathal under the Haryana Ancient and Historical Monuments Act, 1964.
3. The Union Budget 2020-21 named five iconic archaeological sites, including Rakhigarhi and Adichanallur.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. All three
c. None
d. Only two

Answer: (d)

Statement 1 is wrong: the 56 skeletons went to the Anthropological Survey of India. The Budget 2020-21 sites (Rakhigarhi, Hastinapur, Shivsagar, Dholavira, Adichanallur) and the protection of Tighrana and Mitathal are correct – so only two.

80. [Kept own]
A 4,500-year-old skeleton and an ancient DNA study are associated with which Harappan site?

a. Rakhigarhi
b. Mohenjodaro
c. Ropar
d. Daimabad

Answer: (a)
Rakhigarhi has yielded a 4,500-year-old skeleton and has been the subject of an ancient DNA study.

6. Boundary Sites (PYQs 2 · MCQs 6)

Direction	Site	Place / river
North	Manda	Chenab, Jammu; base for Himalayan wood
South	Daimabad	Pravara, Ahmednagar, Maharashtra
East	Alamgirpur	Hindon, Meerut, western UP
West	Sutkagendor	Makran coast, Baluchistan

- N–S–E–W = **Manda – Daimabad – Alamgirpur – Sutkagendor**; Alamgirpur finds reflect **Harappan** culture (Late Harappan, cloth impression).
- **Shortughai** (Afghanistan): trade outpost for **lapis lazuli**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History Part 1 p.15, p.17; NextGen Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.24-26

81. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2005
The archaeological finds from Alamgirpur in Meerut district reflected the

a. Harappa Culture
b. Vedic Culture
c. Mauryan Culture
d. Gupta Period Culture

Answer: (a)
Alamgirpur (Meerut, on the Hindon) is the easternmost Harappan site, so its finds reflect Harappan culture.

82. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023
Eastern boundary of the Harappa culture is indicated by which of the following?

a. Manda
b. Harappa
c. Alamgirpur
d. Rakhigarhi

Answer: (c)
Alamgirpur (Meerut, UP) marks the eastern boundary; Manda the northern, Daimabad the southern and Sutkagendor the western.

83. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements about the boundary sites of the Harappan culture:
1. Sutkagendor on the Makran coast marks the southern limit.
2. Alamgirpur on the Hindon, in Meerut district, marks the eastern limit.
3. Manda on the Chenab, the northern limit, was a base for Himalayan wood.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 and 3 only
b. 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 1 is wrong: Sutkagendor (Makran coast, Baluchistan) is the WESTERN limit; Daimabad is the southern one. Manda (Chenab, Himalayan wood) and Alamgirpur (Hindon, Meerut) are correct.

84. [Kept own]
Which Harappan site is correctly matched?

a. Balu – Salt production centre
b. Nageshwar – Lapis lazuli
c. Kerala-no-dhoro – Earliest evidence of garlic
d. Shortughai – Lapis lazuli

Answer: (d)
Shortughai was a lapis lazuli outpost. Balu gave the earliest garlic, Nageshwar was a shell centre and Kerala-no-dhoro a salt production centre.

85. [Kept own]
Match the following:
List-I (Boundary) - List-II (Harappan site)
A. Northern - 1. Alamgirpur
B. Southern - 2. Sutkagendor
C. Eastern - 3. Manda
D. Western - 4. Daimabad
Select the correct answer using the code given below.

a. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
b. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2
c. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
d. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

Answer: (c)
North-South-East-West = Manda, Daimabad, Alamgirpur, Sutkagendor.

86. [Kept own]
The Harappan site of Alamgirpur, on the Hindon, is in which district?

a. Muzaffarnagar
b. Saharanpur
c. Meerut
d. Bulandshahr

Answer: (c)
Alamgirpur lies on the Hindon in Meerut, Uttar Pradesh; Kalibangan is in Hanumangarh and Ropar on the Sutlej in Punjab.

7. Chronology and Phases (PYQs 1 · MCQs 4)

Phase	Dates	Features
Early Harappan	3300–2600 BCE	Kot Diji, Amri, Sothi; villages
Mature Harappan	2600–1900 BCE	Planned cities, 1:2:4 bricks, script
Late Harappan	1900–1300 BCE	De-urbanisation; OCP, Cemetery-H

- **John Marshall:** 3250–2750 BCE by **Mesopotamian cross-dating**; **D. P. Agrawal** (radiocarbon): **2500–1750 BCE**.
- **Dholavira:** inhabited c. **3000–1800 BCE** in **seven stages** (R. S. Bisht); UNESCO: 3rd to mid-2nd millennium BCE.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History Part 1 p.1-2, p.17; app notes 1:5 (sub 3)

87. [PYQ] · APPSC
What was the time duration when the Dholavira site was inhabited?

a. 3000 - 1700 BCE
b. 3000 - 1800 BCE
c. 3100 - 1900 BCE
d. 3150- 1700 BCE

Answer: (b)
Dholavira was occupied c. 3000–1800 BCE in seven stages (R. S. Bisht); UNESCO describes it as dating from the 3rd to the mid-2nd millennium BCE.

88. [New pattern · match]
Match List-I (Phase / dating) with List-II (Dates):
List-I
A. Early Harappan phase
B. Mature Harappan phase
C. Late Harappan phase
D. D. P. Agrawal's radiocarbon dating
List-II
i. 2600–1900 BCE
ii. 2500–1750 BCE
iii. 3300–2600 BCE
iv. 1900–1300 BCE
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-i, B-iii, C-iv, D-ii
b. A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii
c. A-iii, B-i, C-ii, D-iv
d. A-ii, B-iv, C-iii, D-i

Answer: (b)
Early Harappan 3300–2600 BCE, Mature 2600–1900 BCE, Late 1900–1300 BCE, D. P. Agrawal's radiocarbon range 2500–1750 BCE: A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii.

89. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the chronology of the Harappan Civilisation:
1. Kot Diji and Amri are typical sites of the Late Harappan phase.
2. Bricks in the ratio 1:2:4 belong to the Mature Harappan phase.
3. John Marshall dated it to 3250–2750 BCE by Mesopotamian cross-dating.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Statement 1 is wrong: Kot Diji, Amri and Sothi belong to the Early Harappan phase (3300–2600 BCE); the Late phase is marked by OCP and Cemetery-H. Marshall's cross-dating and the Mature-phase 1:2:4 bricks are correct.

90. [Kept own]

In which period did the radiocarbon dating associated with D. P. Agrawal place the civilisation?

a. 3250–2750 BCE
b. 2500–1750 BCE
c. 2600–1900 BCE
d. 1900–1300 BCE

Answer: (b)

D. P. Agrawal's radiocarbon-based dating placed the civilisation approximately in 2500–1750 BCE. The 3250–2750 BCE range was associated with John Marshall's older dating.

Row 6: Ivc Town Planning – Grid Layout, Citadel and Lower Town, Drainage, Great Bath, Granaries

1. Hallmarks of the IVC – Town Planning, Burnt Bricks, Bronze Age (PYQs 8 · MCQs 12)

What the exams ask

- **Hallmark / specialisation: town planning** (urban centres, grid, drains) is the single most distinctive feature of the IVC (APPSC G2 2011) – not "all of these".
- **Most significant feature: burnt-brick buildings** – large-scale use of burnt bricks in almost all constructions (BPSC 2018, JPSC 2023). Egypt used mainly dried bricks; no "first true arches", no buildings of worship.
- **Known for (UK UDA 2003):** town planning, Mohenjodaro and Harappa, agriculture and craft industry (bead, shell, metal factories) → "all of these".
- **No temples or palaces** clearly found, unlike Mesopotamia and Egypt.
- Standard bricks, grid, streets and drains point to a **civic authority**; the absence of palaces or temples does **not** disprove it.
- **Not known:** the **true arch** (only corbelled), and **iron** – IVC is a **Bronze Age** culture; iron came c. 1000 BC (Later Vedic). Pillars (Mohenjodaro assembly hall, 20 pillars), wells, drains and bows-and-arrows were all known.

IVC vs Vedic / Aryan

Point	IVC (Harappan)	Vedic
Life	Urban, planned cities	Rural, pastoral
Script	Pictographic (undeciphered)	No script
Metal	Copper, bronze; no iron	Iron in Later Vedic age
Pottery	Red ware painted in black	Painted Grey Ware

- **Why IVC is placed before the Aryans (UPPCS 1990): pottery** – the stratified pottery sequence (from Mehrgarh to the black-on-red Harappan ware) lies below the Painted Grey Ware of the Vedic people.
- **IVC different from Vedic (UPPCS 2004):** city amenities + pictographic script + no iron → "all of the above".

> Trap: "the IVC knew iron" is always the false statement.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.83-86, p.101, p.107; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.5, p.7; old app notes row 6

1. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

The Indus Valley Civilisation specialised in

a. Architecture
b. Town planning
c. Craftsmanship
d. All of these

Answer: (b)

Town planning (grid streets, citadel and lower town, drains) is the hallmark of the IVC, so it is the specialisation singled out; "all of these" is not the intended answer.

2. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

The important reason to keep Indus-Valley civilization before Aryan civilization is –

a. Script
b. Town Planning
c. Copper
d. Potteries

Answer: (d)

Pottery fixes the sequence: the Harappan black-on-red ware (rooted in early Mehrgarh pottery) lies below the Painted Grey Ware of the Vedic people, so pottery places the IVC before the Aryans. Script and town planning show advancement, not date.

3. [PYQ] · MPPSC 2019

Which among the following is not related to Indus Valley Civilisation?

a. Constructions of streets
b. Constructions of pillars
c. Constructions of wells
d. Constructions of bows

Answer: (–)

Defective as printed: the Harappans built streets, wells and pillars (20-pillar assembly hall at Mohenjodaro, polished pillar bases at Dholavira) and used bows and arrows, so every option is "related". The printed key "pillars" contradicts the sources; "bows" is probably a mistranslation of arches (dhanushakar), which they did not build (true arch unknown).

4. [PYQ] · UK UDA/LDA (Pre) 2003

Indus Valley Civilisation is known

I. for its town planning

II. for Mohenjodaro and Harappan

III. for their agricultural work

IV. for its industrialisation.
Codes

a. I and II
b. I, II and III
c. II, III and IV
d. All of these

Answer: (d)
The IVC is known for town planning, for its type-sites Mohenjodaro and Harappa, for its agriculture and for craft industries (bead, shell and metal factories at Chanhudaro and Lothal), so "all of these" is keyed.

5. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

The Indus Valley culture was different from the Vedic Civilization because

a. It had the amenities of developed city life
b. It has a pictographic script
c. It lacked knowledge of iron and defensive arrow
d. All of the above

Answer: (d)
The IVC was urban with city amenities, used a pictographic script and did not know iron, while the Vedic culture was rural and later used iron, so all three differences hold.

6. [PYQ] · BPSC 2018

What is the most significant feature of the Indus Valley Civilisation?

a. Burnt brick buildings
b. First true arches
c. Buildings of worship
d. Art and architecture

Answer: (a)
Large-scale use of burnt bricks is the most characteristic feature of the IVC. True arches were unknown and no buildings of worship (temples) have been found.

7. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023 +1 more

What is the most significant feature of the Indus Valley Civilization?

a. Burnt brick buildings
b. First true arches
c. Buildings of worship
d. Art and architecture

Answer: (a)
Burnt-brick buildings are the most significant feature of the IVC; no temples have clearly been found and the true arch was unknown.

8. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Which of the following statements about the Indus civilization is not true?

a. Accurate drainage system in cities
b. Trade and commerce were in an advanced stage
c. Worshipping of Mother Goddess
d. People knew about iron

Answer: (d)
The IVC was a Bronze Age civilisation and did not know iron. Its drainage was advanced, trade and commerce were developed and the Mother Goddess was worshipped.

9. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan cities:
1. The absence of palaces and temples proves that there was no civic authority.
2. No temples or palaces have been clearly found, unlike in Mesopotamia and Egypt.
3. Standard bricks, a grid plan, streets and drains point to a civic authority.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 1 is wrong: the absence of palaces or temples does NOT disprove a civic authority – standard bricks, grid, streets and drains point to one. Statement 2 is correct.

10. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about what the Harappans knew:
1. Wells, drains and bows-and-arrows were known.
2. They built only corbelled arches, never the true arch.
3. The assembly hall at Mohenjodaro had 20 pillars.
4. Iron tools were in common use.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only three
b. Only one
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (a)
Statement 4 is wrong: the IVC is a Bronze Age culture and did not know iron, which came c. 1000 BC in the Later Vedic age. The corbelled arch, the 20-pillared hall, wells, drains and bows-and-arrows were all known.

11. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements comparing the IVC and the Vedic culture:
1. Harappan pottery was red ware painted in black, while the Vedic people used Painted Grey Ware.
2. The stratified pottery sequence from Mehrgarh to the Harappan black-on-red ware lies below the Painted Grey Ware.
3. The Vedic people used a pictographic script.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is wrong: the Vedic people had no script; the pictographic (undeciphered) script belongs to the IVC. The pottery contrast and the pottery sequence below the Painted Grey Ware are correct.

12. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. Town planning is regarded as the hallmark of the Indus Valley Civilisation.
2. Clear remains of temples and palaces have been found in Harappan cities.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
Town planning is the hallmark of the IVC, but no temples or palaces have been clearly found, unlike in Mesopotamia and Egypt.

2. Wells, Drainage and Water Management (PYQs 6 · MCQs 11)

Site	Feature
Mohenjodaro	About 700 brick wells, many inside houses → most wells (UPPCS 2004)
Dholavira	Water management: 16 reservoirs, dams, embankments, channels; some rock-cut (UPSC 2021, CDS 2012, UPPCS 2010)
Kalibangan	Many houses had their own wells; wooden drains
Banawali	No systematic drainage
Allahdino (Sindh)	Well irrigation

- **Drainage** = the most advanced IVC feature: house drains → sump/cesspit → **covered** street drains (bricks or stone slabs) with **manholes** → **soak pits** or main channels; streets sloped for flow; better than contemporary Mesopotamia and Egypt. Lothal: mud-brick houses but burnt-brick drains.
- **Dholavira reservoirs:** water from the **Manhar and Mansar** rivulets; huge rock-cut reservoir about **73–79 m long, 7 m deep**; stepwells cut in sandstone = Harappan **rock-cut architecture** (UPPSC 2006).

> Trap: Dholavira = reservoirs (water harvesting); Mohenjodaro = wells.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.85-86, p.102-103; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.14; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.21-22; old app notes row 6

13. [PYQ] · Indian History previous paper (header not legible)

In which Indus valley site more number of wells were discovered?

a. Harappa
b. Kalibangan
c. Lothal
d. Mohanjodaro

Answer: (d)

Mohenjodaro had about 700 brick wells, the largest number at any Harappan site. Kalibangan had house wells too, but far fewer.

14. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004 +1 more

From which one of the following places, remains of wells have been found in houses belonging to the developed stage of the Indus Valley Civilization?

a. Harappa
b. Kalibangan
c. Lothal
d. Mohenjodaro

Answer: (d)

Mohenjodaro is noted for wells inside private houses (about 700 wells), part of its water supply and drainage system; Harappa, Kalibangan and Lothal are not the answer.

15. [PYQ] · CDS 2012

Which one among the following Indus cities was known for water management?

a. Lothal
b. Mohenjodaro
c. Harappa
d. Dholavira

Answer: (d)

Dholavira was known for water management, with 16 reservoirs, dams, embankments and channels, some rock-cut. Mohenjodaro is known for wells and drains, Lothal for its dock.

16. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

A highly advanced water management system of Harappan times has been unearthed at–

a. Alamgirpur
b. Dholavira
c. Kalibangan
d. Lothal

Answer: (b)

Dholavira has a huge rock-cut reservoir (about 73-79 m long, 7 m deep) and 16 reservoirs fed by dams, the most advanced Harappan water management; Alamgirpur, Kalibangan and Lothal are not known for it.

17. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2006

From where the evidence of rock-cut architecture were found, with reference to Harappa Civilisation?

a. Kalibangan
b. Dholavira
c. Kot Diji
d. Amri

Answer: (b)

Dholavira has reservoirs and stepwells cut into the rock, the rock-cut architecture of the Harappan civilisation. Kalibangan, Kot Diji and Amri are not known for this.

18. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre.) 2021

Which one of the following ancient towns is wellknown for its elaborate system of water harvesting and management by building a series of dams and channelizing water into connected reservoirs?

a. Dholavira
b. Kalibangan
c. Rakhigarhi
d. Ropar

Answer: (a)

Dholavira in Gujarat is well known for its elaborate system of water harvesting, building a series of dams and channelling water into connected reservoirs; Kalibangan, Rakhigarhi and Ropar are not.

19. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Site) with List-II (Water feature):
List-I
A. Mohenjodaro
B. Dholavira
C. Kalibangan
D. Allahdino
List-II
i. Wooden drains
ii. 16 reservoirs with dams and embankments
iii. About 700 brick wells
iv. Well irrigation
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-ii, B-iii, C-i, D-iv
b. A-iii, B-ii, C-iv, D-i
c. A-iii, B-ii, C-i, D-iv
d. A-iv, B-i, C-ii, D-iii

Answer: (c)

Mohenjodaro – about 700 brick wells, Dholavira – 16 reservoirs, dams and embankments, Kalibangan – wooden drains (and house wells), Allahdino (Sindh) – well irrigation: A-iii, B-ii, C-i, D-iv.

20. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan drainage:
1. Banawali had the most systematic drainage of all Harappan towns.
2. At Lothal the houses were of mud brick but the drains of burnt brick.
3. The waste water finally drained into soak pits or main channels.
4. House drains led into covered street drains that had manholes.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All four
d. Only three

Answer: (d)

Statement 1 is wrong: Banawali had NO systematic drainage. Covered drains with manholes, soak pits / main channels and Lothal's burnt-brick drains are correct – drainage was the most advanced IVC feature.

21. [Kept own]

What was provided in covered Harappan drains for cleaning them?

a. Manholes
b. Sluice gates
c. Stepwells
d. Ventilation shafts

Answer: (a)

Covered Harappan drains had manholes for maintenance and used street slopes for natural flow.

22. [Kept own]

How many reservoirs, covering about 10% of the site, were found at Dholavira?

a. 6
b. 10
c. 16
d. 21

Answer: (c)

Dholavira had 16 reservoirs, about 10% of the site, some of them rock-cut.

23. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Dholavira:
1. It is one of the five largest Harappan cities.
2. Its huge rock-cut reservoir was about 79 m × 12 m.
3. It was built mainly of baked bricks.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Dholavira was one of the five largest cities and had a 79 m × 12 m rock-cut reservoir; it used sandstone and limestone blocks, not baked brick.

3. Citadel and Lower Town – Dholavira's Three Parts (PYQs 4 · MCQs 6)

Site	Plan
Mohenjodaro, Harappa	Citadel on the west (smaller, higher, on a mud-brick platform, elite and public buildings) + lower town on the east (larger, commoners)
Kalibangan	Citadel + lower town, both fortified
Dholavira	Only city in three parts: citadel, middle town, lower town
Chanhudaro	No citadel (only Harappan city without one)
Lothal, Surkotada	Citadel not separately walled; inside one fortified enclosure
Sutkagendor	Citadel + lower city

- **Great Bath, granary, college of priests, assembly hall** stood on the **citadel** of Mohenjodaro → both "citadel on the west" and "Great Bath in the citadel" are correct (AP Sachivalayam).
- Pataliputra is NOT an IVC site; Kalibangan, Ropar and Lothal are.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.84-85, p.102; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.5, p.14; old app notes row 6

24. [PYQ] · U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Which Harappan city is divided into three parts?

a. Lothal
b. Kalibangan
c. Dholavira
d. Surkotada

Answer: (c)
Dholavira is the only Harappan city in three parts: citadel, middle town and lower town. Lothal, Kalibangan and Surkotada have only a citadel and a lower town.

25. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

In which of the following site remnants of three townships have been revealed?

a. Mohenjodaro
b. Sanghol
c. Kalibangan
d. Dholavira

Answer: (d)
Dholavira (Kachchh, Gujarat) was divided into citadel, middle town and lower town. Mohenjodaro and Kalibangan have two parts; Sanghol is a later (Kushana-age) site.

26. [PYQ] · UPRO/ARO 2013

Which city of Indus Valley Civilisation was divided into three parts?

a. Lothal
b. Kalibangan
c. Dholavira
d. Suskotda

Answer: (c)
Dholavira is the only Harappan city built in three parts: citadel, middle town and lower town. Lothal, Kalibangan and Surkotada have a citadel and lower town only.

27. [PYQ] · AP Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III Ward Sanitation & En

Consider the following statements regarding the unique features of Harappan cities :

A. Citadel were on the western side of the cities.

B. Great Bath was built in the Citadel area.
Choose the correct option from the codes given below.

a. A only
b. B only
c. Both A and B
d. Neither A nor B

Answer: (c)
The citadel lay on the western side of Harappan cities, and at Mohenjodaro the Great Bath was built on the citadel, so both A and B are correct.

28. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Site) with List-II (Town plan):
List-I
A. Kalibangan
B. Dholavira
C. Chanhudaro
D. Lothal
List-II
i. Citadel and lower town both fortified
ii. No citadel
iii. Three parts – citadel, middle town, lower town
iv. Citadel not separately walled, inside one enclosure
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-iv
b. A-iii, B-i, C-ii, D-iv
c. A-i, B-iii, C-iv, D-ii
d. A-ii, B-iii, C-i, D-iv

Answer: (a)
Kalibangan – citadel and lower town both fortified, Dholavira – three parts, Chanhudaro – no citadel, Lothal – citadel inside one fortified enclosure: A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-iv.

29. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT an Indus Valley site?

a. Kalibangan
b. Ropar
c. Pataliputra
d. Lothal

Answer: (c)
Pataliputra is not an IVC site; Kalibangan, Ropar and Lothal are.

4. Bricks, Streets and Houses (PYQs 3 · MCQs 9)

Bricks

- **Burnt bricks** common; **mud bricks** for fillings and platforms and at **Kalibangan**. Both baked and raw bricks used.
- Standard ratio **1:2:4** (thickness : width : length) = 4:2:1.
- **Same ratio, different sizes:** house bricks **7.5×15×30 cm** (≈7×14×28), city-wall bricks **10×20×40 cm** → "the same size of brick for all constructions" is **false**.
- **Dholavira**: **sandstone and limestone** blocks, not baked brick.
- **Ornamental bricks** = Kalibangan; **curved bricks** = Chanhudaro.

Streets

- **Grid layout**: streets ran north-south and east-west, crossing at **right angles**, splitting the city into blocks → **broad and straight** (not narrow, zig-zag).
- Main streets about **10 m (30 feet)** wide (Rocket: main road of Mohenjodaro ≈9.15 m). **Banawali** = only city with **radial streets**.

Houses

- Rooms round a **central courtyard**; brick-paved **bathrooms** and toilets; no ground-level windows (privacy).
- Doors and windows opened on **side lanes**, not main streets (Lothal is the exception – entrances on the main street).
- **Storeys:** most houses single-storeyed but **staircases** show many had an upper storey. CGPSC 2022 key treats "mostly all houses single storey" as untrue along with "same size of bricks" → **(i) and (ii)**; "main roads ~10 m" is true.
- **Arch:** Harappans used only the corbelled arch, never the true arch (MPPSC 2009).

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.85-86; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.5; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.19; old app notes row 6

30. [PYQ] · SSC 2012

How were the street of cities of Indus Valley Civilisation?

a. Broad and straight
b. Narrow and zig-zag
c. Slippery
d. Narrow and dirty

Answer: (a)

Streets followed a grid, running straight and crossing at right angles, and the main streets were about 10 m wide, so they were broad and straight, not narrow and zig-zag.

31. [PYQ] · MPPSC 2009

Which one of the following was not known to the Harappans?

a. Construction of Wells
b. Construction of Pillars
c. Construction of Drains
d. Construction of Arches

Answer: (d)

Harappans knew wells, drains and pillared halls (Mohenjodaro assembly hall) but not the true arch; they used only corbelling.

32. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Based on findings of excavation of Harappan Civilization, what are not true? (i) For all kinds of constructions, same size of bricks were used. (ii) Mostly all the houses were single storey. (iii)Main roads were on average ten meters in width.

a. (i) and (ii)
b. (ii) and (iii)
c. (i) and (iii)
d. (i), (ii) and (iii)

Answer: (a)

Statement (i) is untrue: bricks kept the 1:2:4 ratio but differed in size (house 7.5x15x30 cm, wall 10x20x40 cm). The CGPSC key also treats (ii) as untrue, since staircases show many houses had an upper storey, while (iii) is true (main roads about 10 m). (official key: a; PMF says most houses were single-storeyed, so statement (ii) is contested)

33. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan building material:
1. Mud bricks were used for fillings and platforms and notably at Kalibangan.
2. Dholavira, like Mohenjodaro, was built mainly of baked brick.
3. The standard brick ratio was 1:2:4 (thickness : width : length).
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

Statement 2 is wrong: Dholavira used sandstone and limestone blocks, not baked brick. Mud bricks (Kalibangan) and the 1:2:4 ratio are correct.

34. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Feature) with List-II (Site):
List-I
A. Ornamental bricks
B. Curved bricks
C. Radial streets
D. House entrances on the main street
List-II
i. Banawali
ii. Chanhudaro
iii. Lothal
iv. Kalibangan
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii
b. A-iv, B-ii, C-iii, D-i
c. A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
d. A-i, B-ii, C-iv, D-iii

Answer: (c)

Ornamental bricks – Kalibangan, curved bricks – Chanhudaro, radial streets – Banawali (the only such city), entrances on the main street – Lothal (the exception): A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii.

35. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan streets and houses:
1. Main streets were about 10 m wide.
2. Streets ran north-south and east-west, crossing at right angles.
3. Doors and windows of houses generally opened on the main streets.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 3 is wrong: doors and windows opened on side lanes, not the main streets (Lothal is the exception). The right-angled grid and ~10 m main streets are correct.

36. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The same size of brick was not used for all Harappan constructions.
Reason (R): House bricks and city-wall bricks kept the same 1:2:4 ratio.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (b)
Both are true but R does not explain A: house bricks were about 7.5×15×30 cm and city-wall bricks 10×20×40 cm – the same 1:2:4 ratio but different sizes. Keeping the ratio is not why the sizes differ.

37. [Kept own]

Which Harappan city is noted as the only one with radial streets instead of the usual grid pattern?

a. Banawali
b. Mohenjodaro
c. Harappa
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (a)
Banawali is the only Harappan city with radial streets; Mohenjodaro and Harappa show the typical grid layout with streets crossing at right angles.

38. [Kept own]

What do the staircases found in Harappan houses show?

a. Built on stilts
b. Rock-cut
c. Multi-storeyed
d. Only single-storeyed

Answer: (c)
Staircases show that houses could be multi-storeyed; 'houses mostly single-storey' is a trap.

5. The Great Bath (PYQs 2 · MCQs 5)

Angle	Fact
Site	Mohenjodaro, on the citadel mound, Sindh – not Harappa, Lothal, Ropar or Kalibangan
Size	11.88 × 7.01 m, 2.43 m deep; two flights of steps on north and south
Material	Burnt bricks set in gypsum mortar; bitumen (natural tar) waterproofing
Water	From a large well in a side room; drain in one corner
Purpose	Ritual bath (most view); public bath ruled out as houses had bathrooms

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.84; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.10, p.12; old app notes row 6

39. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

The Great Bath was found from the Indus Valley civilization at -

a. Mohenjodaro
b. Harappa
c. Lothal
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (a)
The Great Bath stands on the citadel mound of Mohenjodaro in Sindh, Pakistan; it is not found at Harappa, Lothal or Kalibangan.

40. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2007

The 'Great Bath' was found at the archaeological site of -

a. Ropar
b. Harappa
c. Mohenjodaro
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (c)
The Great Bath stood on the citadel mound of Mohenjodaro in Sindh. Harappa, Ropar and Kalibangan do not have it.

41. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Great Bath of Mohenjodaro:
1. It had flights of steps on the east and west sides.
2. It lay on the citadel mound and measured about 11.88 × 7.01 m, 2.43 m deep.
3. It was made of burnt bricks set in gypsum mortar and waterproofed with bitumen.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 and 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 1 is wrong: the two flights of steps were on the north and south. Its place on the citadel, its size and the gypsum mortar with bitumen waterproofing are correct.

42. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Most scholars see the Great Bath as a ritual bath rather than a public bath.
Reason (R): Harappan houses had their own brick-paved bathrooms.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: since houses had their own bathrooms, a public bath is ruled out and the Great Bath is read as a ritual bath.

43. [Kept own]

The Great Bath at Mohenjodaro was about how deep?

a. 1.2 m
b. 2.4 m
c. 4.8 m
d. 7 m

Answer: (b)
The Great Bath was about 12 m × 7 m and 2.4 m deep.

6. Granaries and Other Public Buildings (PYQs 1 · MCQs 6)

Structure	Site
Great Granary – largest building (45.71 × 15.23 m), on the citadel	Mohenjodaro (Hostel Welfare 2017; APPSC G2 2008)
Granary of 12 rooms in two rows of six, near the Ravi	Harappa
Granaries also at	Kalibangan, Rakhigarhi
Warehouse on a raised platform beside the dock, seal impressions	Lothal
Pillared assembly hall (20 pillars in 4 rows)	Mohenjodaro
College of priests	Mohenjodaro
Fire altars	Kalibangan (seven), Lothal, Banawali, Rakhigarhi

- Granaries stored the farm surplus (cereals probably taken as tax).
- **Harappa finds:** Cemetery H, R-37, coffin burial, wheat and barley in a wooden mortar, dice, unicorn seal. Not Harappa: dockyard = Lothal; horse bones = Surkotada; bronze chariot = Daimabad.

> Trap: Great Granary = Mohenjodaro; two rows of six = Harappa.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.84-85; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.11-12; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.19; old app notes row 6

44. [PYQ] · Hostel Welfare Officer Grade-II (Male & Female) in A.P BC We

The Great Granary of Harappan Culture is found at?

a. Harappa
b. Mohenjodaro
c. Lothal
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (b)

The Great Granary, the largest building of Mohenjodaro (45.71 x 15.23 m), stood on its citadel. Harappa had a granary of 12 rooms in two rows of six, not the "Great Granary".

45. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Structure) with List-II (Site):
List-I
A. Granary of 12 rooms in two rows of six
B. Warehouse on a raised platform beside the dock
C. Seven fire altars
D. Pillared assembly hall
List-II
i. Lothal
ii. Kalibangan
iii. Mohenjodaro
iv. Harappa
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iii, B-i, C-ii, D-iv
b. A-iv, B-i, C-ii, D-iii
c. A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
d. A-i, B-iv, C-iii, D-ii

Answer: (b)

Granary of 12 rooms (two rows of six, near the Ravi) – Harappa, dock warehouse – Lothal, seven fire altars – Kalibangan, pillared assembly hall (20 pillars) – Mohenjodaro: A-iv, B-i, C-ii, D-iii.

46. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. The so-called college of priests was found at Harappa.
2. Fire altars have been found at Kalibangan, Lothal, Banawali and Rakhigarhi.
3. Harappan granaries stored the farm surplus, probably taken as tax.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Statement 1 is wrong: the college of priests is at Mohenjodaro. Fire altars at Kalibangan, Lothal, Banawali and Rakhigarhi and granaries as stores of the surplus are correct.

47. [New pattern · statements]

Which of the following finds come from Harappa?
1. A bronze chariot
2. A dockyard
3. Cemetery H and Cemetery R-37
4. Wheat and barley in a wooden mortar
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. 2, 3 and 4 only
b. 1 and 4 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 3 and 4 only

Answer: (d)

Only 3 and 4 are Harappa finds. The dockyard is at Lothal and the bronze chariot at Daimabad.

48. [Kept own]

How are Harappan granaries generally interpreted?

a. Residential blocks
b. Temples
c. Royal palaces
d. Stores of farm surplus

Answer: (d)

Granaries are commonly read as stores of agricultural surplus, though the interpretation is debated.

49. [Kept own]
At which site were wheat and barley found in a wooden mortar?

a. Harappa
b. Lothal
c. Kalibangan
d. Dholavira

Answer: (a)
Wheat and barley in a wooden mortar are among the finds at Harappa.

7. Dholavira – Plan, Stadium and Signboard (PYQs 0 · MCQs 2)

- **Kachchh** (Khadir island), Gujarat; rectangular plan; one of the **five largest** cities (with Mohenjodaro, Harappa, Ganweriwala, Rakhigarhi).
- **Stadium** (~283 × 47 m) between citadel and middle town; special cemetery structures; **ten-sign signboard** near the **North Gate** = largest Harappan signs.
- Settled in seven stages, **c. 3000–1500 BCE** (APPSC 2018 marked 3000–1800 BCE).
- **UNESCO 2021**: India's **40th** WHS; **first IVC site in India** on the list.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.102; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.14, p.16; old app notes row 6

50. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements about Dholavira:
1. It lies on Khadir island in Kachchh, Gujarat.
2. It was settled in seven stages.
3. Its ten-sign signboard was found near the South Gate.
4. A stadium of about 283 × 47 m lay between the citadel and the middle town.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only three
b. Only one
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (a)
Statement 3 is wrong: the ten-sign signboard (largest Harappan signs) was near the North Gate. Khadir island (Kachchh), the stadium and the seven stages are correct.

51. [Kept own]
A stadium-like open ground was found at which Harappan site?

a. Lothal
b. Kalibangan
c. Dholavira
d. Rakhigarhi

Answer: (c)
Dholavira had a stadium-like open ground and special cemetery structures besides its reservoirs.

Row 7: Major Harappan Sites and Their Signature Finds

1. Signature Find → Site (PYQs 9 · MCQs 19)

Signature find	Site
Great Granary, Great Bath, Pashupati seal, Dancing Girl, Priest-King	Mohenjodaro
Granaries in two rows of six; Cemetery R-37, H; red sandstone torso	Harappa
Bead factory, furnace, lipstick, ink pot; no citadel	Chanhudaro
Earliest ploughed field, seven fire altars, camel bones, wooden drain	Kalibangan
Terracotta (toy) plough, radial streets, barley	Banawali
Horse bones (doubtful), pot burials	Surkotada
Reservoirs, stadium, 10-sign signboard, three-part town, rock-cut stepwells	Dholavira
Bronze (copper) chariot, bronze buffalo, rhinoceros, elephant	Daimabad (CGPSC 2013)
Rice, bajra, sorghum; Late Harappan	Rangpur
Largest site in India; granary; gemstone factory	Rakhigarhi
Dog buried with human; oval pit burials	Ropar
125 graves; human burials	Sinauli (Sanauli)
Earliest garlic	Balu
Shell objects	Nageshwar, Balakot
Lapis lazuli trade outpost; canals	Shortughai (Afghanistan)
Earliest furnace	Kot Bala
Salt production	Kerala-no-dhoro
Rhinoceros remains	Amri
Himalayan wood	Manda

- **Mohenjodaro** = "Mound of the Dead" (Sindhi; Lothal means the same in Gujarati); **Kalibangan** = "black bangles"; Dholavira local name **Kotada**.
- **Cylindrical seals:** Kalibangan and Mohenjodaro; **ship seal:** Lothal.
- Surkotada horse bones dated c. 2100–1700 BCE; Banawali has pre-, mature and post-Harappan phases.

> Trap: horse remains = Surkotada, not Lothal; ploughed field = Kalibangan, toy plough = Banawali.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.11-15; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.18-27; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.72, p.82-83; old app notes row 7

- **Ropar** (Sutlej, Punjab) also gave a typical Harappan **steatite seal** with Indus script; Rakhigarhi (not Banawali) is the largest Indian site.
- **Skeletons in wells and streets: Mohenjodaro** (late level) – Wheeler's "massacre"; now read as multiple burials.
- **Earthquake:** the earliest evidence of an **earthquake** in the Harappan context is at **Kalibangan** (end of its early phase, c. 2700 BCE).

1. [PYQ] · CGPSC 2013

From where the copper chariot of Harappan times was found?

a. Kunal
b. Rakhigarhi
c. Daimabad
d. Banawali

Answer: (c)

The copper/bronze chariot (a man riding a two-wheeled cart drawn by two oxen) comes from Daimabad in Maharashtra; Kunal, Rakhigarhi and Banawali are not known for it.

2. [PYQ] · Police Constable Preliminary Exam 2016

Match the following Harappan civilization towns with their archaeological sources:
List-I:
A. Harappa
B. Mohenjo Daro
C. Lothal
D. Rangapur
List-II: i. The great bath ii. Paddy Husk iii. Port City iv. Granary

a. A-iv, B-i, C-iii, D-ii
b. A-ii, B-iii, C-i, D-iv
c. A-iii, B-ii, C-i, D-iv
d. A-i, B-iii, C-iv, D-ii

Answer: (a)
Harappa – granary, Mohenjodaro – Great Bath, Lothal – port city (dockyard), Rangpur – paddy husk: A-iv, B-i, C-iii, D-ii.

3. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2002

Match
List I (Ancient site) with
List II (Archaeological finding) and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:
List I (Ancient site)
A. Lothal
B. Kalibangan
C. Dholavira
D. Banawali
List II (Archaeological finding)
1. Ploughed field
2. Dockyard
3. Terracotta replica of a plough
4. An inscription comprising ten large sized signs of the Harappan script
Codes:

a. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
b. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
c. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
d. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

Answer: (b)
Lothal – dockyard, Kalibangan – ploughed field, Dholavira – ten-sign inscription, Banawali – terracotta plough: A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3.

4. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2021

Which one of the following ancient towns is well-known for its elaborate system of water harvesting and management by building a series of dams and channelizing water into connected reservoirs?

a. Dholavira
b. Kalibangan
c. Rakhigarhi
d. Ropar

Answer: (a)
Dholavira had dams, channels and connected reservoirs fed by two seasonal streams – one of the earliest water-management systems.

5. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

From where was the evidence of rock-cut architecture found, with reference to Harappa civilization?

a. Kalibangan
b. Dholavira
c. Kot Diji
d. Amri

Answer: (b)
Dholavira (Kutch) shows rock-cut architecture – rock-cut reservoirs and dressed-stone structures.

6. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

A ploughed field was discovered at –

a. Mohenjodaro
b. Kalibangan
c. Harappa
d. Lothal

Answer: (b)
Kalibangan (pre-Harappan level) gave the earliest ploughed field with criss-cross furrows.

7. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 2023 (08-01-2023)
During the Indus Valley Civilization, the beads manufacturing industry was located at

a. Harappa
b. Mohenjo-Daro
c. Chanhudaro
d. Lothal

Answer: (c)
Chanhudaro is the Harappan bead-making centre (Mackay's bead factory, 'Lancashire of India'); Lothal also made beads, but Chanhudaro is the key.

8. [PYQ] · State PSC
In which of the following Harappan cities, furrows of ploughed fields have been found?

a. Kalibangan
b. Dholavira
c. Mohenjo-daro
d. Lothal

Answer: (a)
Furrows of a ploughed field were found at Kalibangan (Rajasthan).

9. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Mains) 2017
Match the following.
List I
List II

A. Harappa
1. Cemetry R-37

B. Lothal
2. Dockyard

C. Kalibangan
3. Dancing girl statue

D. Mohenjodaro
4. Furrowed land
Codes A B C D

a. 1 2 3 4
b. 2 1 4 3
c. 3 4 1 2
d. 1 2 4 3

Answer: (d)
Harappa – Cemetery R-37, Lothal – dockyard, Kalibangan – furrowed land, Mohenjodaro – Dancing Girl: 1 2 4 3.

10. [New pattern · statements]
Which of the following were found at Mohenjodaro?
1. The steatite Priest-King
2. The bronze Dancing Girl
3. The Pashupati seal
4. The red sandstone male torso
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1, 3 and 4 only
c. 1, 2, 3 and 4
d. 1, 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
The red sandstone male torso is from Harappa. The Dancing Girl, the Priest-King and the Pashupati seal all come from Mohenjodaro.

11. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Find) with List-II (Site):
List-I
A. Camel bones
B. Terracotta toy plough
C. Dog buried with a human
D. Horse bones (doubtful)
List-II
i. Banawali
ii. Ropar
iii. Surkotada
iv. Kalibangan
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iv, B-i, C-ii, D-iii
b. A-i, B-iv, C-ii, D-iii
c. A-iv, B-i, C-iii, D-ii
d. A-ii, B-iii, C-iv, D-i

Answer: (a)

Camel bones – Kalibangan, toy plough – Banawali (the ploughed field is Kalibangan), dog with human – Ropar, doubtful horse bones – Surkotada: A-iv, B-i, C-ii, D-iii.

12. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Find) with List-II (Site):
List-I
A. Earliest furnace
B. Rice, bajra and sorghum
C. Ten-sign signboard
D. Bronze chariot
List-II
i. Dholavira
ii. Kot Bala
iii. Daimabad
iv. Rangpur
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
b. A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii
c. A-ii, B-iv, C-iii, D-i
d. A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii

Answer: (b)

Earliest furnace – Kot Bala, rice/bajra/sorghum – Rangpur, ten-sign signboard – Dholavira, bronze chariot – Daimabad: A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii.

13. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Surkotada horse bones are dated c. 2100–1700 BCE.
2. Cylindrical seals come from Kalibangan and Mohenjodaro, and the ship seal from Lothal.
3. Banawali shows pre-, mature and post-Harappan phases.
4. Chanhudaro, the bead-making town, had a fortified citadel.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)

Statement 4 is wrong: Chanhudaro (bead factory, furnace, ink pot) had NO citadel. The Surkotada dating, Banawali's three phases and the cylinder/ship seal sites are correct.

14. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Mohenjodaro means "Mound of the Dead" in Sindhi.
2. Kotada is the local name of Kalibangan.
3. Kalibangan means "black bangles".
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)

Statement 2 is wrong: Kotada is the local name of Dholavira. "Mound of the Dead" (Mohenjodaro; Lothal means the same in Gujarati) and "black bangles" (Kalibangan) are correct.

15. [Kept own]
Banawali shows how many cultural phases?

a. Two
b. Three
c. Five
d. Seven

Answer: (b)
Banawali has three phases: pre-Harappan, Harappan and post-Harappan; seven stages belong to Dholavira.

16. [Kept own]
Which Gujarat site, known for rice husks, belongs to the Late Harappan (Rojdi culture) phase?

a. Dholavira
b. Surkotada
c. Rangpur
d. Lothal

Answer: (c)
Rangpur yielded rice husks and belongs to the Late Harappan (Rojdi culture) phase.

17. [Kept own]
Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

a. Harappa — two rows of six granaries
b. Harappa — Cemetery H
c. Harappa — red sandstone male torso
d. Harappa — ten-sign inscription signboard

Answer: (d)
The ten-sign inscription signboard belongs to Dholavira. Harappa is associated with Cemetery H, a red sandstone male torso and two rows of six granaries.

18. [Kept own]
At which site was a signboard of ten Indus signs found?

a. Lothal
b. Dholavira
c. Kalibangan
d. Ropar

Answer: (b)
The ten-sign signboard is from Dholavira; Lothal has the dockyard and Kalibangan the ploughed field.

19. [Kept own]
Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

a. Surkotada — disputed horse bones
b. Kalibangan — ploughed field
c. Banawali — terracotta toy plough
d. Rangpur — seven fire altars

Answer: (d)
Seven fire altars are associated with Kalibangan, not Rangpur. Rangpur is associated with rice and the Late Harappan Rojdi culture.

2. Lothal – Port Town, Dockyard and the Maritime Heritage Complex (PYQs 6 · MCQs 14)

- **Lothal** (Ahmedabad, Gujarat) on the **Bhogava** (tributary of the Sabarmati), near the **Gulf of Khambhat** = **the port city** of the IVC (UPPCS 1999, BPSC 2011, SI 2019) – not Harappa, Kalibangan, Mohenjodaro or Ropar.
- **Dockyard:** brick-lined basin **218 m × 37 m** with sluice gates – the world's earliest tidal dock; warehouse on a raised platform with seals and sealings.
- **Discovered 1954, excavated 1955–60 by S.R. Rao** (not Wheeler, not Daya Ram Sahni).
- **Other finds:** rice husk, fire altars, bead-making factory, Persian Gulf (button) seal, ship on a seal, terracotta ship, copper dog, chess-like game set, three double burials, painted jar (cunning fox story), ivory scale.
- Entrance of houses on the **main street** (other cities: side lanes). Called "Mini Harappa".
- **Other ports:** Rangpur, Somnath (Prabhas Patan), Balakot, Kuntasi, Khirasara, Sutkagendor.

National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC)

- **NMHC** is being built at **Lothal**, Gujarat (not Kozhikode, Visakhapatnam, Sindhudurg, Kanyakumari, Puri or Panjim) – Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways; approved by the **Union Cabinet, October 2024**.
- **As of Sep 2026:** Phase 1A about **82%** complete, target **31 Oct 2026**; Phase 1B to add eight galleries and a lighthouse museum.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.12-13; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.103; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.17, p.20-21; old app notes row 7

20. [PYQ] · SI Mains Paper-IV 2019

The following is the important port city of the Indus valley period

a. Lothal
b. Harappa
c. Rupar
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (a)
Lothal in Gujarat, with its brick dockyard, was the important port city of the Harappans; Harappa, Rupar (Ropar) and Kalibangan were inland.

21. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

The port city of Indus Valley Civilization was –

a. Harappa
b. Kalibangan
c. Lothal
d. Mohenjodaro

Answer: (c)
Lothal is the Harappan port city with a brick dockyard on the Gulf of Khambhat; Harappa, Kalibangan and Mohenjodaro were inland cities.

22. [PYQ] · APPSC Draughtsman (Technical Assistant) Paper-I General Stud

Indian National Maritime Heritage Complex is located in

a. Kozhikode
b. Vishakhapatnam
c. Sindhudurg
d. Lothal

Answer: (d)
The National Maritime Heritage Complex is being built at Lothal, Gujarat, the Harappan port town, by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways; it is not at Kozhikode, Visakhapatnam or Sindhudurg.

23. [PYQ] · APPSC Forest Range Officer Mains Paper-I General Studies & M

The National Maritime Heritage Complex is at

a. Lothal
b. Kanyakumari
c. Puri
d. Panjim

Answer: (a)
The National Maritime Heritage Complex is at Lothal, Gujarat, the Harappan dockyard town; Kanyakumari, Puri and Panjim are wrong.

24. [PYQ] · BPSC 2011

Which among the following is a port city of Harappa?

a. Sikdariya
b. Lothal
c. Maharathanagash
d. Nagpattneus

Answer: (b)
Lothal in Gujarat had the earliest tidal dockyard and was a port trading with West Asia; the other options are not Harappan ports.

25. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which of the following is a Harappan port?

a. Alexandria
b. Lothal
c. Mahasthangarh
d. Nagapattinam

Answer: (b)
Lothal, with its dockyard, was the Harappan port; Alexandria is Egyptian, Mahasthangarh is in Bangladesh and Nagapattinam is a Chola port.

26. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Lothal:
1. Its dock is regarded as the world's earliest tidal dock.
2. It lies on the Bhogava, a tributary of the Sabarmati, near the Gulf of Khambhat.
3. It was discovered in 1954 and excavated in 1955–60 by Mortimer Wheeler.
4. Its dock is a brick-lined basin of about 218 m × 37 m with sluice gates.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is wrong: Lothal was excavated by S. R. Rao, not Wheeler. The Bhogava location, the 218 × 37 m sluiced basin and its status as the earliest tidal dock are correct.

27. [New pattern · statements]

Which of the following have been found at Lothal?
1. A ship on a seal and a terracotta ship
2. A copper dog
3. The Great Granary
4. A Persian Gulf (button) seal
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. 1 and 4 only
b. 2, 3 and 4 only
c. 1, 2 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)
The Great Granary is at Mohenjodaro. The ship seal, terracotta ship, Persian Gulf seal and copper dog are Lothal finds and show its West Asian trade.

28. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Harappa was a port on the Ravi.
2. The National Maritime Heritage Complex at Lothal is being built by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways.
3. Rangpur, Somnath (Prabhas Patan) and Balakot were Harappan ports besides Lothal.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 1 is wrong: Harappa was an inland city; Lothal was THE port city. Rangpur, Somnath, Balakot (also Kuntasi, Khirasara, Sutkagendor) were ports, and the NMHC (approved Oct 2024) is under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways.

29. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Lothal is called the port city of the Harappan Civilisation.
Reason (R): Lothal stands on the Ravi, close to the Arabian Sea.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (c)
A is true (tidal dock, warehouse, ship seals) but R is false: Lothal is on the Bhogava near the Gulf of Khambhat; the Ravi is Harappa's river.

30. [Kept own]

Which Union Ministry is developing the National Maritime Heritage Complex at Lothal?

a. Ministry of Culture
b. Ministry of Tourism
c. Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways
d. Ministry of Defence

Answer: (c)
The NMHC at Lothal is a project of the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways.

31. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements about the National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC):
1. It is being developed at Lothal in Gujarat.
2. It was approved by the Union Cabinet in October 2024.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
The NMHC at Lothal was approved by the Union Cabinet in October 2024.

32. [Kept own]
Which Harappan site is especially associated with trade with West Asia?

a. Ropar
b. Amri
c. Lothal
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (c)
Lothal is the site associated with trade with West Asia, supported by its dockyard and the Persian Gulf-type seal.

33. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements:
1. The Lothal dock was joined to the Gulf of Khambhat.
2. Harappa was a port on the Ravi.
3. Sutkagendor was the westernmost Harappan port.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Lothal's dock joined the Gulf of Khambhat and Sutkagendor was the westernmost port; Harappa was an inland city on the Ravi, not a port.

3. Site → Excavator, River and State (PYQs 3 · MCQs 9)

Site	Excavator (year)	River	Present location
Harappa	Daya Ram Sahni (1921)	Ravi	Punjab (Pakistan)
Mohenjodaro	R.D. Banerji (1922)	Indus	Larkana, Sindh (Pakistan)
Chanhudaro	N.G. Majumdar (1931); Mackay 1935–36	Indus	Sindh (Pakistan)
Lothal	S.R. Rao (1954–57)	Bhogava	Ahmedabad, Gujarat
Kalibangan	A. Ghosh (1953); B.B. Lal and B.K. Thapar (1960–69)	Ghaggar	Hanumangarh, Rajasthan
Banawali	R.S. Bisht (1973–74)	Ghaggar (Saraswati)	Fatehabad, Haryana
Rakhigarhi	Amarendra Nath (1997); later Vasant Shinde	Ghaggar–Drishadvati	Hisar, Haryana
Dholavira	J.P. Joshi (found 1967–68); R.S. Bisht (1990)	Manhar, Mansar rivulets	Kachchh, Gujarat
Surkotada	J.P. Joshi (1964)	–	Kachchh, Gujarat
Rangpur	M.S. Vats (1931); S.R. Rao (1953–54)	Sukhbhadar	Gujarat
Ropar	Y.D. Sharma (1953–56) – first site dug after Independence	Sutlej	Punjab (India)
Daimabad	B.P. Bopardikar (1958)	Pravara	Maharashtra

Manda	J.P. Joshi (1982)	Chenab	Jammu

- **Not in Gujarat: Banawali** (Haryana) – Surkotada, Lothal, Dholavira are all in Gujarat (WBCS 2018).
- S.R. Rao = Lothal; R.S. Bisht = Banawali and Dholavira; J.P. Joshi = Surkotada; A. Ghosh = Kalibangan.

~~ Sources: Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.17-25; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.82, p.111; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.4; old app notes row 7

34. [PYQ] · APPSC

Who was the excavator of Lothal?

a. Daya Ram Sahni
b. Amalanand Ghosh
c. J.P Joshi
d. S.R Rao

Answer: (d)

S.R. Rao excavated Lothal (discovered 1954, dug 1955-60). Daya Ram Sahni dug Harappa, A. Ghosh found Kalibangan and J.P. Joshi dug Surkotada.

35. [PYQ] · State PSC

Harappa was situated on the bank of river

a. Beas
b. Sutlej
c. Ravi
d. Ghaggar

Answer: (c)

Harappa lies on the bank of the Ravi. The Ghaggar is associated with Kalibangan and Banawali, and the Sutlej with Ropar.

36. [PYQ] · WBCS 2018

Which among the following Harappan sites is not located in Gujarat?

a. Surkotada
b. Lothal
c. Dholavira
d. Banawali

Answer: (d)

Banawali is in Fatehabad, Haryana, on the Ghaggar, so it is not in Gujarat. Surkotada and Dholavira are in Kachchh and Lothal is near Ahmedabad, all in Gujarat.

37. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Site) with List-II (Excavator):
List-I
A. Harappa
B. Rangpur
C. Rakhigarhi
D. Ropar
List-II
i. Amarendra Nath
ii. Y. D. Sharma
iii. Daya Ram Sahni
iv. M. S. Vats
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii
b. A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii
c. A-iii, B-iv, C-ii, D-i
d. A-i, B-ii, C-iii, D-iv

Answer: (a)

Harappa – Daya Ram Sahni (1921), Rangpur – M. S. Vats (1931), Rakhigarhi – Amarendra Nath (1997), Ropar – Y. D. Sharma (1953–56): A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii.

38. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. R. S. Bisht also excavated Banawali.
2. J. P. Joshi found Dholavira in 1967-68 and R. S. Bisht excavated it in 1990.
3. Mohenjodaro stands on the Ravi.
4. Ropar, on the Sutlej, was the first Harappan site dug after Independence.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)

Statement 3 is wrong: Mohenjodaro is on the Indus; Harappa is on the Ravi. Joshi/Bisht at Dholavira, Bisht at Banawali and Ropar (Sutlej) as the first post-Independence dig are correct.

39. [New pattern · match]
Match List-I (Site) with List-II (River):
List-I
A. Banawali
B. Manda
C. Dholavira
D. Daimabad
List-II
i. Pravara
ii. Ghaggar (Saraswati)
iii. Manhar and Mansar rivulets
iv. Chenab
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iv, B-ii, C-iii, D-i
b. A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii
c. A-ii, B-iv, C-iii, D-i
d. A-iii, B-i, C-ii, D-iv

Answer: (c)
Banawali – Ghaggar (Saraswati), Manda – Chenab, Dholavira – the Manhar and Mansar rivulets, Daimabad – Pravara: A-ii, B-iv, C-iii, D-i.

40. [Kept own]
In which year did R.D. Banerji excavate Mohenjodaro?

a. 1921
b. 1922
c. 1931
d. 1953

Answer: (b)
Mohenjodaro was excavated by R.D. Banerji in 1922, a year after Harappa.

41. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements:
1. Mohenjodaro is in Larkana district of Sindh.
2. Banawali is in Fatehabad district of Haryana.
3. Lothal stands on the Ravi.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Mohenjodaro is in Larkana and Banawali in Fatehabad; Lothal is on the Bhogava/Sabarmati, not the Ravi.

42. [Kept own]
Match List-I (Site) with List-II (River):
List-I
A. Kalibangan
B. Rangpur
C. Ropar
List-II
1. Sutlej
2. Sukhbhadar
3. Ghaggar
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. A-3, B-2, C-1
b. A-1, B-2, C-3
c. A-3, B-1, C-2
d. A-2, B-3, C-1

Answer: (a)
Kalibangan is on the Ghaggar, Rangpur on the Sukhbhadar and Ropar on the Sutlej.

4. Not a Harappan Site – Odd-one-out (PYQs 2 · MCQs 5)

Name	Status
Sutkagendor (Makran, Baluchistan)	Harappan – westernmost
Surkotada, Desalpur (Kachchh)	Harappan

Kot Diji, Chanhudaro (Sindh)	Harappan (Kot Diji also pre-Harappan)
Rakhigarhi (Hisar)	Harappan
Sohgaura (Gorakhpur, UP, on the Rapti)	NOT Harappan – Mauryan-era copper plate on famine granaries (UPSC 2019, APPSC G2)
Pataliputra	NOT Harappan

> Sohgaura sounds like Surkotada – it is a Mauryan copper-plate site.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.79-83; old app notes row 7

43. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ

Which of the following is not a Harappan site?

a. Sutkagendo
b. Surkotada
c. Sohgaura
d. Rakhigarhi

Answer: (c)
Sohgaura, on the Rapti near Gorakhpur, is a Mauryan-era copper-plate site and is not Harappan. Sutkagendor, Surkotada and Rakhigarhi are Harappan sites.

44. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Which one of the following is not a Harappan site?

a. Chanhudaro
b. Kotdiji
c. Sohgaura
d. Desalpur

Answer: (c)
Sohgaura (Gorakhpur, UP) gave a Mauryan copper-plate inscription on famine granaries; it is not Harappan. Chanhudaro, Kot Diji and Desalpur are Harappan sites.

45. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Kot Diji in Sindh has a pre-Harappan level as well as a Harappan one.
2. Sohgaura (Gorakhpur) is a Mauryan copper-plate site, not a Harappan one.
3. Surkotada and Desalpur are Harappan sites in Kachchh.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (c)
All three are correct: Sohgaura's copper plate (on famine granaries) is Mauryan; Kot Diji is Harappan and also pre-Harappan; Surkotada and Desalpur are Harappan sites in Kachchh.

46. [Kept own]

At which Harappan site was an inkpot found?

a. Chanhudaro
b. Harappa
c. Dholavira
d. Rakhigarhi

Answer: (a)
Chanhudaro, the bead-making town, also yielded an inkpot.

47. [Kept own]

Which is the westernmost Harappan site?

a. Sutkagendor
b. Kot Diji
c. Desalpur
d. Surkotada

Answer: (a)
Sutkagendor on the Makran coast of Pakistan is the westernmost Harappan site.

5. Largest Sites, UNESCO and Rakhigarhi (PYQs 0 · MCQs 7)

- **Five largest** cities: **Mohenjodaro, Harappa, Ganweriwala, Rakhigarhi, Dholavira**.

- **Rakhigarhi** (Hisar, Haryana) = **largest Harappan site** (about 350–550 ha; 11 mounds per Shinde); **Bhirrana** = oldest.

Site	UNESCO status
Dholavira	WHS 2021 (India's 40th) – only inscribed Harappan site in India
Mohenjodaro (Pakistan)	Inscribed 1980
Rakhigarhi	Tentative List

- **Rakhigarhi DNA:** the ~4,600-year-old female skeleton **lacked the "Steppe Pastoralist" gene** → read as **indigenous ancestry**, challenging the Aryan-invasion view.
- **Mound 7** cemetery: **56 skeletons**; dig of **23 Jun 2026** found **five complete skeletons** (aged 30–40) and **three fragmentary burials**.
- First site excavated: Harappa (1921); first after Independence: Ropar.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.80, p.102, p.106; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.18; old app notes row 7

48. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan sites and UNESCO:
1. Dholavira (2021) is the only inscribed Harappan World Heritage Site in India.
2. Rakhigarhi is on the World Heritage List, inscribed after Dholavira.
3. Mohenjodaro was inscribed in 1980.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 2 is wrong: Rakhigarhi is only on the Tentative List. Dholavira (2021, India's 40th) and Mohenjodaro (1980) are correct.

49. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Rakhigarhi:
1. Bhirrana, not Rakhigarhi, is regarded as the oldest Harappan site.
2. It is the largest Harappan site and lies in Hisar, Haryana.
3. The dig reported on 23 June 2026 found five complete skeletons and three fragmentary burials.
4. Its Mound 7 cemetery has yielded 156 skeletons.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)
Statement 4 is wrong: Mound 7 has 56 skeletons. Rakhigarhi (Hisar) is the largest site, Bhirrana the oldest, and the June 2026 dig found five complete skeletons and three fragmentary burials.

50. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The Rakhigarhi DNA study has been read as a challenge to the Aryan-invasion view.
Reason (R): The ~4,600-year-old female skeleton lacked the "Steppe Pastoralist" gene.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the absence of the Steppe Pastoralist gene was read as indigenous ancestry, which is why the result challenges the Aryan-invasion view.

51. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT one of the five largest Harappan cities?

a. Ganweriwala
b. Rakhigarhi
c. Dholavira
d. Lothal

Answer: (d)
The five largest are Mohenjodaro, Harappa, Ganweriwala, Rakhigarhi and Dholavira; Lothal was a small port town.

52. [Kept own]
Which was the first Harappan site excavated after Independence?

a. Ropar
b. Kalibangan
c. Lothal
d. Surkotada

Answer: (a)
Ropar, dug by Y.D. Sharma in 1955-56, was the first site excavated after Independence.

53. [Kept own]
How many complete skeletons were found in the Rakhigarhi excavation reported in June 2026?

a. Three
b. Five
c. Seven
d. Fifty-six

Answer: (b)
The June 2026 dig found five complete skeletons (aged 30-40) and three fragmentary burials.

54. [Kept own]
In which year was Mohenjodaro inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site?

a. 1972
b. 1980
c. 1993
d. 2021

Answer: (b)
Mohenjodaro (Pakistan) was inscribed in 1980; Dholavira in India followed in 2021.

Row 8: Ivc Economy – Agriculture, Crops, Animals, Crafts, Trade, Seals, Weights, Meluhha

1. Metals and Raw Materials → Source (PYQs 6 · MCQs 9)

- **Copper = the first metal used by man** (not iron, bronze, gold or silver); chalcolithic cultures began with it (APPSC G2 2011, RAS 2012).
- Harappans used **copper, bronze, gold, silver, lead**; **iron NOT found** at any Harappan site (CGPSC 2011) – a Bronze Age culture.
- **Bronze = copper + tin**; tools, weapons and the **Dancing Girl** (lost-wax casting). Pure copper objects far outnumber bronze ones.
- Harappans **pioneered silver** use; silver imported (Afghanistan).

Material	Source
Copper	Khetri mines (Rajasthan); also Oman (Magan)
Tin	Afghanistan, Iran
Gold	Karnataka (Kolar), Afghanistan
Lapis lazuli	Badakhshan via Shortughai (Afghanistan)
Carnelian	Bharuch / Saurashtra (Gujarat)
Steatite	South Rajasthan, north Gujarat
Chert, limestone (blades)	Sukkur and Rohri hills (Sindh) – mass-produced blades for Sindh (CDS 2020); not Khetri
Shells	Saurashtra coast, Nageshwar, Balakot

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.63, p.67, p.88-90; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.5; old app notes row 8

1. [PYQ] · Indian History previous paper (header not legible)

From where did Harappan people obtain copper, which was widely used by them?

a. Afghanistan
b. Mesopotamia
c. Khetri Mines
d. Karnataka

Answer: (c)

The Harappans got most of their copper from the Khetri mines of Rajasthan (also from Oman). Afghanistan supplied tin, silver and lapis lazuli; Mesopotamia was a trade partner, not the copper source.

2. [PYQ] · Hostel Welfare Officer Grade-II (Male & Female) in A.P BC We

The first metal that was used by humans for making implements was?

a. Iron
b. Bronze
c. Gold
d. Copper

Answer: (d)

Copper was the first metal used by humans for tools (chalcolithic stage). Bronze is a later copper-tin alloy and iron came much later.

3. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

Which was the first metal to be used by man?

a. Bronze
b. Tin
c. Iron
d. Copper

Answer: (d)

Copper was the first metal used by man. Bronze is an alloy of copper and tin, and iron came much later.

4. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2012

The first metal used by man was :

a. Gold
b. Silver
c. Copper
d. Iron

Answer: (c)
Copper was the first metal used by humans for implements; gold was known early only as ornament, and silver and iron came later.

5. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Which metal has so far not been discovered in Harappan sites?

a. Copper
b. Gold
c. Silver
d. Iron

Answer: (d)
The Harappan civilisation was a Bronze Age culture: gold, silver and copper are found, but no iron has been found at any Harappan site.

6. [PYQ] · CDS 2020

From which one of the following factory sites were limestone and chert blades mass produced and sent to various Harappan settlement in Sindh?

a. Sukkur and Rohri Hills
b. Khetri in Rajasthan
c. Chagai Hills
d. Hills of Baluchistan

Answer: (a)
Limestone and chert blades were mass-produced at the Sukkur and Rohri hills in Sindh. Khetri was the copper source, not a chert source.

7. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Raw material) with List-II (Source):
List-I
A. Tin
B. Gold
C. Lapis lazuli
D. Carnelian
List-II
i. Badakhshan, via Shortughai
ii. Bharuch / Saurashtra
iii. Kolar (Karnataka)
iv. Afghanistan and Iran
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii
b. A-iv, B-iii, C-ii, D-i
c. A-i, B-ii, C-iv, D-iii
d. A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii

Answer: (d)
Tin – Afghanistan and Iran, gold – Kolar (also Afghanistan), lapis lazuli – Badakhshan via Shortughai (Afghanistan), carnelian – Bharuch / Saurashtra: A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii.

8. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan metallurgy:
1. The Harappans pioneered the use of silver, which they imported.
2. Bronze was made by alloying copper with tin.
3. Bronze objects far outnumber pure copper objects.
4. The Dancing Girl was cast by the lost-wax process.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only three
b. Only one
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (a)
Statement 3 is wrong: pure copper objects far outnumber bronze ones. Bronze = copper + tin, silver was pioneered (imported from Afghanistan) and the Dancing Girl is a lost-wax casting.

9. [Kept own]
From where did the Harappans obtain lapis lazuli?

a. Kolar
b. Khetri
c. Badakhshan
d. Oman

Answer: (c)
Lapis lazuli came from Badakhshan through Shortughai; copper came from Khetri and Oman and gold from Kolar.

2. Earliest Agriculture – Mehrgarh and the First Cereal (PYQs 4 · MCQs 7)

First	Site / fact
Earliest agriculture and animal domestication in the subcontinent	Mehrgarh (Kachhi plain, Baluchistan), c. 7000 BC – not Lothal, Harappa, Mundigak, Koldihwa, Kili Gul Muhammad
First farmers' crops	Mainly barley, also wheat; sheep, goats, cattle
First cereal used by man	Barley (c. 8000 BC)
Early Baluchistan farming villages	Kili Gul Muhammad (c. 5000–4000 BC), Damb Sadaat, Anjira, Rana Ghundai
First agriculture per latest research; oldest paddy	Lahuradeva (Sant Kabir Nagar, UP)
Once thought oldest paddy	Koldihwa (Belan valley, UP)
Rice and cattle pens (not barley)	Mahagara
Earliest iron in India	Atranjikhera (Kali river); dug by R.C. Gaur (1962)

- Mehrgarh (7th–3rd millennium BCE) is the neolithic root of the Harappan civilisation; similar villages at Mundigak (Afghanistan).
- Iron spread in North India 1000–600 BC (Later Vedic).

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.78; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.1, p.5; old app notes row 8

10. [PYQ] · U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004 +1 more
The earliest evidence of agriculture in Indian subcontinent comes from –

a. Koldihwa
b. Lahuradeva
c. Mehrgarh
d. Tokwa

Answer: (c)
Mehrgarh (Baluchistan) is the earliest farming settlement in the Indian subcontinent, about 7000 BCE. Koldihwa and Lahuradeva are Ganga-valley rice sites and Tokwa is later.

11. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997
The first cereal used by man was :

a. Wheat
b. Rice
c. Barley
d. Sorghum

Answer: (c)
Barley was the first cereal cultivated and used by man (Near East, c. 8000 BC); the first farmers of Mehrgarh also grew mainly barley. Wheat came alongside, rice and sorghum much later.

12. [PYQ] · U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre.) 2021
The earliest evidence of animal domestication and agriculture in India has come from

a. Anjira
b. Damb Sadat
c. Kili Gul Muhammad
d. Mehrgarh

Answer: (d)
Mehrgarh (Kachhi plain, Baluchistan, c. 7000 BC) gives the earliest evidence of both agriculture and animal domestication. Kili Gul Muhammad, Damb Sadaat and Anjira are later (5th-4th millennium BC) Baluchistan farming villages, so the printed key is wrong.

13. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

The earliest evidence of Agriculture in Indian subcontinent is found at

a. Lothal
b. Harappa
c. Mehrgarh
d. Mundigak

Answer: (c)

Mehrgarh (Kachhi plains, Balochistan, c. 7000 BC) gives the earliest settled life and agriculture in the subcontinent; Lothal and Harappa are later Harappan sites and Mundigak is in Afghanistan.

14. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about early farming sites:
1. Koldihwa in the Belan valley was once thought to have the oldest paddy.
2. Mahagara is known for early barley cultivation.
3. Lahuradeva (UP) has the oldest paddy according to the latest research.
4. Kili Gul Muhammad (c. 5000–4000 BC) is an early farming village of Baluchistan.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)

Statement 2 is wrong: Mahagara is known for rice and cattle pens, not barley. Kili Gul Muhammad, Lahuradeva (oldest paddy) and Koldihwa (once thought oldest) are correct.

15. [Kept own]

Assertion (A): Iron spread in North India between 1000 and 600 BC.
Reason (R): The Iron Age in India is associated with the Later Vedic period, around 1000 BC.

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (b)

Both are true but R does not explain A: iron spread in North India during 1000–600 BC, and the Iron Age began in the Later Vedic period. R gives the start date, not the reason for the spread.

16. [Kept own]

Where has the earliest evidence of iron in India been found?

a. Mehrgarh
b. Kalibangan
c. Atranjikhera
d. Lothal

Answer: (c)

The earliest iron in India is from Atranjikhera on the Kali river, dug by R.C. Gaur in 1962.

3. Agriculture, Crops and Cotton (PYQs 4 · MCQs 13)

- **Main occupation = agriculture** (not trade or hunting); surplus stored in granaries fed the cities.

Crop	Site of evidence
Wheat (largest finds)	Harappa; Mehrgarh
Barley	Banawali
Rice husk (earliest in South Asia)	Lothal, Rangpur
Millets and rice as staple	Rangpur, Surkotada
Cotton	Mohenjodaro (woven cotton piece); Mehrgarh
Garlic (earliest)	Balu (Haryana)
Indigo	Rojdi

- Also: peas, lentil, chickpea, **sesame**, **mustard**, dates, melon, grapes, henna.
- **Cotton:** the Harappans were the **first to grow cotton** and make cotton cloth → "India" and "cotton" are the answers (UPPSC 2006, SSC 2001); Greeks called it **Sindon** (from Sindh). Not coins – the IVC had no coins.
- **Maize** came with the Portuguese. Rig Vedic economy was pastoral.

Plough and irrigation

Evidence	Site

Earliest ploughed field (cross furrows, two crops together)	Kalibangan (early Harappan level)
Terracotta plough model	Banawali, Cholistan (Bahawalpur)
Clay plough	Rakhigarhi
Traces of canals	Shortughai (Afghanistan)
Well irrigation	Allahdino (Sindh)
Reservoirs	Dholavira

- **Wooden ploughs**; flood irrigation; canal irrigation inconclusive in Punjab/Sindh; double cropping.

  ~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.86-87; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.5; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.18-26; old app notes row 8

17. [PYQ] · SSC 2001

What was the main business of IVC's people?

a. Business
b. Animal Husbandry
c. Hunting
d. Agriculture

Answer: (d)
Agriculture was the economic base of the Harappans: the surplus stored in granaries supported trade, crafts and the cities; trade was secondary.

18. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2006

For clothing, cotton cultivation was first introduced in

a. Egypt
b. Mesopotamia
c. Central America
d. India

Answer: (d)
The Harappans in India were the first to cultivate cotton and weave cotton cloth (the Greeks called it sindon, from Sindh), so India is the answer, not Egypt or Mesopotamia.

19. [PYQ] · SSC 2001

Harappan people were first in which production?

a. Coins
b. Cotton
c. Copper tools
d. Wheat

Answer: (b)
The Harappans were the first to produce cotton and make cotton textiles. They had no coins, and copper tools and wheat were known earlier elsewhere.

20. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ

The traces of the cultivation In Harappan Culture were found at:

a. Kalibangan and Ropar
b. Lothal and Rangapur
c. Chanhudaro and Khetri
d. Mohenjo Daro

Answer: (b)
Rice husks – the trace of rice cultivation – were found at Lothal and Rangpur; Kalibangan has a ploughed field, but Ropar gives no cultivation evidence, so Lothal and Rangpur is the pair.

21. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Crop) with List-II (Site of evidence):
List-I
A. Wheat (largest finds)
B. Garlic (earliest)
C. Indigo
D. Barley
List-II
i. Rojdi
ii. Balu
iii. Banawali
iv. Harappa
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii
b. A-iv, B-ii, C-iii, D-i
c. A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
d. A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii

Answer: (c)
Wheat – Harappa, garlic – Balu (Haryana), indigo – Rojdi, barley – Banawali: A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii. Garlic is not from Lothal or Rangpur, which gave rice husk.

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan crops:
1. A woven cotton piece was found at Mohenjodaro.
2. The earliest rice cultivation comes from Chanhudaro.
3. Rice husk from Lothal and Rangpur is the earliest in South Asia.
4. Millets and rice were staples at Rangpur and Surkotada.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All four
d. Only three

Answer: (d)
Statement 2 is wrong: the earliest rice evidence is from Lothal and Rangpur, not Chanhudaro. Millets/rice at Rangpur and Surkotada and the Mohenjodaro cotton piece are correct.

23. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Harappans were the first to grow cotton, which the Greeks called Sindon.
2. Maize was a Harappan crop.
3. Sesame and mustard were among Harappan crops.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 2 is wrong: maize came with the Portuguese. Cotton (Sindon, from Sindh), sesame and mustard are correct.

24. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Evidence) with List-II (Site):
List-I
A. Terracotta plough model
B. Well irrigation
C. Traces of canals
D. Clay plough
List-II
i. Allahdino
ii. Rakhigarhi
iii. Banawali
iv. Shortughai
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-ii, B-i, C-iv, D-iii
b. A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii
c. A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii
d. A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-iv

Answer: (b)
Terracotta plough model – Banawali (also Cholistan), well irrigation – Allahdino (Sindh), canal traces – Shortughai (Afghanistan), clay plough – Rakhigarhi: A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii.

25. [New pattern · assertion]
Assertion (A): Harappan farmers practised double cropping.
Reason (R): Canal irrigation is fully proved for Harappan Punjab and Sindh.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (c)
A is true but R is false: the notes record double cropping with wooden ploughs and flood irrigation, but canal irrigation in Punjab/Sindh is inconclusive.

26. [Kept own]
Which one of the following statements about the Rig Vedic economy is correct?

a. It was primarily urban and based on maritime trade.
b. It was dominated by specialised craft production in port cities.
c. It was based mainly on intensive rice cultivation and standardised weights.
d. It was primarily pastoral, and cotton, rice and wheat are not mentioned in the Rig Veda.

Answer: (d)
The Rig Vedic economy was pastoral, and cotton, rice and wheat are not mentioned in the Rig Veda.

27. [Kept own]
Which Harappan crop was connected with textiles and trade?

a. Maize
b. Jute
c. Cotton
d. Indigo

Answer: (c)
Cotton was the Harappan textile crop; maize was unknown in India until the Portuguese brought it.

28. [Kept own]
From which site does the earliest evidence of garlic come?

a. Balu
b. Rojdi
c. Rangpur
d. Lothal

Answer: (a)
The earliest garlic is from Balu in Haryana; Rojdi is linked with indigo.

29. [Kept own]
Which crop, unknown to the Harappans, was brought to India by the Portuguese?

a. Sesame
b. Barley
c. Maize
d. Mustard

Answer: (c)
Maize came to India with the Portuguese; it was unknown in India before.

4. Animals – Known and Unknown (PYQs 2 · MCQs 4)

Status	Animals
Domesticated	Humped bull (zebu, favoured), oxen, buffalo, sheep, goat, pig, dog, cat, ass, camel, elephant
Wild but known	Elephant, tiger, rhinoceros, deer, gharial
Not established	Horse – no bones or images in early and mature levels; only doubtful finds (superficial level at Mohenjodaro, Lothal terracotta, Surkotada bones)
Never found	Lion – no remains and not on seals
Remains → site	Camel bones = Kalibangan; dog with human = Ropar; rhinoceros = Amri; copper rhino and elephant = Daimabad

- "Animal **not known** to the IVC" = **Horse** (BPSC accepted b); "remains not discovered" with lion in the options = **Lion** (CGPSC 2011).

  ~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.87, p.96; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.5, p.14; old app notes row 8

30. [PYQ] · State PSC
Which of the following animals was not known to the people of the Indus Valley Civilization?

a. Bull
b. Horse
c. Elephant
d. None of the above

Answer: (b)
The horse is the animal not known to the Harappans: no horse bones or images occur in early and mature levels, and the Surkotada and Lothal finds are doubtful. Bull and elephant are well attested (BPSC accepted b).

31. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011
Remains of which animal have not been discovered in the Indus Valley Civilization?

a. Lion
b. Horse
c. Cow
d. Elephant

Answer: (a)
No lion remains or images have been found in the IVC. Elephant and cattle remains are attested and horse evidence is doubtful, so lion is the safe answer.

32. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements about animals in the IVC:
1. Horse bones are well established in the early and mature levels.
2. Copper figures of a rhinoceros and an elephant come from Daimabad.
3. Camel bones have been found at Kalibangan.
4. The humped bull (zebu) was the favoured domestic animal.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)
Statement 1 is wrong: the horse is not established – no bones or images in the early and mature levels, only doubtful finds. The zebu, Kalibangan camel bones and the Daimabad copper rhino and elephant are correct.

33. [Kept own]
At which site were copper figures of a rhinoceros and an elephant found?

a. Daimabad
b. Ropar
c. Kalibangan
d. Lothal

Answer: (a)
Copper rhinoceros and elephant figures come from Daimabad.

5. Crafts, Industries and Standardisation (PYQs 2 · MCQs 6)

Craft	Centre
Bead-making (carnelian, steatite, lapis)	Chanhudaro, Lothal
Shell work	Nageshwar, Balakot (specialised), Lothal, Chanhudaro
Black terracotta bangles	Kalibangan
Spinning, weaving	Mohenjodaro; Chanhudaro = "Lancashire of India"; Lothal = "Manchester of the Harappan civilisation"
Ivory, copper, bead workshops	Kuntasi
Salt	Kerala-no-dhoro
Earliest furnace	Kot Bala

- **Chanhudaro** was almost wholly a craft town: beads, shell, metal, seals, weights.

- **Spindle-whorls** common in houses; **no spinning wheel** found (UPSC 2026).
- **Boat models:** Mohenjodaro (boat on seals) and Lothal (clay boats, terracotta ship).
- **Kenoyer:** the amazing **standardisation** of crafts (using non-local raw materials and complex technology) was possibly due to **state control** (NDA 2015); others add hereditary craft groups and internal trade.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.88-89, p.101; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.12-13; https://byjus.com/question-answer/harappan-crafts-display-an-amazing-degree-of-standardization-according-to-kenoyer-what-was-the-possible; old app notes row 8

34. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

From which archaeological site of Indus Valley Civilization, the figures or models of boat are found?

a. Harappa and Kot Diji
b. Kalibangan and Ropar
c. Dhaulabira and Bhagatray
d. Mohenjodaro and Lothal

Answer: (d)
A terracotta boat model came from Lothal and boats are depicted on Mohenjodaro seals.

35. [PYQ] · NDA 2015

Harappan craft display an amazing degree of standardisation according to Kenoyer, what was the possible reason for such an achievement?

a. Availability of raw materials at local level
b. Centralised market for craft
c. Specialised training centres for craftmen
d. State control

Answer: (d)
Kenoyer suggested that state control may explain the high standardisation of crafts that used non-local raw materials and complex technologies. Local raw materials or training centres are not his explanation.

36. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Craft evidence) with List-II (Site):
List-I
A. Ivory, copper and bead workshops
B. Salt production
C. Earliest furnace
D. Black terracotta bangles
List-II
i. Kalibangan
ii. Kerala-no-dhoro
iii. Kuntasi
iv. Kot Bala
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-ii, B-iii, C-iv, D-i
b. A-iii, B-ii, C-i, D-iv
c. A-i, B-iv, C-ii, D-iii
d. A-iii, B-ii, C-iv, D-i

Answer: (d)
Ivory, copper and bead workshops – Kuntasi, salt – Kerala-no-dhoro, earliest furnace – Kot Bala, black terracotta bangles – Kalibangan: A-iii, B-ii, C-iv, D-i.

37. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan crafts:
1. Chanhudaro is called the "Lancashire of India" and Lothal the "Manchester of the Harappan civilisation".
2. Chanhudaro, almost wholly a craft town, was a major bead-making centre.
3. Specialised shell work was concentrated at Rangpur and Rojdi.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 3 is wrong: specialised shell work was at Nageshwar and Balakot (also Lothal and Chanhudaro). Chanhudaro's bead-making and the Lancashire/Manchester names are correct.

38. [Kept own]

Chanhudaro is described as the ‘Lancashire of India’ mainly because of its association with which activity?

a. Large-scale canal irrigation
b. Gold mining
c. Cotton spinning and weaving
d. Rice cultivation

Answer: (c)
Chanhudaro was associated with cotton spinning and weaving and is therefore described as the ‘Lancashire of India’.

39. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Harappan spinning:
1. Spindle-whorls are commonly found in houses.
2. A spinning wheel has been found at Harappan sites.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
Spindle-whorls are common in houses, but no spinning wheel has been found.

6. External Trade – Meluhha and Mesopotamia (PYQs 1 · MCQs 7)

Mesopotamian name	Region
Meluhha	Indus (Harappan) region
Dilmun	Bahrain
Magan	Oman (Makran coast)

- **Closest external contact = Mesopotamia** (not Egypt): Harappan seals at **Susa, Ur, Nippur**, Failaka, Bahrain; three Mesopotamian cylinder seals at Mohenjodaro; Dilmun weights followed the Harappan standard.
- **Sargon of Akkad** (c. 2300 BCE) records ships from Meluhha.
- **Exports:** carnelian beads, lapis lazuli, ivory, timber, cotton, copper, gold. **Imports:** silver, tin, woollens.
- Contacts also with Altyn-depe (Turkmenistan), Shahr-i-Sokhta and Tepe Yahya (Iran); network across the Arabian Sea and Persian Gulf.
- **Nov 2025:** a second **Dilmun temple** (c. 1900–1800 BCE) found on **Failaka**, Kuwait.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.90-92; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.3, p.6; old app notes row 8

40. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Harappan people had close external contact with:

a. Iran
b. Egypt
c. Bahrain
d. Mesopotamia

Answer: (d)
Mesopotamia was the Harappans' closest external contact: Harappan seals at Ur, Susa and Nippur, and Mesopotamian texts naming Meluhha. Bahrain (Dilmun) was only an intermediate station and Egypt shows no Harappan finds.

41. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan contacts with West Asia:
1. Mesopotamian records call the Indus region Meluhha, and Magan is Oman.
2. Harappan seals have been found at Susa, Ur and Nippur.
3. Sargon of Akkad (c. 2300 BCE) records ships from Meluhha.
4. The closest external contact of the Harappans was with Egypt.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)
Statement 4 is wrong: the closest contact was with Mesopotamia, not Egypt. Meluhha/Magan (Dilmun = Bahrain), Sargon's ships from Meluhha and the seals at Susa, Ur and Nippur are correct.

42. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan foreign trade:
1. Silver and tin were imported.
2. Woollens were exported.
3. Carnelian beads, lapis lazuli and timber were exported.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Statement 2 is wrong: woollens were IMPORTED, with silver and tin. Carnelian beads, lapis lazuli, ivory, timber, cotton, copper and gold were exports.

43. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Dilmun weights followed the Harappan standard.
2. The Harappans had contacts with Altyn-depe in Turkmenistan.
3. In November 2025 a second Dilmun temple (c. 1900–1800 BCE) was found on Failaka, Kuwait.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)
All three are correct: the second Dilmun temple on Failaka (Nov 2025), Dilmun weights on the Harappan standard, and contacts with Altyn-depe (also Shahr-i-Sokhta and Tepe Yahya).

44. [Kept own]

What do the records of Sargon of Akkad (c. 2300 BCE) mention?

a. Iron tools from Dilmun
b. Horse trade from Magan
c. Ships from Meluhha
d. Gold mines in Saurashtra

Answer: (c)
Records of Sargon of Akkad, around 2300 BCE, mention ships coming from Meluhha, the Indus region.

45. [Kept own]

Which region was called 'Dilmun' in Mesopotamian records?

a. Oman
b. The Indus region
c. Bahrain
d. Makran

Answer: (c)
Dilmun was Bahrain; Meluhha was the Indus region and Magan was Oman or Makran.

46. [Kept own]

What is the principal significance of the Persian Gulf-type seal found at Lothal?

a. It proves that Lothal was the capital of the Mauryas.
b. It confirms direct contact with Bahrain and Mesopotamia.
c. It establishes that Lothal had no overseas trade.
d. It indicates that seals were used only for religious ceremonies.

Answer: (b)
The Persian Gulf-type seal at Lothal confirms direct contact between Lothal and Bahrain and Mesopotamia.

7. Internal Trade and Transport (PYQs 0 · MCQs 4)

- Trade by **barter**, no metal money; **bullock carts** (solid wheels) and **boats**. Reach: South India, UP, Maharashtra, Bihar, Rajasthan.
- **Harappa** = inland city on the Ravi, not a port; Harappa and Mohenjodaro had warehouses.

Port / outpost	Location
Lothal	Gulf of Khambhat, Gujarat – tidal dock
Sutkagendor	Makran coast, Baluchistan; westernmost
Balakot	Sindh coast; shells
Kuntasi, Bhagatrav, Prabhas Patan	Gujarat coast
Shortughai	Afghanistan – trading post for lapis

- Farm surplus + trade + crafts + standard weights → **urbanisation**.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.89-91, p.103; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.5; old app notes row 8

47. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan internal trade:
1. Kuntasi, Bhagatrav and Prabhas Patan were ports on the Gujarat coast.
2. Goods moved in bullock carts with spoked wheels.
3. It was carried on by barter, without metal money.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 2 is wrong: Harappan bullock carts had solid wheels. Barter trade and the Gujarat-coast ports Kuntasi, Bhagatrav and Prabhas Patan are correct.

48. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Harappa was the chief port of the Harappan Civilisation.
Reason (R): Harappa was an inland city on the Ravi.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (d)
A is false but R is true: Harappa (which had warehouses) was an inland city on the Ravi, not a port; the port was Lothal on the Gulf of Khambhat.

49. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Port / outpost) with List-II (Location / note):
List-I
A. Sutkagendor
B. Balakot
C. Shortughai
D. Lothal
List-II
i. Afghanistan – trading post for lapis lazuli
ii. Makran coast – westernmost site
iii. Gulf of Khambhat – tidal dock
iv. Sindh coast – shells
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
b. A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii
c. A-ii, B-iv, C-iii, D-i
d. A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-iv

Answer: (b)
Sutkagendor – Makran coast, westernmost; Balakot – Sindh coast, shells; Shortughai – Afghanistan, lapis trading post; Lothal – Gulf of Khambhat, tidal dock: A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii.

50. [Kept own]

Farm surplus, trade networks, craft specialisation and which of the following together created the conditions for Indus urbanisation?

a. iron tools
b. coined money
c. standard weights
d. horse transport

Answer: (c)
Farm surplus, trade networks, craft specialisation and standard weights together created the conditions for urbanisation.

Row 9: Ivc Seals, Weights and Measures, Harappan Script

1. Seals and Sealings – Uses and Value As A Source (PYQs 6 · MCQs 8)

- The seal is the **most distinctive artefact** of the IVC (APPSC FRO; APPSC GS 2024) – not megaliths, DNA or royal palaces.
- With the script unread, **seals** are the **main source** of knowledge about the Harappan people (RAS 1996); broadly, the culture is known only from **archaeological excavations** (UPPSC 1993) – no inscriptions read, no religious books.
- A **sealing** is the clay impression of a seal pressed on the knot of a package; an intact sealing proved the goods were untouched and named the sender.
- **Uses:** facilitating **long-distance communication** and trade (APPSC G1 → **seals and sealings**), authentication, **ownership**, amulets – **not coins**.
- **Uniform seals and weights** = main proof of **commercial and economic development** and regulated trade (SSC CPO 2002).

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.96; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.6; old app notes row 9

1. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 1993

Which of the following throw light on Harappan culture?

a. Inscription
b. Archaeological excavations
c. Handwriting seals on the utensils
d. Religious books

Answer: (b)

Harappan culture is known from archaeological excavations, since its script is unread and it has no religious books; seals found in digs are the main material, so excavation is the broad correct answer.

2. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1996

The main source of knowledge about the inhabitants of Indus Valley civilizations is the discovery of :

a. Seals
b. Utensils, Jewellery, weapons, tools
c. Temple
d. Scripts

Answer: (a)

Utensils, jewellery and tools were found, but seals are the main source of knowledge about the Indus people (their beliefs, animals and trade); no temple was found and the script is unread.

3. [PYQ] · SSC CPO 2002

Out of the following remains excavated in Indus Valley, which one indicates the commercial and economic development?

a. Pottery
b. Seals
c. Boats
d. Houses

Answer: (b)

Seals were used to seal trade goods and mark ownership, and uniform seals and weights prove regulated trade, so they indicate commercial and economic development; pottery and houses do not.

4. [PYQ] · RAS/RTS (Pre) 1996

The main source of knowledge about the inhabitants of Indus Valley Civilisations is the discovery os

a. seals
b. utensils, jewellery, weapons and tools
c. temple
d. scripts

Answer: (a)

Because the Indus script is undeciphered, seals are the main source of knowledge about the Indus people, their trade, art and beliefs.

5. [PYQ] · APPSC Forest Range Officer Mains Paper-I General Studies & M

One of the distinctive features of Indus Valley Civilization is in the form of

a. Megalith sites
b. Preservation of large amount of DNA
c. Seals
d. Royal palaces

Answer: (c)

Seals are the most distinctive artefact of the IVC. Megaliths belong to later South India, no royal palaces have been found, and DNA preservation is not a defining feature.

6. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Which of the following was mostly used to facilitate long distance communication by the inhabitants of Harappan Civilization?

a. Writing on palm leaves
b. Stone and rock tablets
c. Pigeons and parrots
d. Seals and sealings

Answer: (d)

Seals and sealings facilitated long-distance communication: an intact sealing on a package showed the goods were untouched and named the sender. Palm leaves and stone tablets were not used.

7. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan seals and sealings:
1. Seals were also used as coins.
2. A sealing is the clay impression of a seal pressed on the knot of a package.
3. An intact sealing showed that the goods were untouched and named the sender.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

Statement 1 is wrong: seals served communication, trade, authentication, ownership and as amulets – NOT as coins (the IVC had no coins). Statements 2 and 3 describe sealings correctly.

8. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. Seals are a distinctive feature of the Indus Valley Civilisation.
2. As the Harappan script has been deciphered, seals are only a minor source on Harappan life.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

Statement 1 is correct. Statement 2 is wrong: the script is still undeciphered, so seals are the main source on the people.

2. Seal Motifs and Famous Seals (PYQs 5 · MCQs 12)

Shown on seals / terracotta	Not shown
Unicorn (most common), humped bull (best artwork), bull, buffalo, elephant, tiger, rhinoceros, bison, goat, antelope, gharial	Cow, horse, lion, camel (PMF memory aid "HoLiCa")

- "Animal **not** on seals and terracotta" with cow in the options = **Cow** (UPSC 2001); with horse = **Horse** (UPPCS 2009); lion is never shown either.
- **Pipal** = the tree most commonly depicted on seals.
- **Pashupati seal** (Mohenjodaro, steatite): three-faced horned figure in yogic posture ringed by **elephant, tiger, rhinoceros and buffalo**, two deer below.

Seal	Site
Pashupati seal	Mohenjodaro
Famous (humped) bull seal	Mohenjodaro (Rocket; old notes) – printed keys often say Harappa
Unicorn seal, first seal found (Cunningham, 1872–75)	Harappa
Seal with unicorn + script	Nippur (Mesopotamia)
Mesopotamian-type cylinder seals	Mohenjodaro, Kalibangan
Button / Persian Gulf-type seal	Lothal

- **Jun 2026:** cylindrical **steatite** seal at **Rakhigarhi** – **alligator motif** and **five** Harappan characters; chert weights also found.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.96, p.108; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.19; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.6-7; old app notes row 9

9. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2001

Which one of the following animals was not represented on the seals and terracotta art of the Harappan culture?

a. Cow
b. Elephant
c. Rhinoceros
d. Tiger

Answer: (a)
Elephant, rhinoceros and tiger appear on Harappan seals and terracottas (the Pashupati seal shows elephant, tiger, rhinoceros and buffalo), but the cow is never depicted.

10. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2009

Which one of the following animals is not depicted on the Harappan seal ?

a. Bull
b. Elephant
c. Horse
d. Sheep

Answer: (c)
The horse is not depicted on any Harappan seal, while bull, elephant and sheep/goat figures do appear (the unicorn is the commonest motif).

11. [PYQ] · BPSC 2008

One of the following sites from where the famous Bull-seal of Indus Valley Civilisation was found

a. Harappa
b. Chanhudaro
c. Lothal
d. Mohenjodaro

Answer: (d)
The famous humped (zebu) bull seal comes from Mohenjodaro, alongside the Pashupati seal. Some coaching keys print Harappa, where Cunningham found an early humpless-bull seal, but the famous bull seal is Mohenjodaro's.

12. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2001

Which one of the following animals was NOT represented on the seals and terracotta art of the Harappan culture?

a. Cow
b. Elephant
c. Rhinoceros
d. Tiger

Answer: (a)
Elephant, rhinoceros, tiger, buffalo and the unicorn appear on Harappan seals and terracottas, but the cow is notably absent.

13. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2008

One of the following sites from where the famous bull-seal of Indus Valley Civilization was found-

a. Harappa
b. Chanhudaro
c. Lothal
d. Mohenjodaro

Answer: (d)
The famous humped-bull seal (with the Pashupati seal) comes from Mohenjodaro.

14. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Pashupati seal:
1. The seated figure is ringed by an elephant, a tiger, a rhinoceros and a buffalo.
2. Two deer are shown below the figure.
3. It was found at Mohenjodaro and is made of steatite.
4. A lion stands beside the figure.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All four
d. Only three

Answer: (d)
Statement 4 is wrong: the lion is never shown on Harappan seals. The Mohenjodaro steatite seal shows a three-faced horned figure ringed by elephant, tiger, rhinoceros and buffalo, with two deer below.

15. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Seal) with List-II (Find-spot):
List-I
A. Unicorn seal, the first seal found (Cunningham)
B. Seal with a unicorn and script, found abroad
C. Button (Persian Gulf-type) seal
D. Mesopotamian-type cylinder seals
List-II
i. Lothal
ii. Mohenjodaro and Kalibangan
iii. Nippur
iv. Harappa
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii
b. A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii
c. A-iv, B-iii, C-ii, D-i
d. A-ii, B-i, C-iii, D-iv

Answer: (a)
First (unicorn) seal – Harappa (Cunningham, 1872–75), unicorn + script seal – Nippur (Mesopotamia), Persian Gulf button seal – Lothal, cylinder seals – Mohenjodaro and Kalibangan: A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii.

16. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. The cylindrical steatite seal found at Rakhigarhi in June 2026 carries a tiger motif and ten Harappan characters.
2. The unicorn is the most common motif on Harappan seals.
3. The pipal is the tree most commonly depicted on seals.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
Statement 1 is wrong: the June 2026 Rakhigarhi seal has an ALLIGATOR motif and FIVE characters. The unicorn (commonest motif) and pipal (commonest tree) are correct.

17. [Kept own]

Which tree is most commonly depicted on Harappan seals?

a. Pipal
b. Banyan
c. Neem
d. Mango

Answer: (a)
The pipal is the most depicted tree, while the unicorn is the most common seal motif.

18. [Kept own]

On the Pashupati seal, which animal is shown below the seated figure?

a. Elephant
b. Deer
c. Tiger
d. Buffalo

Answer: (b)
The Pashupati figure is ringed by an elephant, tiger, rhinoceros and buffalo, with deer below.

19. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about animals on Harappan seals:
1. The unicorn is the most common motif.
2. The cow is frequently shown.
3. The rhinoceros is depicted.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
The unicorn is the commonest motif and the rhinoceros is shown; the cow is never depicted.

20. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements about Indus seals:
1. They were commonly carved from steatite.
2. Their motifs included animals and the Pashupati figure.
3. Short lines of script were also present on them.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)
Indus seals were commonly made of steatite, displayed animal and Pashupati motifs, and carried short script lines.

3. Weights and Measures (PYQs 3 · MCQs 7)

- Weights mostly **chert** (also limestone, steatite), **cubical** (not spherical), no markings.

Denomination	System
Lower	Binary: 1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64
Higher	Decimal multiples: 160, 320, 640, 1600, 3200

- Unit weight about **13.63 g**; "16" ratio (16 annas = 1 rupee tradition).
- Same weights over about **8,00,000 sq km** → **central regulation** of trade; Dilmun weights followed this standard.

Scale	Site	Unit
Ivory scale	Lothal (APPSC G2 2011)	Smallest division ~1.70 mm
Shell scale	Mohenjodaro	~6.7 mm
Copper scale	Harappa	–

- Foot ≈ 37.6 cm; cubit 51.8–53.6 cm. Ivory weight balance at Mohenjodaro and Lothal.

> Ivory = Lothal; shell = Mohenjodaro; copper = Harappa.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.95; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.9; old app notes row 9

21. [PYQ] · U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014
An ivory scale in Harappan context was found at –

a. Kalibangan
b. Lothal
c. Dholavira
d. Banawali

Answer: (b)
An ivory scale was found at Lothal; a shell scale came from Mohenjodaro.

22. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ
The measuring scale found at an Indus site is at

a. Harappa
b. Mohenjodaro
c. Kot Diji
d. Lothal

Answer: (d)
The ivory measuring scale was found at Lothal (a shell scale is also known from Mohenjodaro, but the classic answer is Lothal).

23. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011
Which Indus Valley City a scale has been discovered?

a. Chennudaro
b. Surkodede
c. Lothal
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (c)
An ivory scale was discovered at Lothal.

24. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan weights:
1. Lower denominations were binary (1, 2, 4 ... 64) and higher ones decimal multiples.
2. They were mostly of chert, cubical in shape and carried no markings.
3. The unit weight was about 136.3 g.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 3 is wrong: the unit weight was about 13.63 g. Chert cubical unmarked weights and the binary-then-decimal system are correct.

25. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Harappan trade appears to have been centrally regulated.
Reason (R): Identical weights are found over about 8,00,000 sq km.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the same weights over about 8,00,000 sq km (Dilmun too followed the standard) point to central regulation of trade.

26. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan measuring scales:
1. The copper scale was found at Lothal.
2. The ivory scale of Lothal has a smallest division of about 1.70 mm.
3. The shell scale of Mohenjodaro has a unit of about 6.7 mm.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 and 3 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 1 is wrong: the copper scale is from Harappa (ivory = Lothal, shell = Mohenjodaro, copper = Harappa). The 1.70 mm and 6.7 mm units are correct.

27. [Kept own]

What is the approximate unit of the shell scale of Mohenjodaro?

a. 1.70 mm
b. 6.7 mm
c. 13.63 mm
d. 46 mm

Answer: (b)
The shell scale from Mohenjodaro has a unit of about 6.7 mm.

4. Seals – Material and Shape (PYQs 0 · MCQs 4)

- Mostly **steatite (soapstone)** – easy to carve; also agate, chert, copper, faience, terracotta, ivory.
- Standard seal: **square** plaque about 2 × 2 inches of steatite.

Shape	Feature / site
Square	Animal motif + inscription
Rectangular	Inscription only
Mesopotamian-type cylinder	Rare; Mohenjodaro, Kalibangan
Button seal, Persian Gulf-type	Lothal

> Cylinder seals are Mesopotamian-type and rare; the normal Harappan seal is square steatite.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.96; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.6; old app notes row 9

28. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Seal shape) with List-II (Feature):
List-I
A. Square
B. Rectangular
C. Mesopotamian-type cylinder
D. Button seal
List-II
i. Animal motif with inscription
ii. Rare; Mohenjodaro, Kalibangan
iii. Persian Gulf type, Lothal
iv. Inscription only
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iv, B-i, C-ii, D-iii
b. A-i, B-iv, C-iii, D-ii
c. A-i, B-iv, C-ii, D-iii
d. A-ii, B-iii, C-i, D-iv

Answer: (c)

Square – animal motif with inscription (the standard ~2 × 2 inch steatite seal), rectangular – inscription only, cylinder – rare (Mohenjodaro, Kalibangan), button – Persian Gulf type at Lothal: A-i, B-iv, C-ii, D-iii.

29. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Most Harappan seals were made of steatite.
Reason (R): Steatite (soapstone) is easy to carve.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)

Both are true and R explains A: seals were mostly of steatite because soapstone is easy to carve (agate, chert, copper, faience, terracotta and ivory were also used).

30. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT correct about Harappan seals?

a. Mesopotamian-type cylinder seals were common at all sites.
b. Rectangular seals generally carry only an inscription.
c. Square seals generally carry an animal figure with an inscription.
d. Most seals were made of steatite.

Answer: (a)

Mesopotamian-type cylinder seals were rare, not common, at Harappan sites.

31. [Kept own]

Besides steatite, which material was also used for Harappan seals?

a. Iron
b. Glass
c. Terracotta
d. Marble

Answer: (c)

Seals were mostly of steatite, but also of terracotta, copper and ivory.

5. Harappan Script – Features (PYQs 0 · MCQs 9)

Feature	Fact
Nature	Mostly pictographic (not alphabetic); fish = commonest sign
Direction	Right to left; some boustrophedon (Kalibangan)
Number of signs	About 375–400 (estimates 62 to 676)
Average / longest inscription	About 5 / 26 signs
Corpus	About 5,000 inscribed objects (≈3,500 seals)
Found on	Seals, tablets, pottery, copper tools, bone rods, jewellery, a signboard
Status	Undeciphered

- First noticed 1853; seals with unknown symbols reported by **J. Fleet, 1912**.
- Unread because **no bilingual text** (like the **Rosetta Stone**) has been found and the language is unknown.
- **Dholavira signboard: ten large signs** near the **North Gate** – largest Harappan letters; Dholavira dug by **R.S. Bisht, 1990**.

Decipherment views

Hypothesis	Scholar
Proto-Dravidian (most supported)	Iravatham Mahadevan, Asko Parpola, Father Heras
Indo-Aryan (ancestor of Sanskrit)	S.R. Rao (minority view)
Not a language script (tax / trade marks)	Bahata Ansumali Mukhopadhyay

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.92-95; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.1, p.7; old app notes row 9

32. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Harappan script:
1. An average inscription has about 5 signs and the longest about 26.
2. Boustrophedon writing is reported from Kalibangan.
3. About 50,000 inscribed objects are known.
4. It is mostly pictographic and the fish is the commonest sign.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is wrong: about 5,000 inscribed objects (≈3,500 seals) are known. The pictographic nature (fish commonest), Kalibangan boustrophedon and the 5 / 26 sign lengths are correct.

33. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The Harappan script remains undeciphered.
Reason (R): The script was mostly written from right to left.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (b)
Both are true but R does not explain A: the script is unread because no bilingual text (like the Rosetta Stone) has been found and the language is unknown; its right-to-left direction is known and is not the reason.

34. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about readings of the Harappan script:
1. The Proto-Dravidian view, held by Iravatham Mahadevan, Asko Parpola and Father Heras, is the most supported.
2. Bahata Ansumali Mukhopadhyay holds that it is not a language script but tax or trade marks.
3. S. R. Rao read the script as Proto-Dravidian.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Statement 3 is wrong: S. R. Rao read it as Indo-Aryan (ancestor of Sanskrit), a minority view. Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

35. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Dholavira was dug by R. S. Bisht from 1990.
2. The Dholavira signboard has ten large signs and was found near the North Gate.
3. The Harappan script was first noticed in 1912.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 3 is wrong: the script was first noticed in 1853; J. Fleet reported seals with unknown symbols in 1912. The ten-sign North Gate signboard and Bisht's 1990 dig are correct.

36. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Feature of the Harappan script) with List-II (Fact):
List-I
A. Direction of writing
B. Number of signs
C. Commonest sign
D. Corpus
List-II
i. Right to left
ii. Fish
iii. About 375–400
iv. About 5,000 inscribed objects
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-iv
b. A-iii, B-i, C-ii, D-iv
c. A-i, B-iii, C-iv, D-ii
d. A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii

Answer: (a)
Direction – right to left (some boustrophedon), signs – about 375–400, commonest sign – fish, corpus – about 5,000 inscribed objects (≈3,500 seals): A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-iv.

37. [Kept own]

From which site is the boustrophedon style of Harappan writing reported?

a. Kalibangan
b. Lothal
c. Dholavira
d. Rakhigarhi

Answer: (a)
The script is usually written right to left, with some boustrophedon writing at Kalibangan.

38. [Kept own]

Along with Iravatham Mahadevan, which scholar supports the Proto-Dravidian reading of the Harappan script?

a. S.R. Rao
b. J. Fleet
c. Asko Parpola
d. R.S. Bisht

Answer: (c)
Iravatham Mahadevan and Asko Parpola support the Proto-Dravidian hypothesis, the most widely supported view.

39. [Kept own]

How many signs does the longest known Harappan inscription have?

a. 10 signs
b. 5 signs
c. 40 signs
d. 26 signs

Answer: (d)
The longest Harappan text has 26 signs; the Dholavira signboard (10) is the largest in sign size.

40. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the Harappan script:
1. It has been deciphered.
2. It was mostly written from right to left.
3. It has about 400+ signs.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
The script is pictographic, written right to left with about 400+ signs, and remains undeciphered.

Row 10: Ivc Society and Polity – Stratification, Burials, Absence of Temples and Palaces

1. Burials – Types and Sites (PYQs 3 · MCQs 11)

- **Common burial system (HPPSC 2012): extended earth burial with the head generally to the north**, and **grave goods** (pots, ornaments, copper mirrors) buried with the dead → "both a and b". Sitting-posture burial is not Harappan.
- **Three forms:** complete (extended) burials, fractional burials, post-cremation burials.

Burial practice	Site
Extended burials with goods; coffin burial	R-37, Harappa (head generally to the north)
Post-cremation / fractional, Late Harappan	Cemetery H, Harappa
Fractional (bones buried after exposure of the body)	Mohenjodaro, Harappa
Joint / double burial	Lothal (UPPSC 2016)
Dog buried with human, oval pit burials	Ropar
Pot burials; megalith-type grave with a big rock	Surkotada
Large cemetery of human burials (125 graves, N–S)	Sanauli (Sinauli), Baghpat, UP (UP Lower 2004)
Double burials; Mound 7 cemetery; women with jasper, agate beads, shell bangles	Rakhigarhi

- **Kalibangan – three types:** extended burials in rectangular pits; pot burials; circular pits with grave goods but **no skeleton**.
- Grave goods → belief in an **afterlife**; a copper mirror with cotton thread was found in a Harappa grave. Overall the Harappans did not bury precious things.
- **Rakhigarhi Mound 7:** 56 skeletons incl. a ~4,600-year-old woman.
- **Huddled skeletons** at Mohenjodaro (16 with ornaments) – once read as a "massacre", now as **multiple burials**.

> Double burial = Lothal; dog with human = Ropar; pot burial = Surkotada; R-37 = extended; Cemetery H = Late Harappan.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.10, p.14-15; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.95, p.100; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.18, p.25; old app notes row 10

1. [PYQ] · UP Lower sub (Pre) 2004

Recently, from excavations of Harappan site Sanauli what was found?

a. Human burials
b. Animal burials
c. Residential building
d. Protecting wall

Answer: (a)
Sanauli (Baghpat, UP) is known for a large cemetery of 125 human burials, some with copper and gold goods; it did not yield animal burials or a residential building.

2. [PYQ] · HPPSC 2012

Harappan people had a common burial system which is proved by

a. the Earth burial, head of the dead normally laid towards the North.
b. the burial of commonly used item with the dead.
c. Both 'a' and 'b'.
d. the burial of the dead body in the sitting posture.

Answer: (c)
Harappan burials were extended earth burials with the head generally to the north, and grave goods such as pottery and ornaments were buried with the dead, so both a and b; sitting-posture burial is not Harappan.

3. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016 +1 more

Which of the following sites has yielded evidence of a double burial?

a. Kuntasi
b. Dholavira
c. Lothal
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (c)
Lothal yielded three double (joint) burials in brick-lined graves; Kuntasi is a Harappan port/industrial site, not known for double burial, and the printed explanation (Sinauli graves) does not support Kuntasi.

4. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Burial practice) with List-II (Site):
List-I
A. Extended burials with coffin burial (R-37)
B. Dog buried with a human in an oval pit
C. Pot burials
D. Cemetery of 125 graves aligned north–south
List-II
i. Surkotada
ii. Sanauli
iii. Ropar
iv. Harappa
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iii, B-iv, C-i, D-ii
b. A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii
c. A-iv, B-iii, C-ii, D-i
d. A-ii, B-i, C-iii, D-iv

Answer: (b)
R-37 extended and coffin burials – Harappa, dog with human in an oval pit – Ropar (not Lothal), pot burials – Surkotada, 125 graves – Sanauli (Baghpat, UP): A-iv, B-iii, C-i, D-ii.

5. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about burials at Harappa and Mohenjodaro:
1. Cemetery R-37 has extended burials with grave goods, the head generally to the north.
2. Fractional burial meant burying the bones after the body had been exposed.
3. Cemetery H belongs to the Late Harappan phase and has post-cremation or fractional burials.
4. Coffin burial is a feature of Cemetery H.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)
Statement 4 is wrong: the coffin burial belongs to R-37, not Cemetery H. The R-37 extended burials, Late Harappan Cemetery H and the meaning of fractional burial are correct.

6. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Kalibangan has three types of burial.
2. Rakhigarhi's Mound 7 has yielded 56 skeletons, including a ~4,600-year-old woman.
3. The huddled skeletons at Mohenjodaro are now read as evidence of a massacre.
4. At Kalibangan, circular pits with grave goods but no skeleton have been found.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All four
d. Only three

Answer: (d)
Statement 3 is wrong: the huddled skeletons, once read as a massacre, are now read as multiple burials. Kalibangan's three types (incl. skeleton-less circular pits) and Rakhigarhi's 56 skeletons are correct.

7. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The Harappans believed in an afterlife.
Reason (R): They buried large quantities of precious things with the dead.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (c)
A is true – pots, ornaments and copper mirrors were buried with the dead – but R is false: on the whole the Harappans did not bury precious things.

8. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Burial evidence) with List-II (Site):
List-I
A. Joint / double burial
B. Late Harappan post-cremation burials (Cemetery H)
C. Women buried with jasper and agate beads and shell bangles
D. Huddled skeletons, 16 with ornaments
List-II
i. Lothal
ii. Rakhigarhi
iii. Harappa
iv. Mohenjodaro
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iii, B-i, C-ii, D-iv
b. A-i, B-iii, C-iv, D-ii
c. A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-iv
d. A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii

Answer: (c)
Double burial – Lothal, Cemetery H – Harappa, women with jasper/agate beads and shell bangles – Rakhigarhi, huddled skeletons – Mohenjodaro: A-i, B-iii, C-ii, D-iv.

9. [Kept own]

What did fractional burial at Mohenjodaro and Harappa involve?

a. Placing ashes in an urn after cremation
b. Burying a human together with a dog
c. Burying the complete body in a coffin
d. Burying bones after exposure of the body

Answer: (d)
Fractional burial involved burying the bones after the body had been exposed.

10. [Kept own]

At which Harappan site were circular pits with grave goods but no skeleton found?

a. Lothal
b. Ropar
c. Kalibangan
d. Surkotada

Answer: (c)
Kalibangan has three burial types, one being circular pits with grave goods but no skeleton.

11. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT correct about Harappan grave goods?

a. They included pottery, ornaments, mirrors, beads and food
b. They indicate a belief in an afterlife
c. They reflect status differences
d. Public drains, not grave goods, are the most direct evidence of afterlife belief

Answer: (d)
Grave goods such as pottery, ornaments, mirrors, beads and food placed with the dead most directly indicate afterlife belief and status differences; drains say nothing about it.

2. Social Stratification – Evidence (PYQs 0 · MCQs 4)

Evidence	What it shows
Town layout	Citadel (west) – elite and public buildings vs lower town (east) – commoners
Houses	One to twelve rooms; single-roomed barracks at Harappa
Burial goods	Variation in goods and ornament quality = best sign of social differentiation

- **Uniform bricks** prove organisation and authority, **not status**.
- **No proof** of a rigid caste system; caste became fixed in the **Later Vedic** period. On the whole the Harappans seem relatively **egalitarian**.
- Ranks and polity are rebuilt only from **material remains**; the script gives no rulers' names.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.100; old app notes row 10

12. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan society:
1. Uniform bricks prove differences of social status.
2. There is no proof of a rigid caste system; caste became fixed in the Later Vedic period.
3. Variation in burial goods and ornament quality is the best sign of social differentiation.
4. Single-roomed barracks have been found at Harappa.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only three
b. Only one
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (a)
Statement 1 is wrong: uniform bricks prove organisation and authority, not status. Burial-goods variation, the Harappa barracks and the absence of rigid caste are correct.

13. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Harappan ranks and polity can be rebuilt only from material remains.
Reason (R): The undeciphered script gives no names of rulers.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: because the script gives no rulers' names, ranks and polity have to be reconstructed from material remains.

14. [Kept own]

In which period is caste considered to have crystallised?

a. Harappan period
b. Rigvedic period
c. Mauryan period
d. Later Vedic period

Answer: (d)
Caste crystallised in the Later Vedic period; there is no textual evidence of a rigid Harappan caste system.

15. [Kept own]

Which of the following pairs about Harappan settlement layout is correctly matched?

a. Citadel - eastern side
b. Lower town - western side
c. Lower town - public buildings and elite areas
d. Citadel - public buildings and elite areas

Answer: (d)
The western citadel contained public and elite areas, while the eastern lower town held commoners' houses.

3. Polity and Authority (PYQs 0 · MCQs 5)

- Uniform pottery, seals, **weights**, **1:2:4 bricks** and **grid towns** over ~**8,00,000 sq km** show complex decisions made and carried out → a significant authority.

View	Based on
Priestly rule	Citadels, Great Bath, steatite "Priest-King" (not conclusive – no temples)
Merchant rule	Trade-driven uniformity, few weapons
Several rulers / city-states	Several large cities, no single capital
Single state	Most plausible per PMF

- Political structure **not clear**; it **seems corporate**; municipal-type civic administration (NextGen). Later Vedic = hereditary monarchy, weakening Sabha and Samiti.

  ~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.101; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.7; old app notes row 10

16. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (View of Harappan polity) with List-II (Based on):
List-I
A. Priestly rule
B. Merchant rule
C. Several rulers / city-states
D. Single state
List-II
i. Trade-driven uniformity, few weapons
ii. Most plausible per PMF
iii. Several large cities, no single capital
iv. Citadels, Great Bath, steatite Priest-King
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-i, B-iv, C-iii, D-ii
b. A-iv, B-i, C-iii, D-ii
c. A-iv, B-i, C-ii, D-iii
d. A-iii, B-ii, C-iv, D-i

Answer: (b)
Priestly rule – citadels, Great Bath, Priest-King (not conclusive), merchant rule – trade-driven uniformity, city-states – several large cities with no single capital, single state – most plausible per PMF: A-iv, B-i, C-iii, D-ii.

17. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan polity:
1. Like the Harappans, the Later Vedic people had a corporate polity with a strong Sabha and Samiti.
2. The political structure seems corporate, with municipal-type civic administration.
3. Uniform pottery, seals, weights, 1:2:4 bricks and grid towns over ~8,00,000 sq km point to a significant authority.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Statement 1 is wrong: the Later Vedic polity was a hereditary monarchy with a weakening Sabha and Samiti. The uniformity over ~8,00,000 sq km and the corporate, municipal-type Harappan polity are correct.

18. [Kept own]

Unlike the corporate Harappan polity, what kind of polity was the Later Vedic polity?

a. Corporate polity with no king
b. Hereditary monarchy with declining Sabha and Samiti
c. Elected republic with strong Sabha and Samiti
d. Priestly rule without any assemblies

Answer: (b)
The Later Vedic polity was a hereditary monarchy in which the Sabha and Samiti were declining, while the Harappan polity appears corporate.

19. [Kept own]

Several large Harappan cities with no single capital support which reading of the polity?

a. Centralised empire
b. Hereditary monarchy
c. City-state
d. Tribal chiefdom

Answer: (c)
With several large cities and no identified capital, a city-state reading is supported.

20. [Kept own]

Which one of the following statements regarding Harappan buildings and polity is correct?

a. Fortified citadels prove that the cities were governed exclusively by warriors.
b. Planned cities and drainage systems suggest some form of municipal governance.
c. Large palaces and temples have been conclusively identified in all major cities.
d. The political system is conclusively known to have been a hereditary monarchy.

Answer: (b)
Planned cities and drains suggest municipal governance, while the exact political structure remains uncertain. Citadels may indicate a ruling group, but its composition is debated.

4. No Palaces, No Temples (PYQs 0 · MCQs 1)

- **No royal palaces or temples** found. "Possessed great palaces and temples" = **WRONG** (UPSC 2013).
- Worship was probably **domestic or open-air** (trees, animals); power **not personalised** in a king.
- Public buildings were mainly **civic**: Great Bath, granary, pillared hall.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.101; old app notes row 10

21. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Public buildings such as the Great Bath and the pillared hall were royal palaces.
2. Worship was probably domestic or open-air, and power was not personalised in a king.
3. No royal palaces or temples have been found in Harappan cities.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1, 2 and 3
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 1 is wrong: the Great Bath, granary and pillared hall were civic buildings, not palaces. Statements 2 and 3 are correct ("possessed great palaces and temples" is the classic wrong option).

5. Dress, Ornaments, Pastimes and Weapons (PYQs 0 · MCQs 6)

- **Cotton and wool**; two garments (upper and lower); **Priest-King wears a shawl** with trefoil pattern; **no proof of stitching**.
- **Ornaments:** gold, silver, ivory, copper, lapis lazuli; Allahdino gold and silver necklaces.
- **Lipstick** = **Chanhudaro**; also bronze mirrors, ivory combs, collyrium sticks.
- **Toy factory** = Chanhudaro; terracotta carts, animals, marbles, rattles, whistles (Karanpura); **dice** at Harappa and Mohenjodaro; board games (Lothal chess-like set).
- **Weapons:** maces, axes, spears, bows and arrows of copper, bronze and stone; few and simple → relatively **peaceful**; **no horse-drawn chariots** (UPSC 2013).

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.10-11; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.97, p.102; old app notes row 10

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan dress:
1. Stitching of garments is well proved.
2. Cotton and wool were used, and two garments (upper and lower) were worn.
3. The Priest-King wears a shawl with a trefoil pattern.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 and 3 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 1 is wrong: there is no proof of stitching. Cotton and wool, two garments and the Priest-King's trefoil shawl are correct.

23. [New pattern · statements]

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?
1. Dice – Harappa and Mohenjodaro
2. Toy factory – Chanhudaro
3. Lipstick – Chanhudaro
4. Chess-like board game set – Kalibangan
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. 2 and 3 only
b. 1, 2 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)
Pair 4 is wrong: the chess-like game set is from Lothal. Lipstick and the toy factory are Chanhudaro finds and dice come from Harappa and Mohenjodaro; bronze mirrors and ivory combs were also known (iron razors were not).

24. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The Harappans seem to have been a relatively peaceful people.
Reason (R): Their weapons were few and simple, and they had no horse-drawn chariots.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: maces, axes, spears and bows of copper, bronze and stone were few and simple and there were no horse-drawn chariots – hence the peaceful reading.

25. [Kept own]

At which site has a Harappan toy factory been found?

a. Harappa
b. Chanhudaro
c. Lothal
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (b)
Chanhudaro had a toy factory; Harappan toys were of terracotta.

26. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Harappan pastimes:
1. Terracotta carts, marbles and whistles were used as toys.
2. Board games, possibly proto-chess, were played.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Both are correct: toys included terracotta carts, marbles and whistles, and board games, possibly proto-chess, were played.

27. [Kept own]

Of which metals were Harappan maces, axes and spears made?

a. Iron
b. Silver
c. Iron and bronze
d. Copper and bronze

Answer: (d)
Harappan weapons were of copper and bronze, few and simple; no horse-drawn chariots are known.

Row 11: Ivc Art and Craft – Dancing Girl, Priest-king, Terracotta, Beads, Pottery

1. Sculpture – Dancing Girl, Priest-King, Torso (PYQs 3 · MCQs 9)

Sculpture	Site	Material
Dancing Girl (~10.5 cm / 4 inches; found 1926; National Museum, New Delhi)	Mohenjodaro	Bronze (lost-wax) – not clay, gold or carnelian (UPSC 2025)
Priest-King (bearded man in trefoil shawl, half-closed eyes)	Mohenjodaro	Steatite
Male torso	Harappa	Red sandstone / jasper
Daimabad man (chariot)	Daimabad	Bronze

- The IVC gives the **first cities**, the **first script** (right to left) and the **earliest stone sculpture** (three-dimensional) in the subcontinent – but **not iron** sculpture; iron was unknown (CDS 2017).
- Lifelike bronze and stone figures → **advanced metallurgy** and **craft specialisation**.
- **18 Jun 2026: NCERT** to restore the original Dancing Girl image in the new **Class 9 Art** textbook.

  ~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.97-99, p.112 (CDS 2017); NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.8; old app notes row 11

- **Dancing Girl excavated by Ernest Mackay** (1926, Mohenjodaro) – not R.D. Banerji (who found the site, 1922), Daya Ram Sahni or Wheeler.

1. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2025

The famous female figurine known as 'Dancing Girl', found at Mohenjo-daro, is made of

a. carnelian
b. clay
c. bronze
d. gold

Answer: (c)

The Dancing Girl is a bronze figurine about 4 inches (10.5 cm) tall, cast by the lost-wax method; it is not clay, gold or carnelian.

2. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2025

The famous female figurine known as 'Dancing Girl', found at Mohenjo-daro, is made of

a. carnelian
b. clay
c. bronze
d. gold

Answer: (c)

The Dancing Girl of Mohenjodaro is an about 10.5 cm bronze figure cast by the lost-wax technique; clay is used for the terracottas, not for this figure.

3. [PYQ] · CDS 2017

Which one of the following statements about the Harappan Culture is not correct ?

a. It witnessed the first cities in the subcontinent.
b. It marks the first use of script, written from right to left.
c. It marks the earliest known use of iron as a medium for the art of sculpting.
d. It marks the earliest known use of stone as a medium for the art of sculpting.

Answer: (c)

Harappan sculptures were of bronze, steatite and red sandstone; iron was unknown to this Bronze Age culture, so the iron statement is not correct. The first cities, first script (right to left) and earliest stone sculpture are correct.

4. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Dancing Girl:
1. It is about 10.5 cm tall and was found at Mohenjodaro in 1926.
2. It is kept in the National Museum, New Delhi.
3. In June 2026 NCERT decided to restore its original image in the new Class 12 History textbook.
4. It is made of bronze, cast by the lost-wax process.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All four
d. Only three

Answer: (d)
Statement 3 is wrong: NCERT (18 Jun 2026) is restoring the image in the new Class 9 Art textbook. Its size, 1926 find at Mohenjodaro, National Museum home and lost-wax bronze casting are correct.

5. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan stone sculpture:
1. The male torso from Harappa is of red sandstone.
2. The Priest-King was found at Harappa.
3. The Priest-King is a steatite bust of a bearded man in a trefoil shawl with half-closed eyes.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 2 is wrong: the Priest-King comes from Mohenjodaro. The steatite Priest-King's features and the red sandstone (jasper) torso of Harappa are correct.

6. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Harappan sculpture points to advanced metallurgy and craft specialisation.
Reason (R): Lifelike figures such as the Dancing Girl were cast in bronze by the lost-wax method.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: lifelike bronze (lost-wax) and stone figures are the evidence for advanced metallurgy and specialised crafts.

7. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The male torso of Harappa is a lost-wax bronze casting.
Reason (R): The lost-wax technique was used for the Dancing Girl of Mohenjodaro.
In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (d)
A is false – the Harappa torso is carved in red sandstone, not cast – but R is true: the Dancing Girl, the Lothal dog and bird and the Kalibangan bull are lost-wax castings.

8. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Art object) with List-II (Material):
List-I
A. Dancing Girl
B. Priest-King
C. Male torso of Harappa
D. Mother Goddess figurines
List-II
i. Red sandstone
ii. Steatite
iii. Terracotta
iv. Bronze
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-ii, B-iv, C-i, D-iii
b. A-iv, B-ii, C-iii, D-i
c. A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
d. A-i, B-iii, C-iv, D-ii

Answer: (c)
Dancing Girl – bronze (lost-wax), Priest-King – steatite, male torso – red sandstone, Mother Goddess figurines – terracotta: A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii.

9. [Kept own]
In which museum is the Dancing Girl, found in 1926, now kept?

a. Indian Museum, Kolkata
b. Salar Jung Museum, Hyderabad
c. Prince of Wales Museum, Mumbai
d. National Museum, New Delhi

Answer: (d)
The Dancing Girl (about 10.5 cm) is in the National Museum, New Delhi.

2. Pottery (PYQs 2 · MCQs 5)

- **Wheel-made**, sturdy, glossy; typical **red pottery** (red slip) **with black painted designs**; **plain red** ware the most common → colour = **red** (BPSC 1995).
- Motifs: **geometric, floral, pipal leaf, fish-scale**, animals.
- **Perforated jars**: large hole at the base, small holes in the wall – probably for **straining liquor**.
- **Kalibangan** = six types of pottery; **Lothal** = painted jar (cunning fox story); big storage jars reached Oman.
- Only evidence of painting is on pottery (no wall paintings).

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.99; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.8, p.12; old app notes row 11

10. [PYQ] · BPSC (Pre) 1995
Which colour was commonly used in Harappa Pottery?

a. Red
b. Blue-Grey
c. Yellow
d. Blue

Answer: (a)
Harappan pottery was wheel-made and typically red with black painted designs; plain red ware was the most common. Hence red is correct.

11. [PYQ] · BPSC (Pre) 1995
Which colour was commonly used in the Harappan Pottery?

a. Red
b. Blue-grey
c. Yellow
d. Blue

Answer: (a)
Harappan pottery was wheel-made and typically red with black painted designs; plain red ware was the most common, not blue-grey or yellow.

12. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements about Harappan pottery:
1. Perforated jars were probably used for straining liquor.
2. Wall paintings are common at Mohenjodaro.
3. Its motifs include geometric and floral designs, the pipal leaf and fish-scale.
4. It was wheel-made, typically red slip with black painted designs; plain red ware was the most common.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)
Statement 2 is wrong: the only evidence of Harappan painting is on pottery – no wall paintings. The wheel-made red ware, the motifs and the perforated jars (large hole at the base, small holes in the wall) are correct.

13. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements:
1. A painted jar from Lothal shows the cunning fox story.
2. Big Harappan storage jars reached Egypt.
3. Six types of pottery have been reported from Kalibangan.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Statement 2 is wrong: big storage jars reached Oman, not Egypt. Kalibangan's six pottery types and Lothal's cunning-fox jar are correct.

14. [Kept own]
Which design is NOT typical of painted Harappan pottery?

a. Pipal leaves
b. Fish scales
c. Intersecting circles
d. Spoked chariots

Answer: (d)
Painted designs include pipal leaves, fish scales and intersecting circles; chariots are not among them.

3. Lost-wax (Cire Perdue) and Metal Crafts (PYQs 0 · MCQs 7)

- 1. Wax model coated with clay. 2. Heated: wax melts out. 3. Molten metal poured into the hollow mould. 4. Clay removed.
- Lost-wax objects: **Dancing Girl**, **copper dog and bird of Lothal**, **bronze bull of Kalibangan**, buffalo and goat figures; continued in Late Harappan and Chalcolithic cultures (Daimabad bronzes) and later in **Chola** bronzes such as the **Nataraja**.

Object	Site	Metal
Dog chasing a deer	Harappa	Bronze
Dog and bird	Lothal	Copper
Bull / ox	Kalibangan	Bronze
Chariot group, buffalo, rhinoceros, elephant	Daimabad	Bronze / copper
Gold foundry, active furnace	Rakhigarhi	Gold
Gold and silver necklaces	Allahdino	Gold, silver

- Tools: chisels, needles, fishhooks, razors, mirrors, axes; vessels of copper, bronze, **silver**.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.72, p.88, p.97; old app notes row 11

15. [New pattern · sequence]
Arrange the steps of the lost-wax (cire perdue) process in the correct order:
1. Molten metal is poured into the hollow mould.
2. A wax model is coated with clay.
3. The clay is removed.
4. The mould is heated and the wax melts out.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. 2, 1, 4, 3
b. 4, 2, 1, 3
c. 1, 2, 4, 3
d. 2, 4, 1, 3

Answer: (d)
Wax model coated with clay (2) → heated, wax melts out (4) → molten metal poured into the hollow mould (1) → clay removed (3): 2, 4, 1, 3.

16. [New pattern · match]
Match List-I (Metal object) with List-II (Site):
List-I
A. Bronze dog chasing a deer
B. Copper dog and bird
C. Bronze bull / ox
D. Chariot group, buffalo, rhinoceros, elephant
List-II
i. Daimabad
ii. Lothal
iii. Kalibangan
iv. Harappa
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-iv, B-ii, C-iii, D-i
b. A-ii, B-iv, C-iii, D-i
c. A-iv, B-ii, C-i, D-iii
d. A-iii, B-i, C-iv, D-ii

Answer: (a)
Dog chasing a deer – Harappa, copper dog and bird – Lothal, bronze bull – Kalibangan, chariot group and animals – Daimabad: A-iv, B-ii, C-iii, D-i.

17. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Rakhigarhi has yielded a gold foundry with an active furnace.
2. Lost-wax casting continued in the Daimabad bronzes and later in Chola bronzes such as the Nataraja.
3. The chariot group, buffalo, rhinoceros and elephant of Daimabad are of bronze or copper.
4. Gold and silver necklaces come from Allahdino.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. All four
c. Only two
d. Only three

Answer: (b)
All four are correct: lost-wax lived on in the Daimabad and Chola bronzes; Rakhigarhi had a gold foundry; Allahdino gave gold and silver necklaces; the Daimabad figures are bronze/copper.

18. [Kept own]

By what other name is the lost-wax technique of metal casting known?

a. Repousse
b. Granulation
c. Filigree
d. Cire perdue

Answer: (d)
The lost-wax process, or cire perdue, coats a wax model with clay, melts out the wax and pours molten metal into the mould.

19. [Kept own]

The famous bronze Nataraja images of South India were cast by the lost-wax technique under which dynasty?

a. Mauryas
b. Cholas
c. Kushanas
d. Mughals

Answer: (b)
Chola bronzes such as the Shiva Nataraja were cast by the lost-wax (cire perdue) method.

20. [Kept own]

At which site were gold and silver necklaces of the Harappan period found?

a. Allahdino
b. Daimabad
c. Lothal
d. Kalibangan

Answer: (a)
Allahdino yielded gold and silver necklaces.

21. [Kept own]

Which of the following groups consists entirely of objects associated with the lost-wax technique?

a. Painted jar, perforated jar, faience bead
b. Priest-King, Harappa torso, shell bangles
c. Steatite seal, silver vessel, terracotta whistle
d. Dancing Girl, copper dog and bird of Lothal, bronze bull of Kalibangan

Answer: (d)
The Dancing Girl, the copper dog and bird of Lothal, and the bronze bull of Kalibangan are associated with the lost-wax technique.

4. Terracotta Figurines (PYQs 0 · MCQs 3)

Type	Examples
Mother Goddess	Heavily jewelled female figurines (Harappa) – the most important terracottas
Toys	Toy carts with seated drivers (Chanhudaro), whistles, rattles, birds, gamesmen
Animals	Bulls (humpless bull prominent), birds, dogs, monkeys
Horned god	Clay mask of a horned god (Gujarat, Kalibangan)

- Terracottas are crude, used by common people as toys or cult objects; seals and metal images were for the upper class.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.97-99; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.7; old app notes row 11

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan terracottas:
1. Heavily jewelled female figurines from Harappa are identified as the Mother Goddess.
2. Terracottas were refined objects reserved for the upper class.
3. Toy carts with seated drivers come from Chanhudaro.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Statement 2 is wrong: terracottas were crude and used by common people as toys or cult objects; seals and metal images were for the upper class. Statements 1 and 3 are correct.

23. [Kept own]

At which site were terracotta toy carts with seated drivers found?

a. Lothal
b. Kalibangan
c. Chanhudaro
d. Banawali

Answer: (c)
Toy carts with seated drivers come from Chanhudaro.

24. [Kept own]

At which site was a clay mask of a horned god found?

a. Chanhudaro
b. Kalibangan
c. Allahdino
d. Daimabad

Answer: (b)
The clay mask of a horned god is reported from Kalibangan and from Gujarat.

5. Beads, Faience and Shell (PYQs 0 · MCQs 5)

Centre	Evidence
Chanhudaro	Bead-making factory, furnace, shell-working, bangles (APPSC G1 2022); lipsticks, ink pot; only city without a citadel
Lothal	Bead workshops; carnelian beads for export
Rakhigarhi	Gemstone factory – 3,000+ semi-precious stones

- Materials: **carnelian** (from **Saurashtra**/Bharuch), agate, jasper, **steatite**, lapis lazuli, **faience**, **gold**; beads exported to **Mesopotamia** and the **Persian Gulf**.
- **Faience** (ground sand/silica, glazed blue-green): beads, bangles, tiny vessels – called the **world's first glazed ware**; tie with **mosaic glass** = early clue to glass-making.
- Shell work: Chanhudaro shell-ornament factory; Nageshwar, Balakot, Lothal.
- Seal carving (steatite; unicorn commonest motif) and carnelian working = new techniques of the period.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.88, p.100; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.7-8, p.13; old app notes row 11

25. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Rakhigarhi had a gemstone factory with more than 3,000 semi-precious stones.
2. Lothal had no bead workshops.
3. Chanhudaro is the only Harappan city without a citadel.
4. Chanhudaro had a bead-making factory with a furnace and a shell-ornament factory.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All four
d. Only three

Answer: (d)
Statement 2 is wrong: Lothal had bead workshops and exported carnelian beads. Chanhudaro's bead and shell factories, its lack of a citadel and Rakhigarhi's gemstone factory are correct.

26. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about faience:
1. It was used only for making seals.
2. It is called the world's first glazed ware.
3. It is made of ground sand or silica glazed blue-green.
4. Its tie with mosaic glass is an early clue to glass-making.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only three
b. Only one
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (a)
Statement 1 is wrong: faience was used for beads, bangles and tiny vessels. Its make-up, its title as the first glazed ware and the mosaic-glass clue are correct.

27. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan beads:
1. Iron was one of the bead materials.
2. Carnelian came from Saurashtra / Bharuch.
3. Beads were exported to Mesopotamia and the Persian Gulf.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
Statement 1 is wrong: iron was unknown; beads were of carnelian, agate, jasper, steatite, lapis lazuli, faience and gold. Statements 2 and 3 are correct.

28. [Kept own]

To which regions were Harappan beads exported?

a. Mesopotamia and the Persian Gulf
b. Egypt and Crete
c. China and Tibet
d. Rome and Greece

Answer: (a)
Harappan beads went to Mesopotamia and the Persian Gulf.

29. [Kept own]

The link between faience and mosaic glass is an early clue to which craft?

a. Glass-making
b. Bronze casting
c. Bead drilling
d. Seal carving

Answer: (a)
Faience linked with mosaic glass is an early clue to glass-making.

Row 12: Ivc Religion – Pashupati Seal, Mother Goddess, Tree and Animal Worship, Fire Altars

1. Mother Goddess, Pashupati and Male Deities (PYQs 5 · MCQs 10)

Mother Goddess – the chief female deity

- **Mother Goddess (Devi Mata):** terracotta female figurines, heavily jewelled, with fan-shaped head-dresses → **fertility cult**; probably the chief female deity (RAS 1993; SSC 2012: Devi Mata = **Indus Valley Civilisation**).
- **Sites:** Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Kot Diji, Kalibangan, Banawali (with toy plough) and Gujarat sites; not a feature of Ropar (known for the dog burial).
- **Continuity:** the Mother Goddess cult survives in later **Shakti cults**.
- ⚠ **Trap:** "Spirit and Brahma", "ritual" and "sacrificial system" are Vedic ideas – the Indus answer is **Mother Goddess**.

Pashupati seal – the chief male deity

Feature	Detail
Site	Mohenjodaro (steatite seal)
Figure	Three-faced, horned head-dress, seated in a yogic posture
Animals around	Elephant, tiger, rhinoceros, buffalo; two deer below the seat – no lion
Identification	Proto-Shiva / Pashupati ("lord of animals") – John Marshall
Caution	Script undeciphered, so the reading is an inference from later Shiva worship

- **Indus people worshipped Shiva** (proto-Shiva, UKPSC 2006) – Indra and Varuna are Rig Vedic gods; Brahma and Vishnu are later.
- **Both male and female deities** were worshipped (Mother Goddess + Pashupati) – the only correct statement in UPSC 2013 (no palaces or temples, no horse-drawn chariots) → **"only 2"**.

Idol worship

- **Idol worship began in the pre-Aryan (Harappan) period:** no temple has been found, yet idolatry was practised through figurines and seals (UPPCS 1992). The Rig Vedic Aryans had **no idols or temples**.

> Exam angle: "people of the Indus Valley believed in …" → Mother Goddess; "beginning of idol worship" → pre-Aryan; "Shiva / Rudra" → Pashupati.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.7; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.99-101; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.108-109; app notes 1:12 (sub 0, 1)

1. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993 +1 more

The people of Indus Valley believed in –

a. Spirit and Brahma
b. Ritual
c. Sacrificial system
d. Mother Goddess

Answer: (d)

The Harappans worshipped a Mother Goddess, shown by terracotta female figurines. 'Spirit and Brahma', ritual and the sacrificial system belong to Vedic religion, not the Indus people.

2. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

The beginning of idol worship is to be considered in –

a. Pre-Aryan
b. later Vedic period
c. Mauryan Period
d. Kushan Period

Answer: (a)

Idol worship goes back to the pre-Aryan (Harappan) period: no temple has been found, but idolatry was practised (Mother Goddess figurines, Pashupati seal). Rig Vedic Aryans had no idols or temples.

3. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Which of the following characterizes/characterize the people of Indus Civilization?
1. They possessed great places and temples.
2. They worshipped, both male and female deities.
3. They employed horse-drawn chariots in warfare.
Select the correct answer using the code given below

a. 1 and 2
b. Only 2
c. All of these
d. None of these

Answer: (b)
Only 2 is correct: the Harappans worshipped both male (Pashupati) and female (Mother Goddess) deities. No palaces or temples have been found, and horse-drawn chariots are a Vedic, not Harappan, feature (UPSC 2013 key: b).

4. [PYQ] · SSC 2012

Worship of Devi Mata was related to

a. Indus Valley Civilisation
b. Egyptian Civilisation
c. Roman Civilisation
d. Post Vedic Culture

Answer: (a)
Devi Mata (Mother Goddess) worship is a Harappan (Indus Valley) cult, shown by terracotta female figurines; it later survives in Shakti cults.

5. [PYQ] · UKPSC (Mains) 2006

The Indus valley people worshipped

a. Shiva
b. Indra and Varun
c. Brahma
d. Vishnu

Answer: (a)
The Indus people worshipped a proto-Shiva (Pashupati) figure; Indra and Varuna are Rig Vedic gods, and Brahma and Vishnu are later deities.

6. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Harappan Mother Goddess:
1. The terracotta female figurines are heavily jewelled and wear fan-shaped head-dresses.
2. The figurines are taken as evidence of a fertility cult.
3. Ropar is the site best known for Mother Goddess figurines.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct: the jewelled figurines with fan-shaped head-dresses point to a fertility cult. 3 is wrong: the figurines come from Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Kot Diji, Kalibangan, Banawali and Gujarat sites; Ropar is not one of them and is known for the dog burial.

7. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Pashupati seal:
1. It is a steatite seal found at Harappa.
2. The figure on it is three-faced, wears a horned head-dress and is seated in a yogic posture.
3. Two deer are shown below the seat of the figure.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
2 and 3 are correct: the three-faced horned figure sits in a yogic posture, surrounded by elephant, tiger, rhinoceros and buffalo, with two deer below the seat. 1 is wrong: the steatite Pashupati seal was found at Mohenjodaro, not Harappa.

8. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The identification of the Pashupati figure as proto-Shiva by John Marshall is treated with caution.
Reason (R): The Harappan script is undeciphered, so the reading is an inference from later Shiva worship.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: Marshall called the figure proto-Shiva / Pashupati ('lord of animals'), but since the script cannot be read the identification rests only on later Shiva worship.

9. [Kept own]

Which animal is NOT depicted around the figure on the Pashupati seal?

a. Elephant
b. Rhinoceros
c. Lion
d. Buffalo

Answer: (c)
The seal shows an elephant, tiger, rhinoceros and buffalo with deer below; lion and cow are absent.

10. [Kept own]

Which later cult is a parallel of Harappan Mother Goddess worship?

a. Shakti cults
b. Vedic yajna
c. Sun worship
d. Buddhist stupa worship

Answer: (a)
Mother Goddess worship has a later parallel in Shakti or mother-goddess cults.

2. Tree, Animal and Bird Worship; Fertility Symbols (PYQs 2 · MCQs 5)

Sacred trees, animals and birds

- **Pipal:** the tree most often depicted on Indus seals (a deity standing among pipal branches) – MPPSC 2021; the pipal motif goes back to the **Early Harappan** phase and is still worshipped.
- **Pigeon (dove):** listed by NextGen among sacred symbols – the bird "worshipped" by the Harappans (APPSC Group-II 2011); the peacock is only a pottery motif.
- **Sacred animals:** the **unicorn** (mythical one-horned animal, the commonest seal motif), the **humped bull** (next in importance), elephant, tiger, buffalo, rhinoceros; cobras and horned deities also appear.
- **Animals round Pashupati** were probably worshipped too.

Fertility and phallic symbols

- **Linga and yoni:** conical stones (lingas) and **round pierced stones** (yoni) – fertility objects, possibly early Shaivite elements; found at Harappa.
- **Swastika:** a seal motif, later an auspicious Hindu symbol – it has nothing to do with the Vedic yajna.
- **Seals:** mostly of **steatite**, mostly **square** – some with a hole used as **amulets**.

> Exam angle: "shape of which tree on Indus seals" → **pipal**; "bird worshipped" → **pigeon**; "mythical sacred animal" → **unicorn**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.2, p.7; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.100; app notes 1:12 (sub 2)

11. [PYQ] · M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

The shape of which tree is found in the seals from the Indus Civilization?

a. Mango
b. Pipal
c. Parijat
d. Sal

Answer: (b)
The pipal is the tree most often shown on Indus seals (e.g. a deity standing among pipal branches); the pipal motif goes back to the Early Harappan phase.

12. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

Which of the following birds was worshipped by the Harappa People?

a. Pigeon
b. Peacock
c. Crow
d. Eagle

Answer: (a)
NextGen lists the pigeon (dove) among the Harappans' sacred symbols, so pigeon is right; the peacock appears only as a pottery motif, and crow and eagle are not attested.

13. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Harappan symbol) with List-II (Description in the notes):
List-I | List-II
a. Pipal | i. Motif going back to the Early Harappan phase
b. Unicorn | ii. Yoni – fertility objects
c. Round pierced stones | iii. Seal motif, later an auspicious Hindu symbol
d. Swastika | iv. Mythical one-horned animal, the commonest seal motif
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
c. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (d)
Pipal – most often depicted tree, motif from the Early Harappan phase; Unicorn – mythical one-horned animal, commonest seal motif; round pierced stones – yoni (fertility objects) found at Harappa; Swastika – seal motif, later auspicious in Hinduism (not linked to the Vedic yajna).

14. [Kept own]

Which of the following groups consists entirely of animals regarded as sacred in the Indus Valley Civilization?

a. Goat, sheep, dog and eagle
b. Humped bull, unicorn, elephant and tiger
c. Cow, monkey, crocodile and swan
d. Horse, camel, lion and peacock

Answer: (b)
The humped bull, mythical unicorn, elephant and tiger are identified as sacred animals in the Harappan religious tradition.

15. [Kept own]

Which of the following correctly describes the evidence of phallic and yoni worship at Harappa?

a. The symbols were used exclusively as weapons.
b. Lingam and yoni symbols, including round and pierced stones, were possible fertility objects of worship.
c. Only metal images of fertility deities have been found.
d. Phallic symbols were absent from Harappan sites.

Answer: (b)
Lingam and yoni symbols and round or pierced stones at Harappa are interpreted as fertility objects and possible early Shaivite elements.

3. Fire Altars, Great Bath and Ritual Practices (PYQs 2 · MCQs 4)

Fire altars

Site	Evidence
Kalibangan (Rajasthan)	A row of seven fire altars on a mud-brick platform; triangular terracotta cake with a horned deity on one side and a human pulling a goat by a rope (animal sacrifice) on the other
Lothal (Gujarat)	Fire altar
Banawali, Rakhigarhi	Small pits with terracotta cakes regarded as fire altars

- **Horned deity on a terracotta cake → Kalibangan** (State PSC) – not Banawali, Lothal or Surkotada.
- ⚠ **Caution:** Harappan fire altars are **not conclusive proof of the later Vedic yajna**.

Other ritual evidence

- **Great Bath (Mohenjodaro):** probably for **ritual purification** (bathing).
- **Amulets:** holed seals and amulets suggest belief in **ghosts and evil forces**; deities shown in **yogic poses** → practice of yoga and meditation.
- **Burials with grave goods** point to a belief in life after death (details: burial row).

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.7, p.12-13; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.101; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.20-21; app notes 1:12 (sub 1, 3)

16. [PYQ] · State PSC

A horned deity engraved on a terracotta cake has been recovered from

a. Banawali
b. Kalibangan
c. Lothal
d. Surkotada

Answer: (b)
A triangular terracotta cake from Kalibangan carries a horned deity on one side and a human dragging a goat (animal sacrifice) on the other; Kalibangan also has a row of seven fire altars.

17. [PYQ] · Police Constable Preliminary Exam 2016

The worship of Fire in the Indus valley is proved by the discovery of the Fire altar at

a. Surkotada
b. Alamgirpur

c. Kalibangan
d. Chanhudaro

a. a only
b. a and c
c. c only
d. a and d

Answer: (c)

Fire altars were found at Kalibangan (seven in a row) and Lothal (also Banawali, Rakhigarhi), not at Surkotada or Chanhudaro – so 'c only'.

18. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan fire altars:
1. A row of seven fire altars on a mud-brick platform has been found at Kalibangan.
2. A fire altar has also been found at Lothal.
3. A terracotta cake from Banawali shows a horned deity on one side and a human pulling a goat by a rope on the other.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the triangular terracotta cake with the horned deity and the goat-pulling scene (animal sacrifice) is from Kalibangan; Banawali and Rakhigarhi have only small pits with terracotta cakes.

19. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan ritual practices:
1. The Great Bath at Mohenjodaro was probably meant for ritual purification.
2. Deities shown in yogic poses suggest the practice of yoga and meditation.
3. The Harappan fire altars are conclusive proof of the later Vedic yajna.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

1 and 2 are correct; holed seals and amulets also suggest belief in ghosts and evil forces. 3 is wrong: the notes caution that Harappan fire altars are NOT conclusive proof of the later Vedic yajna.

4. Nature of Harappan Religion and Continuities (PYQs 0 · MCQs 2)

- **Character:** predominantly **secular** civilisation – religion present but not dominant; nature- and **fertility-oriented** worship.
- **No temple** has been identified anywhere; worship was domestic or open-air (under trees).
- **Undeciphered script:** every reading of Harappan religion (proto-Shiva, Mother Goddess) is inferred from later traditions.
- **Continuities into Hinduism:** Shiva/Pashupati, Shakti (Mother Goddess), linga-yoni, pipal and animal veneration, yoga.
- **Contrast with the Rig Veda:** Vedic religion = **male nature gods and open-air yajnas**, no idols; Harappan = Mother Goddess, idols, animal and tree worship.
- **Significance:** the earliest material evidence of a Shiva-like deity, a Mother Goddess and fertility cults in India.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.100-101; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.7, p.28; app notes 1:12 (sub 0, 5)

20. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Harappan religion:
1. The Harappan civilisation was predominantly secular; religion was present but not dominant.
2. Worship was nature- and fertility-oriented.
3. Temples have been identified at Mohenjodaro and Kalibangan.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 and 3 only
b. 1 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: no temple has been identified anywhere; worship was domestic or open-air (under trees).

21. [Kept own]

Which of the following best expresses the historical significance of Harappan religious evidence?

a. It demonstrates that Harappan religion was exclusively based on Vedic sacrifice.
b. It provides early material evidence of cults involving a Shiva-like deity, a mother goddess and linga-related symbols that later show continuities.
c. It proves that the later Hindu religious system already existed in its complete form.
d. It establishes that all Harappan symbols had one fixed and universally accepted meaning.

Answer: (b)

Harappan artefacts provide early material evidence of cultic elements that may have continued into later Hinduism. They do not prove that later Hinduism existed in a complete form or that every symbol has a certain interpretation.

Row 13: Decline of the Ivc – Competing Theories; Late Harappan Cultures

1. Late Harappan Phase – Features and Sites (PYQs 2 · MCQs 10)

Features (c. 1900–1300 BCE, post-urban phase)

- **Chalcolithic:** tools of **stone and copper**; **no metal objects requiring complicated casting**; people lived in **villages** (agriculture, stock-raising, hunting, fishing).
- **Lost:** the extraordinary **uniformity** of the Mature phase (pottery, seals, bricks, weights), writing, long-distance trade, large public buildings and craft specialisation; pottery became **regionally varied**.
- **Bhagwanpura (Kurukshetra, Haryana):** Late Harappan houses of **burnt brick** (so "no burnt bricks at Bhagwanpura" is **false**); Late Harappan pottery overlaps with **PGW**; a 13-roomed house (excavated by **J.P. Joshi**).
- **APPSC Group-1 statements:** I chalcolithic ✓, II no complicated casting ✓, III villages ✓, IV no burnt bricks at Bhagwanpura ✗ → **I, II and III**.
- **Astt. Comm. 2018:** uniformity of artefacts ✓ (Mature phase); "Late sites kept the same construction techniques" ✗ → **only I**.
- **Iron** was absent in the Mature phase and came only later (PGW, Later Vedic).

Regional Late Harappan cultures

Culture / site	Region
Cemetery H	Harappa region, Punjab (Pakistan)
Jhukar, Jhangar	Sindh
Rangpur	Kutch, Saurashtra and mainland Gujarat
Late Siswal, Bhagwanpura	Haryana
Bara, Dadheri	Punjab (India)
Alamgirpur	Uttar Pradesh (Meerut)
Daimabad	Maharashtra – southernmost Late Harappan site
Swat	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

- **Movement:** settlements shifted **eastward** to the Ganga–Yamuna Doab and **southward** to Gujarat and the Deccan.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.101, p.105, p.107; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.8; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.2, p.28; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.25; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bhagwanpura,_Haryana; app notes 1:13 (sub 3, 4)

1. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ

The late Harappan cultures are primarily Chalcolithic in which tools of stone and copper are used. 5. II. They do not show metal objects requiring complicated casting. III. The Chalcolithic people in the later Harappan phase lived in villages. IV. In the late Harappan phase at Bhagwanpura in Haryana, burnt bricks were not found.

a. 1, II and IV
b. I, II and III
c. II, III and IV
d. I, II, III and IV

Answer: (b)

I, II and III are correct: Late Harappan cultures were chalcolithic (stone and copper tools), lacked complex cast metal objects, and were village-based. IV is wrong: the Late Harappan people at Bhagwanpura lived in burnt-brick houses (some baked bricks occur there).

2. [PYQ] · Astt. Comm. 2018

Which of the following statements about Harappa Civilisation is/are correct?

I. There is the extraordinary uniformity in artefacts as evident in pottery seals, bricks and weights.

II. The late Harappa sites also maintained the same construction techniques as were used in mature Harappa sites.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

a. Only I
b. Only II
c. Both I and II
d. Neither I nor II

Answer: (a)

Only I: the extraordinary uniformity of pottery, seals, bricks and weights is a Mature Harappan trait. In the Late Harappan phase seals, script, weights and brick standards lost this uniformity, so II is wrong.

3. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Late Harappan phase:
1. Its tools were mainly of stone and copper.
2. Its pottery became regionally varied and long-distance trade was lost.
3. It retained the uniformity of seals, bricks and weights of the Mature phase.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)

1 and 2 are correct: the Late Harappan phase was chalcolithic (stone and copper) and lost writing, long-distance trade and large public buildings, its pottery becoming regionally varied. 3 is wrong: the extraordinary uniformity of pottery, seals, bricks and weights belonged to the Mature phase and was lost.

4. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Late Harappan culture / site) with List-II (Region):
List-I | List-II
a. Cemetery H | i. Kutch, Saurashtra and mainland Gujarat
b. Rangpur | ii. Harappa region, Punjab (Pakistan)
c. Bara and Dadheri | iii. Haryana
d. Bhagwanpura | iv. Punjab (India)
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
c. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
d. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii

Answer: (b)

Cemetery H – Harappa region, Punjab (Pakistan); Rangpur – Kutch, Saurashtra and mainland Gujarat; Bara, Dadheri – Punjab (India); Late Siswal, Bhagwanpura – Haryana (Daimabad, the southernmost site, is in Maharashtra).

5. [Kept own]

In which direction did settlements mainly move after the decline of the Harappan urban centres?

a. westward to Iran and northward to Central Asia
b. eastward towards the Ganga-Yamuna Doab and southward towards Gujarat and the Deccan
c. southwestward towards the Arabian Peninsula
d. northward towards the Himalayan valleys only

Answer: (b)

Post-urban settlement shifts were mainly eastward towards the Ganga-Yamuna Doab and southward towards Gujarat and the Deccan.

6. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the Late Harappan phase:
1. It is dated to about 1900–1300 BCE.
2. Burnt bricks were still used at Bhagwanpura in Haryana.
3. People lived mainly in large planned cities.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

The Late Harappan phase (c. 1900–1300 BCE) was post-urban: people lived in villages, though burnt bricks were still used at Bhagwanpura.

7. [Kept own]

Which Late Harappan regional phase is correctly matched with its area?

a. Cemetery H – Sindh
b. Rangpur – Kutch, Saurashtra and mainland Gujarat
c. Jhukar – Haryana and western Uttar Pradesh
d. Ganga-Yamuna Doab – Harappa region of Punjab

Answer: (b)

The Rangpur phase covers Gujarat. Cemetery H belongs to the Harappa region, Jhukar to Sindh and the Doab phase to Haryana and western Uttar Pradesh.

8. [Kept own]
Consider the following Late Harappan sites and regions:
1. Jhangar – Sindh
2. Daimabad – Maharashtra
3. Alamgirpur – Uttar Pradesh
Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)
All three are correct: Jhangar is in Sindh (with traces at Amri), Daimabad in Maharashtra and Alamgirpur in Uttar Pradesh.

9. [Kept own]
Which of the following was absent in the Mature Harappan phase and became important only later?

a. Iron
b. Pipal worship
c. Burial practices
d. Fire altars

Answer: (a)
Horse, chariot and iron were absent in the Mature Harappan phase; fire altars, pipal worship and burials are cited as continuities.

10. [Kept own]
What did Bhagwanpura yield that makes it significant in the debate on Harappan–Vedic continuity?

a. only iron weapons and horse bones
b. a large Buddhist stupa over a Harappan citadel
c. only Mature Harappan seals
d. a 13-roomed house with Late Harappan pottery and Painted Grey Ware

Answer: (d)
Bhagwanpura provides evidence of overlap through a 13-roomed house containing Late Harappan pottery and Painted Grey Ware.

2. OCP, Copper Hoards and Harappan–Vedic Continuity (PYQs 1 · MCQs 4)

- **Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP):** the Ganga–Yamuna Doab Late Harappan phase; **Copper Hoards** often found with OCP in the **Doab**.
- **Continuity view:** identification of the Ghaggar-Hakra with the Rigvedic **Sarasvati**; Bhagwanpura's **Late Harappan + PGW** overlap.
- **Traits that continued:** crafts, pottery, beads, weights, agriculture – **not iron tools**, which are post-Harappan.
- **Rakhigarhi:** the only Harappan site so far to yield **ancient DNA**.

  ~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.8; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.28; app notes 1:13 (sub 5)

- **Did not continue:** the **Harappan script** disappeared with the cities; wheat and cotton cultivation and proto-Shiva (Pashupati) worship carried on.

11. [PYQ] · AP Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-II Ward Planning and Reg
Which of the following does not display the continuity of Indus Valley Culture ?

a. Cultivation of wheat and cotton
b. The script
c. Use of punch marked coins
d. Worship of Pasupati Siva

Answer: (b)
Wheat and cotton cultivation, Pashupati-Shiva worship and even seal-like symbols on punch-marked coins continued after the IVC, but the Harappan script did not survive and is still undeciphered.

12. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements:
1. Ochre Coloured Pottery represents the Late Harappan phase of the Ganga–Yamuna Doab.
2. Copper Hoards are often found with Ochre Coloured Pottery in the Doab.
3. Rakhigarhi is the only Harappan site so far to yield ancient DNA.
4. Iron tools are a Harappan trait that continued into later cultures.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)
Statements 1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: crafts, pottery, beads, weights and agriculture continued, but iron tools are post-Harappan.

13. [Kept own]
Which view does the identification of the Ghaggar-Hakra river system with the Rigvedic Sarasvati represent?

a. discontinuity view
b. invasion theory
c. continuity view
d. climate-only theory

Answer: (c)
The identification of Ghaggar-Hakra with the Rigvedic Sarasvati is an argument used by scholars supporting continuity between Late Harappan and Vedic cultural traditions.

14. [Kept own]
Which of the following is NOT cited as a Harappan trait continuing into later culture?

a. Fire altars
b. Pipal worship
c. Linga-yoni
d. Iron tools

Answer: (d)
Fire altars, pipal, Mother Goddess, linga-yoni and ritual bathing continue; iron was absent in the Mature Harappan.

3. Decline Theories – Proponents (PYQs 0 · MCQs 7)

Theory	Proponent(s)
Aryan invasion	Ramaprasad Chanda (1926), elaborated by Mortimer Wheeler (1947) – Indra "Purandara", huddled skeletons
Floods	Marshall, Mackay, S.R. Rao; floods + tectonic uplift – M.R. Sahni
Shift of the Indus course	H.T. Lambrick – Mohenjodaro abandoned
Climate change / aridity	Aurel Stein, A.N. Ghosh
Drying of the Ghaggar-Hakra (Sarasvati)	D.P. Agrawal and Sood – Kalibangan, Banawali abandoned
Ecological imbalance	W.A. Fairservis
Decline of trade with Mesopotamia (c. 1900 BCE)	trade-decline school

- **Other stresses: soil salinity**, deforestation, malaria at **Mohenjodaro**; **Chanhudaro** was flooded several times.
- ⚠ **Trap:** Aurel Stein = climate, **not** Aryan invasion.
- **Consensus:** decline was **gradual and multi-causal** – urban collapse over about **200 years** (c. 1900–1700 BCE) and a long tail to c. 1300 BCE; climate change and the drying of the Sarasvati are the most widely accepted causes.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.105-106; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.13; app notes 1:13 (sub 0)

15. [New pattern · match]
Match List-I (Scholar) with List-II (Explanation of the Harappan decline):
List-I | List-II
a. H.T. Lambrick | i. Shift of the Indus course
b. Aurel Stein | ii. Climate change / aridity
c. D.P. Agrawal and Sood | iii. Ecological imbalance
d. W.A. Fairservis | iv. Drying of the Ghaggar-Hakra
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (b)
Lambrick – shift of the Indus course (Mohenjodaro abandoned); Aurel Stein (with A.N. Ghosh) – climate change / aridity; D.P. Agrawal and Sood – drying of the Ghaggar-Hakra (Kalibangan, Banawali abandoned); Fairservis – ecological imbalance.

16. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about theories of the Harappan decline:
1. The Aryan invasion theory was put forward by Ramaprasad Chanda (1926) and elaborated by Mortimer Wheeler (1947).
2. M.R. Sahni linked the decline to floods together with tectonic uplift.
3. Marshall, Mackay and S.R. Rao explained the decline by a shift of the Indus course.
4. A decline of trade with Mesopotamia around 1900 BCE is also cited as a cause.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2, 3 and 4 only
c. 1, 2 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)
1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: Marshall, Mackay and S.R. Rao are proponents of the flood theory; the shift of the Indus course is H.T. Lambrick's theory.

17. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about stresses behind the Harappan decline:
1. Soil salinity and deforestation are cited as ecological stresses.
2. Malaria is cited as a problem at Kalibangan.
3. Chanhudaro was flooded several times.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: malaria is cited for Mohenjodaro, not Kalibangan.

18. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The decline of the Harappan civilisation is now seen as gradual rather than sudden.
Reason (R): The urban collapse spread over about 200 years (c. 1900–1700 BCE), with a long tail to c. 1300 BCE.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the consensus is a gradual, multi-causal decline over about 200 years of urban collapse; climate change and the drying of the Sarasvati are the most widely accepted causes.

19. [Kept own]

Which theory – proponent pair is INCORRECTLY matched?

a. Floods – S.R. Rao
b. Shift of Indus course – H.T. Lambrick
c. Ecological imbalance – W.A. Fairservis
d. Aryan invasion – Aurel Stein

Answer: (d)
The Aryan invasion theory is Wheeler's (with Childe and Piggott); Aurel Stein is linked with climate.

20. [Kept own]

Which Harappan city was abandoned owing to the shifting of the Indus?

a. Lothal
b. Kalibangan
c. Dholavira
d. Mohenjodaro

Answer: (d)
The shifting Indus led to the abandonment of Mohenjodaro.

21. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Ghaggar-Hakra region had the densest cluster of Harappan sites.
2. Chanhudaro was flooded several times.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
The Ghaggar-Hakra had the densest cluster of sites before it dried, and Chanhudaro was flooded several times.

4. Climate and the 4.2 ka Event (PYQs 0 · MCQs 2)

- **4.2 ka event:** sharp weakening of the monsoon about **4,200 years ago**; the same aridity is linked to the fall of **Akkad** and Old Kingdom Egypt.
- **Deoria Tal (Uttarakhand):** pollen record – the **oak-to-pine ratio** shift shows the monsoon **weakened sharply**.
- **IIT Kharagpur study:** continuous low rainfall for about **900 years** drove the decline and migration.
- **Ghaggar-Hakra:** the densest cluster of Harappan sites; its drying ended cities like Kalibangan.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.105; app notes 1:13 (sub 2)

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the climate explanation of the Harappan decline:
1. The 4.2 ka event was a sharp weakening of the monsoon about 4,200 years ago.
2. The same aridity is linked to the fall of Akkad and Old Kingdom Egypt.
3. An IIT Kharagpur study found continuous low rainfall for about 200 years.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the IIT Kharagpur study speaks of continuous low rainfall for about 900 years, which drove decline and migration.

23. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The pollen record of Deoria Tal in Uttarakhand supports the climate explanation of the Harappan decline.
Reason (R): The shift in its oak-to-pine ratio shows that the monsoon weakened sharply.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the oak-to-pine shift at Deoria Tal records the sharp weakening of the monsoon (the 4.2 ka event).

5. Invasion Theory and Its Rejection (PYQs 0 · MCQs 3)

- **Wheeler's case:** the Rig Veda's fort-breaking Indra (Purandara) and the huddled skeletons of Mohenjodaro.
- **Rejected because:** the Rig Veda postdates the decline; the skeletons belong to different levels (multiple burials, not a massacre); there is no evidence of large-scale conflict between Late Harappans and Indo-Aryans.
- **Rakhigarhi DNA (female, c. 4,600 years ago):** no **steppe pastoralist** component → challenges invasion theories, supports **indigenous continuity**; migration (not invasion) is still argued from other DNA studies.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.105-107; app notes 1:13 (sub 1)

24. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The huddled skeletons of Mohenjodaro are no longer accepted as proof of an Aryan massacre.
Reason (R): The Rig Veda describes Indra as Purandara, the breaker of forts.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (b)
Both are true but R does not explain A: Purandara was part of Wheeler's case; the skeletons are rejected as proof because they belong to different levels (multiple burials, not a massacre) and the Rig Veda postdates the decline.

25. [Kept own]

The absence of a ‘Steppe Pastoralist’ genetic component in the female DNA sample from Rakhigarhi is significant because it:

a. challenges invasion theories and suggests indigenous continuity
b. proves that the Harappan civilisation was founded by Steppe migrants
c. supports the theory of a sudden Aryan invasion
d. establishes that no population movement occurred in ancient India

Answer: (a)
The Rakhigarhi DNA finding challenges invasion theories and is used to support the possibility of indigenous continuity. It does not by itself prove that all population movement was absent.

26. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the rejection of Wheeler's invasion theory:
1. The Rig Veda came after the Harappan decline.
2. The huddled skeletons are multiple burials of different periods.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

Both are reasons for rejecting the theory, along with the lack of archaeological proof.

Row 14: Aryan Question – Original Home Theories and Archaeological Correlates

1. Meaning of 'Arya' – A Speech Group, Not a Race (PYQs 5 · MCQs 6)

- **'Aryan' = a speech (linguistic) group:** speakers of Indo-Aryan, a branch of the **Indo-European** family – not an ethnic group, nomadic people or "superior race" (UPSC 1999, asked 3 times).
- **'Arya' in classical Sanskrit:** a **noble man**; originally associated with "**high birth**" (UP Lower Sub 1998).
- **Max Muller:** popularised the term in modern scholarship and was the first European to speak of an "**Aryan race**" (SSC 2006), though he later said it meant only a language group.
- **William Jones** (18th c.) found the Sanskrit–Latin–Greek kinship that led to the idea of the Indo-European family.
- **Languages in India:** Indo-European (Aryan) about **73%** of speakers (NextGen); **Dardic** branch – Jammu and Kashmir.

> Exam angle: "The term Aryan denotes" → **a speech group**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.18; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.120-122; NextGen Indian Geography APPSC Part 15 p.18; app notes 1:14 (sub 0)

1. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 1999

The term 'Aryan' denotes:

a. an ethnic group
b. a nomadic people
c. a speech group
d. a superior race

Answer: (c)

'Aryan' denotes a speech (linguistic) group – speakers of Indo-Aryan, a branch of the Indo-European family; it is not an ethnic group or a 'superior race' (UPSC 1999 key: c).

2. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 1999

The term 'Aryan' denotes

a. an ethnic group
b. a nomadic people
c. a speech group
d. a superior race

Answer: (c)

'Aryan' denotes a speech (linguistic) group – speakers of Indo-Aryan, a branch of the Indo-European family; it is not an ethnic group or a 'superior race' (UPSC 1999 key: c).

3. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1999 +1 more

The term ‘Aryan’ denotes :

a. An ethnic group
b. A nomadic people
c. A speech group
d. A superior race

Answer: (c)

'Aryan' denotes a speech (linguistic) group – speakers of Indo-Aryan, a branch of the Indo-European family; it is not an ethnic group or a 'superior race' (UPSC 1999 key: c).

4. [PYQ] · SSC 2006

Who was the first European to designate Aryan as a race?

a. William Jones
b. HH Wilson
c. Max Muller
d. General Cunningham

Answer: (c)

Max Muller popularised 'Aryan' and was the first European to use it in a racial sense ('Aryan race'), though he later said it meant only a language group. William Jones found the Sanskrit–Latin–Greek link; Wilson and Cunningham are unrelated.

5. [PYQ] · U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 1998

Meaning of the term ‘Arya’ in classical Sanskrit is

a. Believer of the God
b. A hereditary caste
c. A believer in particular religion
d. A Noble man

Answer: (d)

In classical Sanskrit 'Arya' means a noble or respectable man (originally 'high birth'), not a caste or believer of a religion.

6. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements:
1. William Jones found the kinship of Sanskrit with Latin and Greek that led to the idea of the Indo-European family.
2. Indo-European (Aryan) languages account for about 73% of speakers in India.
3. The Dardic branch of Indo-European is associated with Assam.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 2 are correct (William Jones, 18th century; Indo-European about 73% per NextGen). 3 is wrong: the Dardic branch is associated with Jammu and Kashmir.

2. Avesta and Boghazkoi – Linguistic and Epigraphic Evidence (PYQs 3 · MCQs 7)

- **Avesta:** the **oldest Iranian** (Zoroastrian) text, in **Avestan, an old Iranian language**; closely similar to the Rig Veda → relates to **Iran** (UP Lower Sub 2004; APPSC FBO).

Boghazkoi inscription	Fact
Place	Asia Minor (Turkey) – Hittite capital
Date	c. 1380 BCE (14th century BCE)
Content	Treaty between a Hittite king and a Mitanni king
Gods named	Indra, Mitra, Varuna, Nasatyas – not Agni
Significance	Vedic-speaking people or gods in West Asia; taken as evidence of Aryan movement via Iran

- ⚠ **Trap:** Mansehra and Shahbazgarhi are Ashokan rock edicts; Junagarh is Rudradaman's – none names Vedic gods.
- **Other early Indo-European records:** Kassite (Iraq, c. 1600 BCE), Mitanni (Syria, 14th c. BCE).

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.19, p.22; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.121; app notes 1:14 (sub 1)

7. [PYQ] · APPSC Forest Beat Officer & Assistant Beat Officer (Mains) P
Avesta was written in ____ language.

a. Arabic
b. Turkish
c. Iranian
d. Hebrew

Answer: (c)
The Avesta, the Zoroastrian scripture and oldest Iranian text, is in Avestan, an old Iranian language close to Rig Vedic Sanskrit.

8. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ
Which of the following inscriptions mentions the names of Vedic Gods Indra, Varuna, Mitra and Nasatyas?

a. Mansehra
b. Shahbazgarhi
c. Boghazkoi
d. Junagarh

Answer: (c)
The Boghazkoi inscription (c. 1380 BCE, Asia Minor) records a Hittite–Mitanni treaty naming Indra, Mitra, Varuna and the Nasatyas. Mansehra and Shahbazgarhi are Ashokan rock edicts; Junagarh has Rudradaman's record.

9. [PYQ] · U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004
There is a similarity in Avesta and the Rig Veda, from which region the Avesta is related to –

a. India
b. Iran
c. Israel
d. Egypt

Answer: (b)
The Avesta, which closely resembles the Rig Veda, is the oldest Iranian (Zoroastrian) text, so it relates to Iran.

10. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Boghazkoi inscription:
1. It was found in Asia Minor (Turkey), at the Hittite capital.
2. It is dated to about 1380 BCE.
3. It records a treaty between a Hittite king and a Kassite king.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct (Hittite capital in Asia Minor, c. 1380 BCE / 14th century BCE). 3 is wrong: the treaty is between a Hittite king and a Mitanni king; the Kassite records are from Iraq, c. 1600 BCE.

11. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Record) with List-II (Description):
List-I | List-II
a. Mansehra | i. Syria, 14th century BCE
b. Junagarh | ii. Iraq, c. 1600 BCE
c. Kassite records | iii. Inscription of Rudradaman
d. Mitanni records | iv. Ashokan rock edict
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
c. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii
d. a-iv, b-iii, c-ii, d-i

Answer: (d)
Mansehra (like Shahbazgarhi) – Ashokan rock edict; Junagarh – Rudradaman's inscription (none of these names Vedic gods); Kassite – Iraq, c. 1600 BCE; Mitanni – Syria, 14th century BCE.

12. [Kept own]

What is the principal historical significance of the Boghazkoi inscription?

a. Proves that Vedic culture originated exclusively in India
b. Records the establishment of the Mauryan Empire
c. Shows the presence of Vedic-speaking people or gods in West Asia
d. Describes the spread of Buddhism to Central Asia

Answer: (c)
The inscription provides evidence of Vedic-speaking people or deities in West Asia and is used in support of a Central Asian homeland and movement towards Iran and India.

13. [Kept own]

Which Vedic god is NOT named in the Boghazkoi inscription?

a. Indra
b. Mitra
c. Varuna
d. Agni

Answer: (d)
Boghazkoi names Indra, Mitra, Varuna and the Nasatyas.

3. Rigvedic Aryans vs Harappans (PYQs 2 · MCQs 5)

Feature	Rigvedic Aryans	Harappans
Horse	Domesticated; horse-drawn chariots	No clear evidence
Warfare	Coat of mail (varman), helmet, bronze weapons	No such evidence
Metals	Gold, silver, copper (ayas)	Gold, silver, copper – not iron
Wheels	Spoked	Solid
Settlement	Rural, mud settlements	Planned urban cities
Transmission	Oral hymns	Seals and script
Dead	Cremation	Mostly burial

- **UPSC 2017:** I (coat of mail) ✓, II ("Indus people knew copper and iron") ✗, III (horse) ✓ → **I and III only**.
- **Early Vedic period:** c. **1500–1000 BCE**.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.119-121; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.19; app notes 1:14 (sub 5)

14. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 2017

With reference to the difference between the culture of Rigvedic Aryans and Indus valley people, which of the following statements is/are correct?

I. Rigvedic Aryans used the coat of mail and helmet in warfare whereas the people of Indus Valley Civilisation did not leave any evidence of using them.

II. Rigvedic Aryans knew gold, silver and copper whereas Indus valley people knew only copper and iron.

III. Rigvedic Aryans had domesticated the horse whereas there is no evidence of Indus valley people having been aware of this animal.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

a. Only I
b. II and III
c. I and III
d. I, II and III

Answer: (c)
I and III are correct (UPSC 2017 key: c). Rigvedic Aryans used coats of mail (varman) and domesticated the horse, unknown to the Harappans. II is wrong: the Harappans knew gold, silver and copper, not iron.

15. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 2017

With reference to the difference between the culture of Rigvedic Aryans and Indus valley people, which of the following statement is/are correct?

I. Rigvedic Aryans used the coat of mail and helmet in warfare, whereas the people of Indus valley civilisation did not leave any evidence of using them.

II. Rigvedic Aryans knew gold, silver and copper, whereas Indus valley people knew only copper and iron.

III. Rigvedic Aryans had domesticated the horse, whereas there is no evidence of Indus valley people having been aware of this animal.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

a. Only I
b. II and III
c. I and III only
d. I, II and III

Answer: (c)
I and III are correct (UPSC 2017 key: c). Rigvedic Aryans used coats of mail (varman) and domesticated the horse, unknown to the Harappans. II is wrong: the Harappans knew gold, silver and copper, not iron.

16. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements comparing the Rigvedic Aryans with the Harappans:
1. The Rigvedic Aryans used spoked wheels, the Harappans solid wheels.
2. The Rigvedic Aryans lived in planned urban cities.
3. Rigvedic culture was transmitted through oral hymns, while the Harappans used seals and script.
4. The Rigvedic Aryans cremated their dead, while the Harappans mostly buried them.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)
1, 3 and 4 are correct. 2 is wrong: the Rigvedic people lived in rural mud settlements; planned urban cities belonged to the Harappans.

17. [Kept own]

Which animal was domesticated and central to Rigvedic warfare, but is not attested in the Harappan civilisation?

a. Bull
b. Elephant
c. Horse
d. Dog

Answer: (c)
The Rigvedic horse was domesticated and central to warfare; no awareness of the horse is attributed to the Harappans.

18. [Kept own]

To which period is the Early Vedic period dated?

a. 2600–1900 BCE
b. 1000–600 BCE
c. 1900–1300 BCE
d. 1500–1000 BCE

Answer: (d)
Early Vedic culture is dated to about 1500–1000 BCE.

4. Original Home Theories (PYQs 0 · MCQs 4)

Original home	Proponent
Central Asia	Max Muller
Arctic region	B.G. Tilak – *The Arctic Home in the Vedas* (1903)
Tibet	Dayananda Saraswati – *Satyarth Prakash*
Sapta Sindhu	A.C. Das – *Rigvedic India*; also Ganganath Jha (Brahmarshi-desha)
Hungary (Danube)	P. Giles
Southern Russia / Eurasian steppe	most plausible (NextGen); mainstream view

- ⚠ **Trap:** Arctic = Tilak, not A.C. Das.

  ~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.119; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.18; app notes 1:14 (sub 2)

19. [New pattern · match]
Match List-I (Original home of the Aryans) with List-II (Proponent):
List-I | List-II
a. Central Asia | i. P. Giles
b. Arctic region | ii. B.G. Tilak
c. Tibet | iii. Max Muller
d. Hungary (Danube) | iv. Dayananda Saraswati
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii

Answer: (b)
Central Asia – Max Muller; Arctic – B.G. Tilak (The Arctic Home in the Vedas, 1903); Tibet – Dayananda Saraswati (Satyarth Prakash); Hungary – P. Giles.

20. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements about the original home of the Aryans:
1. Dayananda Saraswati put forward his view in the Satyarth Prakash.
2. A.C. Das, in Rigvedic India, placed the original home in Sapta Sindhu.
3. Ganganath Jha placed the original home in Central Asia.
4. Southern Russia / the Eurasian steppe is the mainstream and most plausible view.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 3 and 4 only
c. 1, 2 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (c)
1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: Ganganath Jha placed it in India (Brahmarshi-desha), supporting the Sapta Sindhu view; Central Asia is Max Muller's view.

21. [Kept own]
Who is the author of 'The Arctic Home in the Vedas' (1903)?

a. Max Muller
b. A.C. Das
c. B.G. Tilak
d. Dayananda Saraswati

Answer: (c)
B.G. Tilak argued for an Arctic homeland in this 1903 book.

22. [Kept own]
Which homeland – proponent pair is INCORRECTLY matched?

a. Europe (Germany) – Penka
b. Hungary – P. Giles
c. Brahmarshi-desha – Ganganath Jha
d. Arctic region – A.C. Das

Answer: (d)
A.C. Das proposed Sapta Sindhu; the Arctic region is Tilak's theory.

5. Migration Debate – Archaeology and Genetics (PYQs 0 · MCQs 7)

- **Mainstream:** Indo-Aryans came from Central Asia in waves, the Rig Vedic wave c. **1500 BCE**; migration, not invasion (supporters: **Asko Parpola**, Romila Thapar, Upinder Singh – migration with interaction and assimilation).
- **Route: Andronovo** (steppe, horses, chariots) → **BMAC** (Turkmenistan, Uzbekistan, north Afghanistan – contact zone) → **Gandhara Grave culture** (Swat, horse remains, new burials): **3-1-2**.
- **Indigenous / Out of India: S.R. Rao, B.B. Lal, Shrikant Talageri**; B.B. Lal linked **Painted Grey Ware** with the Vedic tradition (PGW–Later Vedic link still open).
- **Genetics:** haplogroup **R1a**; 2021 *Science* paper – steppe migration 2000–1500 BCE.
- **Rakhigarhi** (Hisar, Haryana; largest known Harappan site, on the seasonal **Drishadvati**): DNA of a woman of about 4,600 years ago with **no steppe ancestry**; **Mound 7** burial plot – **56** skeletons.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.106-107; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.22; app notes 1:14 (sub 3, 4)

23. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I with List-II:
List-I | List-II
a. Andronovo | i. Steppe culture with horses and chariots
b. BMAC | ii. Contact zone in Turkmenistan, Uzbekistan and north Afghanistan
c. Gandhara Grave culture | iii. Genetic haplogroup in the migration debate
d. R1a | iv. Swat valley; horse remains and new burials
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii

Answer: (d)
Andronovo – steppe, horses, chariots; BMAC – contact zone (Turkmenistan, Uzbekistan, north Afghanistan); Gandhara Grave culture – Swat, horse remains, new burials; R1a – haplogroup (2021 Science paper: steppe migration 2000–1500 BCE).

24. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Aryan migration debate:
1. Asko Parpola supports the migration theory.
2. Romila Thapar and Upinder Singh see migration combined with interaction and assimilation.
3. B.B. Lal and Shrikant Talageri are supporters of the migration theory.
4. B.B. Lal linked Painted Grey Ware with the Vedic tradition.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1, 2 and 4 only
c. 2, 3 and 4 only
d. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (b)
1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: S.R. Rao, B.B. Lal and Shrikant Talageri hold the indigenous / Out of India view.

25. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Rakhigarhi:
1. It is in Hisar district of Haryana.
2. It is the largest known Harappan site and lies on the seasonal Drishadvati.
3. Its Mound 7 burial plot has yielded 65 skeletons.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Mound 7 burial plot has 56 skeletons.

26. [Kept own]

The link between Painted Grey Ware archaeology and which of the following remains an open question?

a. BMAC
b. Later Vedic textual geography
c. Megalithic burials
d. Harappan seals

Answer: (b)
The relationship between Painted Grey Ware and Later Vedic textual geography remains an open question.

27. [Kept own]
Arrange in order of the proposed migration route:
1. BMAC
2. Gandhara Grave culture
3. Andronovo

a. 3-1-2
b. 1-3-2
c. 3-2-1
d. 1-2-3

Answer: (a)
The proposed sequence is Andronovo → BMAC → Gandhara Grave culture.

28. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements about the Rakhigarhi DNA study:
1. The DNA came from a woman who lived about 4,600 years ago.
2. Her DNA showed a strong Steppe Pastoralist component.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
The DNA of the about 4,600-year-old woman from Mound 7 had no Steppe Pastoralist gene, so only statement 1 is correct.

29. [Kept own]
According to the mainstream view, around when did the Aryans come from Central Asia?

a. c. 3000 BCE
b. c. 2500 BCE
c. c. 1500 BCE
d. c. 600 BCE

Answer: (c)
The mainstream migration view dates the arrival from Central Asia to about 1500 BCE.

6. Dasas, Dasyus and Panis (PYQs 0 · MCQs 2)

- **Dasas:** a branch of the early Aryans (mentioned in Iranian literature); the Aryan chief was soft towards them.
- **Dasyus:** the original inhabitants; possibly phallus-worshippers who kept no cattle for dairy; **Trasadasyu** = soft to Dasas, hostile to Dasyus.
- **Divodasa** of the Bharata clan defeated **Sambara**.
- **Panis:** non-Aryan cattle-holders and traders, condemned for greed.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.26; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.124; app notes 1:14 (sub 6)

30. [New pattern · match]
Match List-I with List-II (as in the Rig Veda):
List-I | List-II
a. Dasas | i. The original inhabitants
b. Dasyus | ii. A branch of the early Aryans mentioned in Iranian literature
c. Panis | iii. Soft towards the Dasas, hostile to the Dasyus
d. Trasadasyu | iv. Non-Aryan cattle-holders and traders
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
c. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
d. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii

Answer: (d)
Dasas – a branch of the early Aryans (Iranian literature); Dasyus – original inhabitants, possibly phallus-worshippers; Panis – non-Aryan cattle-holders and traders condemned for greed; Trasadasyu – soft to Dasas, hostile to Dasyus.

31. [Kept own]
Whom did Divodasa of the Bharata clan defeat?

a. Sudas
b. Sambara
c. Trasadasyu
d. Puru

Answer: (b)
Divodasa of the Bharata clan defeated Sambara.

Row 15: Rig Vedic Period – Sapta Sindhu, Rivers, Tribes, Battle of Ten Kings

1. Rigvedic Rivers and Their Modern Names (PYQs 6 · MCQs 12)

Rigvedic name	Modern river	Note
Sindhu	Indus	Most mentioned river (UPSC 1996); "Hiranyayi" (golden)
Sarasvati	Ghaggar-Hakra (or Avestan Haraxvati/Helmand)	Holiest: "Ambitame, Naditame, Devitame" – best of mothers, rivers, goddesses (Matetama = best of mothers)
Vitasta	Jhelum	–
Asikni	Chenab	–
Parushni	Ravi	Battle of Ten Kings
Vipas (Vipasha)	Beas	–
Shutudri	Sutlej	–
Drishadvati	Chautang	–
Kubha	Kabul	Afghanistan
Krumu	Kurram	Afghanistan
Gomati	Gomal	Afghanistan
Suvastu	Swat	Afghanistan / Pakistan
Sadanira (Later Vedic)	Gandak	Satapatha Brahmana

- **Afghanistan link: Kubha, Krumu**, Gomati, Suvastu (UPPCS 1999, 2010) – Askini, Parushni, Vipasha, Shutudri are Punjab rivers.
- **Yamuna** mentioned **thrice**, **Ganga once** (10th Mandala).
- ⚠ **Trap:** Parushni = Ravi, not Beas; Vipas = Beas.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.18, p.20; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.123-124; app notes 1:15 (sub 2), 1:16 (sub 6)

1. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Which of the following rivers mentioned in the Rig Veda indicates the relations of Aryans with Afghanistan?

a. Askini
b. Parushni
c. Kubha, Krumu
d. Vipasha, Shutudri

Answer: (c)
Kubha (Kabul) and Krumu (Kurram) flow in Afghanistan and show the Aryans' link with it. Askini (Chenab), Parushni (Ravi), Vipasha (Beas) and Shutudri (Sutlej) are Punjab rivers.

2. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

The Vedic river Kubha was located in:

a. Afghanistan
b. Chinese Turkistan
c. Kashmir
d. Punjab

Answer: (a)
Kubha is the Rigvedic name of the Kabul river, which flows through Afghanistan.

3. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2010

Which of the following rivers mentioned in the Rigveda gives the clue to relations of Aryans with the Afghanistan?

a. Askini
b. Parushni
c. Kubha, Kramu
d. Vipasha, Shutudri

Answer: (c)

Kubha (Kabul) and Krumu (Kurram) flow in Afghanistan and show the Aryans' link with it. Askini (Chenab), Parushni (Ravi), Vipasha (Beas) and Shutudri (Sutlej) are Punjab rivers.

4. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 1996

The river most mentioned in early Vedic literature is:

a. Sindhu
b. Sutudri
c. Sarasvati
d. Ganga

Answer: (a)

The Sindhu (Indus) is the river most mentioned in the Rig Veda; the Sarasvati is the holiest (naditama), the Ganga is named only once.

5. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Which of the following rivers among the following referred as ‘Matetama’, 'Devitama' and ‘Naditama’ in the Rig Veda?

a. Sindhu
b. Saraswati
c. Vitasta
d. Yamuna

Answer: (b)

The Sarasvati is called Ambitame, Naditame, Devitame – best of mothers, best of rivers, best of goddesses (Rig Veda II.41.16).

6. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

The river mentioned most in early Vedic literature is :

a. Sindhu
b. Shutudri
c. Sarasvati
d. Ganga

Answer: (a)

The Sindhu (Indus) is the river most mentioned in the Rig Veda; the Sarasvati is the holiest (naditama), the Ganga is named only once.

7. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Rigvedic river) with List-II (Modern name):
List-I | List-II
a. Vitasta | i. Ravi
b. Asikni | ii. Jhelum
c. Parushni | iii. Chenab
d. Vipas | iv. Beas
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
c. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
d. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv

Answer: (d)

Vitasta – Jhelum; Asikni – Chenab; Parushni – Ravi (site of the Battle of Ten Kings); Vipas (Vipasha) – Beas. Trap: Parushni is the Ravi, not the Beas.

8. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Rigvedic river of the Afghanistan region) with List-II (Modern name):
List-I | List-II
a. Kubha | i. Gomal
b. Krumu | ii. Swat
c. Gomati | iii. Kabul
d. Suvastu | iv. Kurram
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
b. a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (b)

Kubha – Kabul; Krumu – Kurram; Gomati – Gomal; Suvastu – Swat. These rivers show the Aryans' link with Afghanistan.

9. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Vedic river) with List-II (Modern identification):
List-I | List-II
a. Drishadvati | i. Sutlej
b. Sadanira | ii. Chautang
c. Shutudri | iii. Gandak
d. Sarasvati | iv. Ghaggar-Hakra
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii

Answer: (c)
Drishadvati – Chautang; Sadanira – Gandak (Later Vedic, Satapatha Brahmana); Shutudri – Sutlej; Sarasvati – Ghaggar-Hakra (or Avestan Haraxvati/Helmand).

10. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about rivers in the Rigveda:
1. The Sindhu is called 'Hiranyayi' (golden).
2. The Ganga is mentioned only once, in the 10th Mandala.
3. The Yamuna, like the Ganga, is mentioned only once.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Yamuna is mentioned thrice; only the Ganga is mentioned once (10th Mandala).

11. [Kept own]

What does 'Matetama', the title given to the Sarasvati, mean?

a. Best of rivers
b. Best of mothers
c. Best of goddesses
d. Mother of rivers

Answer: (b)
Matetama means best of mothers; Devitama means best of goddesses and Naditama best of rivers.

12. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Sindhu is the river mentioned most often in the Rigveda.
2. The Ganga is mentioned in the Rigveda only once.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Both are correct: the Sindhu is the most mentioned river, while the Ganga is mentioned once and the Yamuna thrice.

2. Battle of Ten Kings and the Tribes (PYQs 4 · MCQs 9)

Dasarajna (Battle of Ten Kings)

- **Where:** banks of the **Parushni (Ravi)** (UPPCS 2008) – not the Vitasta, Vipasa or Asikni.
- **Victor: Sudas**, Bharata king of the **Tritsu** family, with the priest **Vasishtha**.
- **Opponents:** a confederacy of ten tribes – five Aryan (**Puru, Yadu, Turvasa, Anu, Druhyu**) and five non-Aryan – whose priest was **Vishvamitra**; rivalry of Vasishtha and Vishvamitra led to the war.
- **Source: Mandala VII** of the Rigveda.
- **After:** the defeated **Purus** joined the Bharatas → **Kurus**; the Kurus and Panchalas ruled the upper Ganga basin.
- **NDA 2012 "not true":** "Purus sided with the Bharatas" ✗ – they were in the confederacy. The Rig Veda does mention Dasarajna and Sudas; it has about 300 non-Indo-European words.

Tribes

- **Panchajana: Anu, Druhyu, Yadu, Turvasa, Puru** – **Kikata** is not one (UPPCS 2009, twice); the Kikatas lived in **south Bihar (Magadha)**.
- **Other tribes:** Bharatas, Tritsus, Krivis, Srinjayas; **Bharatavarsha** is named after the **Bharatas**.
- **Divodasa** (Bharata) defeated **Sambara**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.26-27; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.124-125; app notes 1:15 (sub 4, 5)

13. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

The famous battle of 'Ten Kings' as described in the Rig Veda was fought on the bank of

a. Parushni
b. Saraswati
c. Vipasa
d. Asikni

Answer: (a)
The Battle of Ten Kings (Dasarajna) was fought on the banks of the Parushni (Ravi); Sudas of the Bharatas won.

14. [PYQ] · NDA 2012

Which one among the following is not true with regard to Rigveda Samhita?

a. There is about 300 non-Indo- European words in Rigveda.
b. There is a reference to Dasarajna (battle of ten kings) in the Rigveda.
c. It is mentioned in the Rigveda that the Bharata Chief Sudas fought against a confederacy of ten tribes.
d. Purus sides with Bharata in the battle of ten kings.

Answer: (d)
The Purus were in the confederacy of ten kings against Sudas and joined the Bharatas (to form the Kurus) only after their defeat, so statement 4 is false. The Rig Veda does mention the Dasarajna and Sudas's victory, and it has about 300 non-Indo-European words.

15. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Give the name of the tribe which is not related to the 'Panchjana' of the Rigveda Aryans:

a. Yadu
b. Puru
c. Turvasu
d. Kikat

Answer: (d)
The Panchajana (five tribes) were Anu, Druhyu, Yadu, Turvasa and Puru. The Kikatas were a non-Panchajana people of south Bihar (Magadha).

16. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Mains) 2009

Give the name of the tribe which is not related to the 'Panchajana' of the Rigveda Aryans.

a. Yadu
b. Puru
c. Turvasa
d. Kikat

Answer: (d)
The Panchajana (five tribes) were Anu, Druhyu, Yadu, Turvasa and Puru. The Kikatas were a non-Panchajana people of south Bihar (Magadha).

17. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Battle of Ten Kings:
1. It was won by Sudas, a Bharata king of the Tritsu family.
2. The priest who supported Sudas was Vishvamitra.
3. It is described in Mandala VII of the Rigveda.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: Sudas was supported by the priest Vasishtha; Vishvamitra was the priest of the ten-tribe confederacy.

18. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Dasarajna:
1. The confederacy that fought Sudas was made up of five Aryan and five non-Aryan tribes.
2. The rivalry of Vasishtha and Vishvamitra led to the war.
3. After the battle the defeated Purus joined the Bharatas to form the Panchalas.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 2 are correct (five Aryan tribes – Puru, Yadu, Turvasa, Anu, Druhyu – and five non-Aryan, with Vishvamitra as priest). 3 is wrong: the Purus and Bharatas merged to form the Kurus; the Kurus and Panchalas then ruled the upper Ganga basin.

19. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Rigvedic tribes:
1. The Panchajana were the Anu, Druhyu, Yadu, Turvasa and Puru.
2. The Kikatas lived in south Bihar (Magadha).
3. Bharatavarsha is named after the Purus.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Bharatavarsha is named after the Bharatas.

20. [Kept own]

Which tribe emerged dominant after the Battle of Ten Kings?

a. Yadus
b. Purus
c. Bharatas
d. Anus

Answer: (c)
The Bharatas emerged dominant; the defeated Purus later allied with them to form the Kurus.

21. [Kept own]

Whom did Divodasa, the Bharata chief, defeat?

a. Vritra
b. Sambara
c. Sudas
d. Bali

Answer: (b)
Divodasa, the Bharata chief, defeated Sambara.

3. Sapta Sindhu, Chronology and Geography (PYQs 0 · MCQs 6)

- **Period:** Early Vedic c. **1500–1000 BCE**; oldest core = **family books, Mandalas II–VII**.
- **Sapta Sindhu:** land of seven rivers – Indus, its five Punjab tributaries and the Sarasvati; spread over **eastern Afghanistan, NWFP (Khyber Pakhtunkhwa), Punjab and Haryana**; the Later Vedic core shifted east to the Ganga–Yamuna Doab.
- **Ganga is not one of the Sapta Sindhu**; Vipas is.
- **Gandhara Grave culture (Swat):** horse remains – linked to the early Indo-Aryans.
- **Terms: Himavant** = Himalayas; **Mujavant** = soma mountain in the **Hindu Kush**; **Dhanva** = desert land; **samudra** = a collection of water (the **Satapatha Brahmana** names the eastern and western seas).
- **Later regions: Brahmarshi Desh** = Ganga–Yamuna Doab and adjoining area; **Madhya Desh** = between the Himalayas and the **Vindhyas**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.18, p.20, p.22, p.29; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.123; app notes 1:15 (sub 0, 1, 3)

22. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The Ganga is not counted among the rivers of Sapta Sindhu.
Reason (R): Sapta Sindhu denotes the Indus, its five Punjab tributaries and the Sarasvati.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the seven rivers are the Indus, its five Punjab tributaries (including the Vipas) and the Sarasvati, so the Ganga is not one of them.

23. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Rigvedic term) with List-II (Meaning):
List-I | List-II
a. Himavant | i. Himalayas
b. Mujavant | ii. Desert land
c. Dhanva | iii. Soma mountain in the Hindu Kush
d. Samudra | iv. A collection of water
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv

Answer: (d)
Himavant – Himalayas; Mujavant – soma mountain in the Hindu Kush; Dhanva – desert land; samudra – a collection of water (the Satapatha Brahmana names the eastern and western seas).

24. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Vedic regions:
1. Brahmarshi Desh denoted the Ganga–Yamuna Doab and adjoining area.
2. Madhya Desh lay between the Himalayas and the Aravallis.
3. In the Later Vedic period the core shifted east to the Ganga–Yamuna Doab.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: Madhya Desh lay between the Himalayas and the Vindhyas.

25. [Kept own]

Which Mandalas of the Rigveda are the 'family books', its oldest core?

a. I–VI
b. II–VII
c. III–VIII
d. IV–IX

Answer: (b)
Mandalas II–VII are the family books, each linked to one rishi family, and form the oldest core.

26. [Kept own]

Which archaeological culture with horse remains in Swat is linked to the early Indo-Aryans?

a. Painted Grey Ware
b. Ochre Coloured Pottery
c. Gandhara Grave culture
d. Black and Red Ware

Answer: (c)
The Gandhara Grave culture of Swat, with horse remains, is linked to early Indo-Aryans; the Painted Grey Ware link is to Later Vedic geography.

27. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Sapta Sindhu:
1. It extended over eastern Afghanistan, Punjab and Haryana.
2. The Later Vedic core shifted east to the Ganga-Yamuna Doab.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Sapta Sindhu covered eastern Afghanistan, NWFP, Punjab, Haryana and fringes of western UP; the Later Vedic core shifted east to the Doab.

Row 16: Early Vedic Polity – Rajan, Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha, Gana; Tribal Chiefdom

1. Vedic Assemblies – Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha, Gana (PYQs 4 · MCQs 11)

Assembly	Nature	Key facts
Sabha	Small, select council of elders/nobles; advised the Rajan and had judicial functions	Mentioned 8 times in the Rigveda; women members Sabhavati; "narishta" in the Atharvaveda
Samiti	General tribal assembly of the people	Tribal business, legislation, choice of the chief
Vidatha	Oldest assembly – religious, military and distributive	Most mentioned (122 times); first to disappear in Later Vedic times
Gana	Tribal group / troop	Also a military unit – not a judicial body or a priest

- **Daughters of Prajapati:** the **Atharvaveda** calls the **Sabha and Samiti** the two daughters of Prajapati – where they appear as separate institutions (UPPCS 2009; MPPSC 2024).
- **Judicial assembly: Sabha** (JPSC 2016).
- **RAS 1994:** the Sabha = a select council (closest: "**council of ministers**"); the "assembly of all the people" is the **Samiti**.
- **Women:** attended the **Sabha and Vidatha**; the Atharvaveda mentions women in the **Samiti**; in the Later Vedic age women were excluded and the Vidatha vanished, while the Sabha and Samiti came under chiefs and nobles.
- **Democratic element:** traces of election of the chief by the Samiti.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.26, p.29; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.128, p.131-132; app notes 1:16 (sub 1)

1. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994 disputed

'Sabha' of Vedic-era –

a. Was an institution of mercantile people of the villages
b. Was a royal court
c. Was a council of ministers
d. National Assembly of all the people of the state

Answer: (c)
Most books and keys: council of ministers. Strictly: a select council of elders/nobles with judicial work, later close to a royal court (PMF A&M Part 1 p.128).
The Sabha was a small, select council of elders and nobles that advised the Rajan (and judged disputes), the closest option being a council of ministers. The 'assembly of all the people' was the Samiti; the Sabha was not a mercantile body.

2. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

In which Veda are Sabha and Samiti declared as separate institutions?

a. Rigveda
b. Samaveda
c. Atharvaveda
d. Yajurveda

Answer: (c)
Sabha and Samiti appear in the Rig Veda, but the Atharvaveda explicitly treats them as two separate institutions, the 'two daughters of Prajapati'.

3. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

In which of the Vedas, Sabha and Samiti are called as two daughters of Prajapati ?

a. Rigveda
b. Samveda
c. Yajurveda
d. Atharvaveda

Answer: (d)
The Atharvaveda calls the Sabha and the Samiti the two daughters of Prajapati.

4. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

The Rigvedic tribal assembly associated with judicial function was

a. Sabha
b. Samiti
c. Vidhata
d. All of these

Answer: (a)

The Sabha, a select body of elders, also performed judicial functions; the Samiti was the general tribal assembly that chose the chief, and the Vidatha was mainly a religious-military gathering.

5. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Early Vedic assembly) with List-II (Nature):
List-I | List-II
a. Sabha | i. Select council of elders with judicial functions
b. Samiti | ii. Oldest assembly, first to disappear in Later Vedic times
c. Vidatha | iii. General tribal assembly; choice of the chief
d. Gana | iv. Tribal group / troop, also a military unit
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
c. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (b)

Sabha – small select council of elders/nobles, advisory and judicial; Samiti – general assembly of the people (tribal business, legislation, choice of chief); Vidatha – oldest religious, military and distributive assembly, first to disappear; Gana – tribal group / troop and military unit (not a judicial body or priest).

6. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Rigvedic assemblies:
1. The Sabha is mentioned 8 times in the Rigveda.
2. Women members of the Sabha were called Sabhavati.
3. The Vidatha is the assembly mentioned least often in the Rigveda.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Vidatha is the most mentioned assembly (122 times).

7. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The Sabha and Samiti lost their popular character in the Later Vedic age.
Reason (R): In the Later Vedic age they came under chiefs and nobles, and women were excluded from them.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)

Both are true and R explains A: in the Later Vedic age the Vidatha vanished, women were excluded, and the Sabha and Samiti came under the chiefs and nobles.

8. [Kept own]

Which of the following statements regarding early Vedic assemblies is correct?

a. They functioned only after the introduction of regular taxation.
b. They were royal sacrifices performed by the king.
c. They were exclusively hereditary territorial institutions.
d. They are cited as early democratic elements because they show traces of elective participation.

Answer: (d)

The assemblies are considered early democratic or proto-participatory elements because they contained traces of elective participation within a tribal order.

9. [Kept own]
Which of the following is NOT correct about early Vedic assemblies?

a. The Sabha of elders and elites had judicial functions
b. The Samiti was the folk assembly that chose the chief
c. The Gana was the assembly that exercised judicial functions
d. The Vidatha was the earliest assembly with religious and military roles

Answer: (c)
The Gana was a troop of tribesmen with military functions; it was the Sabha of elders and elites that had advisory, social and judicial functions.

10. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements about women in early Vedic assemblies:
1. Women attended the Sabha and the Vidatha.
2. Women continued to attend assemblies in the Later Vedic period.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
Women attended the Sabha (Sabhavati) and the Vidatha but were excluded in Later Vedic times.

11. [Kept own]
Which Veda mentions women in the Samiti?

a. Rigveda
b. Samaveda
c. Yajurveda
d. Atharvaveda

Answer: (d)
The Atharvaveda, which calls Sabha and Samiti the daughters of Prajapati, mentions women in the Samiti.

2. Nature of the Polity – Rajan and Tribal Chiefdom (PYQs 2 · MCQs 7)

- **Tribal polity:** kinship-based **tribal chiefdom** (APPSC SQT 2018) – no formal bureaucracy, **no fixed territory**, no standing army.
- **Hierarchy: Jana** (tribe; 275 mentions) → **Vis** (clan, under **Vispati**) → **Grama** (under **Gramani**) → **Kula** (family, under **Kulapa**); **janapada** is absent from the Rigveda.
- **Rajan:** called **Gopati** (lord of cattle) / gopajanasya; protector of the tribe and cattle, **not ruler of a territory**; queen = **Mahisi**.
- **Succession: monarchy**; the post tended to be **hereditary** (with traces of choice by the Samiti) → "**descended (hereditary) monarchy**" (RAS 1993).
- **Divinity:** kingship not divine – only the Puru king **Trasadasyu** is called **ardhadeva** (demi-god).
- **Later Vedic contrast:** territorial kingship, **Rajasuya**, **ratnins** and regular taxes.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.26, p.28; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.127-128; app notes 1:16 (sub 0, 2)

12. [PYQ] · APPSC 2018 Special Qualifying Test for Appointment by Promot
The administrative setup of early Aryans was in the nature of?

a. Democratic republic
b. Tribal polity
c. Anarchy
d. Autocracy

Answer: (b)
The early Aryans had a kinship-based tribal polity: the Rajan was a tribal chief, protector of the tribe and cattle, with no fixed territory or standing army.

13. [PYQ] · RAS/RTS (Pre) 1993
The System of Governance prevalent in the Vedic era was

a. Autocratic
b. Democratic
c. Republic
d. Descended monarchy

Answer: (d)
Monarchy was the form of government and the Rajan's position was hereditary (with traces of choice by the Samiti), i.e. a hereditary (descended) monarchy, not an autocracy or a republic.

14. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the early Vedic political units:
1. The Jana (tribe) is mentioned about 275 times in the Rigveda.
2. The Vis (clan) was headed by the Gramani.
3. The term janapada is absent from the Rigveda.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the Vis was under the Vispati; the Gramani headed the Grama (village).

15. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the early Vedic Rajan:
1. He was called Gopati, the lord of cattle.
2. His queen was called Mahisi.
3. He was the ruler of a fixed territory.
4. Only the Puru king Trasadasyu is called ardhadeva (demi-god).
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)
1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Rajan was the protector of the tribe and its cattle, not the ruler of a territory; kingship was not divine, Trasadasyu being the only exception.

16. [Kept own]

Which one of the following correctly represents the early Vedic political hierarchy from the largest to the smallest unit?

a. Grama – Jana – Vis – Kula
b. Vis – Jana – Kula – Grama
c. Jana – Vis – Grama – Kula
d. Kula – Grama – Vis – Jana

Answer: (c)
The early Vedic hierarchy proceeded from Jana, the tribe, to Vis, the clan, Grama, the village, and Kula, the family.

17. [Kept own]

Which of the following rituals is a feature of the Later Vedic rather than the Early Vedic polity?

a. Bali as a voluntary offering
b. Vidatha meetings
c. Election traces in the Samiti
d. Rajasuya

Answer: (d)
Rajasuya, Vajapeya and Ashvamedha were Later Vedic rituals; Early Vedic rituals were simple.

18. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the early Vedic polity:
1. It had a formal bureaucracy.
2. It had no fixed territory.
3. It was kinship-based.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
The early Vedic tribal polity was kinship-based with no fixed territory and no formal bureaucracy.

3. Officials, Army, Warfare and Bali (PYQs 1 · MCQs 7)

Official	Role
Purohita	Chief priest and adviser (Vasishtha, Vishvamitra)
Senani	Army commander
Vrajapati	Officer in charge of pasture land (SI 2023)
Gramani	Head of the village / fighting band

Kulapa	Head of the family
Spasa	Spy
Duta	Messenger
Jivagribha, Ugra	Police officials
Madhyamasi	Mediator

- **Army:** temporary tribal militia (**Sena**) in units **Sardha, Vrata and Gana**; foot soldiers (patti) and chariot-warriors (rathins); **bronze** weapons, **no iron**.
- **Gavishti** = "search for cows" – the word for war.
- **Bali:** a **voluntary offering** to the Rajan, not a regular tax.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.26-27; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.125, p.128; app notes 1:16 (sub 3, 4)

19. [PYQ] · SI Prelims Paper-II 2023

Who was the officer in-charge of Pastoral Lands in Rigvedic period?

a. Vrajapathi
b. Jiva gribha
c. Kulapa
d. Suta

Answer: (a)
The Vrajapati was the officer in charge of pasture land (vraja); Jivagribha was a police official, Kulapa the head of the family, Suta a charioteer-bard.

20. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Rigvedic official) with List-II (Role):
List-I | List-II
a. Purohita | i. Chief priest and adviser
b. Spasa | ii. Messenger
c. Duta | iii. Mediator
d. Madhyamasi | iv. Spy
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
c. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii

Answer: (c)
Purohita – chief priest and adviser (Vasishtha, Vishvamitra); Spasa – spy; Duta – messenger; Madhyamasi – mediator.

21. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about early Vedic officials:
1. The Gramani was the head of the village / fighting band.
2. The Kulapa was the head of the family.
3. Jivagribha and Ugra were spies.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Jivagribha and Ugra were police officials; the spy was the Spasa.

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the early Vedic army:
1. The Sena was a temporary tribal militia.
2. It was organised in units called Sardha, Vrata and Gana.
3. Its weapons were made of iron.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 2 are correct (foot soldiers – patti – and chariot-warriors – rathins). 3 is wrong: weapons were of bronze; iron was not known.

23. [Kept own]
What was 'Bali' in the early Vedic period?

a. A military unit of chariot warriors
b. A judicial assembly of elders
c. A compulsory land tax collected by appointed officials
d. A voluntary offering rather than a regular tax

Answer: (d)
Bali was a voluntary offering. The early Vedic polity lacked a formal system of regular taxation and tax collection.

24. [Kept own]
What was the early Vedic army commander called?

a. Purohita
b. Gramani
c. Vrajapati
d. Senani

Answer: (d)
The Senani commanded the army; the Purohita was chief priest and the Vrajapati was officer of pasture land.

25. [Kept own]
In the context of early Vedic warfare, what does the term 'gavishti' mean?

a. Search for water sources
b. Search for fertile land
c. Search for cows
d. Search for horses

Answer: (c)
‘Gavishti’ literally refers to the search for cows and denotes cattle raids, which were a common form of warfare in the Rig Vedic period.

Row 17: Early Vedic Society and Economy – Pastoralism, Gavishti, Varna Origins, Position of Women

1. Crafts, Metals, Trade and Exchange (PYQs 5 · MCQs 11)

Craftsman	Term
Carpenter (chariots, boats)	Takshan
Smith / metal worker	Karmara
Goldsmith	Hiranyakara
Potter	Kulala
Weaver	Vaya
Physician	Bhishak
Chariot-maker	Rathakara

- **Ayas** = **copper or bronze**; iron = **krishna ayas** (Later Vedic) – so the **blacksmith** craft was not in use (SSC 2003).
- **Nishka:** a **gold neck ornament** (nishka-griva) in the Rigveda; later a **gold coin** (UPSC 1993; UPPCS 2007).
- **Exchange:** barter, **no coinage**; the cow was the unit of value.
- **Panis:** the **traders**, rich in cattle, condemned for greed and for hiding cattle (MPPSC 2019).
- **Stupa:** the word first occurs in the **Rigveda**, meaning a **tree stem** / raised heap (CGPSC 2015).
- **Occupational mobility:** hymn of a poet whose father is a physician and mother a grinder of corn.
- **Bali:** a voluntary offering by tribesmen to the rajan.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.27; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.33, p.126; app notes 1:17 (sub 2, 3)

1. [PYQ] · SSC 2003

Which of the following handicrafts was not in used by Aryans?

a. Pottery
b. Jewellary
c. Carpenter
d. Blacksmith

Answer: (d)
The Rig Vedic smith (karmara) worked ayas (copper/bronze); iron (krishna ayas) and the blacksmith came only in the Later Vedic period. Potters, carpenters and goldsmiths were known.

2. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

During the Rigvedic Period word ‘Nishka’ was used for a Jewellery but in later periods it was used for the meaning of :

a. Arms
b. Farming equipment
c. Script
d. Coin

Answer: (d)
Nishka was a gold neck ornament (nishka-griva) in the Rig Veda; in later texts it denotes a gold coin/unit of value.

3. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

During the Rigvedic period Nishka was an ornament of–

a. Ear
b. Neck
c. Arm
d. Wrist

Answer: (b)
In the Rig Veda the nishka was a gold ornament worn on the neck (nishka-griva).

4. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Where the word ‘Stupa’ has been used for the first time?

a. Rigveda
b. Jatak Katha
c. Artha Shastra
d. Astadhyayee

Answer: (a)
'Stupa' first occurs in the Rig Veda, where it means a tree stem or a raised heap; Jatakas, Arthashastra and Ashtadhyayi are later.

5. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

The Rigvedic "Pani" belonged to which class of citizens?

a. Priests
b. Ironsmiths
c. Goldsmiths
d. Traders

Answer: (d)
The Panis were a trading class, rich in cattle and condemned for greed; they were not priests or smiths.

6. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Rigvedic craftsmen:
1. The Karmara was the smith or metal worker.
2. The Bhishak was the physician.
3. The Hiranyakara was the potter.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Hiranyakara was the goldsmith; the potter was the Kulala.

7. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The blacksmith's craft was not in use among the Rigvedic Aryans.
Reason (R): In the Rigveda ayas meant copper or bronze; iron (krishna ayas) appears only in the Later Vedic period.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: ayas was copper or bronze, and iron – krishna ayas – belongs to the Later Vedic age, so there was no blacksmith craft.

8. [Kept own]

What does the Rig Vedic hymn in which the speaker is a poet, his father a physician and his mother a grinder of corn illustrate?

a. Occupational mobility
b. A rigid birth-based caste order
c. Craft work being reserved for slaves
d. A priestly monopoly over all occupations

Answer: (a)
The hymn shows members of one family following different occupations, so occupation was not strictly birth-bound in Rig Vedic society.

9. [Kept own]

Match the following:
List-I (Term)
A. Takshan
B. Kulala
C. Vaya
D. Hiranyakara
List-II (Craftsman)
1. Weaver
2. Goldsmith
3. Carpenter
4. Potter
Select the correct answer using the code given below

a. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
b. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1
c. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
d. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3

Answer: (a)
Takshan = carpenter, Kulala = potter, Vaya = weaver, Hiranyakara = goldsmith.

10. [Kept own]
Which of the following is correct about exchange in the Rig Vedic age?

a. Trade was by barter and there was no coinage
b. Nishka was a gold coin
c. Panis were the royal tax collectors
d. Bhaga was the chief medium of exchange

Answer: (a)
Rig Vedic trade was limited and by barter, with no coinage; nishka was a gold neck ornament, not yet a coin.

11. [Kept own]
What did the word 'Stupa' mean in the Rigveda?

a. Burial mound
b. Tree stem
c. Relic casket
d. Sacrificial post

Answer: (b)
Stupa first appears in the Rigveda meaning a tree stem, raised by Varuna above the forest.

2. Pastoral Economy – The Cow (PYQs 4 · MCQs 6)

- **Economy: mainly pastoral**, agriculture secondary (mixed economy).
- **Cow = most valuable property** (UPPCS 2015) and the **standard unit of value and exchange**; **Gau** named **176 times**.
- **Aghanya** = "**not to be killed**" – the Rig Vedic term for the **cow** (UPPCS 2008; UDA 2010; UPPSC 2017).
- **Cattle words: Gavishti** (war = search for cows), **Gomat** (rich man with many cattle), **Duhitri** (daughter = one who milks), **Godhuli** (dusk, when cattle return – time), **Gavyuti** (distance), **Goghna** (guest fed on cattle).
- **Horse:** asva is mentioned 215 times – vital for war and movement.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.27; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.125; app notes 1:17 (sub 0)

12. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008
Which of the following animals was considered as “Aghanya” during the Vedic period:-

a. Bull
b. Sheep
c. Cow
d. Elephant

Answer: (c)
'Aghanya' (not to be killed) is the Rig Vedic term for the cow, the chief form of wealth; it does not refer to bulls, goats, priests or women.

13. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2015
In the early Rigvedic period, what was considered to be the most valuable property?

a. Land
b. Cow
c. Women
d. Water

Answer: (b)
In the early Rig Vedic pastoral economy the cow was the most valuable property and the unit of exchange; land was not yet private property.

14. [PYQ] · U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010
Aghanya in Rig Veda is mentioned for –

a. Goat
b. Cow
c. Elephant
d. Horse

Answer: (b)
'Aghanya' (not to be killed) is the Rig Vedic term for the cow, the chief form of wealth; it does not refer to bulls, goats, priests or women.

15. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2017
The name ‘Aghanya’ mentioned in many passages of the Rigveda refers to

a. priests
b. women
c. cows
d. brahmans

Answer: (c)
'Aghanya' (not to be killed) is the Rig Vedic term for the cow, the chief form of wealth; it does not refer to bulls, goats, priests or women.

16. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Rigvedic economy:
1. It was mainly pastoral, agriculture being secondary.
2. The cow was the standard unit of value and exchange.
3. The word Gau (cow) occurs about 176 times in the Rigveda.
4. The horse (asva) is mentioned fewer than 50 times in the Rigveda.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only three
c. Only two
d. All four

Answer: (b)
1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: asva is mentioned 215 times – the horse was vital for war and movement.

17. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Rigvedic cattle-derived word) with List-II (Meaning):
List-I | List-II
a. Godhuli | i. Daughter – one who milks
b. Gavyuti | ii. Rich man with many cattle
c. Duhitri | iii. Dusk, when cattle return (time)
d. Gomat | iv. Distance
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
b. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
c. a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (c)
Godhuli – dusk (time); Gavyuti – distance; Duhitri – daughter, 'one who milks'; Gomat – a rich man with many cattle. Gavishti (war) and Goghna (guest) are other cattle words.

3. Agriculture, Crops and Food (PYQs 4 · MCQs 10)

Term	Meaning
Yava	Barley – the chief Rigvedic grain
Dhanya	Grain / cereals
Vrihi	Rice – not in the Rigveda (later texts)
Godhuma	Wheat (later texts)
Mudga	Mung bean
Ikshu	Sugarcane
Sira / Langala	Plough drawn by bulls / wooden ploughshare
Sita	Furrow
Datra	Sickle
Urvara	Fertile land
Kshetra	Cultivated field
Kulya	Canal
Avata	Well

- **Rice, wheat and cotton are not Rigvedic crops** – barley (yava) is the staple crop.
- **RAS 2021 match:** Vrihi–rice, Mudga–mung, Yava–millet (only grain left in List-II), Ikshu–sugarcane → **A-ii, B-iii, C-iv, D-i**.
- **Staple food: milk and its products** (ghee, curd), with barley (SSC 2008).
- **Chief livelihood (UPPSC 1993):** cattle-rearing with farming; of the options, **agriculture**, which became the main livelihood in the Later Vedic age.
- **Later Vedic contrast:** agrarian economy; **bhaga = 1/6** of produce; bali, bhaga and shulka collected by the **Bhagadugha**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.27; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.126-127; app notes 1:17 (sub 1)

18. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

The word 'Yava' mentioned in Rigveda is used for which agricultural product ?

a. Barley
b. Gram
c. Rice
d. Wheat

Answer: (a)
Yava in the Rig Veda means barley, the chief grain; wheat (godhuma) and rice (vrihi) appear only in later texts.

19. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre.) 2021 disputed

Match list-I with list-II and choose the correct answer from the code given below –
List-I
List-II
A. Vrihi (i) Sugarcane
B. Mudga (ii) Rice
C. Yava (iii) Mung bean
D. Ikshu (iv) Millet Code –

a. A-(i), B-(ii), C-(iii), D-(iv)
b. A-(iv), B-(iii), C-(ii), D-(i)
c. A-(iii), B-(iv), C-(i), D-(ii)
d. A-(ii), B-(iii), C-(iv), D-(i)

Answer: (d)
Most books and keys: Yava – millet (code d). Strictly: Yava = barley (NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.27).
Vrihi – rice, Mudga – mung bean, Ikshu – sugarcane; Yava (barley/grain) is matched with millet as the only remaining option (RAS 2021 key: d).

20. [PYQ] · SSC 2008

The staple food of the Vedic Aryan was

a. barley and rice
b. milk and its products
c. rice and pulses
d. vegetables and fruits

Answer: (b)
Milk and its products (ghee, curd) were the staple food of the Vedic Aryans of a cattle-based economy; barley was the main grain, rice and pulses came later.

21. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 1993 disputed

In the ancient period chief-livelihood of the Aryans was

a. Agriculture
b. Hunting
c. Artcraft
d. Business

Answer: (a)
Most books and keys: Agriculture. Strictly: the early Rig Vedic Aryans were mainly pastoral, agriculture secondary (NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.27).
Of the options, agriculture: the Aryans combined cattle-rearing with farming, and in the Later Vedic age agriculture became the chief livelihood. Pastoralism (the early Rig Vedic mainstay) is not offered; hunting, craft and business were minor.

22. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Rigvedic agricultural term) with List-II (Meaning):
List-I | List-II
a. Sita | i. Fertile land
b. Urvara | ii. Canal
c. Kulya | iii. Well
d. Avata | iv. Furrow
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
c. a-iv, b-i, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (d)
Sita – furrow; Urvara – fertile land; Kulya – canal; Avata – well.

23. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about crops in the Vedic texts:
1. Vrihi (rice) is not named in the Rigveda.
2. Godhuma (wheat) occurs only in later texts.
3. Cotton was one of the chief crops of the Rigvedic period.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: rice, wheat and cotton are not Rigvedic crops; barley (yava) was the staple.

24. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Later Vedic economy:
1. It was an agrarian economy.
2. Bhaga was one-fourth of the produce.
3. Bali, bhaga and shulka were collected by the Bhagadugha.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: bhaga was one-sixth (1/6) of the produce.

25. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Early Vedic economy was pastoral and associated with yava.
2. The Later Vedic economy was agrarian and associated with rice and wheat.
Which of the above statements is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
The Early Vedic economy was pastoral and linked with yava (barley); the Later Vedic economy became agrarian and was associated with rice and wheat.

26. [Kept own]

What was 'Langala' in Early Vedic agriculture?

a. Wooden ploughshare
b. Bull-drawn cart
c. Iron ploughshare
d. Winnowing basket

Answer: (a)
Langala was a wooden ploughshare, while Sira was a plough drawn by bulls; iron was not used for the Langala.

27. [Kept own]

What was 'Sira' in Rigvedic agriculture?

a. Sickle
b. Furrow
c. Plough drawn by bulls
d. Winnowing fan

Answer: (c)
Sira was a plough drawn by bulls; Sita was the furrow and Datra the sickle.

4. Position of Women (PYQs 4 · MCQs 7)

- **Status:** relatively good (better than later) within a patriarchal society – "**somewhat superior**" (APPSC Sociology 2002); it **declined** in the Later Vedic period.
- **Rights:** education, **choice of husband**, attendance at **assemblies**, sacrifices **with the husband**; no child marriage; **monogamy**; **niyoga** (childless widow with the husband's brother) and widow remarriage; could own cattle.
- **Not:** holding the **highest positions of authority** (CDS 2014 – the incorrect statement); no women priests.
- **Women seers (brahmavadinis): Lopamudra** (wife of **Agastya**, who Aryanised **South India**), **Ghosha**, **Apala**, **Vishvavara** – Rig Vedic (UPSC 1995).
- ⚠ **Trap: Gargi** is Later Vedic – her dialogue with Yajnavalkya is in the **Brihadaranyaka Upanishad** (not Rigvedic).
- **Brahmavadini:** a woman who studied and expounded Vedic knowledge.
- **Sons preferred**, but daughters were educated.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.129-130; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.28, p.31; app notes 1:17 (sub 6)

28. [PYQ] · APPSC Sociology Back Log 2002

This was the status of an Indian woman in the Vedic period

a. Very low level
b. Somewhat superior
c. Sorrorate
d. Incomparable scale

Answer: (b)

Women in the (Rig) Vedic age enjoyed a relatively good status – education, choice of husband, attendance at assemblies, no child marriage – within a patriarchal society, so 'somewhat superior' (compared with later periods). 'Very low' fits later periods, and 'sororate' is a marriage custom, not a status.

29. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 1995

Who among the following was a Brahmavadini who composed some hymns of the Vedas?

a. Lopamudra
b. Gargi
c. Leelavati
d. Savitri

Answer: (a)

Lopamudra, wife of Agastya, was a brahmavadini who composed Rig Vedic hymns; Gargi was a later (Upanishadic) philosopher, and Leelavati is Bhaskara's mathematical text.

30. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which one of the following is not related to the Rigvedic period?

a. Ghosha
b. Gargi
c. Apala
d. Vishvavara

Answer: (b)

Ghosha, Apala and Vishvavara were Rig Vedic women seers; Gargi Vachaknavi belongs to the Later Vedic Brihadaranyaka Upanishad.

31. [PYQ] · CDS 2014

Which of the following statements regarding Rigvedic women is not correct?

a. They could attend assemblies and offer sacrifices along with their husband.
b. Some unmarried women offered sacrifices on their own.
c. Women could occupy the highest positions of authority.
d. Women often choose their partners.

Answer: (c)

Rig Vedic women attended assemblies, joined sacrifices and chose their husbands, but nothing shows them holding the highest positions of authority (CDS 2014 key: c).

32. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about women in the Rigvedic period:
1. Monogamy was the usual form of marriage.
2. Niyoga was the union of a childless widow with her husband's brother.
3. Women had a choice of husband and attended assemblies.
4. The position of women improved further in the Later Vedic period.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All four
d. Only three

Answer: (d)

1, 2 and 3 are correct (they also received education and joined sacrifices with the husband). 4 is wrong: the position of women declined in the Later Vedic period.

33. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I with List-II:
List-I | List-II
a. Lopamudra | i. Rigvedic woman seer, wife of Agastya
b. Agastya | ii. Aryanised South India
c. Gargi | iii. Woman who studied and expounded Vedic knowledge
d. Brahmavadini | iv. Dialogue with Yajnavalkya in the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (a)

Lopamudra – Rigvedic seer, wife of Agastya; Agastya – Aryanised South India; Gargi – Later Vedic, dialogue with Yajnavalkya in the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad; brahmavadini – woman who studied and expounded Vedic knowledge.

34. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about women in the Rig Vedic period:
1. Women could own cattle.
2. Child marriage was common.
3. Widow remarriage was possible.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Women could own cattle and widow remarriage was possible; there was no child marriage, as adult marriage was the norm.

5. Family, Social Units and Varna Origins (PYQs 3 · MCQs 10)

- **Family: patriarchal, patrilineal, patrilocal**, joint (three generations) under the kulapa; **monogamy** usual.
- **Units (ascending): Kula – Grama – Vis – Jana**; **Vaishya** derives from **Vis**.
- **Varna:** the word first occurs in the **Rigveda** (UPPSC 2012) – **arya varna vs dasa varna** = colour / cultural-linguistic distinction.
- **Purusha Sukta (Rigveda X.90, 10th Mandala – a late addition):** first reference to the **four-fold varna** division (APPSC G1 2003, G1 PYQ) – Brahmana from the **mouth**, Kshatriya from the **arms**, Vaishya from the thighs, Shudra from the feet.
- **Shudra:** first appears in the **10th Mandala**; not in the family books.
- **Gotra:** in the Rigveda = cowpen; as lineage first in the **Atharvaveda**; gotra exogamy not yet established.
- **Slavery:** slave women given as gifts to **priests**.
- **Change:** the shift from cattle-tribe to agrarian economy explains later territorial kingship and varna hierarchy.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.22, p.28-29; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.127, p.129; app notes 1:17 (sub 4, 5)

35. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I Prelims 2003

In which of the following great texts is the Purusha Sukta found?

a. Rigveda
b. Manusmriti
c. Mahabharata
d. Tirukkural

Answer: (a)
The Purusha Sukta is hymn X.90 of the Rigveda (10th Mandala, a late addition), describing the origin of the four varnas.

36. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ

The first reference to the fourfold caste system is found in:

a. Purushasukta
b. Rigveda
c. Satapatha Brahmana
d. Manudharmashastral

Answer: (a)
The Purusha Sukta (Rigveda X.90) gives the first reference to the four-fold varna division; it is part of the Rigveda, but the specific answer is the Purusha Sukta.

37. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2012

In which vedic text the term ‘Varna’ is found referred for the first time?

a. Rigveda
b. Atharvaveda
c. Samaveda
d. Yajurveda

Answer: (a)
The word 'varna' first occurs in the Rigveda (arya varna and dasa varna, meaning colour).

38. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about early Vedic society:
1. The family was patriarchal, patrilineal and patrilocal.
2. Monogamy was usual.
3. The term Vaishya derives from Vis.
4. The social units in ascending order were Jana – Vis – Grama – Kula.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All four
d. Only three

Answer: (d)
1, 2 and 3 are correct. 4 is wrong: the ascending order is Kula – Grama – Vis – Jana (Jana being the largest).

39. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Purusha Sukta:
1. It is Rigveda X.90, a late addition in the 10th Mandala.
2. It derives the Brahmana from the mouth and the Kshatriya from the thighs of the Purusha.
3. The word Shudra first appears in the 10th Mandala and not in the family books.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the Kshatriya came from the arms; the Vaishya came from the thighs and the Shudra from the feet.

40. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): Gotra exogamy was not yet established in the Rigvedic period.
Reason (R): In the Rigveda gotra meant a cowpen; it first appears in the sense of lineage in the Atharvaveda.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: in the Rigveda gotra meant only a cowpen, the lineage sense comes first in the Atharvaveda, so gotra exogamy was not yet in place.

41. [Kept own]

According to early Vedic texts, to whom were slave women given as gifts?

a. Foreign merchants
b. Craft guilds
c. Priests
d. Tribal assemblies

Answer: (c)
Dasa and Dasyu captives and slave women are mentioned, including slave women gifted to priests, though slavery was not the base of the economy.

42. [Kept own]

The change from a cattle-based tribal economy to a settled agrarian economy helps explain the later rise of which of the following?

a. Nomadic confederacies and flexible kingship
b. Territorial kingship and varna hierarchy
c. Maritime empires and coin-based trade
d. Temple-centred urban democracy

Answer: (b)
The shift from a cattle-based tribal economy to an agrarian territorial society contributed to the emergence of territorial kingship and a more established varna hierarchy.

43. [Kept own]

What did the distinction between Arya varna and Dasa varna in the early Vedic period mainly reflect?

a. Cultural and linguistic distinction between groups
b. Division based exclusively on wealth
c. Rigid occupational caste system
d. Religious division between two priestly orders

Answer: (a)
Arya and Dasa varna reflected a cultural, linguistic and partly colour-based distinction between Vedic groups and conquered local groups; it was not yet a rigid caste system.

44. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. The word varna first appears in the Rigveda.
2. The Purusha Sukta belongs to the oldest family books of the Rigveda.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
The word varna first occurs in the Rigveda, but the Purusha Sukta is in Mandala X, a late addition, not the family books (II–VII).

6. Dress, Drinks and Pastimes (PYQs 1 · MCQs 2)

- **Garments: Nivi** (undergarment), **Paridhana** (garment), **Adhivasa** (outer wrap) (CDS 2005).
- **Drinks: soma** (ritual drink) and **sura** (fermented, intoxicating drink).
- **Pastimes:** chariot racing, dicing – the **gambler's hymn (X.34)**, music and dance.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.20; app notes 1:17 (sub 7)

45. [PYQ] · CDS 2005

Nivi, Paridhan and Adhivasa were the

a. different types of garments of the Aryans.
b. government officials of the Aryan kings.
c. tribal people of ancient Indians.
d. musical instrument of ancient Indians.

Answer: (a)

Nivi (undergarment), Paridhana (garment) and Adhivasa (outer wrap) were garments of the Vedic Aryans.

46. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Rigvedic age:
1. Sura was a fermented, intoxicating drink, while soma was the ritual drink.
2. The gambler's hymn is Rigveda X.34.
3. Chariot racing was unknown as a pastime.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: chariot racing, dicing, music and dance were pastimes.

Row 18: Later Vedic Period – Eastward Expansion, Iron (krishna Ayas), Painted Grey Ware

1. Eastward Expansion – Kuru-Panchala, Videgha Madhava, Agastya (PYQs 7 · MCQs 11)

Period and spread

- **Later Vedic (post-Rigvedic) period = 1000–600 BC (BCE).** Texts composed in the upper Gangetic basin.
- **Course: Punjab → Ganga-Yamuna Doab** (Kurukshetra, Delhi, upper Doab) → **Kosala** (eastern UP), **Kashi** (Varanasi), **Videha** (north Bihar), reached by about 600 BCE.
- **Kurus** = union of the **Bharatas and Purus**; first between the Sarasvati and Drishadvati, then Delhi and the upper Doab (Kurukshetra). **Panchalas** = middle Doab (Bareilly, Badaun, Farrukhabad).
- **Kuru-Panchala** = **centre / axis of Aryan culture** in the post-Vedic period: the Vedic texts were compiled here (not Anga-Magadha, Kosala-Videha or Matsya-Shurasena).

Place	Capital of
Hastinapur (Meerut district)	Kuru kingdom (Kauravas)
Indraprastha (Purana Qila, Delhi)	Kuru kingdom (Pandavas)
Ahichchhatra (Ramnagar, Bareilly)	Panchala

Videgha Madhava legend (Shatapatha Brahmana)

- **Videgha Madhava** (Mathava), king of Videha, lived on the **Sarasvati**; with his priest **Gautama Rahugana** he followed **Agni Vaishvanara** (sacrificial fire) as it burnt the forests eastward.
- They crossed the **Sadanira (Gandak)**; the land beyond was settled as **Videha**.
- Read as the eastward movement and agricultural colonisation by **burning and clearing forests** (fire and iron axes).

Aryanisation of the South

- **Agastya** = the sage said to have **Aryanised South India** (crossed the Vindhyas); not Vishvamitra, Vasishtha or Apastamba.

> Axis of Aryan culture = Kuru-Panchala; Videgha Madhava's priest = Gautama Rahugana; river crossed = Sadanira (Gandak).

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.30; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.131, p.139, p.148; old app notes 1:18

- **Hastinapura** (Meerut district, UP) lies about 100 km north-east of **Delhi** – of Lucknow, Patna, Delhi, Chandigarh the nearest modern city is Delhi.

1. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

In the post-Vedic period which was considered as the axis of Aryan Culture

a. Anga, Magadha
b. Kosal, Videha
c. Kuru, Panchala
d. Matsya, Shurasena

Answer: (c)
Kuru-Panchala, where the Later Vedic texts were compiled, became the cradle (axis) of Aryan culture; Kosala-Videha was only a later zone of expansion.

2. [PYQ] · UP Lower Sub (Pre) 2015

The priest associated with King Videgha Madhava referred in Shatapatha Brahmin was

a. Rishi Bharadwaj
b. Rishi Vashishtha
c. Rishi Vishwamitra
d. Rishi Gautama Rahugana

Answer: (d)
In the Shatapatha Brahmana Videgha Madhava, accompanied by his priest Gautama Rahugana, followed Agni Vaishvanara east across the Sadanira; Vasishtha and Vishvamitra are Rigvedic priests.

3. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2007

Which among the following is considered as the centre of Aryan civilisation during post-Vedic Period?

a. Anga, Magadha
b. Kosal, Videh
c. Kuru, Panchal
d. Matsya, Surasena

Answer: (c)
Kuru-Panchala (Delhi-Meerut region, capital Hastinapur) was the centre of Aryan culture, where the Vedic texts were compiled; Kosala-Videha was only a later zone of expansion.

4. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

The sage who is said to have Aryanised South India was

a. Vishwamitra
b. Agastya
c. Vashishtha
d. Sambhara

Answer: (b)

Tradition credits Agastya with crossing the Vindhyas and Aryanising South India; he is also called the father of Tamil literature. Vishvamitra and Vasishtha were Rigvedic priests of the north.

5. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ

The sage who is said to have Aryanised South India was:

a. Apastambha
b. Vasishtha
c. Viswamitra
d. Agastya

Answer: (d)

Sage Agastya is traditionally credited with spreading Vedic (Aryan) culture into South India; Apastamba was a Sutra author, Vasishtha and Vishvamitra northern Rigvedic priests.

6. [PYQ] · SSC 2004

The period of Post Rigvedic period is

a. 15000 BC-1000 BC
b. 1000 BC-600 BC
c. 600BC-600AD
d. None of the above

Answer: (b)

The post-Rigvedic (Later Vedic) period is dated 1000-600 BC; 600 BC onwards is the Mahajanapada age.

7. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022 **disputed**

Hastinapura can be identified with which one of the following modern cities?

a. Lucknow
b. Patna
c. Delhi
d. Chandigarh

Answer: (c)

Key / most books: Delhi. Strictly: Hastinapur lies in Meerut district (UP), ~96 km NE of Delhi; Delhi is Indraprastha (en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hastinapur).
Hastinapura, the Kuru capital, is the option associated with Delhi (Indraprastha) among those given; the site itself lies in Meerut district, UP.

8. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Later Vedic Kurus and Panchalas:
1. The Kurus were formed by the union of the Bharatas and the Purus.
2. The Panchalas held the upper Doab around Kurukshetra.
3. Hastinapur in Meerut district was a capital of the Kuru kingdom.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)

1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: the Kurus held Delhi and the upper Doab (Kurukshetra); the Panchalas held the middle Doab (Bareilly, Badaun, Farrukhabad), with their capital at Ahichchhatra.

9. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Videgha Madhava legend:
1. It is narrated in the Shatapatha Brahmana.
2. Videgha Madhava and his priest crossed the Sadanira (Gandak) and the land beyond was settled as Videha.
3. They followed Agni Vaishvanara as it burnt the forests westward from the Sarasvati.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)

1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Agni Vaishvanara burnt the forests eastward, marking the eastward movement from the Sarasvati.

10. [New pattern · assertion]

Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): The Videgha Madhava legend is read as the agricultural colonisation of the eastern Gangetic lands.
Reason (R): The Later Vedic people cleared the Gangetic forests by burning and with iron axes.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the fire burning the forests eastward stands for forest clearance by fire and iron axes, which opened the land for settlement and farming.

11. [Kept own]

Which one of the following represents the broad sequence of the Later Vedic eastward expansion?

a. Punjab → Ganga-Yamuna Doab → Kosala, Kashi and Videha
b. Videha → Punjab → Kuru-Panchala → Kosala
c. Kashi → Punjab → Videha → Kuru-Panchala
d. Kosala → Punjab → Kashi → Ganga-Yamuna Doab

Answer: (a)
The movement proceeded from Punjab into the Ganga-Yamuna Doab, including Kurukshetra and the Delhi-upper Doab, and then towards Kosala, Kashi and Videha by about 600 BCE.

2. Pottery Sequence and Painted Grey Ware (PYQs 4 · MCQs 11)

Sequence of protohistoric pottery (Ganga-Yamuna Doab)

Order	Pottery	Date	Phase
1	Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP)	2000–1500 BCE	Chalcolithic
2	Black and Red Ware (BRW)	1450–1200 BCE	Chalcolithic; also Later Vedic; Megalithic south
3	Painted Grey Ware (PGW)	1200–500 BCE	Early Iron Age / Later Vedic
4	Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)	700–100 BCE (from c. 600 BCE in the Ganga valley)	Mahajanapadas, second urbanisation

- **OCP** is an ill-fired red ware that leaves an **ochre colour on the fingers**; **christened (named) at Hastinapur by B.B. Lal (1950–52)**, not Ahichchhatra, Noh or Red Fort.
- **Four wares known to the Later Vedic people: Red Ware** (most popular), **Black-slipped Ware**, **Black-and-Red Ware**, **Painted Grey Ware** (most distinctive) = I, II, III, IV. **NBPW is NOT** Later Vedic (post-Vedic, shiny black).

Painted Grey Ware culture

- **Grey pottery with black linear / geometric painted designs**; mainly **bowls and dishes**; deluxe tableware of the upper strata; not polished black.
- **Pottery of 1000–600 BC in the Gangetic plain = PGW.**
- About **700 sites**, mainly in the **upper Ganga basin** and the Indo-Gangetic divide (Punjab, Haryana, western UP) – not the lower Indus basin.
- First found at **Ahichchhatra** (excavations 1940–44); **Hastinapur** excavation (1950–52, **B.B. Lal**) established it as a culture.
- Finds: **iron weapons**, copper objects (copper possibly from **Khetri**, Rajasthan), glass, bone, semi-precious beads (trade, barter; no coins).

Site	Region
Hastinapur	Meerut, western UP (Kuru capital)
Atranjikhera	Etah, western UP (Doab)
Ahichchhatra	Bareilly, UP
Bhagwanpura	Haryana – 13-roomed mud house; pre-iron PGW with late Harappan pottery
Noh	Rajasthan (OCP–BRW–PGW sequence)

- Early PGW (Ghaggar-Hakra, Bhagwanpura) has **no iron**; later Doab PGW is iron-using.

> Later Vedic wares exclude NBPW; PGW = upper Ganga basin, 1000–600 BC; OCP named at Hastinapur.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.30, p.32; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.133; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.6-9; old app notes 1:18

12. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ disputed

Consider the following types of pottery: 6.
I. Black and Red Ware
II. Black Slipped Ware
III. Painted Grey Ware
IV. Red Ware
V. Northern Black Polished Ware
Which of the above types of pottery were associated with the Later Vedic people?

a. II, III and IV only
b. II, III and V only
c. I, II, III and IV
d. I, II, III, IV and V 7

Answer: (c)
APPSC key (G1 2024): II, III and IV only. R.S. Sharma and PMF list four Later Vedic wares including Black-and-Red Ware.
Later Vedic people knew four wares: Red ware, Black-slipped ware, Black-and-red ware and Painted Grey Ware, i.e. I, II, III and IV. Only NBPW (from c. 600 BCE, post-Vedic) is excluded. (official key: II, III and IV only)

13. [PYQ] · APPSC 2023 Screening test (Online Mode) to the post of Deput

The pottery from 1000 B.C. to 600 B.C. found in the Gangetic plain is called the _____pottery.

a. Painted Black Ware
b. Painted Grey Ware
c. Painted White Ware
d. Painted Brown Ware

Answer: (b)
Painted Grey Ware is the pottery of the Later Vedic period (1000-600 BC) in the Gangetic plain; the other names are not wares of this sequence.

14. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

The Ochre-coloured Pottery (O.C.P.) was christened at:

a. Hastinapur
b. Ahichhatra
c. Noh
d. Red Fort

Answer: (a)
B.B. Lal named (christened) the Ochre Coloured Pottery at Hastinapur during his 1950-52 excavation; it leaves an ochre colour on the fingers when rubbed.

15. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Mains) 2006

The ochre-coloured pottery was christened in

a. Hastinapur
b. Ahichatra
c. Nuh
d. Red Fort

Answer: (a)
Ochre Coloured Pottery was named at Hastinapur by B.B. Lal during his 1950-52 excavation, so Hastinapur is correct.

16. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the protohistoric pottery sequence of the Ganga–Yamuna Doab:
1. Ochre Coloured Pottery is dated to about 2000–1500 BCE.
2. Black and Red Ware is dated to about 1450–1200 BCE.
3. Painted Grey Ware comes after the Northern Black Polished Ware.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the order is OCP – BRW – PGW (1200–500 BCE) – NBPW (700–100 BCE); PGW comes before NBPW.

17. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Painted Grey Ware culture:
1. About 700 PGW sites are known.
2. Its sites lie mainly in the upper Ganga basin and the Indo-Gangetic divide.
3. PGW was first found at Hastinapur in the excavations of 1940–44.
4. Copper at PGW sites possibly came from Khetri in Rajasthan.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only three
b. Only two
c. Only one
d. All four

Answer: (a)
1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: PGW was first found at Ahichchhatra (1940–44); B.B. Lal's Hastinapur excavation (1950–52) established it as a culture.

18. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Painted Grey Ware site) with List-II (Region):
List-I | List-II
a. Hastinapur | i. Rajasthan
b. Atranjikhera | ii. Meerut, western UP
c. Bhagwanpura | iii. Haryana
d. Noh | iv. Etah, western UP
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
c. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
d. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii

Answer: (b)
Hastinapur – Meerut (Kuru capital); Atranjikhera – Etah (Doab); Bhagwanpura – Haryana (13-roomed mud house, pre-iron PGW with late Harappan pottery); Noh – Rajasthan (OCP–BRW–PGW sequence).

19. [Kept own]

Which pottery leaves an ochre colour on the fingers when rubbed?

a. Black and Red Ware
b. Ochre Coloured Pottery
c. Painted Grey Ware
d. Black Slipped Ware

Answer: (b)
Ochre Coloured Pottery, named at Hastinapur by B.B. Lal, leaves an ochre colour on the fingers.

20. [Kept own]

Which pottery is the shiny black ware associated with the Mahajanapadas and the second urbanisation?

a. Painted Grey Ware
b. Black Slipped Ware
c. Black and Red Ware
d. Northern Black Polished Ware

Answer: (d)
NBPW, from about 600 BCE, is the shiny black ware of the Mahajanapada phase; PGW is grey.

21. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Painted Grey Ware:
1. It is grey pottery bearing linear painted designs.
2. It consists mainly of bowls and dishes.
3. It is a highly polished black pottery.
Which of the above statements are correct?

a. 1, 2 and 3
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (c)
PGW is grey pottery with linear painted designs, mostly bowls and dishes (c. 1000-600 BCE). Highly polished black pottery describes NBPW.

22. [Kept own]

Who excavated Hastinapur in 1950-52 and established Painted Grey Ware as a culture?

a. B.B. Lal
b. H.D. Sankalia
c. Mortimer Wheeler
d. R.D. Banerji

Answer: (a)
B.B. Lal's excavation at Hastinapur (1950-52) established the Painted Grey Ware as a culture.

3. Iron – Krishna Ayas, Dates and Earliest Sites (PYQs 1 · MCQs 7)

Vedic metal terms

Term	Meaning
Ayas (Rigveda)	Copper or bronze
Krishna ayas / Shyama ayas ("black metal")	Iron (Later Vedic texts; first in the Yajurveda)
Lohita ayas	Copper
Hiranya	Gold
Nishka	Gold ornament; later a unit of value

Iron in North India

- Iron technology about **1000–800 BCE**; common at most **PGW sites** of the Doab; iron weapons (arrowheads, spearheads) common in western UP from about 800 BCE.
- Iron axes and fire cleared Gangetic forests; knowledge of iron reached Kosala and Videha by the end of the period.
- **Earliest iron among the classic northern sites = Atranjikhera** (Etah, UP; excavated by R.C. Gaur) – not Taxila, Kaushambi or Hastinapur. Other early sites: Hastinapur, Kaushambi, Taxila (Gandhara, c. 1000 BC).
- **Jakhera** (UP): iron in the **Black and Red Ware phase, before 1200 BCE**; iron in Dharwar (Karnataka) c. 1000 BCE.

Earliest iron – Tamil Nadu dates (2025)

Site	District (TN)	Finding
Sivagalai	Thoothukudi	Iron dated to about 2953 BCE (to 3345 BCE) – now the oldest (TN report, Jan 2025)
Mayiladumparai	Krishnagiri	Iron AMS-dated to 2172 BCE; earliest claim before Sivagalai
Thirumalapuram	Tenkasi	Iron Age urn chamber
Adichanallur	Thoothukudi	Urn burials; not a PGW or northern iron site

- These dates push iron use far earlier than the Gangetic 1000 BCE; they say **nothing about where PGW began**.
- **First metal used in India = copper** (Chalcolithic = "copper-stone" age, Greek *khalkos* + *lithos*); iron came later.

> Krishna ayas = iron, not copper; Sivagalai (2953 BCE) is older than Mayiladumparai (2172 BCE).

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.30, p.32; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.132; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.7; old app notes 1:18

23. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998 outdated

The earliest evidence of the use of iron in India has been discovered from :

a. Taxila
b. Atranjikhera
c. Kaushambi
d. Hastinapur

Answer: (b)

older iron has since been found — now Tamil Nadu sites lead: Mayiladumparai (2172 BCE) and Sivagalai (c. 2953 BCE, TN Archaeology report Jan 2025); in the north Jakhera (before 1200 BCE)
Of the sites offered, Atranjikhera (Etah, UP; excavated by R.C. Gaur) gave the earliest iron (c. 1200-1000 BC); Taxila, Kaushambi and Hastinapur are later.

24. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Vedic metal term) with List-II (Metal):
List-I | List-II
a. Ayas (Rigveda) | i. Copper
b. Krishna ayas | ii. Copper or bronze
c. Lohita ayas | iii. Gold
d. Hiranya | iv. Iron
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
b. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (b)

Ayas (Rigveda) – copper or bronze; krishna ayas / shyama ayas ('black metal') – iron, first in the Yajurveda; lohita ayas – copper; hiranya – gold.

25. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about early iron finds in Tamil Nadu:
1. Iron from Sivagalai (Thoothukudi) is dated to about 2953 BCE, now the oldest.
2. Mayiladumparai in Krishnagiri district has yielded iron AMS-dated to 2172 BCE.
3. Adichanallur is an early northern iron site of the Painted Grey Ware.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Adichanallur (Thoothukudi) is known for urn burials; it is not a PGW or northern iron site.

26. [Kept own]

In which period did iron technology emerge in North India?

a. 1500 and 1200 BCE
b. 1000 and 800 BCE
c. 1200 and 1000 BCE
d. 600 and 400 BCE

Answer: (b)
Iron technology in North India is dated to about 1000-800 BCE and was common at most Painted Grey Ware sites.

27. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the iron dates from Tamil Nadu:
1. They establish that Painted Grey Ware originated in Tamil Nadu.
2. They suggest iron use in India began much earlier than the Gangetic date of about 1000 BCE.
Which of the above statements is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)
The Mayiladumparai (2172 BCE) and Sivagalai (about 2953 BCE) dates push Indian iron use far earlier than about 1000 BCE; they say nothing about the origin of Painted Grey Ware.

28. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about iron in the Later Vedic period:
1. Iron axes and fire helped clear the Gangetic forests.
2. Taxila in Gandhara has yielded iron of about 1000 BC.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Iron axes with fire cleared the Gangetic forests, and Taxila is listed among the early iron sites (c. 1000 BC).

29. [Kept own]

Which was the first metal used by the people of India?

a. Copper
b. Iron
c. Gold
d. Silver

Answer: (a)
Copper was the first metal used in India, in the Chalcolithic (copper-stone) age; iron came later.

4. Agriculture, Settlements and Crafts (PYQs 0 · MCQs 6)

- **Agriculture** became the main livelihood; wooden ploughshare common; ploughs drawn by **6, 8, 12 and even 24 oxen**.

Crop	Later Vedic term
Rice	Vrihi (ritual use; rice remains of 8th c. BCE at Hastinapur, Atranjikhera)
Wheat	Godhuma
Barley	Yava (continued)
Sugarcane	Ikshu

- **Settlements:** mainly **villages** of mud-brick and wattle-and-daub houses; **burnt bricks not common**; Hastinapur and Kaushambi only proto-urban; **true towns** came in the **NBPW phase** (second urbanisation: Shravasti, Kausambi, Hastinapur).

- **Crafts:** carpentry (chariots), leather, pottery, weaving (by women), copper-bronze-iron smiths; **Shresthins** = merchant groups; units of value **nishka, satamana, krishnala**; barter still main.
- **AP angle:** Iron Age in Andhra = **Megalithic culture with BRW** (Brahmagiri, Nagarjunakonda, Gudivada, Jonnawada); H.D. Sankalia: rice first harvested in AP in the Iron Age (Megalithic) era.
- **Sep 2026:** BHU opened 22 sealed boxes of 10,000+ **Rajghat** (Varanasi) artefacts; pre-NBPW pottery dates Varanasi's urban origins to about **800 BCE**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.32; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.132-133; old app notes 1:18

30. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Later Vedic agriculture:
1. Rice (vrihi) had ritual use.
2. Rice remains of the 8th century BCE have been found at Hastinapur and Atranjikhera.
3. Wheat was called yava.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: wheat was godhuma; yava is barley.

31. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Iron Age in Andhra Pradesh:
1. It is represented by the Megalithic culture with Black and Red Ware.
2. Brahmagiri, Nagarjunakonda, Gudivada and Jonnawada are sites of this culture.
3. According to H.D. Sankalia, rice was first harvested in Andhra Pradesh in the Neolithic era.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1, 2 and 3
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: Sankalia held that rice was first harvested in AP in the Iron Age (Megalithic) era.

32. [Kept own]

The emergence of the ‘second urbanisation’ is associated with which pottery phase and which group of settlements?

a. Black and Red Ware; Videha and Kekaya
b. Northern Black Polished Ware; Shravasti, Kausambi and Hastinapur
c. Painted Grey Ware; Kurukshetra and Bhagwanpura
d. Red Ware; Punjab and Sarasvati

Answer: (b)
True towns emerged after the Vedic period during the Northern Black Polished Ware phase, including Shravasti, Kausambi and Hastinapur.

33. [Kept own]

What is the largest number of oxen mentioned for yoking a plough in the Later Vedic period?

a. 8
b. 12
c. 16
d. 24

Answer: (d)
Ploughs were described as yoked with 6, 8, 12 and even 24 oxen, showing the growing scale of plough agriculture.

34. [Kept own]

Who were the 'Shresthins' in the Later Vedic period?

a. Groups of merchants
b. Royal bodyguards
c. Forest-dwelling ascetics
d. Village priests

Answer: (a)
Shresthins point to merchant groups. Nishka functioned as a unit of value, while barter continued as the main form of exchange.

35. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Later Vedic settlements:
1. They were mainly villages of mud and wattle houses.
2. Burnt bricks were commonly used.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
Settlements were mainly villages of mud and wattle houses; burnt bricks were not common.

5. Later Vedic Religion – Gods and Priests (PYQs 0 · MCQs 4)

God	Position
Prajapati	Creator; became supreme
Vishnu	Rose as preserver (minor in the Rigveda)
Rudra	God of animals; later merged with Shiva
Pushan	Cattle god; god of the Shudras
Indra, Agni, Varuna	Lost importance

- Prayers declined; elaborate **sacrifices** grew, raising the priests' power; Upanishadic thinkers criticised **ritualism**.

Priest	Veda / role
Hotri	Recited the Rigveda
Adhvaryu	Yajurveda; did the practical, manual work of the sacrifice
Udgatri	Chanted the Samaveda
Brahman	Atharvaveda; supervised

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.33; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.139; old app notes 1:18

36. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Later Vedic god) with List-II (Position):
List-I | List-II
a. Prajapati | i. Rose as preserver
b. Vishnu | ii. Creator; became supreme
c. Rudra | iii. Cattle god; god of the Shudras
d. Pushan | iv. God of animals, later merged with Shiva
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (a)
Prajapati – creator, became supreme; Vishnu – rose as preserver (minor in the Rigveda); Rudra – god of animals, later merged with Shiva; Pushan – cattle god, god of the Shudras. Indra, Agni and Varuna lost importance.

37. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Priest) with List-II (Veda / role):
List-I | List-II
a. Hotri | i. Chanted the Samaveda
b. Adhvaryu | ii. Atharvaveda; supervised
c. Udgatri | iii. Yajurveda; practical, manual work of the sacrifice
d. Brahman | iv. Recited the Rigveda
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
b. a-iv, b-iii, c-i, d-ii
c. a-iv, b-i, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (b)
Hotri – recited the Rigveda; Adhvaryu – Yajurveda, did the manual work; Udgatri – chanted the Samaveda; Brahman – Atharvaveda, supervised the sacrifice.

38. [Kept own]
The Upanishadic thinkers criticised which tendency of Later Vedic religion?

a. Elaborate ritualism
b. Image worship in temples
c. Worship of mother goddesses
d. Tree worship

Answer: (a)
Later Vedic worship became centred on elaborate rituals, which prompted the Upanishadic critique.

39. [Kept own]
Which Later Vedic god of animals later merged with Shiva?

a. Pushan
b. Prajapati
c. Rudra
d. Varuna

Answer: (c)
Rudra, god of animals, later merged with Shiva.

Row 19: Later Vedic Polity – Territorial Kingship, Royal Sacrifices, Ratnins

1. Kingdoms and Philosopher-Kings (PYQs 1 · MCQs 4)

Kingdom	Region
Kuru	Delhi–Meerut / upper Doab; Hastinapur, Kurukshetra
Panchala	Middle Doab–Rohilkhand; Ahichchhatra
Kosala	Eastern UP
Kashi	Varanasi region
Videha	North Bihar, beyond the Sadanira (Gandak); King Janaka

- Kuru-Panchala dominated the upper Ganga valley; **Kosala, Kashi and Videha** then rose in the east → Mahajanapadas.

Upanishadic (Kshatriya scholar) kings – they taught Brahmins

King	Kingdom
Janaka	Videha
Ashvapati	Kekaya
Ajatashatru	Kashi (not the Magadha king)
Pravahana Jaivali	Panchala

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.131, p.140; old app notes 1:18, 1:19

1. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

King Asvapati of the Upanishadic period was the ruler of:

a. Kashi
b. Kekaya
c. Panchala
d. Videha

Answer: (b)

Ashvapati, a Kshatriya scholar-king of the Upanishads who taught Brahmins, ruled Kekaya; Janaka ruled Videha, Pravahana Jaivali Panchala and Ajatashatru Kashi.

2. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Later Vedic kingdom) with List-II (Association):
List-I | List-II
a. Kuru | i. Hastinapur and Kurukshetra
b. Panchala | ii. Ahichchhatra
c. Videha | iii. Beyond the Sadanira; King Janaka
d. Kashi | iv. Varanasi region
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (b)

Kuru – Delhi–Meerut / upper Doab (Hastinapur, Kurukshetra); Panchala – middle Doab–Rohilkhand (Ahichchhatra); Videha – north Bihar beyond the Sadanira (Gandak), King Janaka; Kashi – Varanasi region.

3. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Upanishadic scholar-king) with List-II (Kingdom):
List-I | List-II
a. Janaka | i. Kashi
b. Ashvapati | ii. Kekaya
c. Ajatashatru | iii. Videha
d. Pravahana Jaivali | iv. Panchala
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv

Answer: (c)

Janaka – Videha; Ashvapati – Kekaya; Ajatashatru – Kashi (not the Magadha king); Pravahana Jaivali – Panchala. These Kshatriya kings taught Brahmins.

4. [Kept own]
Which development contributed to the emergence of the Mahajanapadas?

a. The exclusive expansion of Kuru power into the Deccan
b. The rise of Kosala, Kashi and Videha in the east after Kuru–Panchala dominance in the upper Ganga valley
c. The replacement of agriculture by maritime trade in North India
d. The disappearance of all territorial kingdoms in favour of tribal units

Answer: (b)
The Kuru–Panchala alliance dominated the upper Ganga valley, while Kosala, Kashi and Videha rose in the east. This political development contributed to the emergence of the Mahajanapadas.

2. Royal Sacrifices – Rajasuya, Ashvamedha, Vajapeya (PYQs 1 · MCQs 5)

Sacrifice	Purpose
Rajasuya	Royal consecration; conferred supreme power; includes the Ratnahavimshi (offerings at the Ratnins' houses)
Ashvamedha	Horse sacrifice; supremacy over other kings and control of the area the horse roamed
Vajapeya	"Drink of strength"; chariot race won by the king over his kinsmen
Punarabhisheka	Second anointing at the end of the Rajasuya

- **Muvendavelan** is a title (Chola-period chief), **not** a royal sacrifice.
- Large **Shrauta** sacrifices needed many priests and heavy **dakshina** (up to 2,40,000 cows in a Rajasuya) → strengthened the **Brahmanas**.
- **AP angle:** Satavahanas, **Ikshvakus**, Vishnukundins performed these rites; Ikshvaku titles: **Vajapeya = Samrat/Virat; Ashvamedha = Swarat**; an **Ashvamedha altar at Nagarjunakonda**.

> Ashvamedha = over other kings; Vajapeya = over kinsmen; Rajasuya = consecration.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.31; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.134, p.140; old app notes 1:19

5. [PYQ] · SSC CGL 2019
Which of the following was not a type of sacrifice performed by kings in ancient India to establish their position?

a. Vajapeya
b. Rajasuya
c. Ashvamedha
d. Muvendavelan

Answer: (d)
Rajasuya, Ashvamedha and Vajapeya were the royal sacrifices by which kings asserted their position; Muvendavelan is a Chola-period title, not a sacrifice.

6. [New pattern · match]
Match List-I (Later Vedic royal sacrifice) with List-II (Feature):
List-I | List-II
a. Rajasuya | i. Horse sacrifice; supremacy over other kings
b. Ashvamedha | ii. 'Drink of strength'; chariot race won over kinsmen
c. Vajapeya | iii. Second anointing at the end of the Rajasuya
d. Punarabhisheka | iv. Royal consecration conferring supreme power
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
c. a-iv, b-i, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (d)
Rajasuya – royal consecration (includes the Ratnahavimshi); Ashvamedha – horse sacrifice, supremacy over other kings and the area the horse roamed; Vajapeya – 'drink of strength', chariot race won over kinsmen; Punarabhisheka – second anointing at the end of the Rajasuya.

7. [New pattern · assertion]
Consider the following statements:
Assertion (A): Large Shrauta sacrifices strengthened the position of the Brahmanas in the Later Vedic period.
Reason (R): Such sacrifices needed many priests and heavy dakshina, up to 2,40,000 cows in a Rajasuya.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
b. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
c. A is true, but R is false
d. A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the elaborate Shrauta rites required many priests and enormous dakshina, which raised the power of the Brahmanas.

8. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Vedic royal sacrifices in Andhra:
1. The Satavahanas, Ikshvakus and Vishnukundins performed these rites.
2. Among the Ikshvakus, the Vajapeya brought the title Swarat.
3. An Ashvamedha altar has been found at Nagarjunakonda.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
1 and 3 are correct. 2 is wrong: among the Ikshvakus the Vajapeya brought the title Samrat/Virat; the Ashvamedha brought Swarat.

9. [Kept own]

Over whom did the Ashvamedha sacrifice proclaim the king's supremacy?

a. His kinsmen
b. Other kings
c. The Brahmanas
d. The village assembly

Answer: (b)
Ashvamedha asserted supremacy over other kings; the Vajapeya chariot race was over kinsmen.

3. Assemblies and Taxes (PYQs 1 · MCQs 4)

- **Vidatha disappeared**; **Sabha and Samiti continued** but declined, dominated by chiefs, nobles and Brahmanas; **women no longer sat** in the Sabha; village assemblies tried local cases.

Tax	Nature
Bali	Tribute: voluntary in the Rigveda, now regular and compulsory – the king's tax on the people
Bhaga	King's share of produce (one-sixth; texts give 1/6 to 1/2)
Shulka	Customs / tolls

- **Vaishyas** were the main (only) **tribute-payers**; Bhagadugha collected, Sangrahitri managed the revenue.
- Varman = armour, Vidatha = assembly – not taxes.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.31-32; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.134-136; old app notes 1:19

10. [PYQ] · SSC 2008

The post-Vedic period tax was collected by king from people was called

a. Bali
b. Varman
c. Vidath
d. Tax

Answer: (a)
In the Later Vedic period bali, earlier a voluntary gift, became an obligatory tribute collected by the king. Varman is armour and Vidatha an assembly that vanished.

11. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Later Vedic taxes:
1. Bali, voluntary in the Rigveda, became a regular and compulsory tax.
2. Bhaga was the king's share of the produce, usually one-sixth.
3. Shulka was a land tax paid by the Brahmanas.
4. The Vaishyas were the main tribute-payers.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only three
b. Only two
c. Only one
d. All four

Answer: (a)
1, 2 and 4 are correct. 3 is wrong: shulka meant customs / tolls; the Vaishyas were the main (only) tribute-payers.

12. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Later Vedic taxation:
1. Bhagadugha was the revenue collector.
2. Sangrahitri was the treasurer who managed the revenue.
Which of the above statements is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Bhagadugha collected the revenue and Sangrahitri, the treasurer, managed it. Vaishyas were the main tribute-payers.

13. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Later Vedic assemblies:
1. The Vidatha disappeared.
2. The Sabha and Samiti continued under chiefs, Brahmanas and rich nobles.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
The Vidatha vanished, while the Sabha and Samiti survived under chiefs, Brahmanas and nobles.

4. From Tribe to Territory – Kingship (PYQs 0 · MCQs 8)

- **Jana** (tribe) → **janapada / rashtra** (territory); the word **rashtra** first appears in the Later Vedic texts; tribal chiefdom → **hereditary territorial monarchy**, which prepared the way for the **Mahajanapadas** (6th century BCE).
- Kingship **hereditary**, usually to the **eldest son** (primogeniture); men became rajas by performing big sacrifices; traces of election survived.
- **Ekarat** (Atharvaveda, Aitareya Brahmana) = **sole / paramount ruler**.

Region (Aitareya Brahmana)	Ruler's title
East	Samrat
South	Bhoja
West	Svarat
North	Virat

- State forms in the Aitareya Brahmana: **Rajya, Bhojya, Swarajya, Vairajya, Samrajya** – **Ganatantra is NOT** one.

Divine origin of kingship

Text	Statement
Aitareya Brahmana	Earliest account: the gods, losing to the Asuras, chose a king to lead them; king = protector of Brahmins
Taittiriya Brahmana	Theory of the divine origin of kingship
Shatapatha Brahmana	Linked the king with Prajapati; Rajasuya and Vajapeya gave him divine qualities

- Kingship was **not** traced to election by village assemblies.

Early Vedic	Later Vedic
Tribe; cattle; elective chief	Territory; agriculture; hereditary king
Voluntary bali; strong assemblies	Compulsory taxes (bali, bhaga, shulka); assemblies decline; Ratnins

East = Samrat, North = Virat; rashtra first appears now.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.30-31; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.134, p.141; old app notes 1:19

14. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Later Vedic kingship:
1. The word rashtra first appears in the Later Vedic texts.
2. Kingship was hereditary, usually passing to the eldest son.
3. Ekarat in the Aitareya Brahmana means a ruler elected by the Samiti.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct (traces of election survived). 3 is wrong: Ekarat (Atharvaveda, Aitareya Brahmana) means the sole / paramount ruler.

15. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Region, as in the Aitareya Brahmana) with List-II (Ruler's title):
List-I | List-II
a. East | i. Svarat
b. South | ii. Virat
c. West | iii. Samrat
d. North | iv. Bhoja
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
b. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
c. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
d. a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii

Answer: (d)
East – Samrat; South – Bhoja; West – Svarat; North – Virat.

16. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the origin of kingship in the Later Vedic texts:
1. The Aitareya Brahmana gives the earliest account: the gods, losing to the Asuras, chose a king to lead them.
2. The Aitareya Brahmana regards the king as the protector of Brahmins.
3. The Taittiriya Brahmana traces kingship to election by village assemblies.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: the Taittiriya Brahmana gives the theory of the divine origin of kingship; kingship was not traced to election by village assemblies.

17. [Kept own]

What did Later Vedic society become, in contrast to the tribe-based Early Vedic society?

a. Tribe-based with voluntary bali
b. Nomadic and pastoral
c. Urban and based on coined money
d. Territory-based with agriculture and compulsory taxes

Answer: (d)
The Early Vedic phase meant tribe, cattle and voluntary bali; the Later Vedic phase meant territory, agriculture and compulsory taxes.

18. [Kept own]

The change from tribal chiefdom to hereditary territorial monarchy in the Later Vedic period prepared the way for which of the following in the 6th century BCE?

a. Republican guilds
b. Colonial provinces
c. Mahajanapadas
d. Urban corporations

Answer: (c)
The shift to hereditary territorial monarchy during the Later Vedic period prepared the political ground for the rise of the Mahajanapadas in the 6th century BCE.

19. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT one of the state forms named in the Aitareya Brahmana?

a. Bhojya
b. Vairajya
c. Rajya
d. Ganatantra

Answer: (d)
The Aitareya Brahmana names Rajya, Bhojya, Swarajya, Vairajya and Samrajya. Ganatantra is not included in this list.

20. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the Shatapatha Brahmana's theory of kingship:
1. It linked the king with Prajapati.
2. It regarded the Rajasuya and Vajapeya as giving the king divine qualities.
3. It traced kingship exclusively to election by village assemblies.
Which of the above statements are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
The Shatapatha Brahmana linked the king to Prajapati and saw the Rajasuya and Vajapeya as conferring divine qualities; it did not trace kingship to village election.

21. [Kept own]

Which of the following belongs to the Later Vedic polity rather than the Early Vedic polity?

a. Ratnins
b. An elective chief
c. Voluntary bali
d. Strong assemblies

Answer: (a)
Ratnins were part of the Later Vedic polity; an elective chief, voluntary bali and strong assemblies marked the Early Vedic polity.

5. Ratnins and Officials (PYQs 0 · MCQs 4)

- **Ratnins ("jewels")** = the king's council of **12** royal functionaries: purohita, rajan, mahishi, senani, bhagadugha, sangrahitri, suta, kshata, govikartana, gramani, parivakti, akshavapa (some add palagala); honoured in the **Ratnahavimshi** rite of the Rajasuya.

Official	Function
Purohita	Chief priest
Senani	Army chief
Suta	Charioteer and herald
Bhagadugha	Revenue collector (king's share)
Sangrahitri	Treasurer
Akshavapa	Accountant; superintendent of dice
Palagala	Messenger

- More officers but no regular bureaucracy and **no standing army**.

> Bhagadugha collects; Sangrahitri stores.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.31; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.135; old app notes 1:19

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Later Vedic Ratnins:
1. They formed the king's council of 12 royal functionaries.
2. They were honoured in the Ratnahavimshi rite of the Rajasuya.
3. With them the Later Vedic king maintained a standing army.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
1 and 2 are correct. 3 is wrong: there were more officers but no regular bureaucracy and no standing army.

23. [New pattern · match]

Match List-I (Ratnin) with List-II (Function):
List-I | List-II
a. Senani | i. Charioteer and herald
b. Suta | ii. Accountant; superintendent of dice
c. Sangrahitri | iii. Army chief
d. Akshavapa | iv. Treasurer
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. a-iii, b-i, c-iv, d-ii
b. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
c. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (a)
Senani – army chief; Suta – charioteer and herald; Sangrahitri – treasurer; Akshavapa – accountant and superintendent of dice. (Bhagadugha collects, Sangrahitri stores.)

24. [Kept own]

Which one of the following officials was responsible for collecting the king’s share of revenue?

a. Sangrahitri
b. Palagala
c. Bhagadugha
d. Akshavapa

Answer: (c)
Bhagadugha was the revenue or tax collector who collected the king’s share. Sangrahitri was the treasurer, Akshavapa the accountant and superintendent of dice, and Palagala the messenger.

25. [Kept own]

Which of the following Ratnin – office pairs is NOT correctly matched?

a. Purohita – Chief priest
b. Palagala – Messenger
c. Bhagadugha – Treasurer
d. Suta – Charioteer

Answer: (c)
Bhagadugha was the revenue collector; the treasurer was the Sangrahitri.

Row 20: Later Vedic Society – Varnas, Ashramas, Gotra, Status of Women

1. Varna Order, Untouchability and Guilds (PYQs 3 · MCQs 10)

- Society stratified in the order **Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra** = the **Varna system** (varna came to rest on **birth**; spread of jatis is post-Vedic).

Varna	Role
Brahmana	Priests, teachers; most powerful
Kshatriya (Rajanya)	Rulers, warriors
Vaishya	Farmers, herders, traders, artisans; only tribute-payers
Shudra	Service; no upanayana, no Vedas, no Sabha

- First statement of the four varnas: **Purusha Sukta, Rigveda 10th Mandala**; **Dvija** (twice-born) = upper three, entitled to upanayana.
- **Aitareya Brahmana**: Shudra = "**servant of another**", could be expelled or beaten at will.
- Outside the varna order: **Vratyas, Nishadas**.
- Varna + ashrama = **Varnashrama Dharma**.

Untouchability

- **Chhandogya Upanishad**: the **Chandala** as a person of despised birth – an early sign only; untouchability was absent in the Rigvedic age.
- Untouchability took **clear, formal shape in the Dharmashastra phase** (early Christian era), not in the Rigvedic or Later Vedic phase.

Guilds and money-lending

- **Sarthavaha** (caravan leader, head of a trade guild / Srenipramukh) = **Vaishya**; guild rules = **Samay, Srenidharma**; Vaishya guilds (gana) headed by a **Shreshthin**.
- First reference to **money-lending**: **Shatapatha Brahmana**; usurer = **kusidin**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.29, p.32; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.135-137; old app notes 1:20

1. [PYQ] · APPSC Sociology Back Log 2002

Describing social stratification using the order of Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra is called

a. Caste system
b. Human system
c. Varna system
d. Religious system

Answer: (c)

Ordering society as Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra is the varna system; caste (jati) is the later, multiple birth groups.

2. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

In ancient period, which Varna was also called as ‘Sarthavaha’?

a. Brahmana
b. Kshatriya
c. Vaishya
d. Shudra

Answer: (c)

Sarthavaha (Srenipramukh) was the head of a merchant guild or caravan, so the term belongs to the trading Vaishya varna; guild rules were called Samay and Srenidharma.

3. [PYQ] · State PSC

In which phase, the concept of untouchability was put clearly?

a. Rigvedic phase
b. Later Vedic phase
c. Later Gupta phase
d. Dharmashastra phase

Answer: (d)

The Chhandogya Upanishad only calls the Chandala a person of despised birth; untouchability took definite shape in the Dharmashastra phase (early Christian era), not in the Rigvedic or Later Vedic phase.

4. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Later Vedic society:
1. The first statement of the four varnas is found in the Purusha Sukta of the Tenth Mandala of the Rigveda.
2. The Aitareya Brahmana describes the Shudra as 'a servant of another' who could be expelled or beaten at will.
3. The Vratyas and Nishadas were counted among the Dvija, the twice-born.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statements 1 and 2 are correct as per the notes. Statement 3 is wrong: the Vratyas and Nishadas stood outside the varna order; the Dvija were the upper three varnas entitled to upanayana.

5. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about guilds and money-lending in the Vedic age:
1. The rules of the guilds were called Samay and Srenidharma.
2. The Vaishya guilds (gana) were headed by a Gramani.
3. The first reference to money-lending is found in the Shatapatha Brahmana, which calls the usurer kusidin.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
Statement 2 is wrong: Vaishya guilds (gana) were headed by a Shreshthin, not a Gramani. Statements 1 and 3 are correct: guild rules were Samay/Srenidharma, and the Shatapatha Brahmana gives the first reference to money-lending (usurer = kusidin).

6. [New pattern · match]

Match the varnas of Later Vedic society with their roles:
List-I (Varna)
a. Brahmana
b. Kshatriya (Rajanya)
c. Vaishya
d. Shudra
List-II (Role)
i. Rulers and warriors
ii. Priests and teachers; the most powerful
iii. Service; no upanayana, no Vedas, no Sabha
iv. Farmers, herders, traders, artisans; the only tribute-payers
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii
b. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (c)
Brahmana = priests/teachers and most powerful; Kshatriya (also Rajanya) = rulers/warriors; Vaishya = farmers, herders, traders, artisans and the only tribute-payers; Shudra = service, with no upanayana, Vedas or Sabha.

7. [Kept own]

On what did varna increasingly come to be based in the Later Vedic period?

a. Birth
b. Wealth
c. Personal merit
d. Royal appointment

Answer: (a)
Varna became increasingly birth-based in the Later Vedic period, and gotra exogamy became important.

8. [Kept own]

Varnashrama Dharma combines the varna system with which of the following?

a. Gotra system
b. Jati system
c. Sapinda rules
d. Ashrama system

Answer: (d)
Varnashrama Dharma denotes the combined framework of varna and Ashrama.

9. [Kept own]
Which of the following is NOT correct about the Shudra in Later Vedic society?

a. Was excluded from upanayana
b. Was barred from the Vedas
c. Was called 'servant of another' in the Aitareya Brahmana
d. Was counted among the dvija

Answer: (d)
The dvija were the upper three varnas; Shudras had no upanayana and no Vedas.

10. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements:
1. The Chhandogya Upanishad refers to the Chandala as a person of despised birth.
2. Untouchability took a formal shape already in the Rigvedic period.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
Statement 1 is true. Formal untouchability belongs to the post-Vedic Dharmasutra and Dharmashastra phase, not the Rigvedic period.

2. Ashramas, Purusharthas and Pancha Mahayajnas (PYQs 3 · MCQs 8)

Ashrama	Duty
Brahmacharya	Student; Vedic study
Grihastha	Householder; daily Pancha Mahayajnas
Vanaprastha	Gradual withdrawal (forest)
Sannyasa	Complete renunciation; added last

- **Four ashramas** are described; they are the custom that **emerged in the post-Vedic (Later Vedic) period** – the varnas go back to the Rigveda's Purusha Sukta and Indra-Surya-Rudra-Maruts are Rigvedic gods.
- Only the first three were established in Later Vedic times: first three in the **Chhandogya Upanishad**; all four first in the **Jabala Upanishad** (PMF: early Dharmasutras).
- **Pancha Mahayajnas: Brahma** (Vedic study), **Deva** (gods), **Pitri** (ancestors), **Bhuta** (living beings), **Nri / Atithi** (hospitality to guests).
- **Purusharthas:** Dharma (duty), Artha (wealth), Kama (desire) = **trivarga**; **Moksha** (liberation) added later under Upanishadic ideas.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.136; old app notes 1:20

11. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1994 +1 more
Which of the followings customs emerged during the post-Vedic period :

a. Dharma, Artha, Kama, Moksha
b. Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra
c. Brahmcharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sanyasa
d. Indra, Surya, Rudra, Maruta

Answer: (c)
The four ashramas (Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sannyasa) emerged in the post-Vedic period; the four varnas already appear in the Rigveda's Purusha Sukta, and Indra, Surya, Rudra, Maruts are Rigvedic gods. (UPSC 1994 key: ashramas)

12. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 1994
Which of the following custom emerged during the post-Vedic period?

a. Dharma, Artha, Kama and Moksha
b. Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra
c. Brahmacharya, Grihastha ashrama, Vanaprastha and Sannyasa
d. Indra, Surya, Rudra and Maruta

Answer: (c)
The full set of four ashramas emerged only in the post-Vedic period (first three in the Chhandogya, all four in the Jabala Upanishad / early Dharmasutras); the four varnas appear in the Rigveda's Purusha Sukta and the gods named are Rigvedic.

13. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

How many Ashrams are described in Vedas?

a. Five
b. Ten
c. Four
d. Six

Answer: (c)
Four ashramas are described: Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha and Sannyasa.

14. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the ashramas:
1. The first three ashramas are referred to in the Chhandogya Upanishad.
2. All four ashramas are first mentioned in the Jabala Upanishad.
3. Sannyasa was the first of the four ashramas to be established.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is wrong: Sannyasa (complete renunciation) was added last; only the first three were established in Later Vedic times.

15. [New pattern · match]

Match the Pancha Mahayajnas with what they were meant for:
List-I (Yajna)
a. Brahma-yajna
b. Deva-yajna
c. Pitri-yajna
d. Nri (Atithi)-yajna
List-II (Meant for)
i. Hospitality to guests
ii. Study of the Vedas
iii. Duties towards the ancestors
iv. Offerings to the gods
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
b. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv
c. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-iv, b-iii, c-i, d-ii

Answer: (a)
Brahma = Vedic study; Deva = gods; Pitri = ancestors; Nri/Atithi = hospitality to guests (Bhuta-yajna is for living beings).

16. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Moksha was one of the original trivarga of Purusharthas.
Reason (R): Moksha (liberation) was added to the Purusharthas later, under Upanishadic ideas.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (d)
A is false: the trivarga was Dharma, Artha and Kama. R is true: Moksha was added later under Upanishadic ideas.

17. [Kept own]

Which ashrama involved gradual withdrawal from worldly life?

a. Vanaprastha
b. Grihastha
c. Sannyasa
d. Brahmacharya

Answer: (a)
Vanaprastha was gradual withdrawal; Brahmacharya was Vedic study, Grihastha household life and Sannyasa complete detachment.

18. [Kept own]
For whom among the following were the Pancha Mahayajnas daily duties?

a. Sannyasin
b. Brahmacharin
c. Grihastha
d. Vanaprastha

Answer: (c)
The Pancha Mahayajnas were daily duties of the Grihastha, or householder, Ashrama.

3. Gotra and Kinship (PYQs 3 · MCQs 5)

- **Gotra** literally = **cow-pen** (word first in the **Rigveda**, meaning cow shelter); as a **clan descended from a common male ancestor** it was established in **Later Vedic (post-Vedic) times**; the Atharvaveda mentions gotra in the lineage sense.
- **Gotra exogamy**: no marriage within the same gotra (with caste endogamy and **sapinda** rules).
- **Kula** = family; **Vamsha** = lineage; **Gotra** = clan; **Kosa = treasury (odd one out)**.
- **Irawati Karve**: *Kinship Organization in India* (1953) – four kinship zones.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.29, p.32; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.136; old app notes 1:20

19. [PYQ] · SSC 2008
'Gotra' System came into existance since

a. Rigvedic Period
b. Post Vedic Period
c. Mahakavya Period
d. None of the above

Answer: (b)
Gotra as a clan descended from a common ancestor appeared in Later Vedic (post-Vedic) times; in the Rigveda the word meant only a cow-pen.

20. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 1996
In the context of ancient Indian society, which one of the following terms does not belong to the category of the other three?

a. Kula
b. Vamsa
c. Kosa
d. Gotra

Answer: (c)
Kula (family), vamsha (lineage) and gotra (clan) are kinship terms; kosa means treasury, so it is the odd one out.

21. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1996
In the context of ancient Indian society which one of the following terms does not belong to the category of the other three?

a. Kula
b. Vansha
c. Kosa
d. Gotra

Answer: (c)
Vansha, gotra and kula are words of the family system; kosa is the treasury, so it does not belong.

22. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements about gotra and kinship:
1. The word gotra literally means cow-pen and first occurs in the Rigveda.
2. Gotra exogamy prohibited marriage outside one's own gotra.
3. Irawati Karve's Kinship Organization in India (1953) divided India into four kinship zones.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
Statement 2 is wrong: gotra exogamy prohibited marriage WITHIN the same gotra. Statements 1 and 3 are correct as per the notes.

23. [Kept own]
In which text does the word 'gotra' first appear in the sense of lineage?

a. Atharvaveda
b. Rigveda
c. Samaveda
d. Manusmriti

Answer: (a)
Gotra means cow-pen in the Rigveda; the lineage sense first appears in the Atharvaveda.

4. Samskaras, Upanayana and Education (PYQs 2 · MCQs 6)

- **Samskaras = 16** (shodasha): 3 before birth (Garbhadhana, Pumsavana, Simantonnayana), Jatakarma, Chudakarma (tonsure, 3rd year) ... Upanayana, Vivaha, Antyeshti.
- **Upanayana** = sacred-thread initiation into Vedic study for the **upper three varnas**, in the boy's **8th year**; full description in the **Shatapatha Brahmana**; **Shudras and women excluded**.

Varna	Upanayana metre
Brahmana	Gayatri
Kshatriya	Trishtubh
Vaishya	Jagati

- **Gurukula**: the pupil **lived with the guru**.

Teacher	Meaning
Acharya	Initiated the pupil; taught the whole Veda free
Upadhyaya	Taught Veda / Vedangas for a livelihood

> Kshatriya = Trishtubh; Upadhyaya paid, Acharya free.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.31-32; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.117; old app notes 1:20

24. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

There was a provision for reciting which mantra in the Upanayana ritual of the Kshatriya castes?

a. Jagati Mantra
b. Gayatri Mantra
c. Sarvesham Mantra
d. Trishtubh Mantra

Answer: (d)
The Grihya Sutras prescribe the Gayatri metre for a Brahmana's upanayana, Trishtubh for a Kshatriya and Jagati for a Vaishya.

25. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

What is the total number of Sanskaras?

a. 10
b. 12
c. 15
d. 16

Answer: (d)
Sixteen (shodasha) samskaras are traditionally counted, three before birth and the last (antyeshti) after death; Rocket lists Sanskaras = 16.

26. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Upanayana:
1. It was performed in the boy's 8th year.
2. Its full description is found in the Aitareya Brahmana.
3. The metre prescribed for the Upanayana of a Vaishya was the Jagati.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (c)
Statement 2 is wrong: the full description of the Upanayana is in the Shatapatha Brahmana. Statements 1 (8th year) and 3 (Vaishya = Jagati; Brahmana = Gayatri, Kshatriya = Trishtubh) are correct.

27. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. The Acharya taught the Veda to pupils for a livelihood.
2. The Upadhyaya taught the Veda and Vedangas for a livelihood.
3. Chudakarma (tonsure) was performed in the child's third year.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All three
d. None

Answer: (b)
Statement 1 is wrong: the Acharya initiated the pupil and taught the whole Veda free; it was the Upadhyaya who taught for a livelihood (statement 2). Statement 3 is correct: Chudakarma, the tonsure samskara, came in the 3rd year. So two statements are correct.

28. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements about Upanayana:
1. It was open to Shudras and women.
2. It was the sacred-thread initiation into Vedic study for the upper three varnas.
Which of the above statements is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)
Upanayana was the sacred-thread initiation into Vedic study for Brahmanas, Kshatriyas and Vaishyas; Shudras and women were excluded.

29. [Kept own]
Which of the following was true of the pupil in the gurukula system of education?

a. lived with the guru
b. lived separately from the teacher and studied independently
c. entered education after marriage
d. received instruction only from guild heads

Answer: (a)
In the gurukula system, pupils lived with the guru. Education was confined largely to the Dvija communities.

5. Forms of Marriage (PYQs 2 · MCQs 7)

Form	Nature
Brahma	Duly dowered daughter given to a Veda-learned man of good conduct
Daiva	Daughter given to the officiating priest as fee
Arsha	Groom gives a token cow and bull
Prajapatya	No dowry or bride price; couple jointly perform dharma
Asura	Marriage by purchase (bride price)
Gandharva	Mutual love / consent
Rakshasa	Marriage by capture
Paishacha	Seduction of a sleeping or drunk girl; lowest

- **8 forms** listed by Manu and Kautilya; first four approved.
- **Anuloma** = higher-varna man + lower-varna woman; **Pratiloma** = lower-varna man + higher-varna woman (disapproved).
- **Satavahana Andhra (AP angle):** Gautamiputra Satakarni claimed to protect varnashrama dharma; anuloma offspring = **Ugra**, pratiloma offspring = **Chandala**.

> Asura = purchase; Rakshasa = capture; Gandharva = love.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.33; old app notes 1:20

30. [PYQ] · Civil Services (Preliminary) 2001
What is marriage by purchase called?

a. Arsha marriage
b. Asura marriage
c. Demon marriage
d. Satan's marriage

Answer: (b)
Asura marriage is marriage by purchase: the groom paid a bride price to the girl's family. Arsha involved only a token cow and bull.

31. [PYQ] · APPSC Sociology Back Log 2000
Marriage due to mutual love is called as?

a. Gandharva
b. Rakshasa
c. Divine
d. Asura

Answer: (a)
Gandharva marriage rested on the mutual consent (love) of the two parties; Rakshasa was by capture and Asura by purchase.

32. [New pattern · match]

Match the forms of marriage with their nature:
List-I (Form)
a. Daiva
b. Arsha
c. Prajapatya
d. Paishacha
List-II (Nature)
i. Daughter given to the officiating priest as fee
ii. Groom gives a token cow and bull
iii. Seduction of a sleeping or drunk girl
iv. No dowry or bride price; couple jointly perform dharma
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-iv, b-ii, c-i, d-iii
b. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
c. a-iii, b-i, c-ii, d-iv
d. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii

Answer: (d)
Daiva = daughter given to the officiating priest; Arsha = token cow and bull from the groom; Prajapatya = no dowry/bride price, joint dharma; Paishacha = seduction of a sleeping or drunk girl, the lowest form.

33. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about marriage:
1. Manu and Kautilya list eight forms of marriage, of which the first four were approved.
2. Anuloma marriage was between a higher-varna man and a lower-varna woman.
3. In Satavahana Andhra the offspring of an anuloma union were called Chandala.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 3 is wrong: in Satavahana Andhra anuloma offspring were called Ugra; Chandala was the term for pratiloma offspring. Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

34. [Kept own]

Which Satavahana ruler claimed to have protected varnashrama dharma?

a. Simuka
b. Hala
c. Yajna Sri Satakarni
d. Gautamiputra Satakarni

Answer: (d)
Gautamiputra Satakarni claimed to have protected varnashrama dharma.

35. [Kept own]

Which one of the following was regarded as the lowest form of marriage in the Dharmashastra classification?

a. Daiva
b. Prajapatya
c. Paishacha
d. Arsha

Answer: (c)
Paishacha, involving the seduction of a sleeping or intoxicated girl, was regarded as the lowest form of marriage.

36. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT correctly matched?

a. Rakshasa — marriage by purchase
b. Gandharva — marriage by mutual consent
c. Paishacha — seduction of a sleeping or intoxicated girl
d. Asura — payment of bride price

Answer: (a)
Rakshasa marriage involved capture or abduction. Marriage by purchase was known as Asura marriage.

6. Status of Women (PYQs 2 · MCQs 5)

- **Declined**: lost upanayana and political rights (barred from the **Sabha**), excluded from most rituals, could not choose husbands; child marriage appears; symbolic widow self-immolation (sati as a practice is later).

Text	Statement
Aitareya Brahmana	Daughter = source of misery; son = protector

Shatapatha Brahmana	Wife is half her husband
Maitrayani Samhita	Liquor, dice and women = three evils
Brihadaranyaka Upanishad	Gargi and Maitreyi debated with Yajnavalkya in Janaka's court

- Learned women of Vedic literature: **Gargi, Maitreyi** (Upanishadic); Apala, Ghosha, Lopamudra, Vishvavara (Rigvedic hymn-composers).

  ~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.32-33; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.138, p.149, p.151; old app notes 1:20

37. [PYQ] · M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

In which Upanishad is the famous dialogue of Yagnavalkya and Gargi mentioned?

a. Brihadaranyaka Upanishad
b. Taittiriya Upanishad
c. Aitareya Upanishad
d. Prashnopanishad

Answer: (a)
Gargi's debate with Yajnavalkya in Janaka's court is in the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad.

38. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

The woman eminent in Vedic literature

a. Shakuntala
b. Madalasa
c. Mitreyi
d. Gowthami

Answer: (c)
Maitreyi, wife of Yajnavalkya, is the learned woman of the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad; Shakuntala and Madalasa are epic/Puranic figures.

39. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about women in the Vedic age:
1. In the Later Vedic period women were barred from the Sabha.
2. Gargi and Maitreyi are Upanishadic figures, while Apala, Ghosha and Lopamudra composed Rigvedic hymns.
3. Sati was a widespread, established practice in the Later Vedic period.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All three
d. None

Answer: (b)
Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is wrong: only symbolic widow self-immolation is found; sati as a practice is later. So only two statements are correct.

40. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): In the Later Vedic period women were cut off from the study of the Vedas.
Reason (R): Women lost the right to the Upanayana, the sacred-thread initiation into Vedic study.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: Upanayana was the initiation into Vedic study, and Shudras and women were excluded from it.

41. [New pattern · match]

Match the texts with the statements on women found in them:
List-I (Text)
a. Aitareya Brahmana
b. Shatapatha Brahmana
c. Maitrayani Samhita
d. Brihadaranyaka Upanishad
List-II (Statement)
i. Daughter a source of misery; son a protector
ii. Liquor, dice and women are the three evils
iii. The wife is half her husband
iv. Gargi and Maitreyi debate with Yajnavalkya
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii
b. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-ii, b-iii, c-iv, d-i

Answer: (b)

Aitareya Brahmana = daughter as misery, son as protector; Shatapatha Brahmana = wife is half her husband; Maitrayani Samhita = liquor, dice and women three evils; Brihadaranyaka Upanishad = Gargi and Maitreyi in Janaka's court.

Row 21: Vedic Literature – Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads, Vedangas, Sutras

1. Epics, Puranas and Smritis (PYQs 23 · MCQs 26)

Mahabharata

- By **Vyasa**; original **Jaya / Jayasamhita** (8,800 shlokas) → Bharata → **Shatasahasri Samhita** (~1 lakh verses), **18 books (parvas)**, **Harivamsa** appended; older than the Ramayana; Bhagavad Gita (part of it) in **Sanskrit**.
- **Vaisampayana** told it to **Janamejaya**; **Ugrashrava Sauti** narrated it to Shaunaka's sages at **Naimisharanya**.
- War at Kurukshetra for **18 days**; Arjuna's grandfather = **Vichitravirya** (Pandu's nominal father); Karna spent Indra's **Vasavi Shakti** on **Ghatotkacha**.

Ramayana

- By **Valmiki**: **24,000** verses, 7 kandas, five stages from the 5th century BCE; Rama first met Hanuman in the **Kishkindha Kanda**.
- **Janaka**'s brother = **Kushadhvaja** (king of Sankashya); Janaka's family priest-guru = **Shatananda**, son of sage **Gautama** (the Upanishadic Janaka learnt from Yajnavalkya).
- **Samudra manthan:** serpent **Vasuki** was the churning rope.

Puranas and Smritis

- **18 Mahapuranas**; five marks (**pancha-lakshana**): **Sarga, Pratisarga**, Vamsa, Manvantara, Vamshanucharita. Complete **Dasavatara** narration: **Bhagavata (Maha-bhagavatam)**.
- Yugas: **Krita (Satya) → Treta → Dvapara → Kali**.
- **Manu** = first law-giver (Manusmriti; disapproves **widow remarriage**); **Mitakshara** on the Yajnavalkya Smriti = **Vijnaneshwara**.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.34; old app notes 1:21; Valmiki Ramayana Bala Kanda (Shatananda, Kushadhvaja)

1. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

What was the name of Janaka's brother?

a. Vishvadhvaja
b. Kavidhvaja
c. Kushadhvaja
d. Nimidhvaja

Answer: (c)

In the Ramayana (Bala Kanda) Janaka's younger brother is Kushadhvaja, king of Sankashya, whose daughters married Bharata and Shatrughna. Nimi was the dynasty's founder.

2. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Who is the Guru of King Janaka?

a. Vishwamitra
b. Gautama
c. Rushyasrunga
d. Vasishta

Answer: (b)

In the Ramayana Janaka's guru and family priest is Shatananda, son of sage Gautama (Shatananda Gautama); of the options only Gautama fits. Vishvamitra was a visitor, Vasishtha the Ikshvaku priest, Rishyashringa Dasharatha's ritual priest.

3. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Who told the stories of Mahabharata to Janamejaya?

a. Vaisampayana
b. Vishwamitra
c. Vyasa
d. Dhushyanta

Answer: (a)

Vaisampayana, Vyasa's disciple, recited the Mahabharata to King Janamejaya at his snake sacrifice.

4. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Mahabharat is also known by the name

a. Bhagavat Samhita
b. Jaya Samhita
c. Kuru Samhita
d. Krishna Samhita

Answer: (b)

The Mahabharata's original name was Jaya (Jaya Samhita); it is also called Satasahasri Samhita.

5. [PYQ] · U.P.B.E.O. (Pre.) 2019
The Shatasahasri-Samhita is the nickname of which of the following texts?

a. Rigveda
b. Atharvaveda
c. Ramayana
d. Mahabharata

Answer: (d)
The Mahabharata, which grew from the Jayasamhita, is called Satasahasri Samhita for its roughly one lakh verses.

6. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2015
Sarga, Pratisarga, Vansa, Manvantara and Vanshanucharita are the indicators of -

a. Vedas
b. Puranas
c. Upanishads
d. Sutras

Answer: (b)
Sarga, Pratisarga, Vamsa, Manvantara and Vamshanucharita are the five marks (pancha-lakshana) of the Puranas.

7. [PYQ] · U.P.R.O/A.R.O. (Pre) 2014
Originally the Mahabharata was known as –

a. Brihatkatha
b. Brahmins
c. Brihatsamhita
d. Jayasamhita

Answer: (d)
The Mahabharata was originally called Jaya or Jayasamhita (about 8,800 shlokas).

8. [PYQ] · RRB 2005
Who was the first law maker?

a. Manu
b. Chanakya
c. Chandragupta
d. Seleucus

Answer: (a)
Manu, traditional author of the Manusmriti, is regarded as the first law-giver of ancient India.

9. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 1996
According to ancient Indian cosmogonic ideas, the sequential order of the cycle of four epochs (yugas) is

a. Dvapara, Krita, Treta, and Kali
b. Krita, Dvapara, Treta and Kali
c. Krita, Treta, Dvapara and Kali
d. Treta, Dvapara, Kali and Krita

Answer: (c)
The yugas run Krita (Satya), Treta, Dvapara, Kali, with declining righteousness.

10. [PYQ] · IAS 1996
According to ancient Indian cosmogonic ideas, the sequential order of the cycle of four epochs (Yugas) is

a. Dvapara, Krita, Treta and Kali
b. Krita, Dvapara, Treta and Kali
c. Krita, Treta, Dvapara and Kali
d. Treta, Dvapara, Kali and Krita

Answer: (c)
The yugas run Krita (Satya), Treta, Dvapara, Kali, with declining righteousness.

11. [PYQ] · SSC 2009
The battle of Mahabharata is believed to have been fought at Kurukshetra for

a. 14 days
b. 16 days
c. 18 days
d. 20 days

Answer: (c)
The Mahabharata war at Kurukshetra is traditionally said to have lasted 18 days.

12. [PYQ] · UK UDA/LDA (Pre) 2009

According to Hindu Mythology, which serpent offered himself as a rope for churning the ocean?

a. Kalia
b. Vasuki
c. Pushkar
d. Sheshnag

Answer: (b)
In the Samudra Manthan the serpent Vasuki served as the churning rope round Mount Mandara.

13. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2006

The ancient place where the narration of entire Mahabharata was read in the conference of 60,000 hermits

a. Ahichatra
b. Hastinapur
c. Kampilya
d. Naimisharanya

Answer: (d)
Ugrashrava Sauti narrated the whole Mahabharata to Shaunaka's assembly of sages at Naimisharanya (Naimisha forest).

14. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Mains) 2004

Which Kand of Ramayana describes the first meeting of Rama and Hanuman?

a. Kishkindha Kand
b. Sunder Kand
c. Bal Kand
d. None of the above

Answer: (a)
Rama first met Hanuman in the Kishkindha Kanda, when Sugriva sent him to meet Rama and Lakshmana.

15. [PYQ] · UK UDA/LDA (Pre) 2007

In which language was the ‘Shrimad Bhagavad Gita’ originally written?

a. Sanskrit
b. Urdu
c. Pali
d. Hindi

Answer: (a)
The Bhagavad Gita, part of the Mahabharata, was composed in Sanskrit.

16. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Who among the following is considered to be the first law-giver of India ?

a. Panini
b. Manu
c. Kautilya
d. Kapil

Answer: (b)
Manu, author of the Manusmriti, is regarded as India's first law-giver; Panini was a grammarian, Kautilya a political thinker and Kapila a Sankhya philosopher.

17. [PYQ] · MPPSC (Pre) 2005

Who was the grandfather of the Hero of Mahabharata, Arjuna?

a. Vichitravirya
b. Shantanu
c. Chitrangad
d. Devvrat

Answer: (a)
Arjuna's father Pandu was the son of Vichitravirya's wife Ambalika through Vyasa (niyoga), so Vichitravirya is counted as the grandfather.

18. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

The Total Number of Puranas is

a. 18
b. 20
c. 12
d. 16

Answer: (a)
There are 18 Mahapuranas.

19. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

The number of Puranas is–

a. 16
b. 18
c. 19
d. 21

Answer: (b)
There are 18 (Maha)Puranas, such as Matsya, Markandeya, Bhagavata, Vishnu and Vayu.

20. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2003, UPUDA/LDA (Pre) 2002

Which among the following prohibits remarriage?

a. Jataka
b. Manusmiriti
c. Yagyavalkya
d. Arthashastra

Answer: (b)
The Manusmriti disapproves of widow remarriage; the Yajnavalkya Smriti and Arthashastra permit remarriage in some cases.

21. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Complete narration of 'Dasavataras' was given in

a. Mahabharata
b. Ramayana
c. Mahabhagavatham
d. None

Answer: (c)
The complete narration of the ten avatars is given in the Bhagavata (Maha-bhagavatam); the Mahabharata and Ramayana tell only some of them.

22. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Karna exercised his divine weapon, given by Indra, to attack one of the following

a. Arjuna
b. Sri Krishna
c. Bheema
d. Ghatotkacha

Answer: (d)
In the Mahabharata Karna had to spend Indra's infallible spear (Vasavi Shakti), kept for Arjuna, on Bhima's son Ghatotkacha on the fourteenth night of the war. (Ghatotkacha here is the epic hero, not the Gupta king.)

23. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

The great law-giver of ancient times was –

a. Ashoka
b. Arya Bhatta
c. Manu
d. Vatsyayan

Answer: (c)
Manu, author of the Manusmriti, is the great law-giver of ancient India; Ambedkar was called the 'Modern Manu'. Moved to ancient history.

24. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Mahabharata:
1. The Harivamsa is appended to the Ramayana.
2. Its original core, the Jaya, had 8,800 shlokas.
3. It is divided into 18 books (parvas).
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 1 is wrong: the Harivamsa is appended to the Mahabharata. Statements 2 and 3 are correct (Jaya 8,800 shlokas; 18 parvas; later the Shatasahasri Samhita of about one lakh verses).

25. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the Ramayana:
1. It contains about 24,000 verses.
2. It is described as composed in five stages beginning from the 5th century BCE.
3. It contains about one lakh verses in 18 books.
Which of the above statements are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)
The Ramayana has about 24,000 verses composed in five stages from the 5th century BCE; about one lakh verses in 18 books describes the Mahabharata.

26. [Kept own]

Who wrote the Mitakshara, a commentary on the Yajnavalkya Smriti?

a. Kalhana
b. Jimutavahana
c. Medhatithi
d. Vijnaneshwara

Answer: (d)
Vijnaneshwara wrote the Mitakshara, a commentary on the Yajnavalkya Smriti.

2. Four Vedas – Content, Priests, Trayi (PYQs 16 · MCQs 20)

Veda	Content	Priest	Upaveda
Rigveda	Hymns (prayers); oldest / earliest	Hotri (Hota)	Ayurveda
Yajurveda	Sacrificial formulas; rites and rituals of yajnas (verse + prose)	Adhvaryu	Dhanurveda
Samaveda	Rigvedic hymns set to melody; shortest; origin of Indian music	Udgatri	Gandharvaveda
Atharvaveda	Magical charms, spells, healing; latest	Brahman	Shilpaveda (architecture) / Arthashastra

- **Samaveda** is **compiled from the Rigveda**: about 1,549 verses (1,875 with repeats), all but about **75** from the Rigveda (mostly Mandalas VIII and IX).
- **Atharvaveda**: earliest charms and spells; **Ayurveda ("Science of Life") first appears** here (its prime origin; PMF lists Ayurveda as Upaveda of the Rigveda); term **kshetra-patni ("mistress of the field")** originates here (UPSC 2026); Sabha and Samiti = "twin daughters of **Prajapati**"; mentions Pashupati; recensions **Paippalada, Shaunaka**; reflects non-Aryan beliefs.
- **Trayi / Vedatrayi** = **Rig, Yajur, Sama**; Atharvaveda excluded (recognised later).
- **Yajurveda** has two branches, **Krishna (Black)** and **Shukla (White)**; first mentions Rajasuya and Vajapeya.
- **Upavedas:** Ayurveda – medicine; Dhanurveda – warfare; Gandharvaveda – music; **Shilpaveda – architecture** (not astronomy).
- Vedic people were skilled in **astronomy** (Vedanga Jyotisha), **mathematics** (Sulbasutra geometry) and **medicine** (Atharvaveda) – **not chemistry**.

> Hotri-Adhvaryu-Udgatri-Brahman = Rig-Yajur-Sama-Atharva; Trayi excludes Atharva.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.21-23, p.29; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.147-148; old app notes 1:21; UPSC CSE Prelims 2026 key (Vajiram & Ravi)

27. [PYQ] · Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III Ward Education and Data

Consider the following literary sources known as the four Vedas. Which was the earliest text?

a. Atharva Veda
b. Rig Veda
c. Sama Veda
d. Yajur Veda

Answer: (b)
The Rigveda, composed c. 1500 BCE in the Sapta Sindhu, is the oldest Veda; the Atharvaveda is the latest.

28. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2004
Which one of the following four Vedas contains an account of magical charms and spells?

a. Rig-veda
b. Yajur-veda
c. Atharva-veda
d. Sama-veda

Answer: (c)
The Atharvaveda is the Veda of charms, magic spells and healing; the Sama is chants and the Yajur ritual formulas.

29. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2026
In which one among the following texts does the term kshetra-patni ('mistress of the field') originate?

a. Rigveda
b. Atharvaveda
c. Ashtadhyayi
d. Arthashastra

Answer: (b)
The term kshetra-patni ('mistress of the field') originates in the agricultural hymns of the Atharvaveda (UPSC 2026 key: Atharvaveda).

30. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997
The compilation of which among the following is based upon the Rig Veda?

a. Yajurveda
b. Samaveda
c. Atharvaveda
d. None of the above

Answer: (b)
The Samaveda is compiled almost wholly from Rigvedic verses (all but about 75), set to melody for chanting.

31. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011
Which one of the following four Vedas contains an account of magical charms and spells?

a. Rig Veda
b. Yajurveda
c. Atharvaveda
d. Samaveda

Answer: (c)
The earliest account of charms and spells is in the Atharvaveda.

32. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024
Which among the following Vedas was the earliest composition?

a. Rigveda
b. Samaveda
c. Yajurveda
d. Atharvaveda

Answer: (a)
The Rigveda is the earliest Veda; the Atharvaveda is the latest.

33. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999
Rights and Rituals related to Yajnas are mentioned in–

a. Rig Veda
b. Samaveda
c. Brahmin Granthas
d. Yajurveda

Answer: (d)
The Yajurveda is the ritual Veda: it gives the rules and formulas to be observed at sacrifices. The Brahmanas explain rituals but the Veda of yajna rites is the Yajurveda.

34. [PYQ] · U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013
In the Vedic rituals HOTA is associated with the–

a. Rig Veda
b. Yajurveda
c. Samaveda
d. Atharvaveda

Answer: (a)
The Hotri (Hota) priest recited the Rigveda; Adhvaryu = Yajur, Udgatri = Sama, Brahman = Atharva.

35. [PYQ] · State PSC
‘Trayi’ is a name for –

a. Three Vedas
b. Dharma, Sangha and Buddha
c. Three Gods in Hindu Pantheon
d. Three seasons

Answer: (a)
Trayi denotes the first three Vedas: Rig, Yajur and Sama.

36. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994
‘Ayurveda’ that is ‘Science of Life’ appeared first in :

a. Aranyaka
b. Samveda
c. Yajurveda
d. Atharvaveda

Answer: (d)
Ayurveda, the 'science of life', has its prime origin in the Atharvaveda, which describes medicines and herbs.

37. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2025
Which of the following Vedas is divided into two branches as Krishna and Shukla ?

a. Rig Veda
b. Sama Veda
c. Yajur Veda
d. Atharva Veda

Answer: (c)
The Yajurveda has two branches, Krishna (Black: mantra mixed with prose) and Shukla (White: mantra only).

38. [PYQ] · SSC 2017
Combination of three Vedas has been called ‘Vedatrayi’

a. Rigveda, Yajurveda
b. Rigveda, Samaveda and Atharvaveda
c. Rigveda, Samaveda and Yajurveda
d. Yajurveda, Samaveda and Atharvaveda

Answer: (c)
Vedatrayi (Trayi) = Rigveda, Samaveda and Yajurveda; the Atharvaveda is excluded.

39. [PYQ] · UK UDA/LDA (Pre) 2007
Which one of the following is oldest Veda?

a. Yajurveda
b. Rigveda
c. Samaveda
d. Atharvaveda

Answer: (b)
The Rigveda is the oldest Veda; the Atharvaveda is the latest.

40. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2010
Which one of the following is oldest Veda?

a. Yajurveda
b. Rigveda
c. Samaveda
d. Atharvaveda

Answer: (b)
The Rigveda is the oldest Veda; the Atharvaveda is the latest.

41. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ disputed
In which of the following subjects were the Vedic Aryans not proficient?

a. Astronomy
b. Mathematics
c. Chemistry
d. Medicine

Answer: (c)
APPSC key: Astronomy. The texts show Vedanga Jyotisha (astronomy), Sulbasutra mathematics and Ayurveda; chemistry is the only discipline absent (NextGen p.25).
The Vedic people were proficient in astronomy (Vedanga Jyotisha), mathematics (Sulbasutra geometry) and medicine (Atharvaveda, Ayurveda); chemistry was not a Vedic discipline. (official key: Astronomy)

42. [PYQ] · Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III Animal Husbandry Assist

The Samaveda is an important source for

a. Painting
b. Medicine
c. Music
d. The art of warfare

Answer: (c)

The Samaveda, a collection of Rig Vedic hymns set to melody, is the source of Indian music.

43. [New pattern · match]

Match the Vedas with the priests associated with them:
List-I (Veda)
a. Rigveda
b. Yajurveda
c. Samaveda
d. Atharvaveda
List-II (Priest)
i. Brahman
ii. Udgatri
iii. Hotri (Hota)
iv. Adhvaryu
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii
c. a-iii, b-iv, c-ii, d-i
d. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii

Answer: (c)

Rigveda = Hotri; Yajurveda = Adhvaryu; Samaveda = Udgatri; Atharvaveda = Brahman (Hotri-Adhvaryu-Udgatri-Brahman = Rig-Yajur-Sama-Atharva).

44. [New pattern · match]

Match the Vedas with their Upavedas as given in the table of the notes:
List-I (Veda)
a. Rigveda
b. Yajurveda
c. Samaveda
d. Atharvaveda
List-II (Upaveda)
i. Gandharvaveda
ii. Ayurveda
iii. Dhanurveda
iv. Shilpaveda
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-iv, b-ii, c-i, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
d. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv

Answer: (d)

Rigveda = Ayurveda (medicine); Yajurveda = Dhanurveda (warfare); Samaveda = Gandharvaveda (music); Atharvaveda = Shilpaveda (architecture, not astronomy).

45. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Atharvaveda:
1. It is regarded as the latest of the four Vedas.
2. Paippalada and Shaunaka are its recensions.
3. It calls the Sabha and Samiti the twin daughters of Indra.
4. It forms part of the Trayi.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (b)

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is wrong: the Atharvaveda calls the Sabha and Samiti the twin daughters of Prajapati. Statement 4 is wrong: the Trayi is Rig, Yajur and Sama; the Atharvaveda was recognised later. So only two are correct.

46. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Samaveda:
1. It is the shortest of the four Vedas.
2. All but about 75 of its verses are taken from the Rigveda.
3. Its priest is the Adhvaryu.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

Statement 3 is wrong: the Samaveda's priest is the Udgatri; the Adhvaryu belongs to the Yajurveda. Statements 1 and 2 are correct (shortest; compiled from the Rigveda, mostly Mandalas VIII and IX, all but about 75 verses).

3. Upanishads and Vedanta (PYQs 16 · MCQs 20)

- **108** (Muktika list), about **13 principal**; c. 800–600 BCE; **anti-ritualistic**; **Atman = Brahman**; karma, samsara, moksha; called **Vedanta** ("end of the Vedas").
- **Prasthanatrayi** = **Upanishads, Brahma Sutra** (Badarayana), **Bhagavad Gita**; the **Bhagavata is not** included. **Shankaracharya** wrote bhashyas on these three – **not on the Rigveda**.

Saying / story	Upanishad
Satyameva Jayate (national motto, adopted 26 Jan 1950, below the State Emblem)	Mundaka
Asato ma sadgamaya; Yajnavalkya with Gargi and Maitreyi; first statement of transmigration	Brihadaranyaka
Tat tvam asi; Satyakama Jabala (son of the unmarried Jabala); Uddalaka–Shvetaketu; Krishna, son of Devaki (first mention)	Chandogya
Nachiketa–Yama dialogue on death	Katha (Kathopanishad)
Trimurti	Maitrayani
Name means "white horse"; introduces bhakti	Shvetashvatara
Taittiriya Upanishad	Krishna Yajurveda

> Satyameva Jayate = Mundaka (not Mandukya); Jabala Upanishad is a different, later text.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.24-25; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.149-152; old app notes 1:21

- **Pancha kosha** (five sheaths: anna, prana, mano, vijnana, ananda) comes from the **Taittiriya Upanishad**; in education it is elaborated by **Sri Aurobindo** (integral education).

47. [PYQ] · RAS/RTS (Pre) 2016

The legend of Satyakam Jabal, which challenges the stigma of being an unmarried mother, is mentioned in

a. Jabal Upanishad
b. Prashnopanishad
c. Chhandogya Upanishad
d. Kathopanishad

Answer: (c)

Satyakama, son of the unmarried Jabala, who took his mother's name, is told of in the Chhandogya Upanishad (Book IV); the Jabala Upanishad is a different, later text.

48. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Taittiriya Upanishad belongs to which Veda?

a. Ayurveda
b. Dhanur Veda
c. Samaveda
d. Krishna Yajurveda

Answer: (d)

The Taittiriya Upanishad belongs to the Krishna (Black) Yajurveda; Ayurveda and Dhanurveda are Upavedas, not Vedas.

49. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I Prelims 2003

Which of the following was not commented upon by Shankaracharya?

a. Brahma Sutras
b. Upanishads
c. Rigveda
d. Bhagavad Gita

Answer: (c)

Shankaracharya wrote bhashyas on the Prasthanatrayi: the Upanishads, Brahma Sutras and Bhagavad Gita; he did not comment on the Rigveda Samhita.

50. [PYQ] · AEE Screening Test 2016

The Words 'Satymeva Jayate' in the State Emblem of India, have been adopted from which one of the following?

a. Brahma Upanishad
b. Mudgala Upanishad
c. Maitreyi Upanishad
d. Mundaka Upanishad

Answer: (d)

Satyameva Jayate, the motto below the State Emblem, is taken from the Mundaka Upanishad.

51. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2014

The national motto of India, 'Satyameva Jayate' inscribed below the Emblem of India, is taken from

a. Katha Upanishad
b. Chandogya Upanishad
c. Aitareya Upanishad
d. Mundaka Upanishad

Answer: (d)

The national motto Satyameva Jayate comes from the Mundaka Upanishad.

52. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1997 +3 more

The famous dialogue between Nachiketa and Yama is mentioned in the :

a. Brihadaranyaka Upanishad
b. Chhandogyopanishad
c. Kathopanishad
d. Kenopanishad

Answer: (c)

The Nachiketa-Yama dialogue on death and the immortal atman is in the Katha Upanishad.

53. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Which one of the following is not included in ‘Prasthan trayi’ :

a. Bhagavata
b. Bhagavad Gita
c. Brahma Sutra
d. Upanishad

Answer: (a)

The Prasthanatrayi of Vedanta = Upanishads, Brahma Sutra and Bhagavad Gita; the Bhagavata Purana is not part of it.

54. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004 +1 more

From which Upanishad, the words “Satyameva Jayate” have been taken?

a. Mundakopanishad
b. Kathopnishad
c. Chhandogyopanishad
d. None of these

Answer: (a)

Satyameva Jayate is taken from the Mundaka Upanishad and was adopted as the national motto on 26 January 1950.

55. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2004 +1 more

From where was word ‘Satyameva Jayate’ taken?

a. Manusmriti
b. Bhagawadgita
c. Rig Veda
d. Mundakopanishad

Answer: (d)

Satyameva Jayate is taken from the Mundaka Upanishad.

56. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 2004

From where the word ‘Satyameva Jayate’ taken?

a. Manusmriti
b. Bhagavad Gita
c. Rigveda
d. Mundkopanishad

Answer: (d)

Satyameva Jayate comes from the Mundaka Upanishad, not the Rigveda, Gita or Manusmriti.

57. [PYQ] · RAS/RTS (Pre) 2016

The legend of ‘Satyakama Jabala’, which challenges the stigma of being an unmarried mother, is mentioned in

a. Jabala Upanishad
b. Prashnopanishad
c. Chandogya Upanishad
d. Kathopanishad

Answer: (c)

Satyakama Jabala's story (he took his unmarried mother Jabala's name) is found in the Chhandogya Upanishad.

58. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2016 +1 more added

The literal meaning of which Upanishad is white horse?

a. Kathopanishad
b. Chhandogya Upanishad
c. Taittiriya Upanishad
d. Eshopanishad
e. Shvetashvatara Upanishad

Answer: (e)

The printed options did not include the correct answer (Shvetashvatara Upanishad); it is added as option 5.
Shvetashvatara means 'white horse' (shveta = white, ashva = horse); the printed options are wrong – Katha, Chhandogya, Taittiriya (tittiri = partridge) and Isha have other meanings. The old notes' 'Taittiriya' was an error.

59. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

‘Nachiketa’ legend finds mention in :

a. Atharvaveda
b. Shatpatha Brahmin
c. Kathopanishad
d. Brihadaranyaka Upanishad

Answer: (c)

The Nachiketa-Yama dialogue on death is in the Katha Upanishad (Kathopanishad) of the Krishna Yajurveda; the Brihadaranyaka has Yajnavalkya, Gargi and Maitreyi.

60. [PYQ] · RAS/RTS (Pre) 1999

Which of the following epic has primarily mentioned Krishna, son of Devaki?

a. Mahabharata
b. Chandogya Upainshad
c. Ashtadhyayi
d. Bhagavata Purana

Answer: (b)

Krishna, son of Devaki, is first mentioned in the Chhandogya Upanishad (III.17), as a pupil of Ghora Angirasa; the Mahabharata and Bhagavata are later.

61. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant B.C. Welfare Officer, Assistant Social Welfa

The Pancha Kosha Theory of Education was elaborated by

Answer: Aurobindo

The five-sheath (pancha kosha) model comes from the Taittiriya Upanishad; in education it is elaborated in Sri Aurobindo's integral education (physical, vital, mental, psychic, spiritual), so the expected answer is Aurobindo.

62. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

In the parlance of Vedic Literature this sentence is said to be prominent one.

a. Thatvamasi
b. Sri Rama Rama Rameti
c. Krishnam Vande Jagadgurum
d. Om Namaha Pranavardhaya

Answer: (a)

'Tat tvam asi' (That thou art), a mahavakya of the Chandogya Upanishad, is the celebrated Vedic sentence. The others are later devotional lines.

63. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Upanishads:
1. About 13 of the 108 Upanishads are regarded as principal.
2. They are anti-ritualistic and teach the identity of Atman and Brahman.
3. The Prasthanatrayi consists of the Upanishads, the Brahma Sutra and the Bhagavata.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All three
d. None

Answer: (b)
Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is wrong: the Prasthanatrayi is the Upanishads, the Brahma Sutra and the Bhagavad Gita; the Bhagavata is not included. So only two are correct.

64. [New pattern · match]

Match the following sayings/ideas with the Upanishads in which they occur:
List-I (Saying / idea)
a. Asato ma sadgamaya
b. Story of Satyakama Jabala
c. Trimurti
d. Introduces bhakti
List-II (Upanishad)
i. Brihadaranyaka
ii. Shvetashvatara
iii. Maitrayani
iv. Chandogya
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
d. a-ii, b-iii, c-iv, d-i

Answer: (b)
Asato ma sadgamaya = Brihadaranyaka (also the first statement of transmigration); Satyakama Jabala = Chandogya; Trimurti = Maitrayani; Shvetashvatara ('white horse') introduces bhakti.

65. [Kept own]

On which date was Satyameva Jayate adopted as India's national motto?

a. 26 January 1950
b. 15 August 1947
c. 26 November 1949
d. 26 January 1951

Answer: (a)
Satyameva Jayate was adopted as the national motto on 26 January 1950.

66. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the Upanishads:
1. Satyameva Jayate is taken from the Mundaka Upanishad.
2. Tat tvam asi is found in the Chandogya Upanishad.
3. The Nachiketa–Yama dialogue is in the Mandukya Upanishad.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
The Nachiketa–Yama dialogue is in the Katha Upanishad; the other two are correct.

4. Rigveda – Mandalas, Hymns, Gayatri (PYQs 15 · MCQs 18)

- **10 mandalas, 1,028 hymns (suktas)** = 1,017 + 11 Valakhilya; 10,552 mantras; a **collection of hymns** to nature deities; similar to the Iranian **Avesta**; "First Testament of Mankind".

Mandala	Content
II–VII	Family books, oldest core (Gritsamada, Vishvamitra, Vamadeva, Atri, Bharadvaja, Vasishtha)
III	Gayatri Mantra – composed by Vishvamitra, deity Savitri
VII	Battle of Ten Kings (Vasishtha)
IX	Wholly Soma (Soma Pavamana, 114 hymns)

X	Purusha Sukta (four varnas, origin of caste – first use of "varna" for the four orders), Nasadiya Sukta (creation), Surya Sukta (marriage, X.85)

- Word **gotra** first occurs in the **Rigveda**, meaning cow shelter / herd of cows.
- **Memory of the World (2007): 30 Rigveda manuscripts** at the **Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute, Pune** on UNESCO's register; Vedic chanting = UNESCO intangible heritage (2008).
- **Script:** the Rigveda was composed and transmitted **orally**; exam keys give **Brahmi** as its basic script (surviving manuscripts are much later, in Devanagari / Sharada).

> Gayatri = Mandala III, Vishvamitra; Soma = Mandala IX; Purusha Sukta = Mandala X.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.22-23, p.29; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.145-147; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.1; old app notes 1:21

67. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2011

Where does the term "Gothra" occur for the first time?

a. Sama Veda
b. Rig Veda
c. Atharvana Veda
d. Yajur Veda

Answer: (b)
The word gotra first occurs in the Rigveda, where it means a cow-pen or herd of cows; its lineage sense appears in the Atharvaveda and Later Vedic texts.

68. [PYQ] · State PSC

Gayatri Mantra is found in which book?

a. Upanishad
b. Bhagwadgita
c. Rig Veda
d. Yajurveda

Answer: (c)
The Gayatri Mantra is in the third Mandala of the Rigveda, attributed to Vishvamitra.

69. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

In Rig Veda there are..... mantras –

a. 1028
b. 1017
c. 1128
d. 1020

Answer: (a)
The Rigveda has 1,028 hymns (1,017 plus 11 Valakhilya) in 10 mandalas.

70. [PYQ] · U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

The 'Mantra' famous with the name of 'Gayatri Mantra' found in which of the following scriptures –

a. Bhagwat Gita
b. Atharvaveda
c. Rig Veda
d. Manusmriti

Answer: (c)
The Gayatri Mantra is in Mandala III of the Rigveda, attributed to Vishvamitra.

71. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

The 'Purush Sukta' related to Varna System is originally found in –

a. Atharvaveda
b. Samaveda
c. Rig Veda
d. Manusmriti

Answer: (c)
The Purusha Sukta, the first statement of the four varnas, is the 90th hymn of Mandala X of the Rigveda.

72. [PYQ] · UP RO/ARO (Pre) 2016

The Rigveda is the

a. collection of hymns.
b. collection of stories.
c. collection of words.
d. text of war.

Answer: (a)
The Rigveda is a collection of hymns (suktas) in praise of nature deities.

73. [PYQ] · CGPSC 2012
Rigveda consists of ..... ritual hymns.

a. 1028
b. 1017
c. 1128
d. 1020

Answer: (a)
The Rigveda has 10 mandalas and 1,028 hymns (1,017 plus 11 Valakhilya); 1,017 is only the count without the Valakhilya hymns.

74. [PYQ] · GPSC 2014, CDS 2003
The Purushasukta, which refers to the origin of caste, is found in the

a. Atharvaveda
b. Rigveda
c. Samaveda
d. Yajurveda

Answer: (b)
The Purusha Sukta, describing the four varnas, is in the 10th mandala of the Rigveda.

75. [PYQ] · UKPSC (Pre) 2012
In which Vedic text the term ‘Varna’ is found referred for the first time?

a. Rigveda
b. Atharvaveda
c. Samaveda
d. Yajurveda

Answer: (a)
The Purusha Sukta of the Rigveda's 10th mandala is the first to name the four varnas; the word varna (colour) itself is already Rigvedic.

76. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I Prelims 2010 (05-09-2010)
Recently, the manuscripts of which one of the following has been included in the UNESCO's Memory of World Register?

a. Mahabharata
b. Ramayana
c. Rigveda
d. Abhidhamma Pitaka

Answer: (c)
In 2007 UNESCO inscribed 30 Rigveda manuscripts of the Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute, Pune, in the Memory of the World Register.

77. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005
The word Gotra occurs for the first time in

a. Atharvaveda
b. Rigveda
c. Samaveda
d. Yajurveda

Answer: (b)
Gotra first occurs in the Rigveda, meaning a cow shelter or herd of cows; the sense of lineage came later.

78. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006
Who composed the Gayatri Mantra?

a. Vasishtha
b. Vishwamitra
c. Indra
d. Parikshit

Answer: (b)
The Gayatri Mantra (Rigveda III) is attributed to the sage Vishvamitra.

79. [PYQ] · CDS 2018
In the 10th Mandala of the Rigveda, which one of the following hymns reflects upon the marriage ceremonies?

a. Surya Sukta
b. Purusha Sukta
c. Dana Sutra
d. Uma Sutra

Answer: (a)
The Surya Sukta (Rigveda X.85) focuses on marriage ceremonies; the Purusha Sukta (X.90) concerns the varnas.

80. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2004 disputed

Fundamental or basic script of the ‘Rigveda’ was

a. Devanagari
b. Kharosthi
c. Pali
d. Brahmi

Answer: (d)

Most books and keys: Brahmi. Strictly: the Rigveda was oral; its oldest manuscripts are in Sharada and Devanagari (UNESCO MoW nomination, BORI).
Exam keys give Brahmi as the basic script of the Rigveda; strictly the Rigveda was composed and transmitted orally and its surviving manuscripts are late (Devanagari, Sharada).

81. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which Mandala of Rig Veda is completely dedicated to ‘Soma’?

a. Seventh Mandala
b. Eighth Mandala
c. Ninth Mandala
d. Tenth Mandala

Answer: (c)

All hymns of the 9th Mandala of the Rigveda (114) are dedicated to Soma.

82. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Rigveda:
1. Mandalas II to VII, the family books, form its oldest core.
2. The Battle of Ten Kings is described in Mandala IX.
3. The Nasadiya Sukta on creation is in Mandala X.
4. Thirty Rigveda manuscripts kept at the Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute, Pune, are on UNESCO's Memory of the World Register.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)

Statement 2 is wrong: the Battle of Ten Kings is in Mandala VII (Vasishtha); Mandala IX is wholly devoted to Soma. Statements 1, 3 and 4 are correct, so three are correct.

83. [Kept own]

The Gayatri Mantra occurs in which Mandala of the Rigveda?

a. Seventh
b. First
c. Third
d. Ninth

Answer: (c)

The Gayatri Mantra is in the Third Mandala; the Seventh has the Battle of Ten Kings and the Ninth the Soma Pavamana hymns.

84. [Kept own]

The Rigveda shows similarities with which Iranian text?

a. Dinkard
b. Behistun inscription
c. Shahnameh
d. Avesta

Answer: (d)

The Rigveda shows similarities with the Iranian Avesta.

5. Mahabharata – Characters, Epithets and Episodes (PYQs 10 · MCQs 10)

Narrators and scribe

- **Ganesha** wrote the Mahabharata down as **Vyasa** dictated it (tradition, Adi Parva).
- **Sanjaya**, given divine sight by Vyasa, narrated the war to the blind king **Dhritarashtra** (the Bhagavad Gita is his report).
- **Vishnu Sahasranama** was first recited by **Bhishma** to Yudhishthira (Anushasana Parva).

Who's who

Person	Remember
Bhishma (Devavrata)	Son of King Shantanu and the river Ganga

Karna	Radheya (after foster mother Radha); led the Kaurava army for two days (16th–17th) after Drona
Arjuna	Gudakesha ("conqueror of sleep")
Sahadeva	Youngest Pandava; killed Shakuni on the 18th day
Nakula	Conch Sughosha (Sahadeva – Manipushpaka; Krishna – Panchajanya; Arjuna – Devadatta; Bhima – Paundra)

- **Dushta chatushtaya** (the four wicked): **Duryodhana, Dussasana, Karna, Shakuni** – Sisupala is not one of them.

> Endowment-exam angle: epithet → hero, weapon/conch → owner, "who killed whom".

~~ Sources: Mahabharata (BORI Critical Edition) Adi, Karna, Shalya and Anushasana Parvas; Bhagavad Gita 1.14–1.18 (conches); old app notes 1:21

85. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
What was the name of the Conch of Nakula?

a. Sughosha
b. Panchajanya
c. Naveena
d. Sudhara

Answer: (a)
In the Bhagavad Gita (1.16) Nakula blew the conch Sughosha and Sahadeva Manipushpaka; Panchajanya was Krishna's. (Mahabharata topic, moved.)

86. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment Prelims General Studies 2022
Who narrated the war of Mahabharat to Dhrita Rashtra?

a. Vyasa
b. Sanjaya
c. Parasara
d. Balarama

Answer: (b)
Sanjaya, given divine sight by Vyasa, narrated the Kurukshetra war to the blind king Dhritarashtra (Bhagavad Gita is his report).

87. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Who is known as Radheya in Mahabharatha?

a. Krishna
b. Karna
c. Arjuna
d. Drishtadyumna

Answer: (b)
Karna is called Radheya after his foster mother Radha. Krishna, Arjuna and Dhrishtadyumna have other epithets.

88. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
For how many days Karna was the commander of Kaurava Military during Kurukshetra war?

a. Ten
b. Fifteen
c. Two
d. Three

Answer: (c)
In the Mahabharata Karna led the Kaurava army for two days (the 16th and 17th) after Drona, until Arjuna killed him.

89. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Which Mahabharata warrior was also known as Gudakesh?

a. Dharmaraja
b. Karna
c. Drona
d. Arjuna

Answer: (d)
Gudakesha ('conqueror of sleep') is an epithet of Arjuna in the Mahabharata/Bhagavad Gita.

90. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment Prelims General Studies 2022
Who killed Shakuni in Mahabharat war?

a. Dharmaraja
b. Bheema
c. Nakula
d. Sahadeva

Answer: (d)
Sahadeva, the youngest Pandava, killed Shakuni on the 18th day of the Kurukshetra war.

91. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment Prelims General Studies 2022
Who wrote down the epic Mahabharatha while Vyasa was dictating?

a. Shiva
b. Ganesha
c. Narada
d. Vishwakarma

Answer: (b)
By tradition Ganesha wrote down the Mahabharata as Vyasa dictated it. Shiva, Narada and Vishwakarma are not the scribe.

92. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
One among the four was not one of the four wicked.

a. Duryodhana
b. Dhussasana
c. Sakuni
d. Sisupala

Answer: (d)
The 'dushta chatushtaya' (four wicked ones) of the Mahabharata are Duryodhana, Dussasana, Karna and Sakuni; Sisupala is not one of them.

93. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Who is the father of Bhishma?

a. Bharatha
b. Shanthanu
c. Parikshit
d. Janamejaya

Answer: (b)
Bhishma (Devavrata) was the son of King Shantanu and the river Ganga.

94. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Who has recited the 'Vishnusahasranama' for the first time?

a. Yudhishtira
b. Sri Krishna
c. Bhishma
d. Vidura

Answer: (c)
In the Anushasana Parva of the Mahabharata, Bhishma recites the Vishnu Sahasranama to Yudhishthira.

6. Yajurveda Branches and the Brahmanas (PYQs 8 · MCQs 12)

Branch	Nature	Samhitas	Brahmana
Shukla (White)	Mantras only, clearly arranged	Vajasaneyi (Madhyandina, Kanva)	Shatapatha
Krishna (Black)	Mantras + prose mixed	Taittiriya, Maitrayani, Kathaka, Kapishthala	Taittiriya
Veda	Brahmanas	Aranyakas	Upanishads
Rig	Aitareya, Kaushitaki	Aitareya, Kaushitaki	Aitareya, Kaushitaki
Sama	Panchavimsha (Tandya), Jaiminiya, Shadvimsha, Chandogya	Jaiminiya, Chandogya	Chandogya, Kena

Yajur	Taittiriya, Shatapatha	Taittiriya, Brihadaranyaka	Brihadaranyaka, Isha, Katha, Taittiriya (Krishna YV), Shvetashvatara
Atharva	Gopatha (only one)	None	Mundaka, Mandukya, Prashna

- **Shatapatha Brahmana**: largest; Videgha Madhava's eastward journey; **Great Flood**; **first reference to money-lending** (kusidin); full **upanayana**; "wife is half her husband"; **Purushamedha** (described with the Vajasaneyi Samhita of the Shukla Yajurveda).
- **Aitareya Brahmana**: origin of kingship, ten forms of government, Shudra as servant, first mention of the **Andhras** (Sunahshepa story).

> Gopatha = Atharva; Jaiminiya = Sama; Purushamedha = Shatapatha.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.23-24, p.29; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.144, p.147-148; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.117; old app notes 1:21

95. [PYQ] · M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Separate Brahmin texts were written for each Veda. The Brahmin texts related to Yajurveda is:

a. Gopatha
b. Panchvish and Jaiminiya
c. Aitareya and Kaushitaki
d. Taittiriya and Shatpatha

Answer: (d)
The Yajurveda's Brahmanas are the Taittiriya and Shatapatha; Gopatha is Atharvaveda, Panchavimsha and Jaiminiya Samaveda, Aitareya and Kaushitaki Rigveda.

96. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Which of the following is a Samhita of Shukla Yajurveda?

a. Vajasanami
b. Maitrayani
c. Taittiriya
d. Kathak

Answer: (a)
The Vajasaneyi Samhita (Madhyandina and Kanva) is the Samhita of the Shukla Yajurveda; Maitrayani, Taittiriya and Kathaka belong to the Krishna Yajurveda.

97. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Which Vedic text first refers to money lending?

a. Atharvaveda
b. Yajurveda
c. Satapatha Brahmana
d. Gopatha Brahmana

Answer: (c)
The Shatapatha Brahmana has the first reference to money-lending; it calls the usurer kusidin.

98. [PYQ] · U.P.R.O./A.R.O (Pre) 2014

'Gopatha Brahmana' is associated with –

a. Yajurveda
b. Samaveda
c. Atharvaveda
d. Rigveda

Answer: (c)
The Gopatha Brahmana is the only Brahmana of the Atharvaveda.

99. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2008

The name of scripture in which 'Purusha Megha' was mentioned is

a. Krishna Yajurveda
b. Shukla Yajurveda
c. Shatpath Brahmin
d. Panchvish Brahmin

Answer: (c)
The Purushamedha is described in the Shatapatha Brahmana (XIII.6), with its victims listed in the Vajasaneyi Samhita of the Shukla Yajurveda; not the Panchavimsha Brahmana.

100. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 2008

The name of scripture in which ‘Purusha Megha’ was mentioned in

a. Krishna Yajurveda
b. Shukla Yajurveda
c. Shatpath Brahmin
d. Panchvish Brahmin

Answer: (c)

The Purushamedha is described in the Shatapatha Brahmana (XIII.6); the old note crediting the Panchavimsha Brahmana was wrong.

101. [PYQ] · U.P. P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008 +1 more

The name of scripture in which ‘’Purusha Medha’ was mentioned is:

a. Krishna Yajurveda
b. Shukla Yajurveda
c. Shatpath Brahmana
d. Panchvish Brahmana

Answer: (c)

The Purushamedha is described in the Shatapatha Brahmana (XIII.6) of the Shukla Yajurveda, not the Panchavimsha (Tandya) Brahmana of the Samaveda.

102. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Which one of the following Brahmana texts belongs to the Rigveda?

a. Aitareya Brahmana
b. Gopatha Brahmana
c. Shatpatha Brahmana
d. Taittiriya Brahmana

Answer: (a)

The Aitareya Brahmana belongs to the Rigveda; Gopatha is Atharvaveda, Shatapatha and Taittiriya are Yajurveda.

103. [New pattern · match]

Match the Brahmanas with the Vedas to which they belong:
List-I (Brahmana)
a. Kaushitaki
b. Jaiminiya
c. Shatapatha
d. Gopatha
List-II (Veda)
i. Shukla Yajurveda
ii. Atharvaveda
iii. Samaveda
iv. Rigveda
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-iii, c-iv, d-i
b. a-iii, b-i, c-ii, d-iv
c. a-iv, b-iii, c-i, d-ii
d. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv

Answer: (c)

Kaushitaki (with Aitareya) = Rigveda; Jaiminiya (with Panchavimsha) = Samaveda; Shatapatha = Shukla Yajurveda; Gopatha = Atharvaveda (its only Brahmana).

104. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Yajurveda:
1. The Shukla (White) Yajurveda contains mantras only.
2. The Vajasaneyi is a Samhita of the Krishna (Black) Yajurveda.
3. The Yajurveda first mentions the Rajasuya and Vajapeya.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)

Statement 2 is wrong: the Vajasaneyi Samhita belongs to the Shukla Yajurveda; the Krishna Yajurveda's Samhitas are Taittiriya, Maitrayani, Kathaka and Kapishthala. Statements 1 and 3 are correct.

105. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Shatapatha Brahmana:
1. It is the largest Brahmana and tells the story of the Great Flood.
2. It describes the eastward journey of Videgha Madhava.
3. It contains the first mention of the Andhras.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 3 is wrong: the first mention of the Andhras (Sunahshepa story) is in the Aitareya Brahmana. Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

106. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about the Atharvaveda:
1. The Gopatha Brahmana belongs to it.
2. The Mundaka Upanishad is associated with it.
Which of the above statements is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Gopatha is the Brahmana of the Atharvaveda and Mundaka is one of its associated Upanishads.

7. Bhagavata Purana, Sages and Puranic Stories (PYQs 8 · MCQs 8)

- **Shuka** (son of Vyasa) narrated the **Bhagavata Purana** to King **Parikshit**; Suta later retold it to Shaunaka's sages.
- **Ekavimsati** (21) in the Bhagavatam = the **21 avataras** of Vishnu listed in its first skandha.
- **Durvasa** = son of sage **Atri** (one of the Saptarishis) and **Anasuya** (with Dattatreya and Chandra).
- **Vaikhanasa** = a **maharshi** to whom the Vaikhanasa Agama of temple worship is traced.
- **Dhruva** = son of King **Uttanapada** and Suniti (Vishnu and Bhagavata Puranas).
- **Samudra manthan** of the Kshira Sagara: Mount **Mandara** = churning rod (serpent Vasuki = rope).
- **Gurus: Shukracharya** (son of Bhrigu) = guru of the asuras/rakshasas; **Brihaspati** = guru of the devas.
- **Vasishtha's cow** = **Nandini** (daughter of Kamadhenu) in most books and keys; the Valmiki Ramayana calls her **Shabala**.

~~ Sources: Bhagavata Purana 1.3 (avataras), 1.4 and 4.8 (Dhruva), 8.6–8.7 (churning); Vishnu Purana 1.11; Mahabharata Adi Parva (Nandini); old app notes 1:21

107. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Who was the father of Dhruva?

a. Karna
b. Dasharatha
c. Nahusha
d. Uttanapada

Answer: (d)
In the Vishnu and Bhagavata Puranas Dhruva is the son of King Uttanapada and Suniti. Karna, Dasharatha and Nahusha are unrelated.

108. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

One of the sons to Atri, one among the Sapta Rushies (Seven Rushies) and his wife Anasuya.

a. Durvasa
b. Vishwamitra
c. Astavakra
d. Jamadagni

Answer: (a)
Durvasa was a son of Atri and Anasuya (with Dattatreya and Chandra). Vishwamitra, Ashtavakra and Jamadagni were not.

109. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Who narrated Bhagavata Puranam to Parikshita Maharaja?

a. Shounaka
b. Shuka
c. Soota
d. Vyasa

Answer: (b)
Sage Shuka (son of Vyasa) narrated the Bhagavata Purana to King Parikshit; Suta later retold it to Shaunaka and the sages. (Off-topic; moved.)

110. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Who is Vaikhanasa?

a. Powerful Man
b. Warrior
c. Maharshi
d. Intelligent Man

Answer: (c)
Vaikhanasa was a sage (maharshi) to whom the Vaikhanasa Agama of temple worship is traced.

111. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Eka Vimshathi in Bhagavatham represents this

a. Avatharalu
b. Skandhas
c. Samharalu
d. Yaagalu

Answer: (a)
'Ekavimsati' (twenty-one) in the Bhagavatam refers to the 21 avataras of Vishnu listed in its first skandha.

112. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
The name of the mountain which was used to churn Ksheera Sagara

a. Mandara
b. Vindhya
c. Meru
d. Himavat Parvatha

Answer: (a)
In the Samudra Manthan legend the gods and asuras used Mount Mandara as the churning rod and the serpent Vasuki as the rope to churn the Kshira Sagara. Off-topic (mythology), moved.

113. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Who is the Guru (Teacher) of demons (Rakshasulu)?

a. Bruhaspathi
b. Sukracharya
c. Vebheeshana
d. Mairavana

Answer: (b)
Shukracharya (Shukra, son of Bhrigu) is the guru of the asuras/rakshasas; Brihaspati is the guru of the devas, and Vibhishana and Mairavana are Ramayana characters. (Off-topic; moved.)

114. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022 **disputed**
What is the name of Vasishta's Cow?

a. Shabala
b. Nandini
c. Kamadhenu
d. Kalyani

Answer: (b)
Most books and keys: Nandini (Mahabharata). The Valmiki Ramayana calls the same cow Shabala (Sabala).
Vasishtha's wish-fulfilling cow, coveted by Vishvamitra, is called Nandini (daughter of Kamadhenu) in most books and keys. Off-topic (epics), moved.

8. Vedangas, Sutras and Grammarians (PYQs 7 · MCQs 14)

Vedanga	Subject
Shiksha	Phonetics
Kalpa	Rituals (Sutras)
Vyakarana	Grammar (Panini)
Nirukta	Etymology (Yaska)
Chandas	Metrics (Pingala)
Jyotisha	Astronomy

- Mimamsa is a darshana, **not** a Vedanga.

Sutra	Subject
Shrauta	Public, large sacrifices

Grihya	Domestic rites
Dharma	Law, social practice
Sulba	Measurement and construction of altars (geometry)

- Sulba authors: **Baudhayana, Apastamba, Katyayana**, Manava. **Baudhayana theorem** = lengths of the sides of a right-angled triangle = the **Pythagoras theorem**.

Author	Work
Panini (c. 500 BCE)	Ashtadhyayi (Sanskrit grammar)
Yaska	Nirukta
Katyayana	Varttika
Patanjali	Mahabhashya; Yoga Sutras

- Darshana founders: Nyaya – Gautama; **Vaisheshika – Kanada**; Sankhya – Kapila; Yoga – Patanjali; Purva Mimamsa – Jaimini; Uttara Mimamsa – Badarayana.
- **Gayatri chandas** = **24 syllables** (3 × 8).

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.25; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.1-5; old app notes 1:21

115. [PYQ] · APPSC Extension Officer Grade-I Common Paper General Studies

Which of the following is related to Baudhayana?

Answer: Pythagoras Theorem

Baudhayana's Sulbasutra states the theorem on the sides of a right-angled triangle later called the Pythagoras theorem.

116. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2008

What does the Baudhayan theorem (Baudhayan Sulva Sutra) relate to?

a. Lengths of sides of a right-angled triangle
b. Calculation of the value of pi
c. Logarithmic calculations
d. Normal distribution curve

Answer: (a)

Baudhayana's Sulbasutra theorem relates the lengths of the sides of a right-angled triangle, an early form of the Pythagoras theorem.

117. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Astadhyayi was written by

a. Jaimini
b. Panini
c. Vyasa
d. Sankaracharya

Answer: (b)

Panini wrote the Ashtadhyayi, the Vedanga text on Sanskrit grammar.

118. [PYQ] · APPSC Zilla Sainik Welfare Officer (Sainik Welfare Service)

Ashtadhyayi, the Sanskrit Grammar book was composed by

a. Charvaka
b. Kalidasa
c. Kapila
d. Panini

Answer: (d)

Panini composed the Ashtadhyayi, the Sanskrit grammar.

119. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

'Ashtadhyayi' was written by –

a. Vedavyas
b. Panini
c. Shukadeva
d. Valmiki

Answer: (b)

The Ashtadhyayi, the Sanskrit grammar text, was composed by Panini (c. 500 BCE).

120. [PYQ] · SSC 2010

Who among the following wrote Sanskrit Grammar?

a. Kalidas
b. Charak
c. Panini
d. Aryabhatt

Answer: (c)
Panini wrote the Ashtadhyayi, the foundational Sanskrit grammar; Kalidasa was a poet, Charaka a physician, Aryabhata an astronomer.

121. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

How many letters in Gayatri Chandas?

a. 12
b. 32
c. 24
d. 9

Answer: (c)
The Gayatri metre has 24 syllables (three padas of eight).

122. [New pattern · match]

Match the Vedangas with their subjects:
List-I (Vedanga)
a. Shiksha
b. Nirukta
c. Chandas
d. Jyotisha
List-II (Subject)
i. Etymology
ii. Astronomy
iii. Metrics
iv. Phonetics
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-iv, b-iii, c-i, d-ii
b. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
c. a-iv, b-i, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv

Answer: (c)
Shiksha = phonetics; Nirukta = etymology (Yaska); Chandas = metrics (Pingala); Jyotisha = astronomy.

123. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The Sulbasutras show the skill of the Vedic people in geometry.
Reason (R): Baudhayana, Apastamba, Katyayana and Manava were authors of Sulbasutras.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (b)
Both are true but R does not explain A: the geometry comes from the Sulbasutras' subject, the measurement and construction of altars (the Baudhayana theorem = Pythagoras theorem); the list of authors explains nothing.

124. [New pattern · match]

Match the authors with their works:
List-I (Author)
a. Panini
b. Yaska
c. Katyayana
d. Patanjali
List-II (Work)
i. Ashtadhyayi
ii. Varttika
iii. Nirukta
iv. Mahabhashya
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii
b. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
c. a-ii, b-iii, c-iv, d-i
d. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv

Answer: (d)
Panini = Ashtadhyayi; Yaska = Nirukta; Katyayana = Varttika; Patanjali = Mahabhashya (and the Yoga Sutras).

125. [Kept own]
Which of the following is NOT one of the six Vedangas?

a. Mimamsa
b. Nirukta
c. Kalpa
d. Jyotisha

Answer: (a)
The six Vedangas are Shiksha, Kalpa, Vyakarana, Nirukta, Chandas and Jyotisha; Mimamsa is not one of them.

126. [Kept own]
Which Sutras deal with domestic rites?

a. Shrauta Sutras
b. Sulba Sutras
c. Dharma Sutras
d. Grihya Sutras

Answer: (d)
Grihya Sutras deal with domestic rites; Shrauta with large public sacrifices.

127. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements about the Sutras:
1. Shrauta Sutras deal with public, large sacrifices.
2. Dharma Sutras deal with the measurement of altars.
3. Apastamba and Katyayana were authors of Sulbasutras.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Altar measurement is the subject of the Sulba Sutras; Dharma Sutras deal with law and social practice.

128. [Kept own]
Who among the following is associated with the Vaisheshika school of philosophy?

a. Gautama
b. Kanada
c. Kapila
d. Jaimini

Answer: (b)
Vaisheshika is associated with Kanada; Nyaya with Gautama, Sankhya with Kapila and Purva Mimamsa with Jaimini.

9. Ramayana – Characters and Episodes (PYQs 6 · MCQs 6)

Episode	Answer
Woke Rama with "Kausalya supraja Rama" (Bala Kanda)	Vishwamitra
Mother of Shatrughna (twin of Lakshmana)	Sumitra (Kaikeyi – Bharata; Kausalya – Rama)
Urged Ravana to abduct Sita	His sister Surpanakha, insulted by Lakshmana
Ravana's son killed by Hanuman (Sundara Kanda)	Aksha Kumara (Indrajit was killed by Lakshmana)
Sabari served in the ashram of	Sage Matanga, near Pampa
Real name of Indrajit	Meghanada (killed by Lakshmana)

~~ Sources: Valmiki Ramayana – Bala Kanda 23, Aranya Kanda 34–35 and 74, Sundara Kanda 47; old app notes 1:21

129. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Who wake up Sri Rama by singing Kausalya Supraja Rama...?

a. Vasistha
b. Koundinya
c. Vishwamitra
d. Bharadwaja

Answer: (c)
In the Bala Kanda of the Ramayana, Vishwamitra wakes Rama with 'Kausalya supraja Rama' on the way to his yajna. Vasishtha was the family preceptor.

130. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Who was the mother of Shatrughna?

a. Kaikeyi
b. Savitri
c. Suniti
d. Sumitra

Answer: (d)
In the Ramayana, Shatrughna (twin of Lakshmana) was the son of King Dasharatha and Queen Sumitra; Kaikeyi was Bharata's mother.

131. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Who has instigated Ravana to abduct Sita?

a. Thataki
b. Mandara
c. Mandodari
d. Surpanakha

Answer: (d)
In the Ramayana, Ravana's sister Surpanakha, insulted by Lakshmana, urged Ravana to abduct Sita. Mandodari was Ravana's wife and Tataka a demoness killed by Rama.

132. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment Prelims General Studies 2022
Name the son of Ravan who was killed in the hands of Lord "Hanuma".

a. Mahodara
b. Indrajit
c. Aksha Kumar
d. Mahaparsva

Answer: (c)
In the Sundara Kanda of Valmiki's Ramayana, Hanuman kills Ravana's young son Aksha Kumara at the Ashoka grove. Indrajit (Meghanada) was killed by Lakshmana; Mahodara and Mahaparshva were Ravana's commanders, not sons killed by Hanuman.

133. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
Sabari was in the Ashram of

a. Jabaali
b. Valmiki
c. Mathanga
d. Vishwamitra

Answer: (c)
In the Ramayana, Sabari served in the ashram of sage Matanga near Pampa and waited there for Rama. (Moved to ancient literature.)

134. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022
What is the real name of Indrajit?

a. Meghanadha
b. Aksha Kumara
c. Anaranya
d. Kalakeya

Answer: (a)
Indrajit, Ravana's son, was born Meghanada; he got the name Indrajit after defeating Indra. Akshakumara was another son of Ravana.

10. Layers of Vedic Literature – Shruti (PYQs 3 · MCQs 6)

- Order: **Samhitas → Brahmanas → Aranyakas → Upanishads**; Vedangas, Sutras, Smritis come later.
- All are **Shruti** ("heard"), **apaurusheya** (not of human origin); Smriti = remembered (Dharmashastras, epics, Puranas).
- **Samhitas + Brahmanas = Karma-kanda**; **Aranyakas + Upanishads = Jnana-kanda**.
- **Brahmanas**: prose commentaries that **explain the Vedic hymns** and the meaning of sacrifices (karma-marga; "liturgies").
- **Aranyakas**: "**forest texts**", concluding parts of the Brahmanas; symbolic / secret meaning of ritual; bridge karma-marga → jnana-marga. **Atharvaveda has no Aranyaka**.
- **Veda Vyasa (Krishna Dvaipayana)** compiled and classified the Vedas. Veda from *vid* = to know.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.21-24; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.143, p.149, p.152; old app notes 1:21

135. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment Prelims General Studies 2022
The other name of Vedic text is

a. Sruthi
b. Bhashyam
c. Smruthi
d. Sutram

Answer: (a)
The Vedic texts are Shruti ('heard'), revealed to the rishis; Smriti, Bhashya and Sutra are later classes of texts.

136. [PYQ] · Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III (Panchayat Secretary Gr
The Hymns in Vedas were traditionally explained by-

a. Upanishads
b. Aranyakas
c. Brahmanas
d. Puranas

Answer: (c)
The Brahmanas are commentaries that explain the Vedic hymns and the meaning of the rituals in an orthodox way.

137. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014
Which of the following is the correct order of the Vedic literature?

a. Vedic Samhitas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads
b. Vedic Samhitas, Upanishads, Aranyakas, Brahmanas
c. Vedic Samhitas, Aranyakas, Brahmanas, Upanishads
d. Vedic Samhitas, Vedangas, Aranyakas, Smritis

Answer: (a)
Each Veda runs Samhita, Brahmana, Aranyaka, Upanishad; Samhitas and Brahmanas form the karma-kanda, Aranyakas and Upanishads the jnana-kanda.

138. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements about Vedic literature:
1. The Puranas are classed as Shruti.
2. The Aranyakas and Upanishads together form the Jnana-kanda.
3. The Atharvaveda has no Aranyaka.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 1 is wrong: the Puranas (like the epics and Dharmashastras) are Smriti; Shruti are the 'heard' Vedic texts. Statements 2 and 3 are correct.

139. [New pattern · assertion]
Assertion (A): The Brahmanas belong to the Karma-kanda of Vedic literature.
Reason (R): The Brahmanas are prose commentaries that explain the Vedic hymns and the meaning of the sacrifices.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the Brahmanas explain sacrifices (karma-marga), so with the Samhitas they form the Karma-kanda.

140. [Kept own]
Veda Vyasa, also known as Krishna Dvaipayana, is traditionally associated with which of the following?

a. Compilation and classification of the Vedas
b. Composition of the Ashtadhyayi
c. Writing of the Mahabhashya
d. Compilation of the Jatakas

Answer: (a)
Veda Vyasa, or Krishna Dvaipayana, is traditionally remembered as the person who classified the Vedas.

11. Mahabharata – Characters, Epithets and Episodes (PYQs 0 · MCQs 0)

Narrators and scribe

- **Ganesha** wrote the Mahabharata down as **Vyasa** dictated it (tradition, Adi Parva).
- **Sanjaya**, given divine sight by Vyasa, narrated the war to the blind king **Dhritarashtra** (the Bhagavad Gita is his report).
- **Vishnu Sahasranama** was first recited by **Bhishma** to Yudhishthira (Anushasana Parva).

Who's who

Person	Remember
Bhishma (Devavrata)	Son of King Shantanu and the river Ganga
Karna	Radheya (after foster mother Radha); led the Kaurava army for two days (16th–17th) after Drona
Arjuna	Gudakesha ("conqueror of sleep")
Sahadeva	Youngest Pandava; killed Shakuni on the 18th day
Nakula	Conch Sughosha (Sahadeva – Manipushpaka; Krishna – Panchajanya; Arjuna – Devadatta; Bhima – Paundra)

- **Dushta chatushtaya** (the four wicked): **Duryodhana, Dussasana, Karna, Shakuni** – Sisupala is not one of them.

> Endowment-exam angle: epithet → hero, weapon/conch → owner, "who killed whom".

~~ Sources: Mahabharata (BORI Critical Edition) Adi, Karna, Shalya and Anushasana Parvas; Bhagavad Gita 1.14–1.18 (conches); old app notes 1:21

12. Ramayana – Characters and Episodes (PYQs 0 · MCQs 0)

Episode	Answer
Woke Rama with "Kausalya supraja Rama" (Bala Kanda)	Vishwamitra
Mother of Shatrughna (twin of Lakshmana)	Sumitra (Kaikeyi – Bharata; Kausalya – Rama)
Urged Ravana to abduct Sita	His sister Surpanakha, insulted by Lakshmana
Ravana's son killed by Hanuman (Sundara Kanda)	Aksha Kumara (Indrajit was killed by Lakshmana)
Sabari served in the ashram of	Sage Matanga, near Pampa
Real name of Indrajit	Meghanada (killed by Lakshmana)

~~ Sources: Valmiki Ramayana – Bala Kanda 23, Aranya Kanda 34–35 and 74, Sundara Kanda 47; old app notes 1:21

13. Bhagavata Purana, Sages and Puranic Stories (PYQs 0 · MCQs 0)

- **Shuka** (son of Vyasa) narrated the **Bhagavata Purana** to King **Parikshit**; Suta later retold it to Shaunaka's sages.
- **Ekavimsati** (21) in the Bhagavatam = the **21 avataras** of Vishnu listed in its first skandha.
- **Durvasa** = son of sage **Atri** (one of the Saptarishis) and **Anasuya** (with Dattatreya and Chandra).
- **Vaikhanasa** = a **maharshi** to whom the Vaikhanasa Agama of temple worship is traced.
- **Dhruva** = son of King **Uttanapada** and Suniti (Vishnu and Bhagavata Puranas).
- **Samudra manthan** of the Kshira Sagara: Mount **Mandara** = churning rod (serpent Vasuki = rope).
- **Gurus: Shukracharya** (son of Bhrigu) = guru of the asuras/rakshasas; **Brihaspati** = guru of the devas.
- **Vasishtha's cow** = **Nandini** (daughter of Kamadhenu) in most books and keys; the Valmiki Ramayana calls her **Shabala**.

~~ Sources: Bhagavata Purana 1.3 (avataras), 1.4 and 4.8 (Dhruva), 8.6–8.7 (churning); Vishnu Purana 1.11; Mahabharata Adi Parva (Nandini); old app notes 1:21

Row 22: Vedic Religion, Ritual and Philosophy; the Six Orthodox Schools

1. Six Orthodox Schools – Founders, Texts and Pairs (PYQs 19 · MCQs 23)

School (darshana)	Founder	Key text	Core idea
Samkhya (oldest)	Kapila	Samkhya Sutra; Samkhya Karika (Ishvarakrishna)	Dualism of Purusha and Prakriti; Satkaryavada
Yoga	Patanjali	Yoga Sutra	Ashtanga (eight-limbed) discipline; Samkhya metaphysics
Nyaya	Gautama (Akshapada)	Nyaya Sutra	Logic; four pramanas; 16 padarthas
Vaisheshika	Kanada	Vaisheshika Sutra	Atomism (paramanu); 9 dravyas
Purva Mimamsa	Jaimini	Mimamsa Sutra	Vedic ritual and duty (karma)
Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta)	Badarayana (Vyasa)	Brahma Sutra	Brahman the only reality; knowledge of Brahman

- **Three pairs: Samkhya–Yoga, Nyaya–Vaisheshika, Mimamsa–Vedanta**.
- **Oldest darshana = Samkhya** (APPSC 2018 flashcard). Kapila is its **earliest exponent**.
- **Uttara Mimamsa = Badarayana = Vyasa** (APPSC G1 2002) – not Kapila, Patanjali or Gautama; an old APPSC key giving Kapila is wrong.
- **Not among the six: Smriti** (a class of texts), **Lokayata** (Charvaka materialism), **Kapalika** (a Shaiva sect) (UPSC 2014), Charvaka, Ajivika.
- **Fully articulated / perfected in the Gupta age** (SSC CPO 2003); their sutras are older.
- **Navya-Nyaya** ("new logic") was founded by **Gangesha Upadhyaya** of Mithila (Tattvachintamani, 14th c.); Raghunatha Shiromani came later.
- **Kapila and the sons of Sagara:** in the Ramayana and Puranas the sage **Kapila** burnt the 60,000 sons of King Sagara to ashes; Bhagiratha brought the Ganga down to redeem them.

> Founder matches: Kapila–Samkhya, Patanjali–Yoga, Gautama–Nyaya, Kanada–Vaisheshika, Jaimini–Purva Mimamsa, Badarayana–Uttara Mimamsa.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.25, p.36-37; PMF Art & Culture Part 5 p.97-102; NextGen Indian History Part 3 (Guptas); Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.121; Britannica 'Nyaya'

1. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment Prelims General Studies 2022

Which saint turned the Sagara Kumaras to ashes?

a. Durvasa
b. Vishwamitra
c. Sanaka
d. Kapila

Answer: (d)

In the Ramayana and Puranas, the 60,000 sons of King Sagara, searching for the sacrificial horse, disturbed sage Kapila, whose glance burnt them to ashes; Bhagiratha later brought down the Ganga to redeem them.

2. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant Motor Vehicle Inspectors, Agriculture Office

There are six "Astikas" (systems) of Hindu philosophy. Which of these is the oldest?

Answer: Sankhya

Samkhya (Sankhya) of Kapila is regarded as the oldest of the six orthodox darshanas (APPSC key).

3. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I Prelims 2002

Jaimini commented on 'Purva Mimamsa'. Who commented on 'Uttara Mimamsa'?

a. Patanjali
b. Gautama
c. Kapila
d. Vyasa

Answer: (d)

Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta) is ascribed to Badarayana, author of the Brahma Sutra, who is identified with Vyasa. Patanjali founded Yoga, Gautama Nyaya and Kapila Samkhya (an old APPSC key giving Kapila is wrong).

4. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Which of the following does not constitute a part of the Shad-Darshanas (six orthodox schools of Hindu philosophy)?

a. Sankhya
b. Yoga
c. Smriti
d. Nyaya

Answer: (c)

The six darshanas are Samkhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Mimamsa and Vedanta; Smriti is a class of texts (remembered tradition), not a school.

5. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Jaimini was the exponent of Purva Mimamsa. Who was the exponent of Uttara Mimamsa?

a. Patanjali
b. Goutama
c. Kapil
d. Vyasa

Answer: (d)

Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta) is ascribed to Badarayana, author of the Brahma Sutra, who is identified with Vyasa. Patanjali founded Yoga, Gautama Nyaya and Kapila Samkhya (an old APPSC key giving Kapila is wrong).

6. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2014

Which one of the following pairs does not form part of the six systems of Indian Philosophy?

a. Mimamsa and Vedanta
b. Nyaya and Vaisheshika
c. Lokayata and Kapalika
d. Sankhya and Yoga

Answer: (c)

Lokayata (Charvaka materialism) is a nastika school and Kapalika a Shaiva sect, so neither is among the six systems; Mimamsa-Vedanta, Nyaya-Vaisheshika and Sankhya-Yoga are the three orthodox pairs.

7. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Author of ‘Nyaya Darshan’ was-

a. Gautama
b. Kapila
c. Kanad
d. Jaimini

Answer: (a)

The Nyaya school (logic) was founded by Gautama (Akshapada), author of the Nyaya Sutra. Kapila founded Samkhya, Kanada Vaisheshika, Jaimini Mimamsa; Charvaka is the materialist school.

8. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Mimamsa was initiated by–

a. Kanad
b. Vasistha
c. Vishwamitra
d. Jaimini

Answer: (d)

Purva Mimamsa was founded by Jaimini (Mimamsa Sutra). Kanada founded Vaisheshika; Vasistha and Vishvamitra were Rigvedic priests, not founders of a darshana.

9. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

‘Sankhya’ Philosophy is propounded by –

a. Gautam
b. Jaimini
c. Kapila
d. Patanjali

Answer: (c)

Samkhya was founded by Kapila (Samkhya Sutra). Gautama founded Nyaya, Jaimini Mimamsa, Patanjali Yoga; Nagarjuna was a Buddhist (Madhyamika) and Charvaka a materialist.

10. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Whose contribution is there in ancient Sankhya Darshan?

a. Kapila
b. Gautam
c. Nagarjuna
d. Charvak

Answer: (a)

Samkhya was founded by Kapila (Samkhya Sutra). Gautama founded Nyaya, Jaimini Mimamsa, Patanjali Yoga; Nagarjuna was a Buddhist (Madhyamika) and Charvaka a materialist.

11. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Which one of the following pairs does not form part of the six systems of Indian Philosophy?

a. Mimamsa and Vedanta
b. Nyaya and Vaisheshika
c. Lokayata and Kapalika
d. Sankhya and Yoga

Answer: (c)

Lokayata (Charvaka materialism) is a nastika school and Kapalika a Shaiva sect, so neither is among the six systems; Mimamsa-Vedanta, Nyaya-Vaisheshika and Sankhya-Yoga are the three orthodox pairs.

12. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005 +1 more

The Nyaya Philosophical system was propagated by:

a. Charvaka
b. Gautama
c. Kapila
d. Jaimini

Answer: (b)

The Nyaya school (logic) was founded by Gautama (Akshapada), author of the Nyaya Sutra. Kapila founded Samkhya, Kanada Vaisheshika, Jaimini Mimamsa; Charvaka is the materialist school.

13. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Which of the following pairs (School of Thought- Proponent) is correctly matched?

a. Vaisheshika – Patanjali
b. Nyaya – Gautama
c. Mimamsa – Kanada
d. Uttara Mimamsa – Kapila

Answer: (b)

Nyaya–Gautama is correct. Vaisheshika is Kanada's (not Patanjali's), Mimamsa Jaimini's (not Kanada's) and Uttara Mimamsa Badarayana's (not Kapila's).

14. [PYQ] · SSC CPO 2003

The six distinct school of Indian philosophy–Samkhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaishasika, Mimamsa, Vedanta became fully articulated during the

a. Vedic Age
b. Gupta Age
c. Kushana Age
d. Maurya Age

Answer: (b)

The six schools of philosophy were perfected (fully articulated) in the Gupta age; their sutras are older, but the classical systems took final shape then.

15. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 1995

The founder of school of Navya-Nyaya was :

a. Raghunatha Siromani
b. Gangesh
c. Sridhara
d. Udayana

Answer: (b)

Navya-Nyaya ('new logic') was founded by Gangesha Upadhyaya of Mithila (14th c.) in his Tattvachintamani; Raghunatha Shiromani was a later exponent, Udayana an earlier Nyaya thinker.

16. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007 +3 more

Who propagated 'Yoga Darshan'?

a. Patanjali
b. Gautam
c. Jaimini
d. Shankaracharya

Answer: (a)

Patanjali, author of the Yoga Sutra, founded the Yoga darshana. Gautama is Nyaya, Jaimini Mimamsa and Shankaracharya Advaita Vedanta.

17. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

The system of philosophy propounded by Kapila Muni is :

a. Purva Mimamsa
b. Sankhya Philosophy
c. Nyaya Philosophy
d. Uttar Mimamsa

Answer: (b)

Samkhya was founded by Kapila (Samkhya Sutra). Gautama founded Nyaya, Jaimini Mimamsa, Patanjali Yoga; Nagarjuna was a Buddhist (Madhyamika) and Charvaka a materialist.

18. [PYQ] · RAS/RTS 2009

Nyaya (philosophy of judgement/logic) was propounded by

a. Charvaka
b. Gautama
c. Kapila
d. Jaimini

Answer: (b)

The Nyaya school (logic) was founded by Gautama (Akshapada), author of the Nyaya Sutra. Kapila founded Samkhya, Kanada Vaisheshika, Jaimini Mimamsa; Charvaka is the materialist school.

19. [PYQ] · APPSC Assistant B.C. Welfare Officer, Assistant Social Welfa

The branch of philosophy that is concerned with reasoning is called

Answer: Logic

Logic is the branch of philosophy concerned with the principles of correct reasoning (in Indian thought, the Nyaya school).

20. [New pattern · match]

Match the orthodox schools with their founders:
List-I (School)
a. Nyaya
b. Vaisheshika
c. Purva Mimamsa
d. Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta)
List-II (Founder)
i. Kanada
ii. Jaimini
iii. Gautama (Akshapada)
iv. Badarayana (Vyasa)
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-iv, b-ii, c-i, d-iii
b. a-iii, b-i, c-ii, d-iv
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv

Answer: (b)

Nyaya = Gautama (Akshapada), Nyaya Sutra; Vaisheshika = Kanada; Purva Mimamsa = Jaimini; Uttara Mimamsa = Badarayana (Vyasa), Brahma Sutra.

21. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the six orthodox schools:
1. The Vaisheshika school recognises nine dravyas (substances).
2. Samkhya is paired with Nyaya among the six darshanas.
3. Samkhya is regarded as the oldest of the six darshanas.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (c)

Statement 2 is wrong: the pairs are Samkhya–Yoga, Nyaya–Vaisheshika and Mimamsa–Vedanta. Statements 1 (9 dravyas) and 3 (Samkhya oldest) are correct.

22. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. Samkhya teaches liberation through discriminating Purusha from Prakriti.
2. Yoga provides the practical discipline and method for achieving that liberation.
Which of the above statements is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Samkhya supplies the discriminating knowledge of Purusha and Prakriti, and Yoga supplies the practical method for liberation.

23. [Kept own]

Which among the following is NOT one of the six orthodox schools of Indian philosophy?

a. Vaisheshika
b. Purva Mimamsa
c. Charvaka
d. Samkhya

Answer: (c)
Charvaka (Lokayata) is a nastika, materialist school; the six orthodox darshanas are Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Samkhya, Yoga, Purva Mimamsa and Vedanta.

2. Rigvedic Gods – Indra, Agni, Varuna, Soma (PYQs 15 · MCQs 23)

God	Domain	Exam fact
Indra	Lightning, storm, war	~250 hymns (most); ranked first; Purandara (fort-breaker); most popular god; wife Shachi (Indrani)
Agni	Fire	~200 hymns (second); messenger between gods and men; first hymn of the Rigveda (1.1)
Varuna	Water, cosmic order	Ranked third; upholder of Rita; ethically the highest
Soma	Plant and ritual drink	Whole 9th Mandala; god of plants; Haoma of the Avesta
Surya	Sun	Aspects: Savitri (Gayatri), Mitra, Pushan, Vishnu
Pushan	Paths, herdsmen, cattle	Solar aspect; god of the Shudras in later Vedic times
Brihaspati	Prayer	Priest (purohita) and preceptor of the gods
Dyaus	Sky	Celestial father, like Zeus
Ushas	Dawn	Female
Aditi	Mother of the gods	Female; not Prithvi (Prithvi = fertility goddess)
Aranyani	Forest	Female
Rudra	Disease	Archer god of the mountains; later merged with Shiva
Yama	Death	–
Vishnu	Aspect of Surya	Only 3 hymns; rose later

- **War-god** = Indra (UPPSC 2011, Uttarakhand 2016). When Indra is not offered, the most hymns = **Agni** (UPPSC 2010).
- **Priest of the gods** = **Brihaspati** in most keys; Agni is also hailed as purohita in Rigveda 1.1.
- **Later Vedic: Prajapati** became supreme creator; **Vishnu** rose as preserver; **Rudra** grew; **Indra and Agni lost importance**.

> Indra 250 > Agni 200 > Varuna third; 9th Mandala = Soma; Aditi (not Prithvi) = mother of gods.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.28, p.34-36; Britannica 'Brihaspati', 'Indra'; old app notes row 22

24. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Who is the wife of God Indra?

a. Rathi
b. Shachi
c. Menaka
d. Urvasi

Answer: (b)

Shachi (Indrani), daughter of the asura Puloman, is the wife of Indra. Rati is Kama's wife; Menaka and Urvashi are apsaras.

25. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Who among the following was the most popular God of the early Vedic Aryans ?

a. Varuna
b. Vishnu
c. Rudra
d. Indra

Answer: (d)

Indra was the most popular and most important Rigvedic god (about 250 hymns, ranked first). Agni was second and Varuna third; Vishnu and Rudra rose only in the later Vedic period.

26. [PYQ] · CDS 2002

The Rigvedic God Varuna was

a. harbinger of peace
b. destroyer of foes
c. guardian of the cosmic order
d. God of prosperity

Answer: (c)

Varuna personified water and upheld Rita, the natural and moral order, so he is the guardian of the cosmic order; he was ethically the highest Rigvedic god.

27. [PYQ] · State PSC

The ninth mandala of the Rigveda is devoted wholly to:

a. Indra and his elephant
b. Urvashi and the Heaven
c. Gods related to plants and drugs
d. ‘Soma’, the god who is named after the drink

Answer: (d)

The whole of the 9th Mandala of the Rigveda is devoted to Soma, the plant and ritual drink deified as a god (the god of plants). It is not about Indra's elephant or Urvashi.

28. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Who among the following is regarded as War-God in the Rig Veda ?

a. Agni
b. Indra
c. Surya
d. Varuna

Answer: (b)

Indra, the warlord and breaker of forts (Purandara), god of storm and thunder, is the war-god of the Rigveda. Agni is fire, Surya the sun and Varuna the god of water and cosmic order.

29. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Who of the following Gods was considered as War-God in the Vedic literature?

a. Varuna
b. Indra
c. Agni
d. Mitra

Answer: (b)

Indra, god of lightning, storm and war (Purandara), is the Vedic war-god. Varuna is the god of water and cosmic order, Agni the god of fire and Mitra a solar deity.

30. [PYQ] · Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

The largest hymn of Rigveda is dedicated to which Vedic god?

a. Agni
b. Indra
c. Varuna
d. Aditya

Answer: (b)

The largest number of Rigvedic hymns (about 250) is dedicated to Indra; Agni comes second with about 200.

31. [PYQ] · BPSC (Pre) 1995

The ninth mandala of the Rigveda Samhita is devoted wholly to

a. Indra and his elephant
b. Urvashi and the Heaven
c. Gods related to plants and drugs
d. 'Soma' and the God who is named after the drink

Answer: (d)

The whole of the 9th Mandala of the Rigveda is devoted to Soma, the plant and ritual drink deified as a god (the god of plants). It is not about Indra's elephant or Urvashi.

32. [PYQ] · CDS 2001

The God who is the most prominent in 'Rigveda' is

a. Indra
b. Agni
c. Pasupati
d. Vishnu

Answer: (a)

Indra, with about 250 hymns, is the most prominent Rigvedic god; Agni is second. Pashupati is a later (Harappan/Shaiva) idea and Vishnu was a minor Rigvedic god (3 hymns).

33. [PYQ] · CDS 2007

Which one of the following Vedic God/Goddess depicts an association with the Sun?

a. Ashvin
b. Pusan
c. Indra
d. Aranyani

Answer: (b)

Pushan is one of the solar aspects of Surya (with Savitri, Mitra and Vishnu), the god of paths and cattle. The Ashvins are twin healers, Indra a storm god and Aranyani the forest goddess.

34. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Mains) 2013 disputed

Who among the following Vedic deities was believed to be their priest?

a. Agni
b. Brihaspati
c. Dyaus
d. Indra

Answer: (b)

Most books and keys: Brihaspati, the priest-preceptor of the gods. Strictly, Agni is also called the gods' priest (purohita) in Rigveda 1.1.1. Brihaspati (Brahmanaspati), the 'lord of prayer', is the preceptor and purohita (priest) of the gods and the model of the earthly priest. Agni is also hailed as the divine 'purohita' in Rigveda 1.1, but the standard key is Brihaspati; Dyaus and Indra are not priests.

35. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

The largest number of Rigvedic hymns are devoted to:

a. Agni
b. Indra
c. Rudra
d. Vishnu

Answer: (b)

The largest number of Rigvedic hymns (about 250) are devoted to Indra; Agni has about 200.

36. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

The largest number of the Hymns in Rig Veda belongs to–

a. Agni
b. Varuna
c. Vishnu
d. Yama

Answer: (a)

Indra has the most hymns, but he is not offered; of the options Agni (about 200 hymns, second only to Indra) has the largest number. Vishnu has only 3 hymns.

37. [PYQ] · SI Mains Paper-IV 2017

During the Vedic period Indra was treated as?

a. Warrior God
b. God of rain
c. God of fire
d. God of Ushassu

Answer: (a)

Indra, called Purandara (breaker of forts), was above all the warlord who led the Aryans to victory; he was also regarded as a rain god, but the warrior role is the one stressed. Agni was the fire god.

38. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 2023 (08-01-2023)

Select the correct statements about religious beliefs of the Rig Vedic Period :

I. Dyus was a celestial God of the Rig Vedic Aryans similar to Jupiter of the Greeks.

II. Prithvi was considered as the mother of all Gods.

III. Agni was worshipped as the intermediary of taking the offerings to the deities.

IV. Cow sacrifice was also the part of worship.

a. I, II and III only
b. I, III and IV only
c. II, III and IV only
d. All of the above

Answer: (b)

I, III and IV: Dyaus (Dyaus pitar) parallels Greek Zeus/Roman Jupiter, Agni carried offerings to the gods, and animal (including cattle) sacrifice was part of worship. II is wrong: Aditi, not Prithvi, was the mother of the gods.

39. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Rigvedic gods:
1. Indra, with about 250 hymns, was called Purandara, the fort-breaker.
2. Agni was the messenger between gods and men, and the first hymn of the Rigveda is addressed to him.
3. Varuna ranked second among the Rigvedic gods.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)

Statement 3 is wrong: Agni (about 200 hymns) ranked second; Varuna, upholder of Rita, ranked third. Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

40. [New pattern · match]

Match the Rigvedic deities with their domains:
List-I (Deity)
a. Pushan
b. Dyaus
c. Aranyani
d. Brihaspati
List-II (Domain)
i. Sky; celestial father, like Zeus
ii. Paths, herdsmen and cattle
iii. Forest
iv. Prayer; priest of the gods
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-iv, b-iii, c-i, d-ii
c. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
d. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (a)

Pushan = paths, herdsmen and cattle; Dyaus = sky, the celestial father compared with Zeus; Aranyani = forest; Brihaspati = prayer, priest and preceptor of the gods.

41. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Vedic gods:
1. Rudra, the archer god of the mountains, later merged with Shiva.
2. About 250 hymns of the Rigveda are addressed to Vishnu.
3. In the Later Vedic period Prajapati became the supreme creator.
4. In the Later Vedic period Pushan became the god of the Shudras.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)
Statement 2 is wrong: Vishnu has only 3 hymns in the Rigveda and rose later; about 250 hymns belong to Indra. Statements 1, 3 and 4 are correct, so three are correct.

42. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Soma:
1. Soma was associated with a plant and a ritual drink.
2. Soma was a female deity associated with dawn.
3. The entire Ninth Mandala of the Rigveda is devoted to Soma hymns.
Which of the above statements are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Soma was a plant and ritual drink, and the whole Ninth Mandala is devoted to Soma hymns; Soma was not a female dawn deity.

43. [Kept own]

Savitri, the deity of the Gayatri Mantra, is an aspect of which god?

a. Surya
b. Agni
c. Soma
d. Indra

Answer: (a)
Savitri is an aspect of Surya, along with Mitra, Pushan and Vishnu.

44. [Kept own]

Match the following:
List-I (Rigvedic deity)
A. Ushas
B. Yama
C. Rudra
D. Aditi
List-II (Domain)
1. Disease
2. Mother of gods
3. Dawn
4. Death
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
b. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1
c. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
d. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3

Answer: (a)
Ushas is dawn, Yama is death, Rudra is disease and Aditi is the mother of the gods.

45. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. Prithvi was regarded as the mother of all gods.
2. Aditi was regarded as the mother of the gods.
Which of the above statements is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)
Aditi was the mother of the gods; Prithvi was a fertility goddess, not the mother of all gods.

46. [Kept own]
Which of the following is NOT correct about Rig Vedic gods?

a. Agni ranked second among the Rig Vedic gods
b. Agni acted as intermediary between humans and gods
c. Varuna upheld Rita
d. Agni was the deity who upheld Rita

Answer: (d)
Agni was second in rank and the intermediary between humans and gods; it was Varuna, not Agni, who upheld Rita.

3. Vedanta Schools – Shankara, Ramanuja, Madhva (PYQs 11 · MCQs 14)

School	Teacher	Meaning	Path to mukti
Advaita	Adi Shankaracharya (8th c., Kaladi, Kerala)	Non-dualism: Brahman alone is real, Atman = Brahman, world = Maya	Jnana (knowledge)
Vishishtadvaita	Ramanujacharya (11th c., Sriperumbudur; Srirangam)	Qualified non-dualism: souls and world real, inseparable from Vishnu	Bhakti and divine grace
Dvaita	Madhvacharya	Dualism	Bhakti
Dvaitadvaita	Nimbarka	Dualistic non-dualism	–
Shuddhadvaita	Vallabhacharya	Pure non-dualism	–

- **Shankara:** founded **four mathas** – **Sringeri** (south), **Puri** (east), **Dwarka** (west), **Badrinath / Jyotirmath (Joshimath)** (north); not Prayag, Kanchi or Varanasi. Called a "**crypto-Buddhist**" (Buddhist in disguise). Also Dashanami order and Panchayatana worship.
- **Ramanuja:** first great promoter of the **Bhakti** movement; Sri Vaishnava.
- **Bhagavad Gita:** gives **equal importance to Jnana, Karma and Bhakti** as means of liberation (UPPSC 2005).
- **Swami Vivekananda's Neo-Vedanta** reworked Advaita.
- Other teachers: **Lakulisha** – Pashupata Shaivism; **Nagarjuna** – Madhyamika (Shunyavada).

> Advaita = Shankara = non-dualism = jnana; Vishishtadvaita = Ramanuja = bhakti; Dvaita = Madhva.

~~ Sources: PMF Art & Culture Part 5 p.98, p.105-110; Britannica 'Bhagavadgita'; old app notes row 22

47. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ
The school of philosophy taught by Sankaracharya is

a. Dvaita
b. Advaita
c. Vasishtadvaita
d. Dvaitadvaita

Answer: (b)
Shankaracharya (8th c., Kaladi) taught Advaita Vedanta – Atman and Brahman are one, the world is Maya. Vishishtadvaita is Ramanuja's, Dvaita Madhva's, Dvaitadvaita Nimbarka's.

48. [PYQ] · Junior Assistant cum Typist in Prisons & Correctional Servic
Who preached "Vishishtadwaitha"?

a. Sankaracharya
b. Desikacharya
c. Madhvacharya
d. Ramanujacharya

Answer: (d)
Ramanujacharya (11th c., Sriperumbudur; taught at Srirangam) preached Vishishtadvaita, qualified non-dualism. Shankara taught Advaita, Madhva Dvaita, Vallabha Shuddhadvaita.

49. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991
Ramanujacharya is related to –

a. Bhakti
b. Dvaitvad
c. Vishistadvaita
d. Monotheism

Answer: (c)
Ramanujacharya (11th c., Sriperumbudur; taught at Srirangam) preached Vishishtadvaita, qualified non-dualism. Shankara taught Advaita, Madhva Dvaita, Vallabha Shuddhadvaita.

50. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Which one of the following gives equal importance to Jnana, Karma and Bhakti as a means of liberation?

a. Advaita Vedanta
b. Vishistadvaitvad Vedanta
c. Bhagavad Gita
d. Mimamsa

Answer: (c)

The Bhagavad Gita gives equal place to Jnana, Karma and Bhakti as paths to liberation (a synthesis). Advaita stresses jnana, Vishishtadvaita bhakti and Mimamsa karma.

51. [PYQ] · State PSC

Samkara's philosophy is called as

a. Monism
b. Integral Monism
c. Dualism
d. Non-dualism

Answer: (d)

Shankara's Advaita means 'non-dualism': Brahman alone is real and Atman is Brahman. 'Monism' is a loose synonym, but the exact name is non-dualism; dualism is Madhva's.

52. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

By which of the following according to Advaita Vedanta, can Mukti be obtained?

a. Gyana
b. Karma
c. Bhakti
d. Yoga

Answer: (a)

In Advaita Vedanta mukti comes through jnana – realising that Atman is Brahman (Jnana Yoga); karma is the Mimamsa path and bhakti Ramanuja's.

53. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021 +1 more

Who was the founder of Visistadvaita Siddhanta?

a. Ramanujacharya
b. Vallabhacharya
c. Srikanthacharya
d. Madhavacharya

Answer: (a)

Ramanujacharya (11th c., Sriperumbudur; taught at Srirangam) preached Vishishtadvaita, qualified non-dualism. Shankara taught Advaita, Madhva Dvaita, Vallabha Shuddhadvaita.

54. [PYQ] · State PSC

Who is called 'Crypto-Buddhist'?

a. Shamkara
b. Kapil
c. Ramanuja
d. Patanjali

Answer: (a)

Shankaracharya was called a 'crypto-Buddhist' (Buddhist in disguise) by opponents because his Advaita resembled Buddhist doctrine.

55. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2006

Adi Shankaracharya established four Mathas. These Mathas are situated at

a. Badrinath, Dwarka, Puri, Sringeri
b. Sringeri, Dwarka, Badrinath, Prayag
c. Dwarka, Badrinath, Prayag, Sringeri
d. Puri, Sringeri, Dwarka, Varanasi

Answer: (a)

Shankara's four cardinal mathas are at Sringeri (south), Puri (east), Dwarka (west) and Badrinath / Jyotirmath (Joshimath) (north). Prayag, Kanchi and Varanasi are not among them.

56. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2006

Adi Shankaracharya established four Mathas. These Mathas are situated at

a. Sringeri, Dwarka, Joshimath and Prayag
b. Dwarka, Joshimath, Prayag and Kanchi
c. Joshimath, Dwarka, Puri and Sringeri
d. Puri, Sringeri, Dwarka and Varanasi

Answer: (c)

Shankara's four cardinal mathas are at Sringeri (south), Puri (east), Dwarka (west) and Badrinath / Jyotirmath (Joshimath) (north). Prayag, Kanchi and Varanasi are not among them.

57. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014
The Founder of Advait Philosophy is –

a. Sankaracharya
b. Ramanujacharya
c. Madhvacharya
d. Mahatma Buddha

Answer: (a)
Adi Shankaracharya is the founder (chief exponent) of Advaita philosophy; Ramanuja founded Vishishtadvaita and Madhva Dvaita.

58. [New pattern · match]
Match the Vedanta schools with their teachers:
List-I (School)
a. Vishishtadvaita
b. Dvaita
c. Dvaitadvaita
d. Shuddhadvaita
List-II (Teacher)
i. Vallabhacharya
ii. Ramanujacharya
iii. Madhvacharya
iv. Nimbarka
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv
b. a-ii, b-iii, c-iv, d-i
c. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
d. a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii

Answer: (b)
Vishishtadvaita = Ramanuja; Dvaita = Madhva; Dvaitadvaita = Nimbarka; Shuddhadvaita = Vallabha (Advaita = Shankara).

59. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements:
1. Adi Shankaracharya founded four mathas, one of them at Kanchi.
2. Ramanuja was the first great promoter of the Bhakti movement.
3. Swami Vivekananda's Neo-Vedanta reworked Advaita.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Statement 1 is wrong: Shankara's four mathas are Sringeri, Puri, Dwarka and Badrinath/Jyotirmath, not Prayag, Kanchi or Varanasi. Statements 2 and 3 are correct.

60. [Kept own]
Which of the following is NOT correctly matched (school – path to liberation)?

a. Samkhya – discriminating knowledge
b. Yoga – discipline and meditation
c. Mimamsa – karma (ritual)
d. Advaita Vedanta – bhakti

Answer: (d)
Advaita Vedanta seeks liberation through jnana, knowledge of the identity of Atman and Brahman.

4. Mimamsa – Jaimini, Kumarila Bhatta, Karma and Apurva (PYQs 10 · MCQs 13)

- **Founder: Jaimini** (Mimamsa Sutra). Other exponents: **Kumarila Bhatta** and **Prabhakara**.
- **Kumarila Bhatta** = **Purva Mimamsa** (APPSC G2 2012, 2019; AP History PYQs) – not Uttara Mimamsa, Advaita, Dvaita, Yogachara or Jnana marga. Works: **Slokavartika**, Tantravartika. He **defended Vedic ritual (karma-kanda)** and attacked Buddhist doctrines.
- Also called **Karma-Mimamsa**: it centres on ritual action → the **theory of karma** belongs to Mimamsa (UPPSC 1997).
- **Liberation through karma** – correct performance of Vedic rites and duties (UPSC 2005).
- The **Vedas are eternal** and contain eternal truth (CGPSC 2013).
- **Apurva** = the **unseen force** that links a ritual act (karma) with its later result.
- **Purva Mimamsa = Karmakanda** (ritual part of the Vedas); **Uttara Mimamsa = Jnanakanda** (knowledge part).

~~ Sources: PMF Art & Culture Part 5 p.100-101; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.121; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.37; old app notes row 22

61. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2012

Which philosophical theory was propagated by Kumarila Bhattu?

a. Purvamimamsa
b. Uttaramimamsa
c. Advaita
d. Dvaita

Answer: (a)
Kumarila Bhatta was the great exponent of Purva Mimamsa (ritual Mimamsa), defending Vedic ritual against Buddhism. Uttara Mimamsa is Badarayana's, Advaita Shankara's and Dvaita Madhva's.

62. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

The theory of Karma is related with :

a. Nyaya
b. Mimansa
c. Vedanta
d. Vaisheshika

Answer: (b)
Mimamsa is also called Karma-Mimamsa because it centres on ritual action (karma) and the law of karma; Nyaya is logic, Vaisheshika atomism and Vedanta knowledge of Brahman.

63. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S (Pre) 2013

Which of the following schools of philosophy is of the opinion that Vedas contain the eternal truth?

a. Sankhya
b. Vaisheshika
c. Mimamsa
d. Nyaya

Answer: (c)
Mimamsa interprets the Vedas and holds that they are eternal (apaurusheya) and contain eternal truth; it is the school of Vedic authority and ritual.

64. [PYQ] · State PSC

The doctrine of Apurva is related to

a. Charvaka
b. Jaina
c. Bauddha
d. Mimamsa

Answer: (d)
Apurva, the unseen force that links a ritual act (karma) with its later result, is a Mimamsa doctrine.

65. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 1997

The theory of Karma is related to

a. Nyaya
b. Mimamsa
c. Vedanta
d. Vaisheshika

Answer: (b)
Mimamsa is also called Karma-Mimamsa because it centres on ritual action (karma) and the law of karma; Nyaya is logic, Vaisheshika atomism and Vedanta knowledge of Brahman.

66. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

Which of the following spiritual doctrines was propagated by Kumarila Bhatta?

a. Yogachara
b. Purva Mimamsa
c. Uttara Mimamsa
d. Jnana Marga

Answer: (b)
Kumarila Bhatta was the great exponent of Purva Mimamsa; Yogachara is a Buddhist school, Uttara Mimamsa is Vedanta and Jnana Marga the path of knowledge.

67. [PYQ] · APPSC AP History PYQ

Which philosophical theory was propagated by Kumarila Bhatta?

a. Purvamimamsa
b. Uttaramimamsa
c. Advaita
d. Dvaita

Answer: (a)
Kumarila Bhatta was the great exponent of Purva Mimamsa (ritual Mimamsa), defending Vedic ritual against Buddhism. Uttara Mimamsa is Badarayana's, Advaita Shankara's and Dvaita Madhva's.

68. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

According to Mimamsa system of philosophy liberation is possible by means of:

a. Gyan
b. Bhakti
c. Yoga
d. Karma

Answer: (d)
Mimamsa (Karma-Mimamsa) holds that liberation comes through karma – the correct performance of Vedic rituals and duties.

69. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-II 2019

Which of the following spiritual doctrine was propagated by Kumarila Bhatta?

a. Yogachara
b. Purva Mimamsa
c. Uttara Mimamsa
d. Jnana Marga

Answer: (b)
Kumarila Bhatta was the great exponent of Purva Mimamsa; Yogachara is a Buddhist school, Uttara Mimamsa is Vedanta and Jnana Marga the path of knowledge.

70. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-2 PYQ

Which school of spiritual doctrine was propagated by Kumarila Bhatta?

a. Uttara mimamsa
b. Purva mimamsa
c. Yogachara
d. Gnana-marga

Answer: (b)
Kumarila Bhatta was the great exponent of Purva Mimamsa; Yogachara is a Buddhist school, Uttara Mimamsa is Vedanta and Jnana Marga the path of knowledge.

71. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Mimamsa school:
1. Prabhakara was an exponent of Purva Mimamsa.
2. Kumarila Bhatta wrote the Slokavartika.
3. Apurva, in Mimamsa, means the ultimate reality.
4. Purva Mimamsa is called the Jnanakanda.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (b)
Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is wrong: Apurva is the unseen force linking a ritual act with its later result. Statement 4 is wrong: Purva Mimamsa = Karmakanda; Uttara Mimamsa = Jnanakanda. So only two are correct.

72. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Kumarila Bhatta defended Vedic ritual (karma-kanda) and attacked Buddhist doctrines.
Reason (R): Kumarila Bhatta was an exponent of Purva Mimamsa, the school that centres on ritual action.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: as the exponent of Purva Mimamsa (Karma-Mimamsa), Kumarila defended the Vedic ritual that Buddhism rejected.

73. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Purva Mimamsa:
1. It was founded by Jaimini.
2. It holds that liberation comes through karma (ritual).
3. It is called Jnanakanda.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Purva Mimamsa (Jaimini) seeks liberation through ritual and is the Karmakanda; Uttara Mimamsa is the Jnanakanda.

5. Doctrines of the Schools – Samkhya, Nyaya, Vaisheshika (PYQs 6 · MCQs 10)

Doctrine	School
Satkaryavada (effect pre-exists in the cause)	Samkhya (MPPSC 2025)
World formed by the blending of nature (Prakriti)	Samkhya
Atom as the basis of the world	Vaisheshika (Kanada)
Pramanas – perception, inference, comparison, testimony	Nyaya
Apurva; theory of karma	Mimamsa
Niyati (predetermined fate)	Ajivika (Makkhali Gosala)
Materialism	Lokayata / Charvaka
Syadvada	Jaina
Shunyavada / Madhyamika	Nagarjuna

- **Samkhya: accepts rebirth**; liberation by **self-knowledge** (discriminating Purusha from Prakriti), not by an outside agent → UPSC 2013 "only 2". Kapila taught that man's life is shaped by the **forces of nature, not a divine agency** (CGPSC 2020: both true).
- **Nyaya:** "nyaya" = logic or decision; **16 padarthas**. **Vaisheshika:** 9 dravyas; beginning of physics in India.
- **APPSC G1 2023 match:** Samkhya – blending of nature; Vaisheshika – atom; Lokayata – materialism; Ajivika – predetermined fate.

~~ Sources: PMF Art & Culture Part 5 p.99-104; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.37-38; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.121; old app notes row 22

74. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

With reference to the history of philosophical thought in India, consider the following statements regarding Sankhya School
1. Sankhya does not accept the theory of rebirth or transmigration of the soul.
2. Sankhya holds that it is the self-knowledge that leads to liberation and not any exterior influence or agent.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. Only 1
b. Only 2
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)
Samkhya does accept rebirth and transmigration, so statement 1 is wrong; it holds that liberation comes from self-knowledge (discriminating Purusha from Prakriti), not from any outside agent, so only 2 is correct.

75. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Read the following statements and choose the correct option:
Statement I : Kapila is the earliest exponent of Sankhya system Statement II : Kapila teaches that a man's life is shaped by the forces of nature and not by any divine agency

a. Statement I and Statement II both are true
b. Statement I is false, but Statement II is true
c. Statement I and Statement II both are false
d. Statement I is true, but Statement II is false

Answer: (a)
Kapila is the earliest exponent of Samkhya, and Samkhya teaches that man's life is shaped by the forces of nature (Prakriti), not by any divine agency, so both statements are true.

76. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which of the following philosophies of India propounded the atom theory?

a. Yoga
b. Nyaya
c. Sankhya
d. Vaisheshika

Answer: (d)
The Vaisheshika school of Kanada propounded the atomic theory (paramanu); it marks the beginning of physics in India.

77. [PYQ] · M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

‘Satkaryavada’ is the main doctrine of which philosophical system?

a. Vaisheshika philosophy
b. Mimamsa philosophy
c. Samkhya philosophy
d. Nyaya philosophy

Answer: (c)

Satkaryavada – the effect pre-exists in its cause – is the main doctrine of Samkhya (Kapila). Nyaya-Vaisheshika hold the opposite, Asatkaryavada.

78. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

'Syadvada' is related to

a. Charvaka
b. Jaina
c. Bauddha
d. Samkhya

Answer: (b)

Syadvada ('may be'), the doctrine that all judgments are conditional, is Jaina (part of Anekantavada and Saptabhangi).

79. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 2023 (08-01-2023)

Match the following schools of philosophies with their theories :
List I

a. Sankhya

b. Vaisheshika

c. Lokayata

d. Ajivika
List II

I. Predetermined fate theory

II. World was formed by the blending of nature

III. Considered Atom as basis of the world

IV. Advocated materialistic ideology

a. a-I, b-II, c-III, d-IV
b. a-II, b-III, c-IV, d-I
c. a-III, b-II, c-I, d-IV
d. a-IV, b-I, c-II, d-III

Answer: (b)

Samkhya – world formed by the blending of nature (Prakriti) (II); Vaisheshika – atom as basis of the world (III); Lokayata – materialism (IV); Ajivika – Niyati, predetermined fate (I). So a-II, b-III, c-IV, d-I.

80. [New pattern · match]

Match the doctrines with the schools/teachers they belong to:
List-I (Doctrine)
a. Satkaryavada
b. Niyati (predetermined fate)
c. Syadvada
d. Shunyavada
List-II (School)
i. Ajivika
ii. Jaina
iii. Madhyamika (Nagarjuna)
iv. Samkhya
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
c. a-iii, b-ii, c-iv, d-i
d. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (d)

Satkaryavada (effect pre-exists in the cause) = Samkhya; Niyati = Ajivika (Makkhali Gosala); Syadvada = Jaina; Shunyavada = Madhyamika of Nagarjuna.

81. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): The Vaisheshika school marks the beginning of physics in India.
Reason (R): The Vaisheshika school holds the blending of Prakriti (nature) to be the basis of the world.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (c)
A is true (Vaisheshika: 9 dravyas, beginning of physics in India). R is false: Vaisheshika holds the atom (paramanu) to be the basis of the world; the world formed by the blending of nature (Prakriti) is the Samkhya view.

82. [Kept own]

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

a. Materialism — Lokayata
b. Atom as basis of the world — Vaisheshika
c. Niyati — Ajivika
d. Pramanas — Samkhya

Answer: (d)
Pramanas, or valid means of knowledge, are associated with Nyaya, not Samkhya. The other three pairs are correctly matched.

83. [Kept own]

How many categories (padarthas) does the Nyaya school recognise?

a. 9
b. 7
c. 16
d. 25

Answer: (c)
The Nyaya school of Gautama is based on logic, the pramanas and 16 categories.

6. Astika vs Nastika; Charvaka (Lokayata) (PYQs 5 · MCQs 8)

- **Test: belief in the authority of the Vedas** – astika accept it, nastika reject it (UPPSC 2005); not belief in God, rebirth or heaven.
- **Astika:** the six darshanas. **Nastika: Charvaka, Buddhism (Bauddha), Jainism, Ajivika**.
- **Charvaka = Lokayata** ("of the common people"); credited to **Brihaspati**; **materialism**; **perception** the only valid knowledge; no soul, rebirth or afterlife.
- **Ajita Kesakambali** – early materialist of the Buddha's time.

> Odd-one-out lists slip a nastika school (Charvaka, Bauddha, Ajivika) among the six.

~~ Sources: PMF Art & Culture Part 5 p.97, p.105; old app notes rows 22-23

84. [PYQ] · APPSC General Studies & Mental Ability (Common Paper for Var

The philosophy that Charvakas propounded is known as

a. Mimamsa
b. Lokayata
c. Panchayatana
d. Upasaka

Answer: (b)
The materialist philosophy of the Charvakas is called Lokayata ('derived from the common people'). Mimamsa is an orthodox school and Panchayatana a form of worship.

85. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Which one of the following is the distinctive feature of a nastika and astika system in India ?

a. Belief in the existence of God
b. Belief in the doctrine of re-birth
c. Belief in the authenticity of the Vedas
d. Belief in the existence of heaven and hell

Answer: (c)
Astika schools accept the authority of the Vedas and nastika schools reject it; belief in God, rebirth or heaven is not the test (Samkhya and Mimamsa are astika yet non-theistic).

86. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023
Which of the following is the Nastika school of thought?

a. Sankhya
b. Yoga
c. Nayaya
d. Bauddha

Answer: (d)
Bauddha (Buddhism) is nastika because it rejects the authority of the Vedas; Samkhya, Yoga and Nyaya are astika.

87. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Mains) 2005
Which one of the following is the distinctive features of a nastika and astika system in India?

a. Belief in the existence of God.
b. Belief in the doctrine of re-birth.
c. Belief in the authenticity of the vedas.
d. Belief in the existence of heaven and hell.

Answer: (c)
Astika schools accept the authority of the Vedas and nastika schools reject it; belief in God, rebirth or heaven is not the test (Samkhya and Mimamsa are astika yet non-theistic).

88. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre)-2021
Charvaka philosophical system was also called :

a. Vaisesika system
b. Lokayata system
c. Astika system
d. Mimamsa system

Answer: (b)
Charvaka materialism is also called Lokayata; it is a nastika school, not Vaisheshika, astika or Mimamsa.

89. [New pattern · statements]
Consider the following statements about materialist thought:
1. Charvaka (Lokayata) materialism is credited to Brihaspati.
2. For the Charvakas, inference is the only valid means of knowledge.
3. Ajita Kesakambali was an early materialist of the Buddha's time.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 2 is wrong: for the Charvakas perception is the only valid knowledge. Statements 1 and 3 are correct.

90. [New pattern · assertion]
Assertion (A): The Charvaka school is classed as a nastika system.
Reason (R): The Charvaka school rejects the authority of the Vedas.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the astika/nastika test is belief in the authority of the Vedas, not belief in God, rebirth or heaven.

91. [Kept own]
Which one of the following groups consists entirely of nastika systems or traditions?

a. Mimamsa, Vedanta and Vaisheshika
b. Nyaya, Charvaka and Vedanta
c. Samkhya, Yoga and Nyaya
d. Charvaka, Buddhism, Jainism and Ajivika

Answer: (d)
Charvaka, Buddhism, Jainism and Ajivika reject the authority of the Vedas and are classified as nastika traditions.

7. Nature of Vedic Religion – Rita, Dharma, Sacrifice (PYQs 5 · MCQs 11)

- **Nature worship**; male gods dominate; worship for material gains; **sacrifice (yajna) central**, in the open air – **no temples, no idols** (UPPSC 1993: "sacrifice and rituals").
- **Henotheism** (term of **Max Müller**): each god praised in turn as supreme.
- **Rita** = cosmic and moral order, upheld by **Varuna**; **Dharma** = obligation and duty to oneself and others, grown from Rita → UPSC 2011 "both".
- Iranian parallels: **Mitra–Mithra, Rita–Asha, Soma–Haoma**.

Ritual / term	Associated with
Hotri (Rig), Adhvaryu (Yajur), Udgatri (Sama)	Priests
Ceremonial chanting	Samaveda
Agnistoma	Regular Soma sacrifice
Rajasuya, Vajapeya, Ashvamedha	Royal sacrifices
Grihya Sutras	Domestic rites

- **Sanskaras: 16** = 3 before birth, 12 during life, **1 after death**.
- **Later Vedic:** elaborate, costly sacrifices; Prajapati supreme; Indra and Agni decline; priests grow powerful.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.28, p.33; PMF Art & Culture Part 5 p.97; old app notes row 22

92. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2012
The religion of early Vedic Aryans was primarily of

a. Bhakti
b. Image worship and yajnas
c. Worship of nature and yajnas
d. Worship of nature and bhakti

Answer: (c)
Early Vedic religion was worship of nature (personified forces) through open-air yajnas; there were no images and bhakti came much later.

93. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2016
In context on Indian culture 'Rita' means

a. Natural law
b. Artificial law
c. Human law
d. Social law

Answer: (a)
Rita is the natural (cosmic) order or natural law, upheld by Varuna.

94. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014
Rig-vedic religion was–

a. Polytheistic
b. Monotheistic
c. Monistic
d. Libertarian

Answer: (a)
Rig Vedic religion was polytheistic (many nature gods, each praised in turn as supreme – henotheism); it was not monotheistic or monistic.

95. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 2011
The ‘Dharma’ and ‘Rita’ depict a central idea of ancient Vedic civilisation of India. In this context, consider the following statements.

I. ‘Dharma’ was a conception of obligation and of the discharge of one’s duties to oneself and to others.

II. ‘Rita’ was the fundamental moral law governing the functioning of the universe and all it contained.
Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

a. Only I
b. Only II
c. Both I and II
d. Neither I nor II

Answer: (c)
Rita is the fundamental moral and cosmic law governing the universe, and Dharma is the idea of obligation and duty to oneself and to others that grew out of it, so both statements are correct (UPSC 2011).

96. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Pre) 1993
In the Rigvedic period, people believed mainly in

a. Idol worship
b. One God Belief
c. Goddess worship
d. Sacrifice and rituals

Answer: (d)
Rigvedic people worshipped nature gods through prayers and yajnas; sacrifice occupied a central role, there were no temples or idols, and male gods dominated over goddesses, so 'sacrifice and rituals' is correct.

97. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Vedic religion:
1. The term henotheism was applied to Rigvedic religion by Max Müller.
2. Rita, the cosmic and moral order, was upheld by Varuna.
3. The Avestan parallel of Rita is Haoma.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 3 is wrong: the parallel of Rita is Asha; Haoma is the parallel of Soma (and Mithra of Mitra). Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

98. [New pattern · match]

Match the Vedic rituals/terms with what they are associated with:
List-I (Ritual / term)
a. Agnistoma
b. Grihya Sutras
c. Ceremonial chanting
d. Rajasuya
List-II (Associated with)
i. Domestic rites
ii. Regular Soma sacrifice
iii. Samaveda
iv. Royal sacrifice
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii
c. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
d. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv

Answer: (a)
Agnistoma = regular Soma sacrifice; Grihya Sutras = domestic rites; ceremonial chanting = Samaveda; Rajasuya (with Vajapeya and Ashvamedha) = royal sacrifice.

99. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT correct about Rig Vedic worship?

a. Temples and idols formed the normal basis of worship
b. Worship was conducted through hymns and yajnas in the open air
c. Its principal aims included cattle, sons and victory
d. The cult of the domestic hearth was significant

Answer: (a)
Temples and idols were absent in Rig Vedic worship, which used hymns and open-air yajnas for material ends such as cattle, sons and victory.

100. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about later Vedic religion:
1. Prajapati became the supreme god.
2. Indra and Agni gained importance.
3. Worship centred on elaborate, costly sacrifices.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
In later Vedic times Prajapati became supreme and costly sacrifices dominated; Indra and Agni lost importance.

101. [Kept own]

Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

a. Adhvaryu — Samaveda
b. Udgatri — Samaveda
c. Adhvaryu — Yajurveda
d. Hotri — Rigveda

Answer: (a)
The Adhvaryu was associated with the Yajurveda, whereas the Udgatri was associated with the Samaveda.

102. [Kept own]
Of the 16 sanskaras, how many are performed after death?

a. 1
b. 2
c. 3
d. 4

Answer: (a)
The 16 sanskaras are 3 before birth, 12 during life and 1 after death.

8. Upanishadic Philosophy (PYQs 4 · MCQs 7)

Concept	Meaning
Brahman	Ultimate reality (cosmic principle)
Atman	The self – not body or mind
Karma	Links action with consequence
Samsara	Rebirth – transmigration first in the Brihadaranyaka
Moksha	Liberation – not a Vedic Samhita term; first discussed in the Upanishads

- **Main theme = philosophy** (UPPSC 2004, UP Lower 1998); anti-ritualistic; **Atman is Brahman**.
- Criticised **mechanical sacrifice**; stressed meditation and the guru-disciple relationship; **ignorance** = cause of sorrow.
- **Katha (Katha) Upanishad: Nachiketa** questions **Yama** on death and the Atman (UPSC 1997).
- Basic approach is universal – it does not reject other schools or scriptures.

~~ Sources: NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 p.25, p.29; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.2; old app notes row 22

103. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 1997
The famous dialogue between Nachiketa and Yama is mentioned in the

a. Chhandogyopanishad
b. Mundakopanishad
c. Kathopanishad
d. Kenopanishad

Answer: (c)
The dialogue of Nachiketa and Yama, god of death, on the Atman and immortality is in the Katha (Katha) Upanishad.

104. [PYQ] · U.P.Lower Sub. (Pre) 1998
The main theme of Upanishads is –

a. Social structure
b. Philosophy
c. Law
d. State

Answer: (b)
The Upanishads are philosophical, anti-ritualistic texts dealing with Brahman, Atman, karma and moksha, so their main theme is philosophy.

105. [PYQ] · UPPSC (Mains) 2004
Upanishads are book on

a. Religion
b. Yoga
c. Law
d. Philosophy

Answer: (d)
The Upanishads are mainly books of philosophy (Vedanta), on Brahman, Atman and moksha, not law, yoga or ritual religion.

106. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2003
Which one of the following Vedic literature talks about salvation :

a. Rig Veda
b. Later Samhitas
c. Brahmins
d. Upanishads

Answer: (d)
Moksha (salvation) is not a Vedic Samhita term; it is first discussed in the Upanishads, whose aim is liberation from the cycle of birth and death.

107. [New pattern · match]

Match the Upanishadic concepts with their meanings:
List-I (Concept)
a. Brahman
b. Atman
c. Karma
d. Samsara
List-II (Meaning)
i. Ultimate reality (cosmic principle)
ii. Rebirth
iii. Links action with consequence
iv. The self, not body or mind
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
b. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-iv, b-iii, c-ii, d-i

Answer: (b)
Brahman = ultimate reality; Atman = the self; Karma = links action and consequence; Samsara = rebirth (Moksha = liberation).

108. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Upanishadic philosophy:
1. The doctrine of transmigration is first found in the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad.
2. Moksha is not a Vedic Samhita term and is first discussed in the Upanishads.
3. It holds sacrifice to be the cause of sorrow.
4. It stressed meditation and the guru-disciple relationship.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)
Statement 3 is wrong: Upanishadic philosophy holds ignorance to be the cause of sorrow (it criticised mechanical sacrifice). Statements 1, 2 and 4 are correct, so three are correct.

109. [Kept own]

Which of the following statements about the basic philosophy of the Upanishads is incorrect?

a. It is described as philosophy for all times and for all.
b. It does not oppose any school of thought, religion or scriptural interpretation.
c. It has a universal approach.
d. It rejects every school of thought, religion and scriptural interpretation.

Answer: (d)
Option D is incorrect: Upanishadic philosophy has a universal approach and does not oppose any school, religion or scriptural view. A, B and C are right.

9. Ashtanga Yoga (PYQs 2 · MCQs 3)

No.	Limb	Group
1	Yama	Bahiranga (outer)
2	Niyama	Bahiranga
3	Asana	Bahiranga
4	Pranayama	Bahiranga
5	Pratyahara	Bahiranga (the bridge to the inner limbs)
6	Dharana	Antaranga (inner)
7	Dhyana	Antaranga
8	Samadhi	Antaranga

- **Antaranga sadhana = Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi** (MPPSC 2024 → Dharana). **Anusmriti** is NOT a limb (CGPSC 2015).
- **Bahiranga = 5** (Yama to Pratyahara); **antaranga = 3**; **Pranayama** is the 4th limb.

~~ Sources: PMF Art & Culture Part 5 p.99-100; old app notes row 22

110. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

What is called Antaranga Sadhana under Ashtanga Yoga?

a. Pratyahara
b. Niyama
c. Pranayama
d. Dharana

Answer: (d)

Antaranga (inner) sadhana = Dharana, Dhyana and Samadhi. Pratyahara is the bridge between the outer (bahiranga) limbs – Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama – and the inner ones, so Dharana is the answer.

111. [PYQ] · CGPSC (Pre) 2015

Which of the following is not the part of “Ashtangayoga”?

a. Anusmriti
b. Pratyahara
c. Dhyana
d. Dharana

Answer: (a)

The eight limbs are Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana and Samadhi; Anusmriti (recollection) is a Buddhist meditation term, not a limb.

112. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga:
1. Pranayama is the fourth limb.
2. Pratyahara belongs to the antaranga (inner) group.
3. Five limbs are bahiranga (outer).
Which of the statements given above is/are NOT correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (b)

Statement 2 is NOT correct: Pratyahara is the fifth and last bahiranga limb (the bridge to the inner limbs); antaranga = Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi. Statements 1 and 3 are correct.

Row 23: The Sixteen Mahajanapadas – List, Capitals, Monarchies vs Ganasanghas

1. Mahajanapada → Capital → Region (PYQs 10 · MCQs 18)

Mahajanapada	Capital	Region / river
Anga	Champa	Bhagalpur, Munger (east Bihar); Ganga–Champa confluence
Magadha	Rajagriha / Girivraja → Pataliputra	Patna, Nalanda, Gaya – the area south of the Ganga
Kashi	Varanasi	Between the Varuna and Asi
Kosala	Shravasti, Saket (Ayodhya)	Awadh; Sarayu
Vajji	Vaishali	North Bihar (Vaishali, Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga)
Malla	Kushinara, Pava	Kushinagar, Deoria
Chedi	Sotthivati / Suktimati	Eastern Bundelkhand
Vatsa	Kaushambi	Prayagraj; Yamuna
Kuru	Indraprastha (also Hastinapura)	Meerut, Delhi, Thaneshwar
Panchala	North Ahichchhatra, south Kampilya	Rohilkhand (Bareilly, Badaun, Farrukhabad)
Matsya	Viratnagar (Bairat)	Jaipur, Alwar, Bharatpur – Rajasthan
Shurasena	Mathura	Braj; Yamuna
Assaka / Ashmaka	Potana / Potali = Bodhan	Godavari
Avanti	North Ujjayini (ancient Avantika), south Mahishmati	Malwa; Shipra, Narmada
Gandhara	Taxila (Pushkalavati)	Peshawar–Rawalpindi
Kamboja	Rajapura / Hatak (PMF: Poonch)	J&K, Hazara; Kubha (Kabul); horse-breeding

- **Not correctly matched (UPRO 2017):** Kosala – Ahichchhatra (Ahichchhatra is **North Panchala**).
- **APPSC G1 2024:** Avanti–Ujjain, Kosala–Shravasti, Vatsa–Kaushambi, Anga–Champa.
- **8 of 16** in present Uttar Pradesh; Bihar: Anga, Magadha, Vajji.
- **Kashi** was ruled by the **Brahmadatta** dynasty until **Kosala** annexed it.

> Ahichchhatra = Panchala; Suktimati = Chedi; Viratnagar = Matsya; Champa = Anga; Mathura = Shurasena.

~~ Sources: Rocket Indian History Part 2 p.110 (Sheet #138); PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.20-27; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 3 p.27; NCERT Class 6 ch.1; old app notes row 23

1. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Matsya Mahajanapada of 6th Century B.C. was located in:

a. Western Uttar Pradesh
b. Rajasthan
c. Bundelkhand
d. Rohilkhand

Answer: (b)
Matsya lay in eastern Rajasthan (Jaipur, Alwar, Bharatpur) with its capital at Viratnagar (Bairat).

2. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

The capital of North Panchal, according to Mahabharata, was located at :

a. Hastinapur
b. Indraprastha
c. Ahichhatra
d. Mathura

Answer: (c)

Panchala was split by the Ganga: North Panchala's capital was Ahichchhatra (Ramnagar, Bareilly) and South Panchala's Kampilya. Hastinapura and Indraprastha were Kuru, Mathura Shurasena.

3. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993 +1 more

What was the ancient name of Ujjain?

a. Taxila
b. Indraprastha
c. Avantika
d. None of above

Answer: (c)

Ujjain (Ujjayini), capital of northern Avanti on the Shipra, was anciently called Avantika. Taxila was Gandhara's capital and Indraprastha Kuru's.

4. [PYQ] · U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Which of the following is not correctly matched?

a. Anga- Champa
b. Koshala - Ahichchhatra
c. Vatsa - Kaushambi
d. Matsya - Viratnagar

Answer: (b)

Koshala's capitals were Shravasti and Saket, not Ahichchhatra (North Panchala). Anga–Champa, Vatsa–Kaushambi and Matsya–Viratnagar are correct.

5. [PYQ] · U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014

Champa was the capital of which Mahajanapada?

a. Magadha
b. Vajji
c. Kosala
d. Anga

Answer: (d)

Champa, on the confluence of the Ganga and Champa rivers near Bhagalpur, was the capital of Anga; Bimbisara annexed it.

6. [PYQ] · Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

During the period of 16 Mahajanapadas, Mathura was the capital of –

a. Vajji
b. Vatsa
c. Kashi
d. Surasena

Answer: (d)

Mathura on the Yamuna was the capital of Shurasena. Vajji's capital was Vaishali, Vatsa's Kaushambi and Kashi's Varanasi.

7. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

In the sixth century B.C. Suktimati was the capital of

a. Panchala
b. Kuru
c. Chedi
d. Avanti

Answer: (c)

Suktimati (Sotthivati) was the capital of Chedi in eastern Bundelkhand.

8. [PYQ] · WBCS 2018

Which kingdom covered the modern Patna and Gaya districts of Bihar?

a. Anga
b. Kosala
c. Magadha
d. Avanti

Answer: (c)

Magadha covered the modern Patna and Gaya (and Nalanda) districts of Bihar; Anga lay east around Bhagalpur and Munger.

9. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I Prelims 2024 (17-03-2024)

Match the following:
List-I (Mahajanapada)

A. Avanti

B. Koshala

C. Vatsa

D. Anga
List-II (Capital)

I. Ujjain

II. Shravasti

III. Kaushambi

IV. Champa
Choose the correct answer using the codes given below:

a. A-I, B-II, C-III, D-IV
b. A-II, B-I, C-IV, D-III
c. A-IV, B-III, C-II, D-I
d. A-III, B-IV, C-I, D-II

Answer: (a)
Avanti–Ujjain, Koshala–Shravasti, Vatsa–Kaushambi and Anga–Champa, so A-I, B-II, C-III, D-IV (APPSC G1 2024).

10. [PYQ] · State PSC added

In ancient times, the area to the south of the Ganga was known as

a. Anarta
b. Takshashila
c. Chola
d. More than one of the above
e. Magadha

Answer: (e)
The printed options did not include the correct answer (Magadha); it is added as option 5.
The area south of the Ganga (modern south Bihar) was known as Magadha (NCERT Class 6). None of the printed options fits: Anarta is north Gujarat (Dwarka region), Takshashila is in Gandhara and Chola in the far south, so the printed key 'Anarta' is wrong.

11. [New pattern · match]

Match the Mahajanapadas with their capitals:
List-I (Mahajanapada)
a. Kashi
b. Panchala
c. Kamboja
d. Matsya
List-II (Capital)
i. Ahichchhatra and Kampilya
ii. Viratnagar (Bairat)
iii. Rajapura
iv. Varanasi
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-iv, b-i, c-iii, d-ii
c. a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii
d. a-iii, b-i, c-ii, d-iv

Answer: (b)
Kashi = Varanasi; Panchala = Ahichchhatra (north) and Kampilya (south); Kamboja = Rajapura; Matsya = Viratnagar (Bairat).

12. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Mahajanapadas:
1. Anga corresponds to the present Bhagalpur and Munger region.
2. Vatsa lay on the Yamuna with its capital at Kaushambi.
3. The southern capital of Avanti was Ujjayini.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (c)
Statement 3 is wrong: Avanti's northern capital was Ujjayini and its southern capital Mahishmati (Avanti lay on the Shipra/Narmada). Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

13. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Eight of the sixteen Mahajanapadas lay in present Uttar Pradesh.
2. Anga, Magadha and Vajji lay in present Bihar.
3. Kashi was ruled by the Pradyota dynasty until Magadha annexed it.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All three
d. None

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is wrong: Kashi was ruled by the Brahmadatta dynasty until Kosala annexed it; Magadha got it later as dowry and by war. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, so only two are correct.

14. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. Koshala had Saket and Shravasti as its capitals.
2. Malla had Kushinara and Pawa as its capitals.
Which of the above statements is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Koshala had Saket (Ayodhya) and Shravasti as capitals, and the Mallas ruled from Kushinara and Pawa.

15. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
I. Magadha was associated with Patna, Nalanda and Gaya.
II. Vajji was associated with Vaishali, Muzaffarpur and Darbhanga.
III. Chedi was associated with Eastern Bundelkhand.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. I, II and III
b. I and III only
c. I and II only
d. II and III only

Answer: (a)
I, II and III are correct: Magadha covered Patna, Nalanda and Gaya; Vajji covered Vaishali, Muzaffarpur and Darbhanga; Chedi lay in eastern Bundelkhand.

16. [Kept own]

Which of the following pairs is INCORRECTLY matched?

a. Avanti – Ujjain
b. Kosala – Shravasti
c. Vatsa – Kaushambi
d. Anga – Mahishmati

Answer: (d)
Anga's capital was Champa; Mahishmati was the southern capital of Avanti.

17. [Kept own]

Match the following:
List-I (Mahajanapada)
A. Gandhara
B. Shurasena
C. Chedi
D. Vajji
List-II (Capital)
1. Vaishali
2. Suktimati
3. Mathura
4. Taxila
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1
b. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
c. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1
d. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

Answer: (a)
Gandhara had its capital at Taxila, Shurasena at Mathura, Chedi at Suktimati (Sotthivati) and Vajji at Vaishali.

18. [Kept own]
Which was the capital of the Kuru Mahajanapada?

a. Kaushambi
b. Mathura
c. Champa
d. Indraprastha

Answer: (d)
The Kuru Mahajanapada (Meerut, Delhi, Thaneshwar) had its capital at Indraprastha, also Hastinapura.

2. Gana-sanghas – Vajji, Malla, Shakya (PYQs 7 · MCQs 11)

Aspect	Gana-sangha	Monarchy
Rule	Many rajas in an assembly of clan heads	Single hereditary king
Hall	Santhagara	Royal court
Location	NW and Himalayan foothills	Ganga plain
Examples	Vajji, Malla	Kosala, Magadha, Vatsa

- **Vajji confederacy:** 8 clans – **Lichchhavis** (most powerful), Videhas, Jnatrikas, Vajjis; capital **Vaishali** = seat of the **world's first republic**; led by **Chetaka**, maternal uncle of **Mahavira**.
- **Malla:** confederacy of 9 clans; capitals **Kushinara** (Buddha's **Mahaparinirvana**) and **Pava** (Mahavira died). A-R (UPPSC 2004): Kushinagar = Malla capital and parinirvana site, both true, R not the explanation.
- **Buddha-period republics:** Shakya (Kapilavastu), Bhagga (Sumsumaragiri), Buli (Alakappa), Kalama (Kesaputta), Koliya (Ramagama), Malla, Lichchhavi. **Yaudheya** is NOT one – it is a post-Mauryan republic of Punjab–Haryana.
- **Kamboja:** a monarchy in the 6th century BCE but a **sangha** in the Arthashastra.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.19-23; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 4 (Yaudheyas); old app notes row 23

19. [PYQ] · AP Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-I Panchayat Secretary /
Which of the following Mahajanpads followed the 'Republican' model of polity in the era of Mahajanpads ?

A. Mallas
B. Vajjis
C. Vatsa
Choose the correct answer from the codes given below.

a. A only
b. B only
c. A and B
d. A, B and C

Answer: (c)
The Mallas and the Vajjis were gana-sanghas (republics/oligarchies); Vatsa under Udayana was a monarchy.

20. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011
Gautama Buddha attained “Mahaparinirvana” in kingdom of –

a. Aung
b. Magadha
c. Malla
d. Vatsa

Answer: (c)
The Buddha attained Mahaparinirvana at Kushinagar (Kusinara), a capital of the Malla gana-sangha.

21. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992
Which one was not in the earlier Republic?

a. Shakya
b. Lichchhavi
c. Yaudheya
d. All of the above

Answer: (c)
Shakyas (Kapilavastu) and Lichchhavis (Vaishali) were Buddha-period republics; the Yaudheyas were a post-Mauryan tribal republic of Punjab-Haryana, so Yaudheya was not in the earlier republics.

22. [PYQ] · BPSC 2004

Where was the seat of the first Republic of the world in 6th century BC?

a. Vaishali
b. Athens
c. Sparta
d. Patliputra

Answer: (a)

Vaishali, capital of the Vajji confederacy led by the Lichchhavis, is called the seat of the world's first republic (6th century BC). Athens and Sparta are Greek; Pataliputra was a Magadhan monarchy.

23. [PYQ] · State PSC

By whom the first republic of the world was established in Vaishali –

a. Maurya
b. Nanda
c. Gupta
d. Lichchhavi

Answer: (d)

The Lichchhavis, the most powerful clan of the Vajji confederacy, ran the republic at Vaishali; Mauryas, Nandas and Guptas were monarchies.

24. [PYQ] · State PSC

Where was the first republican system of the world during 6th century B.C. located?

a. Vaishali
b. Athens
c. Sparta
d. Pataliputra

Answer: (a)

Vaishali, capital of the Vajji confederacy led by the Lichchhavis, is called the seat of the world's first republic (6th century BC). Athens and Sparta are Greek; Pataliputra was a Magadhan monarchy.

25. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Assertion (A) : Kushinagar was the capital of Malla Republic.
Reason (R) : Lord Buddha's Mahaparinirvana took place in Kushinagar.
Select the correct answer using the code given below :

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct ex-
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (b)

Kushinagar was a capital of the Malla republic (A true) and the Buddha's Mahaparinirvana took place there (R true), but the Buddha's death does not explain why it was the Malla capital – so (b).

26. [New pattern · match]

Match the Buddha-period republics with their centres:
List-I (Republic)
a. Shakya
b. Bhagga
c. Koliya
d. Kalama
List-II (Centre)
i. Kapilavastu
ii. Kesaputta
iii. Sumsumaragiri
iv. Ramagama
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
b. a-ii, b-iii, c-iv, d-i
c. a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii

Answer: (d)

Shakya = Kapilavastu; Bhagga = Sumsumaragiri; Koliya = Ramagama; Kalama = Kesaputta (Buli = Alakappa).

27. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the gana-sanghas:
1. A gana-sangha was ruled by many rajas in an assembly of clan heads.
2. The assembly hall of a gana-sangha was called the Santhagara.
3. Kamboja was a gana-sangha in the 6th century BCE but a monarchy in the Arthashastra.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 3 is reversed: Kamboja was a monarchy in the 6th century BCE but a sangha in the Arthashastra. Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

28. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Vajji confederacy:
1. It was a confederacy of eight clans, of which the Lichchhavis were the most powerful.
2. Its leader Chetaka was the maternal uncle of the Buddha.
3. The Shakyas were one of its clans.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (a)
Only statement 1 is correct. Statement 2 is wrong: Chetaka was the maternal uncle of Mahavira. Statement 3 is wrong: the Vajji clans were the Lichchhavis, Videhas, Jnatrikas and Vajjis; the Shakyas were a separate republic at Kapilavastu.

29. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Pava is an important place in Jain history.
Reason (R): Mahavira died at Pava, one of the capitals of the Mallas.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: Pava, a Malla capital, was where Mahavira died (Kushinara, the other capital, was the Buddha's parinirvana site).

3. Sources Listing the Mahajanapadas (PYQs 5 · MCQs 8)

Text	Tradition	List
Anguttara Nikaya (Sutta Pitaka)	Buddhist	16 Mahajanapadas
Bhagavati Sutra	Jain	Also 16, some different names; adds Vanga, Malava, Ladha
Digha Nikaya	Buddhist	Only 12 (omits Ashmaka, Avanti, Gandhara, Kamboja)
Ashtadhyayi (Panini)	Grammar	22 janapadas; names Magadha, Ashmaka, Kamboja

- 16 listed in **Anguttara Nikaya + Bhagavati Sutra** (RAS 2016) – not the Arthashastra or Digha Nikaya.
- **Panini:** born at **Pushkalavati** (Gandhara); Ashtadhyayi = ~4,000 sutras in **8 chapters**.
- Anguttara order: Anga, Magadha, Kashi, Kosala, Vajji, Malla, Chedi, Vatsa, Kuru, Panchala, Matsya, Shurasena, Ashmaka, Avanti, Gandhara, Kamboja.

~~ Sources: Rocket Indian History Part 2 p.110; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.20-21; old app notes row 23

30. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S. (Re. Exam) (Pre) 2013

Janpadas of the age of Mahajanapada have often been mentioned in the Buddhist literature which of the following Janapadas have been mentioned by Panini in his Ashtadhyayi?
A. Magadh
B. Ashmak
C. Kamboj
D. Chedi
E. Vatsa
Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

a. A, B and C
b. D and E
c. C, D and E
d. A, C, D and E

Answer: (a)
Panini's Ashtadhyayi mentions 22 janapadas and specifically names Magadha, Ashmaka and Kamboja among the important ones, so the answer is Magadha, Ashmaka and Kamboja (RAS key).

31. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Pre) 2004

Which Buddha text has described 16 Mahajanpads of 6th century B.C.?

a. Digha Nikaya
b. Tripitaka
c. Deepavansh
d. Anguattar Nikaya

Answer: (d)
The Anguttara Nikaya (Sutta Pitaka) gives the list of 16 Mahajanapadas. The Digha Nikaya names only 12, the Tripitaka is the whole canon and the Dipavamsa is a Sri Lankan chronicle.

32. [PYQ] · R.A.S. /R.T.S. (Pre) 2016

In which of the following texts the list of the sixteen great states (Shodasha Mahajanapadas) of ancient India occur? Select the correct answer from the code given below: (i) Arthashastra (ii) Anguttara Nikaya (iii) Digha Nikaya (iv) Bhagavati Sutra

a. (ii) and (iv)
b. (ii), (iii) and (iv)
c. (i) and (ii)
d. (i), (ii)and (iii)

Answer: (a)
The 16 Mahajanapadas are listed in the Buddhist Anguttara Nikaya and the Jain Bhagavati Sutra (with different names). The Digha Nikaya mentions only 12 and the Arthashastra gives no such list.

33. [PYQ] · RAS/RTS 2013

16 Janapadas of the age of Mahajanapada have often been mentioned in the Buddhist literature.
Which of the following Janapadas have been mentioned by Panini in his Ashtadhyayi?

I. Magadh
II. Asmaka

III. Kamboj
IV. Chedi

V. Vatsa
Codes

a. I, II and III
b. IV and V
c. III, IV and V
d. I, III, IV and V

Answer: (a)
Panini's Ashtadhyayi mentions 22 janapadas and specifically names Magadha, Ashmaka and Kamboja among the important ones, so the answer is Magadha, Ashmaka and Kamboja (RAS key).

34. [PYQ] · State PSC

The list of sixteen Mahajanapadas is available in –

a. Mahabharata
b. Anguttar Nikaya
c. Chandogya Upanishad
d. Samyukta Nikaya

Answer: (b)
The Anguttara Nikaya gives the list of the sixteen Mahajanapadas.

35. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the sources that list the Mahajanapadas:
1. The Anguttara Nikaya, which lists sixteen Mahajanapadas, belongs to the Sutta Pitaka.
2. The Bhagavati Sutra is a Buddhist text.
3. The Digha Nikaya lists only twelve Mahajanapadas.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (c)
Statement 2 is wrong: the Bhagavati Sutra is a Jain text (it also lists 16, adding Vanga, Malava and Ladha). Statements 1 and 3 are correct (the Digha Nikaya omits Ashmaka, Avanti, Gandhara and Kamboja).

36. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Panini:
1. He was born at Pushkalavati in Gandhara.
2. His Ashtadhyayi is divided into eight chapters.
3. The Ashtadhyayi mentions sixteen janapadas.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All three
d. None

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is wrong: the Ashtadhyayi names 22 janapadas (including Magadha, Ashmaka and Kamboja). Statements 1 and 2 are correct, so only two are correct.

37. [Kept own]

Which names does the Bhagavati Sutra add to the list of Mahajanapadas?

a. Kuru, Panchala and Matsya
b. Vajji, Malla and Gandhara
c. Vanga, Malava and Ladha
d. Magadha, Kosala and Vatsa

Answer: (c)
The Jain Bhagavati Sutra gives a different list and includes eastern and southern names such as Vanga, Malava and Ladha or Radha.

4. Kingdoms and Rulers of the Buddha's Time (PYQs 5 · MCQs 10)

Ruler	Kingdom
Bimbisara, Ajatashatru	Magadha
Prasenajit (Pasenadi)	Kosala
Udayana	Vatsa
Chanda Pradyota	Avanti (a monarchy)
Pukkusati	Gandhara

- **Four great powers: Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa, Avanti**; Gandhara was not one. After Magadha, **Kosala** (which absorbed Kashi and the Shakyas) was the strongest – "only Koshala and Magadha emerged as powerful".
- **Kosala** annexed **Kashi**; Magadha later got it as dowry and by war. **Pradyota** rivalled **Bimbisara and Udayana**.
- **Udayana:** married **Vasavadatta**, daughter of Pradyota (**Bhasa's Svapnavasavadatta**); the Buddha visited **Kaushambi** in his reign; turned Buddhist under **Pindola Bharadvaja**; donated the **Ghoshitarama** vihara.
- **Legend links: Dasharatha** ruled **Kosala** (Ayodhya); in the Puranas **King Anga** was the father of **Vena** (father of Prithu).

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.21-27; Vishnu Purana (Anga–Vena); old app notes row 23

38. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Who was the father of Vena Maharaja?

a. Anga
b. Anshuman
c. Sagara
d. Kapila

Answer: (a)
In the Puranas King Vena (father of Prithu) was the son of King Anga of the line of Dhruva and Sunitha; Sagara and Anshuman belong to the solar line, Kapila is a sage.

39. [PYQ] · SI Mains Paper-IV 2019 added

Among the Sixteen Janapadas, the greatest power was exercised by the following

a. Kambhoja
b. Avanti
c. Kosala
d. Vatsa
e. Magadha

Answer: (e)

The printed options did not include the correct answer (Magadha); it is added as option 5.
Magadha became the most powerful of the sixteen Mahajanapadas, absorbing Kosala, Avanti, Vatsa and the rest under the Haryankas, Shishunagas and Nandas. Of the printed options, Kosala and Avanti were Magadha's main rivals but lost out to it; Kambhoja and Vatsa were minor.

40. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Which one of the following is the kingdom of king Dasaratha?

a. Kosala
b. Magadha
c. Kaambhoja
d. Matsya

Answer: (a)

King Dasharatha of the Ramayana ruled Kosala from Ayodhya, a city of the Kosala Mahajanapada.

41. [PYQ] · U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Buddha had visited Kaushambi during the reign of

a. Satanika
b. Udayana
c. Bodhi
d. Nicakshu

Answer: (b)

The Buddha visited Kaushambi during the reign of Udayana of Vatsa, who became Buddhist under Pindola Bharadvaja (Ghoshitarama vihara).

42. [PYQ] · M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Chand-pradyota was the ruler of which ancient republic?

a. Kasi
b. Anga
c. Avanti
d. Vajji

Answer: (c)

Chanda Pradyota ruled Avanti (a monarchy, though the stem says 'republic'); he fought Vatsa, Magadha and Kosala.

43. [New pattern · match]

Match the rulers of the Buddha's time with their kingdoms:
List-I (Ruler)
a. Prasenajit (Pasenadi)
b. Udayana
c. Chanda Pradyota
d. Pukkusati
List-II (Kingdom)
i. Avanti
ii. Gandhara
iii. Kosala
iv. Vatsa
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-iii, b-ii, c-i, d-iv
b. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
c. a-iv, b-i, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii

Answer: (d)

Prasenajit = Kosala; Udayana = Vatsa; Chanda Pradyota = Avanti; Pukkusati = Gandhara (Bimbisara and Ajatashatru = Magadha).

44. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Udayana of Vatsa:
1. He married Vasavadatta, the daughter of Prasenajit.
2. He turned Buddhist under the influence of Pindola Bharadvaja.
3. He donated the Ghoshitarama vihara.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 1 is wrong: Vasavadatta was the daughter of Chanda Pradyota of Avanti (Bhasa's Svapnavasavadatta). Statements 2 and 3 are correct.

45. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): After Magadha, Kosala was the strongest of the Mahajanapadas.
Reason (R): Kosala had absorbed Kashi and the Shakyas.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: by absorbing Kashi and the Shakyas, Kosala became the strongest power after Magadha.

46. [Kept own]

Chanda Pradyota of Avanti was a rival of whom?

a. Bimbisara and Udayana
b. Ambhi and Porus
c. Prasenajit and Chetaka
d. Mahapadma Nanda and Kalashoka

Answer: (a)
Chanda Pradyota of Avanti rivalled Bimbisara of Magadha and Udayana of Vatsa.

47. [Kept own]

Which of the following was NOT one of the four dominant powers of the Mahajanapada period?

a. Magadha
b. Kosala
c. Vatsa
d. Gandhara

Answer: (d)
The four dominant powers were Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa and Avanti.

5. Rivers and the South – Assaka on the Godavari (PYQs 4 · MCQs 5)

- **Assaka (Ashmaka):** the **only Mahajanapada south of the Vindhyas**, on the **Godavari** (between the Godavari and Manjira); on the **Dakshinapatha**.
- Capital **Potana / Potali = Bodhan, Nizamabad (Telangana)**; some place it at **Paithan (ancient Pratishthana)**.
- **Suttanipata:** sage **Bavari's** ashram on the Godavari in Assaka – earliest Andhra-region link in Buddhist texts.

Region	River (UPSC 2025)
Asmaka	Godavari ✔
Kamboja	Kubha (Kabul), not Vipas ✘
Avanti	Shipra / Narmada, not Mahanadi ✘
Kosala	Sarayu ✔ (Ayodhya stands on it)

> UPSC 2025: only **two** pairs correct.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.23-28; Rocket Indian History Part 2 p.110; old app notes row 23

48. [PYQ] · APPSC Endowment (Prelims) General Studies 2022

Which river is located beside Ayodhya?

a. Sarayu
b. Papanashini
c. Ganga
d. Gomati

Answer: (a)

Ayodhya (Saketa), in the Kosala Mahajanapada, stands on the Sarayu river.

49. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2025

With reference to ancient India (600–322 BC), consider the following pairs: Territorial region River flowing in the region
1. Asmaka Godavari
2. Kamboja Vipas
3. Avanti Mahanadi
4. Kosala Sarayu
How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All the four

Answer: (b)

Asmaka – Godavari is correct and Kosala – Sarayu is correct. Kamboja lay on the Kubha (Kabul), not the Vipas (Beas), and Avanti on the Shipra/Narmada, not the Mahanadi – so only two pairs (UPSC 2025).

50. [PYQ] · R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2008

Mahajanapada situated on the bank of river Godavari was-

a. Avanti
b. Vatsa
c. Assaka
d. Kamboja

Answer: (c)

Assaka (Ashmaka) lay on the Godavari (between the Godavari and Manjira), with its capital Potana/Bodhan – the only Mahajanapada south of the Vindhyas.

51. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2025

With reference to ancient India (600-322 BC), consider the following pairs : Territorial region River flowing in the region
I. Asmaka : Godavari
II. Kamboja : Vipas
III. Avanti : Mahanadi
IV. Kosala : Sarayu
How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All the four

Answer: (b)

Asmaka – Godavari is correct and Kosala – Sarayu is correct. Kamboja lay on the Kubha (Kabul), not the Vipas (Beas), and Avanti on the Shipra/Narmada, not the Mahanadi – so only two pairs (UPSC 2025).

52. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Assaka (Ashmaka):
1. It was the only Mahajanapada south of the Vindhyas, on the Godavari.
2. Its capital Potana is identified with Bodhan in Karimnagar district.
3. Paithan, where some place the Assakas, was anciently called Pratishthana.
4. The Suttanipata places sage Bavari's ashram on the Godavari in Assaka.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)

Statement 2 is wrong: Bodhan (Potana/Potali) is in Nizamabad district, Telangana. Statements 1, 3 and 4 are correct, so three are correct.

Row 24: Second Urbanisation – Nbpw, Punch-marked Coins, Guilds and Towns

1. Guilds (Shreni), Merchants and Trade Terms (PYQs 2 · MCQs 6)

- **Shrenis:** associations of artisans, merchants, moneylenders under elected or hereditary heads (**jetthaka / pamukha**). Craft shrenis trained workers, procured raw materials, sold products; merchant shrenis organised trade.
- **Powers (UPSC 2012 → II and III):** fixed **wages, rules of work, standards and prices**; had **their own laws (shreni-dharma)** and **judicial powers** over members. They were **autonomous – the king did not interfere**, so "every guild registered with the central authority, king the chief administrator" is **wrong**.
- **Guilds as banks:** deposits invested at interest – **Nashik inscription** records guild deposits at fixed interest.
- **Satapatha Brahmana:** first reference to **money-lending**; usurer = **kusidin**.

Term	Meaning
Sarthavaha (satthavaha)	Caravan / convoy of merchants, or its leader
Setthi / Shreshthi	Rich merchant-banker
Gahapati	Wealthy householder / landowner
Vanija	Trader
Kusidin	Usurer

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.15-17; NextGen Indian History Part 3 (guilds' own laws); old app notes row 24

1. [PYQ] · IAS (Pre) 2012

With reference to the guilds (Shreni) of ancient India that played a very important role in the country's economy which of the following statement is/are correct?

I. Every guild was registered with the central authority of the state, and the King was the chief administrative authority on them.

II. The wages, rules of work, standard and prices were fixed by guild.

III. The guild had judicial powers over its members.
Select the correct answer using the code given below

a. I and II only
b. Only III
c. II and III only
d. I, II and III

Answer: (c)
Guilds fixed wages, work rules, standards and prices (II) and had their own laws and judicial authority over members (III); they were autonomous and the king did not interfere, so I is wrong (UPSC 2012).

2. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

What was "Sarthwah"?

a. Brokers
b. Convoy of Merchants
c. Moneylender
d. Pilgrims

Answer: (b)
Sarthavaha (satthavaha) was a caravan/convoy of merchants or its leader, a rich long-distance trader; not a broker, moneylender or pilgrim.

3. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about guilds (shrenis) and money-lending:
1. The head of a guild was called the jetthaka or pamukha.
2. The guilds were autonomous and the king did not interfere in them.
3. The Satapatha Brahmana uses the term setthi for a usurer.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is wrong: the Satapatha Brahmana, which first refers to money-lending, calls the usurer kusidin; a setthi was a rich merchant-banker. Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

4. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Guilds in early India also acted as banks.
Reason (R): Deposits were made with guilds and invested at interest, as the Nashik inscription records.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: the Nashik inscription records guild deposits at fixed interest, which is the banking role of guilds.

5. [New pattern · match]

Match the early trade terms with their meanings:
List-I (Term)
a. Setthi
b. Gahapati
c. Vanija
d. Kusidin
List-II (Meaning)
i. Trader
ii. Rich merchant-banker
iii. Wealthy householder / landowner
iv. Usurer
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i
b. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii
c. a-ii, b-iii, c-i, d-iv
d. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv

Answer: (c)
Setthi/Shreshthi = rich merchant-banker; Gahapati = wealthy householder; Vanija = trader; Kusidin = usurer (Sarthavaha = caravan of merchants or its leader).

6. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about guilds (shreni):
1. They fixed prices and wages.
2. They had their own rules called shreni-dharma.
3. Their head was always appointed by the king.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Guilds fixed prices and wages and followed their own shreni-dharma; their head held office by heredity or was chosen by the members, not appointed by the king.

2. Punch-marked Coins and Early Money (PYQs 1 · MCQs 6)

- **Punch-marked (Aahat) coins: earliest extant coins** of India (7th–6th c. BC to the Mauryan period); **mostly silver**, some copper; symbols only (**sun, animals, trees, hills**), no writing.
- Called **panas / karshapanas**; issued under Haryankas, Nandas and Mauryas; first definite literary references in **Pali texts**.

Term	Meaning
Nishka	Gold / a gold ornament in Vedic texts (nishka-griva = gold necklace); a prestige object, later a unit – not cows or copper/silver coins
Karshapana / kahapana	Standard silver or copper punch-marked coin
Satamana	Value or weight unit of 100 mana
Suvarna	Gold coin (Satavahana usage)

- **Satavahanas** first used inherited punch-marked coins, then die-struck coins of **lead**, potin, copper, silver; **ship-mast** coins of **Yajnasri Satakarni**.
- **Gold coins in large numbers: Kushanas** (not Mauryas).
- **Vaishya Tekri** (near Ujjain): Mauryan-era (BCE) stupa bigger than Sanchi; punch-marked and cast Avanti coins; MP to re-excavate it (2026).

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 1 p.33; PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.17; Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.55; Rocket Indian History Part 2 (Sheet #90); old app notes row 24

7. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

'Nishka' in ancient India was known as –

a. Gold Ornament
b. Cows
c. Copper Coins
d. Silver Coins

Answer: (a)

In Vedic texts nishka meant gold or a gold ornament (nishka-griva = gold necklace), a prestige object rather than a coin; later it also denoted a gold unit, but never cows or copper/silver coins.

8. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about punch-marked coins:
1. They are the earliest extant coins of India.
2. They were mostly made of gold.
3. They bore symbols such as the sun, animals, trees and hills, but no writing.
4. The first definite literary references to coins are found in Pali texts.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)

Statement 2 is wrong: punch-marked coins (panas/karshapanas) were mostly silver, some copper. Statements 1, 3 and 4 are correct, so three are correct.

9. [New pattern · match]

Match the ancient terms with their meanings:
List-I (Term)
a. Nishka
b. Karshapana
c. Satamana
d. Suvarna
List-II (Meaning)
i. Standard silver or copper punch-marked coin
ii. Gold coin (Satavahana usage)
iii. Gold / a gold ornament in Vedic texts
iv. Value or weight unit of 100 mana
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
b. a-iv, b-ii, c-iii, d-i
c. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
d. a-iii, b-i, c-iv, d-ii

Answer: (d)

Nishka = gold/gold ornament (nishka-griva = gold necklace); Karshapana = standard silver or copper punch-marked coin; Satamana = unit of 100 mana; Suvarna = gold coin.

10. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about early coinage:
1. The Satavahanas issued die-struck coins of lead, among other metals.
2. The ship-mast coins were issued by Gautamiputra Satakarni.
3. The Mauryas were the first to issue gold coins in large numbers.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (a)

Only statement 1 is correct. Statement 2 is wrong: ship-mast coins belong to Yajnasri Satakarni. Statement 3 is wrong: gold coins in large numbers were first issued by the Kushanas, not the Mauryas.

11. [Kept own]

With which of the following is Vaishya Tekri, where excavation is proposed to resume, associated?

a. a Satavahana stupa at Amaravati
b. a Gupta temple at Sarnath
c. a Kushana monastery at Taxila
d. a Mauryan stupa at Ujjain

Answer: (d)

Vaishya Tekri near Ujjain (Avanti's capital on the Sipra) is a BCE stupa bigger than Sanchi; it yielded punch-marked and cast Avanti coins, and its excavation is to resume after about 90 years.

12. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Satavahana coinage:
1. The Satavahanas first used inherited punch-marked coins.
2. Ship-mast coins were issued by Yajnasri Satakarni.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Both are correct: the Satavahanas first used inherited punch-marked coins, and Yajnasri Satakarni issued ship-mast coins.

3. Towns and Trade Routes (PYQs 1 · MCQs 6)

Town	Region	Feature
Rajagriha	Magadha	Ringed by five hills
Shravasti	Kosala	Crescent-shaped plan
Kaushambi	Vatsa	On the Yamuna; fortified
Ujjayini	Avanti	On the Sipra; Ptolemy's "Ozene"
Taxila	Gandhara	Learning centre; Uttarapatha junction
Vaishali	Vajji	Republican capital
Champa	Anga	Near Bhagalpur, on the Ganga

- **Uttarapatha:** linked **Taxila** (north-west) with the Ganga valley up to Tamralipti.
- **Dakshinapatha:** southern route to the Deccan (Kaushambi–Ujjayini–Pratishthana), through **Assaka**.
- AP angle: Satavahana trade centres **Kotilingala, Dhulikatta, Kondapur**.

  ~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.17; old app notes row 24

- **Pali terms for settlements: nigama** = (market) town, **nagara** = large city; the Vedic **pur** = fortified settlement.

13. [PYQ] · Degree Lecturers 2011

In Pali texts, the city is known as:

a. Nigam
b. Pur
c. Nagar
d. None of the above

Answer: (a)
Pali texts use 'nigama' for a town (market town) beside 'nagara' for a large city; the printed key takes Nigam. 'Pur' is the Vedic term for a fortified settlement.

14. [New pattern · match]

Match the towns with their features:
List-I (Town)
a. Rajagriha
b. Ujjayini
c. Champa
d. Kaushambi
List-II (Feature)
i. Near Bhagalpur, on the Ganga
ii. Ringed by five hills
iii. On the Yamuna; fortified
iv. On the Sipra; Ptolemy's 'Ozene'
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-iv, b-iii, c-ii, d-i
c. a-iv, b-ii, c-i, d-iii
d. a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii

Answer: (d)
Rajagriha (Magadha) = five hills; Ujjayini (Avanti) = on the Sipra, Ptolemy's Ozene; Champa (Anga) = near Bhagalpur on the Ganga; Kaushambi (Vatsa) = fortified town on the Yamuna.

15. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about trade routes and centres:
1. The Uttarapatha linked Taxila with the Ganga valley up to Tamralipti.
2. The Dakshinapatha passed through Gandhara.
3. Kotilingala, Dhulikatta and Kondapur were Satavahana trade centres.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 2 is wrong: the Dakshinapatha, the southern route (Kaushambi–Ujjayini–Pratishthana), passed through Assaka. Statements 1 and 3 are correct.

16. [Kept own]

Which of the following pairs is INCORRECTLY matched?

a. Kaushambi – Fortified town on the Yamuna
b. Rajagriha – Fortified by five hills
c. Kaushambi – Vatsa
d. Taxila – Junction of the Dakshinapatha

Answer: (d)
Taxila, the Gandhara learning centre, stood at the junction of the Uttarapatha, not the Dakshinapatha, which was the southern route to the Deccan.

17. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements about Shravasti:
1. It belonged to Kosala.
2. It is described as having a crescent-shaped plan.
3. It was the capital of the Vajji confederacy.
Which of the above statements are correct?

a. 1 and 3 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (c)
Shravasti belonged to Kosala and had a crescent-shaped plan; Vaishali, not Shravasti, was the Vajji capital.

18. [Kept own]

Which town was the republican capital of the Vajji confederacy?

a. Champa
b. Shravasti
c. Kaushambi
d. Vaishali

Answer: (d)
Vaishali was the republican capital of the Vajjis; Shravasti was in Kosala, Champa in Anga, Kaushambi in Vatsa.

4. Northern Black Polished Ware and the Second Urbanisation (PYQs 0 · MCQs 7)

- **NBPW:** fine, glossy black, mirror-like **deluxe tableware of the rich**; **c. 700–200 BCE**; **after Painted Grey Ware**; the hallmark of the second urbanisation.
- **NBPW sites:** mainly the Ganga valley – Hastinapur, Kaushambi, Shravasti, Ayodhya, Varanasi, Rajgir, Pataliputra, Vaishali, Champa; also Ujjain, Vidisha, Taxila (not Lothal).

Cause	Effect
Iron tools	Forest clearance in the Ganga plain; surplus
Trade, crafts, coinage	Taxes and wages in money
State formation	Mahajanapada capitals became administrative centres
New merchant classes	Vaishyas backed Buddhism and Jainism

- **Over 60 towns** in 600–300 BCE; the Mahajanapadas and Magadha = the **second urbanisation**.
- **Rajghat (Varanasi):** pre-NBPW levels, punch-marked coins, **Greek-inscribed seals**; BHU re-study (Sep 2026) puts urban Varanasi at **c. 800 BCE**.

Development	Period
Iron at Mayiladumparai (AMS dating)	c. 2172 BCE; southern Iron Age c. 2100 BCE – older than the Gangetic Iron Age

Iron ploughshares, axes in the Ganga valley	Later Vedic, c. 1000–600 BCE
Urban Varanasi	c. 800 BCE
NBPW	c. 700–200 BCE
Punch-marked coins begin	7th–6th c. BCE
Gold coins in large numbers	Kushanas, 1st–2nd c. CE

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.16; NextGen Indian History - APPSC Exams Part 1 (NBP Ware); old app notes row 24

19. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW):
1. It is dated to c. 700–200 BCE.
2. It came after the Painted Grey Ware.
3. Lothal is one of its sites.
Which of the statements given above is/are NOT correct?

a. 1 only
b. 3 only
c. 1 and 2 only
d. 1 and 3 only

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is NOT correct: NBPW sites are mainly in the Ganga valley (Hastinapur, Kaushambi, Rajgir, Pataliputra etc.), plus Ujjain, Vidisha and Taxila, not Lothal. Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

20. [New pattern · match]

Match the causes of the second urbanisation with their effects:
List-I (Cause)
a. Iron tools
b. Trade, crafts, coinage
c. State formation
d. New merchant classes
List-II (Effect)
i. Taxes and wages in money
ii. Vaishyas backed Buddhism and Jainism
iii. Mahajanapada capitals became administrative centres
iv. Forest clearance in the Ganga plain; surplus
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
b. a-i, b-iii, c-ii, d-iv
c. a-iv, b-i, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-iv, b-iii, c-ii, d-i

Answer: (c)
Iron tools = forest clearance and surplus; trade, crafts and coinage = taxes and wages in money; state formation = capitals as administrative centres; new merchant classes = Vaishya support for Buddhism and Jainism.

21. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Iron tools contributed to the second urbanisation in the Ganga plain.
Reason (R): Over 60 towns flourished in the Ganga region in 600–300 BCE.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (b)
Both are true but R does not explain A: A is explained by iron tools making forest clearance and a surplus possible; the number of towns (over 60 in 600–300 BCE) is a feature of the second urbanisation, not its cause.

22. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Over 60 towns flourished in the Ganga region in 600–300 BCE.
2. Rajghat (Varanasi) has yielded punch-marked coins and Greek-inscribed seals.
3. The BHU re-study of Rajghat places urban Varanasi at c. 1200 BCE.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All three
d. None

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is wrong: the re-study (Sep 2026) puts urban Varanasi at c. 800 BCE. Statements 1 and 2 are correct, so only two are correct.

23. [Kept own]

Which of the following is NOT correct about the iron evidence from Mayiladumparai?

a. It was dated by AMS dating
b. It is dated to about 2172 BCE
c. It places the southern Iron Age at about 2100 BCE
d. It shows the southern Iron Age began after the Gangetic Iron Age

Answer: (d)

AMS dating places Mayiladumparai iron at about 2172 BCE, so the southern Iron Age (c. 2100 BCE) is earlier, not later, than the Gangetic Iron Age.

24. [Kept own]

Iron ploughshares and axes came into use in the Ganga valley during which period?

a. Rigvedic period, c. 1500-1000 BCE
b. Later Vedic period, c. 1000-600 BCE
c. Mauryan period, c. 322-185 BCE
d. Kushana period, 1st-2nd century CE

Answer: (b)

Iron ploughshares and axes in the Ganga valley belong to the Later Vedic period, c. 1000-600 BCE, which helped forest clearance and agriculture.

25. [Kept own]

Arrange in chronological order:
1. Iron at Mayiladumparai
2. Urban Varanasi
3. Gold coins in large numbers under the Kushanas
4. Beginning of punch-marked coins

a. 1, 2, 4, 3
b. 2, 1, 4, 3
c. 1, 4, 2, 3
d. 1, 2, 3, 4

Answer: (a)

Mayiladumparai iron is c. 2172 BCE, urban Varanasi c. 800 BCE, punch-marked coins 7th–6th c. BC and Kushana gold coins 1st–2nd c. CE.

Row 25: Rise of Magadha – Haryankas, Shishunagas, Nandas and Causes of Supremacy

1. Haryankas – Bimbisara, Ajatashatru, Udayin (PYQs 16 · MCQs 25)

Bimbisara (c. 545–493 BCE)

- **Founder of the Haryanka dynasty** (NextGen Rocket; APPSC; SSC CGL 2019) – PMF adds that many scholars give the founding to his grandfather, but exams key **Bimbisara**. Brihadratha belongs to the earlier legendary line.
- **Real founder of the Magadhan empire**; also called **Seniya / Shrenika** (WBCS 2017).
- **Contemporary of the Buddha** and of Mahavira (APPSC GS 2018; FRO 2020; Sachivalayam).

  - ⚠ **Disputed:** Ajatashatru was also a contemporary – the Buddha died in his reign – but keys give **Bimbisara** when both are offered.

- **Conquest:** defeated Brahmadatta of **Anga** and put **Kunika (Ajatashatru)** as viceroy at **Champa**.
- **Diplomacy:** friendship with **Pradyota of Avanti**; when Pradyota had jaundice, Bimbisara sent his royal physician **Jivaka** to Ujjain.
- **Jivaka:** physician of Bimbisara's court (UP UDA 2006; State PSC); son of the Rajgriha courtesan **Salavati** (MPPSC 2009) – not Amrapali (Vaishali).

Queen	Clan / kingdom	Note
Kosaladevi (Mahakosala)	Kosala, sister of Prasenajit	Brought Kashi as dowry
Chellana	Lichchhavi of Vaishali	Mother of Ajatashatru (not Udayin)
Khema	Madra (Punjab)	–

- **Death:** imprisoned and starved to death by his son **Ajatashatru**.

Ajatashatru (c. 493–462 BCE)

- **Parricide:** killed his father Bimbisara (UPPCS 2011) – Jain name **Kunika**, "Pitruhanta"; he was in turn **killed by his son Udayin** (UPPCS 2007; UPPSC 2007).
- **Patricide chain (Buddhist texts): Bimbisara → Ajatashatru → Udayin**.
- **Kosala:** war with **Prasenajit** over Kashi; Prasenajit gave his daughter **Vajira** with Kashi as dowry; later annexed Kosala.
- **Vajji:** annexed after a **16-year** war; minister **Vassakara** split the Lichchhavi chiefs.
- **War engines: mahashilakantaka** (stone-throwing catapult) and **rathamusala** (chariot fitted with a mace).
- **Buddhism:** met the Buddha (Bharhut relief); hosted the **First Buddhist Council** at Rajgriha.

Udayin (c. 462–444 BCE)

- **Shifted the capital to Pataliputra**; a devout Jain in Jain tradition. Not to be confused with **Udayana of Vatsa**.
- Probably killed at the urging of **Palaka of Avanti**; his weak successors ended with **Nagadasaka**.

Contemporaries

- **Milinda (Menander)**, the 2nd-century-BCE Indo-Greek, was **not** a contemporary of Bimbisara, the Buddha and **Prasenajit (Kosala)** (IAS 2005).

> Exam angle: "founder of Haryanka" → **Bimbisara**; "killed his father and was killed by his son" → **Ajatashatru**; "Jivaka" → **Bimbisara's court**.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.99-101; NextGen Rocket Indian History Part 1 p.29-30; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 2 p.40; britannica.com/biography/Bimbisara; app notes 1:25 (sub 3, 8)

1. [PYQ] · APPSC

Who was the founder of Haryanka dynasty?

a. Ajatashatru
b. Bimbisara
c. Udayin
d. Naga- Dasak

Answer: (b)

Bimbisara founded the Haryanka dynasty (NextGen Rocket); Ajatashatru and Udayin were his successors and Nagadasaka the last Haryanka. (PMF notes that some scholars give the founding to Bimbisara's grandfather, but exams key Bimbisara.)

2. [PYQ] · Forest Range Officers Mains 2020 disputed

Who was a contemporary of Gautama Buddha?

a. Bimbisara
b. Udayin
c. Mahapadma
d. Ajatashatru

Answer: (a)

Most books and keys: Bimbisara. Strictly, Ajatashatru (option d) was also a contemporary: he met the Buddha (Bharhut relief), and the Buddha died in his reign (PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.101).
Bimbisara is the standard answer: he ruled Magadha as a contemporary of the Buddha, and the Buddha visited his court. Udayin and Mahapadma came later.

3. [PYQ] · AP Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III Village Fisheries As disputed

Which Ruler of Magadha was a contemporary of Buddha ?

a. Chandragupta Maurya
b. Ajat Shatru
c. Bimbisara
d. Mahapadmanabha

Answer: (c)

Most books and keys: Bimbisara. Strictly, Ajatashatru (option b) was also a contemporary of the Buddha, who died in his reign (PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.101).
Bimbisara was the Magadhan king contemporary with the Buddha. Chandragupta Maurya and Mahapadma Nanda came much later.

4. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

The Prince who was responsible for the death of his father was-

a. Ajatashatru
b. Chandapradyota
c. Prasenjit
d. Udayan

Answer: (a)

Ajatashatru (Kunika, 'Pitruhanta' in Jain texts) imprisoned and starved his father Bimbisara to death. Chandapradyota (Avanti), Prasenjit (Kosala) and Udayana (Vatsa) were not parricides.

5. [PYQ] · U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Jivaka, the famous physician of the time of Mahatma Buddha, was associated with the court of –

a. Bimbisara
b. Chanda Pradyota
c. Prasenjit
d. Udyana

Answer: (a)

Jivaka was Bimbisara's royal physician; Bimbisara sent him to Ujjain to treat Pradyota of Avanti for jaundice, so Pradyota was his patient, not his patron.

6. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

Which initial ruler of Magadha killed his father for enthroning and also was killed by his son for the same reason?

a. Bimbisara
b. Ajatshatru
c. Udayin
d. Nagdashak

Answer: (b)

Ajatashatru killed his father Bimbisara to take the throne and was himself killed by his son Udayin (Buddhist tradition).

7. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which of the following great ruler founded the "Haryanka Vansh" in ancient Bihar?

a. Bimbisara
b. Brihadrath
c. Ajatshatru
d. More than one of the above

Answer: (a)

Bimbisara founded the Haryanka dynasty; Brihadratha founded the earlier legendary dynasty of Magadha (Jarasandha's line) and Ajatashatru was Bimbisara's son.

8. [PYQ] · WBCS 2017
Which Magadha ruler was known as ‘Seniya’?

a. Bimbisara
b. Ajatashatru
c. Mahapadma Nanda
d. Chandragupta Maurya

Answer: (a)
Bimbisara was called Seniya (Shrenika) in Buddhist and Jain texts, from his standing army (sena); Ajatashatru was Kunika.

9. [PYQ] · SSC ..... CGL 2019
First ruler of Magadha from the Haryanka Dynasty was

a. Ashoka
b. Prasenajit
c. Bimbisara
d. Ajatashatru

Answer: (c)
Bimbisara was the founder and first ruler of the Haryanka dynasty; Ajatashatru was his son and Prasenajit ruled Kosala.

10. [PYQ] · UPPSC 2007
Which early ruler of Magadha murdered his father to ascend the throne and , in turn, was murdered by his own son?

a. Bimbisara
b. Ajatashatru
c. Udayan
d. Nagadashak

Answer: (b)
Ajatashatru murdered his father Bimbisara and was in turn killed by his son Udayin; Udayan was the king of Vatsa.

11. [PYQ] · MPPSC 2009
Jivaka, the royal physician of Rajgriha, was the son of the Ganika named as

a. Salavati
b. Ramaniya
c. Basantsena
d. Amrapali

Answer: (a)
Buddhist tradition (Vinaya, Mahavagga) makes Jivaka the son of the Rajagriha courtesan Salavati; Amrapali was the courtesan of Vaishali.

12. [PYQ] · State PSC
Who was the Physician of Magadh ruler Bimbisara?

a. Shilabhadra
b. Vijayasena
c. Jeevaka
d. Manu

Answer: (c)
Jivaka (Jeevaka) was the royal physician of Bimbisara (67th BPSC key: Jeevaka). Shilabhadra was a Nalanda teacher.

13. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 2005
Who among the following was not a contemporary of the other three?

a. Bimbisara
b. Gautama Buddha
c. Milinda
d. Prasenjit

Answer: (c)
Milinda (Menander), the Indo-Greek king of the 2nd century BCE, lived centuries later; Bimbisara, the Buddha and Prasenjit of Kosala were contemporaries.

14. [PYQ] · APPSC Zilla Sainik Welfare Officer (Sainik Welfare Service)
Bimbisara belonged to the ____ dynasty.

a. Koshala
b. Madra
c. Haryanka
d. Pradyota

Answer: (c)
Bimbisara belonged to the Haryanka dynasty of Magadha; Pradyota was a dynasty of Avanti.

15. [PYQ] · State PSC

Who defeated and assimilated the Vajjis into the empire of Magadha?

a. Chandragupta Maurya
b. Asoka
c. Mahapadma Nanda
d. Ajatshatru

Answer: (d)
Ajatashatru defeated the Vajji confederacy after a 16-year war, using deceit, and annexed Vaishali to Magadha.

16. [PYQ] · State PSC

What was the name of the dynasty of Ajatshatru?

a. Maurya
b. Haryanka
c. Nanda
d. Gupta

Answer: (b)
Ajatashatru, son and successor of Bimbisara, belonged to the Haryanka dynasty.

17. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Bimbisara:
1. He is regarded as the real founder of the Magadhan empire.
2. He defeated Brahmadatta of Anga and placed Kunika as viceroy at Champa.
3. He sent his physician Jivaka to Ujjain to treat Prasenajit for jaundice.
4. His physician Jivaka was the son of the Vaishali courtesan Amrapali.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (b)
Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is wrong: Jivaka was sent to treat Pradyota of Avanti. Statement 4 is wrong: Jivaka was the son of the Rajgriha courtesan Salavati, not Amrapali. So only two are correct.

18. [New pattern · match]

Match the royal women with the facts about them:
List-I (Queen)
a. Kosaladevi
b. Chellana
c. Khema
d. Vajira
List-II (Fact)
i. Sister of Prasenajit; brought Kashi as dowry to Bimbisara
ii. Daughter of Prasenajit; married Ajatashatru
iii. Queen of Bimbisara from Madra (Punjab)
iv. Lichchhavi of Vaishali; mother of Ajatashatru
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-iii, c-iv, d-ii
c. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-ii, b-iv, c-iii, d-i

Answer: (c)
Kosaladevi = Kosala, sister of Prasenajit, Kashi as dowry; Chellana = Lichchhavi, mother of Ajatashatru (not Udayin); Khema = Madra; Vajira = Prasenajit's daughter given to Ajatashatru with Kashi as dowry.

19. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Ajatashatru:
1. He annexed the Vajji confederacy after a 16-year war.
2. His minister Vassakara split the Lichchhavi chiefs.
3. The mahashilakantaka was a chariot fitted with a mace.
4. Jain texts call him Kunika.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 1, 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 4 only

Answer: (d)
Statement 3 is wrong: the mahashilakantaka was a stone-throwing catapult; the chariot fitted with a mace was the rathamusala. Statements 1, 2 and 4 are correct.

20. [Kept own]
Which sequence represents the patricide tradition associated with the Haryanka succession?

a. Bimbisara → Ajatashatru → Udayin
b. Ajatashatru → Bimbisara → Udayin
c. Udayin → Bimbisara → Ajatashatru
d. Bimbisara → Udayin → Ajatashatru

Answer: (a)
Buddhist texts preserve a patricide chain involving Bimbisara, followed by Ajatashatru and then Udayin. Udayin was probably killed at the instigation of Palaka of Avanti.

21. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements:
I. Ajathasatru killed Bimbisara.
II. Ajathasatru defeated and annexed Vajji.
III. Ajathasatru patronised the First Buddhist Council.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

a. II and III only
b. I, II and III
c. I and III only
d. I and II only

Answer: (b)
I, II and III are correct: Ajatashatru killed Bimbisara, defeated and annexed the Vajji confederacy, and patronised the First Buddhist Council at Rajgriha.

22. [Kept own]
Bimbisara is associated with which one of the following combinations?

a. Conquest of Anga and contemporary of Buddha and Mahavira
b. Defeat of Vajji and founding of the Mauryan Empire
c. Conquest of Avanti and convening of the Second Buddhist Council
d. Conquest of Kalinga and resistance to Alexander

Answer: (a)
Bimbisara conquered Anga, entered into matrimonial alliances, and was a contemporary of both Buddha and Mahavira.

23. [Kept own]
Udayin of Magadha should not be confused with Udayan. Which kingdom did Udayan rule?

a. Avanti
b. Kosala
c. Anga
d. Vatsa

Answer: (d)
Udayan ruled Vatsa; Udayin was Ajatashatru's son who first chose Pataliputra as capital.

24. [Kept own]
What was the 'rathamusala' used by Ajatashatru in his wars?

a. A corps of war elephants
b. A chariot fitted with a mace or blades
c. A stone-throwing engine
d. A water-fort on the Ganga

Answer: (b)
Rathamusala was a chariot with a mace or blades; mahashilakantaka was the stone-throwing engine.

25. [Kept own]
Which of the following is NOT correct about the Magadhan rulers?

a. Udayin moved the capital to Pataliputra
b. Kalashoka held the Second Buddhist Council
c. Mahapadma Nanda was called Ekarat
d. Bimbisara belonged to the Shishunaga dynasty

Answer: (d)
Bimbisara belonged to the Haryanka dynasty, not the Shishunaga dynasty.

2. Capitals of Magadha – Rajgriha, Pataliputra, Vaishali (PYQs 15 · MCQs 20)

Capitals in order

Capital	Ruler	Fact

Girivraja / Rajgriha (modern Rajgir)	Brihadratha line (Jarasandha); Bimbisara, Ajatashatru	First capital; ringed by five hills, walled – impregnable
Pataliputra (fort)	Ajatashatru	Fortified the village Pataligrama and built the city as a base against the Vajjis
Pataliputra (capital)	Udayin	Shifted the capital from Rajgriha to Pataliputra
Vaishali	Shishunaga	Capital moved there temporarily
Pataliputra again	Kalashoka	Capital moved back; it stayed the capital of the Mauryas and Guptas

- **First / earliest / initial capital: Girivraja (Rajgriha, Rajgir)** – asked 6 times (State PSC ×3, BPSC 2004, NDA 2001). Not Pataliputra, Vaishali, Champa (capital of **Anga**) or Varanasi.
- ⚠ **Option missing:** a State PSC paper asked the first capital with only Pataliputra, Vaishali, Champa and Anga – none is right; the answer is **Rajgriha**.
- **Vaishali:** capital of the **Lichchhavi (Vajji) republic**, named after King **Vishal**; near **Mahavira's birthplace**; venue of the **Second** (not First) Buddhist Council.
- **Not a Magadhan capital: Kaushambi** – capital of **Vatsa** (CGPSC 2011).

Who founded Pataliputra

- **Ajatashatru** fortified Pataligrama and **built the city of Pataliputra** – the answer when Udayin is not offered (APPSC G1 2002 and G1 PYQ: Ajatashatru; Dhanyakataka, Nalanda, Lumbini are distractors).
- **Udayin** made it the **capital**; Jain texts call him the **founder of Pataliputra** – the answer when Ajatashatru is not offered ("who founded Pataliputra": Udayin, not Ashoka, Bimbisara, Mahapadma).
- ⚠ **Disputed:** with both offered, most books and keys give **Ajatashatru** for the city and **Udayin** for the capital.
- **"First chose Pataliputra as capital": Udayin** (not Ajatashatru, Kalashoka or Kanishka).

Pataliputra – site and remains

- **Site:** modern **Patna**, at the **confluence of the Ganga and the Son**; surrounded by rivers – a **water-fort (jaladurga)**.
- **Excavated remains: Kumrahar** (Mauryan pillared hall) and **Bulandibagh** (wooden palisade) – both = Pataliputra, not Vaishali, Kapilavastu, Shravasti or Varanasi.
- **Decline:** Hiuen-Tsang (7th c. CE) found it in ruins.

Rajgir today

- **Vishwa Shanti Stupa:** the World Peace Pagoda on **Ratnagiri hill, Rajgir** – billed as the highest in the world (BPSC 2008).
- **Rajgriha** was also the place of **Mahavira's first sermon** and of the **First Buddhist Council** (Saptaparni cave).

> Exam angle: "first capital" → **Rajgriha**; "built Pataliputra / Pataligrama fort" → **Ajatashatru**; "made it the capital" → **Udayin**; Kumrahar, Bulandibagh → **Pataliputra**.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.100-101, p.103; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 2 p.40-41; app notes 1:25 (sub 0, 6); nalanda.nic.in (Vishwa Shanti Stupa)

- **Not Magadhan: Tughlaqabad** (Delhi) was built by **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq**, not Firoz Shah Tughlaq; Udayin succeeded Ajatashatru.

26. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which was the capital of Magadha?

a. Pratishthan
b. Vaishali
c. Girivraj (Rajgriha)
d. Champa

Answer: (c)

Girivraja/Rajgriha (Rajgir), ringed by five hills, was Magadha's first capital; Udayin later moved it to Pataliputra. Vaishali was the Vajji (Lichchhavi) capital and Champa the capital of Anga.

27. [PYQ] · State PSC **added**

Which was the first capital of ancient Mahajanapada Magadh?

a. Pataliputra
b. Vaishali
c. Champa
d. Anga
e. Girivraja (Rajgriha)

Answer: (e)

The printed options did not include the correct answer (Girivraja (Rajgriha)); it is added as option 5.
No printed option is right: Magadha's first capital was Girivraja/Rajgriha (Rajgir). Pataliputra became the capital only under Udayin; Vaishali was the Vajji capital, Champa the capital of Anga, and Anga itself was a separate Mahajanapada. The printed key (Pataliputra) is wrong.

28. [PYQ] · BPSC 2004
Which was the first capital of Magadha?

a. Pataliputra
b. Vaishali
c. Girivarja (Rajgriha)
d. Champa

Answer: (c)
Girivraja/Rajgriha (Rajgir) was Magadha's first capital; Pataliputra came later under Udayin and Vaishali was the Vajji capital.

29. [PYQ] · NDA 2001
In ancient India, the earliest capital of Magadha kingdom was at

a. Pataliputra
b. Rajgir
c. Vaishali
d. Varanasi

Answer: (b)
Rajgir (Girivraja/Rajgriha) was Magadha's earliest capital; Udayin later shifted the capital to Pataliputra.

30. [PYQ] · BPSC (Pre) 2008
Where is the highest in the world 'Vishwa Shanti Stupa' located in Bihar?

a. Vaishali
b. Nalanda
c. Rajgir
d. Patna

Answer: (c)
The Vishwa Shanti Stupa (World Peace Pagoda), billed as the world's highest, stands on Ratnagiri hill at Rajgir, the old Magadhan capital.

31. [PYQ] · State PSC
By which ruler was Pataliputra chosen as the capital for the first time?

a. Ajatashatru
b. Kalashoka
c. Udayin
d. Kanishka

Answer: (c)
Udayin, son of Ajatashatru, shifted the capital from Rajgriha to Pataliputra; Ajatashatru had only fortified Pataligrama, and Kalashoka moved the capital back from Vaishali later.

32. [PYQ] · State PSC disputed
Who among the following kings had founded Pataliputra?

a. Sisunaga
b. Bimbisara
c. Ajatashatru
d. Udayin

Answer: (c)
Most books and keys (PMF; APPSC G1 2002): Ajatashatru built Pataliputra. Jain texts and some books (e.g. Lucent) credit Udayin (option d), who founded the city as capital (PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.101).
Ajatashatru fortified the village of Pataligrama and built the city of Pataliputra as a base against the Vajjis; his son Udayin later made it the capital.

33. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-1 PYQ
Which of the following cities was founded by the king Ajata Satru?

a. Dhanyakatakam
b. Nalanda
c. Pataliputra
d. Lumbini

Answer: (c)
Ajatashatru fortified Pataligrama on the Ganga and built the city of Pataliputra. Dhanyakatakam was a Satavahana centre, Nalanda a later university and Lumbini the Buddha's birthplace.

34. [PYQ] · Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011
Which one of the following was not a capital of Magadhan Empire?

a. Girivraja
b. Rajgriha
c. Pataliputra
d. Kaushambi

Answer: (d)
Girivraja/Rajgriha and Pataliputra were Magadhan capitals (Vaishali too, briefly, under Shishunaga); Kaushambi was the capital of Vatsa.

35. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Bulandibagh was ancient site of :

a. Kapilavastu
b. Pataliputra
c. Vaishali
d. Varanasi

Answer: (b)

Bulandibagh, with Kumrahar, is an excavated site of ancient Pataliputra (Patna), where the wooden palisade of the Mauryan city was found.

36. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which was the initial capital of Magadha?

a. Pataliputra
b. Vaishali
c. Girivraja (Rajgriha)
d. Champa

Answer: (c)

Magadha's first capital was Girivraja/Rajgriha (Rajgir); Pataliputra came later under Udayin.

37. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

The remains of which ancient city have been found at the Kumrahar site?

a. Vaishali
b. Pataliputra
c. Kapilavastu
d. Shravasti

Answer: (b)

Kumrahar (Patna) holds the remains of ancient Pataliputra, including the 80-pillared Mauryan hall.

38. [PYQ] · State PSC

Who founded Pataliputra –

a. Udayin
b. Ashoka
c. Bimbisara
d. Mahapadmanada

Answer: (a)

Of the options only Udayin fits: Jain texts call him the founder of Pataliputra, and he made it the capital after Ajatashatru had fortified Pataligrama. Ashoka ruled from an existing Pataliputra.

39. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I Prelims 2002

Which of the following cities was founded by Ajatashatru?

a. Dhanyakataka
b. Nalanda
c. Pataliputra
d. Lumbini

Answer: (c)

Ajatashatru fortified Pataligrama during the Vajji war and built the city of Pataliputra. Dhanyakataka, Nalanda and Lumbini are unrelated.

40. [PYQ] · State PSC added

Which ruler had made Pataliputra the capital of his empire for the first time?

a. Chandragupta Maurya
b. Ashoka the Great
c. Chandragupta Vikramaditya
d. Kanishka
e. Udayin

Answer: (e)

The printed options did not include the correct answer (Udayin); it is added as option 5.
No printed option is right: Udayin (Haryanka) first made Pataliputra the capital of Magadha, moving it from Rajgriha. The Nandas already ruled from there before Chandragupta Maurya, and Ashoka, Chandragupta Vikramaditya and Kanishka came later still. The printed key (Chandragupta Maurya) is wrong.

41. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the capitals of Magadha:
1. Ajatashatru fortified the village Pataligrama as a base against the Vajjis.
2. Shishunaga moved the capital temporarily to Vaishali.
3. Kalashoka made Rajgriha the permanent capital.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is wrong: Kalashoka moved the capital back to Pataliputra, which stayed the capital of the Mauryas and Guptas. Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

42. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements:
1. Vaishali, capital of the Lichchhavi republic, was named after King Vishal.
2. Vaishali was the venue of the First Buddhist Council.
3. Kumrahar and Bulandibagh are excavated remains of Pataliputra.
4. Rajgriha was the place of Mahavira's first sermon.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. Only three
d. All four

Answer: (c)
Statement 2 is wrong: Vaishali hosted the Second Buddhist Council; the First was at Rajgriha (Saptaparni cave). Statements 1, 3 and 4 are correct, so three are correct.

43. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Pataliputra was a water-fort (jaladurga).
Reason (R): Pataliputra stood at the confluence of the Ganga and the Son and was surrounded by rivers.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: being ringed by the Ganga, the Son and other rivers is what made Pataliputra a natural water-fort.

44. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. Magadha became the base of the Mauryan Empire.
2. Vaishali was the first capital of Magadha.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)
Magadha was the base of the Mauryan Empire; its first capital was Girivraj (Rajgriha), not Vaishali.

45. [Kept own]

Consider the following statements:
1. Pataliputra was founded by Ajatashatru.
2. Udayin moved the capital of Magadha from Rajgriha to Pataliputra.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. Both 1 and 2
d. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)
Ajatashatru founded Pataliputra and Udayin shifted the capital there from Rajgriha.

3. Shishunagas and Nandas (PYQs 9 · MCQs 16)

Shishunaga dynasty (c. 413–345 BCE)

- **Shishunaga:** a viceroy at Banaras / amatya **chosen by the people** after Udayin's weak successors; moved the capital to **Vaishali**.
- **Malwa:** Shishunaga **destroyed Avanti** (capital **Ujjayini**) and annexed Avanti and Vatsa – the expansion over Malwa (UP Lower 2008 ×2).

- **Kalashoka:** moved the capital **back to Pataliputra**; **Second Buddhist Council** at Vaishali (383 BCE).
- **End:** the last Shishunaga, **Mahanandin**, was killed by **Mahapadma Nanda**.

Conquests in order

Ruler	Annexed
Bimbisara	Anga
Ajatashatru	Kosala, Vajji
Shishunaga	Avanti, Vatsa
Mahapadma Nanda	Kalinga, Kshatriya kingdoms of the north

Nanda dynasty (c. 345–321 BCE)

- **Sequence:** Haryanka → **Shishunaga → Nanda → Maurya** (State PSC; BPSC 2005).
- **Mahapadma Nanda:** founder; **first non-Kshatriya dynasty**; **first empire-builder** of India; titles **Ekarat** (sole sovereign) and **Sarvakshatrantaka** (destroyer of Kshatriyas) → hence **Aparoparashurama**, "a second Parashurama" (UPUDA 2010).
- **Hathigumpha inscription** of Kharavela: a **Nanda king dug a canal in Kalinga** and carried off a Jina image (UPPCS 1999).
- **Dhana Nanda: last Nanda** (RRB 2001); Greek **Agrammes / Xandrames**; ruled at **Alexander's invasion** (326 BCE) – the dynasty ruling North India then was the **Nanda** (UPSC 2000).
- **Fall:** Chandragupta Maurya, with Chanakya, overthrew Dhana Nanda in **c. 321 BCE**.
- **Army (Greek accounts):** about 200,000 infantry, 60,000 cavalry, 3,000–6,000 elephants.

> Exam angle: "after the Shishunagas" → **Nandas**; "after the Nandas" → **Mauryas**; "Malwa added" → **Shishunaga**; "Aparoparashurama" → **Mahapadma Nanda**.

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.101-102, p.105-106; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 2 p.40-41; app notes 1:25 (sub 4, 5)

46. [PYQ] · State PSC

Which dynasty ruled Magadh (Bihar) after Shishunag dynasty ?

a. Maurya Vansh
b. Sunga Vansh
c. Nanda Vansh
d. More than one of the above

Answer: (c)
The Nanda dynasty succeeded the Shishunagas: Mahapadma Nanda killed Mahanandin, the last Shishunaga. The Mauryas followed the Nandas and the Sungas came after the Mauryas.

47. [PYQ] · BPSC 2005

Which dynasty did rule over Magadha after Nanda dynasty?

a. Maurya
b. Sunga
c. Gupta
d. Kushana

Answer: (a)
Chandragupta Maurya overthrew Dhana Nanda (c. 321 BCE) and founded the Mauryan dynasty, so the Mauryas followed the Nandas.

48. [PYQ] · UP Lower 2008

The expansion of Magadha on Malwa Plateau was under the reign of

a. Bimbisar
b. Ajatashatru
c. Shisunaga
d. Virabhadra

Answer: (c)
Shishunaga defeated Avanti (Malwa, capital Ujjayini) and made Avanti and Vatsa part of Magadha; Bimbisara annexed Anga and Ajatashatru Kosala and Vajji.

49. [PYQ] · U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Power of Magadha was extended over the Malwa region during the reign period of –

a. Bimbisara
b. Ajatshatru
c. Udayabhadra
d. Sisunaga

Answer: (d)
Shishunaga destroyed the power of Avanti (Malwa) and annexed it to Magadha.

50. [PYQ] · UPSC CSE Prelims 2000

Which dynasty was ruling over North India at the time of Alexander's invasion?

a. Nanda
b. Maurya
c. Sunga
d. Kanva

Answer: (a)
Magadha (North India's leading power) was under the Nandas, led by Dhana Nanda, at the time of Alexander's invasion (326 BCE); the Mauryas came after 321 BCE.

51. [PYQ] · UPUDA/LDA 2010

Which emperor of Magadha is known as ‘Aparoparashurama’?

a. Bindusar
b. Ajatashatru
c. Kalashoka
d. Mahapadma Nanda

Answer: (d)
Mahapadma Nanda, the 'destroyer of all Kshatriyas' (Sarvakshatrantaka), is called a second Parashurama (Aparoparashurama) in the Puranas. Bindusara, Ajatashatru and Kalashoka carry no such epithet.

52. [PYQ] · RRB 2001

The last emperor of Nanda Dynasty was

a. Mahapadma Nanda
b. Dhana Nanda
c. Kalashoka
d. None of the above

Answer: (b)
Dhana Nanda (Agrammes of the Greeks) was the last Nanda king, overthrown by Chandragupta Maurya; Mahapadma was the founder.

53. [PYQ] · U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

The epigraphical evidence reveals that under the instructions of a Nanda king, a canal was dug in :

a. Anga
b. Vanga
c. Kalinga
d. Magadha

Answer: (c)
Kharavela's Hathigumpha inscription says a Nanda king (Mahapadma) conquered Kalinga, dug a canal there and carried off a Jina image.

54. [PYQ] · APPSC Group-I 1987-88

Nanda clan are followers of which clan?

a. Shishunaga dynasty
b. Haryanka dynasty
c. Achaemenid dynasty
d. Mauryan dynasty

Answer: (a)
The Nandas succeeded (followed) the Shishunaga dynasty: Haryanka → Shishunaga → Nanda → Maurya.

55. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Shishunaga dynasty:
1. Shishunaga came to the throne by being chosen by the people.
2. Shishunaga destroyed the power of Avanti.
3. Kalashoka held the Second Buddhist Council at Rajgriha.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 1 and 3 only
c. 2 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Statement 3 is wrong: the Second Buddhist Council under Kalashoka was held at Vaishali (383 BCE). Statements 1 and 2 are correct.

56. [New pattern · match]

Match the Magadhan rulers with the territories they annexed:
List-I (Ruler)
a. Bimbisara
b. Ajatashatru
c. Shishunaga
d. Mahapadma Nanda
List-II (Annexed)
i. Kosala and Vajji
ii. Kalinga
iii. Anga
iv. Avanti and Vatsa
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-i, b-ii, c-iv, d-iii
b. a-iii, b-i, c-iv, d-ii
c. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
d. a-i, b-iv, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (b)
Bimbisara = Anga; Ajatashatru = Kosala and Vajji; Shishunaga = Avanti and Vatsa; Mahapadma Nanda = Kalinga and the Kshatriya kingdoms of the north.

57. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the Nandas:
1. Mahapadma Nanda founded the first non-Kshatriya dynasty.
2. Mahapadma Nanda's title Sarvakshatrantaka means 'sole sovereign'.
3. The Hathigumpha inscription of Kharavela credits a Nanda king with a canal in Kalinga.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 only
b. 1 and 2 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 2 and 3 only

Answer: (c)
Statement 2 is wrong: Sarvakshatrantaka means destroyer of the Kshatriyas; 'sole sovereign' is Ekarat. Statements 1 and 3 are correct.

58. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Mahapadma Nanda is called Aparoparashurama, 'a second Parashurama'.
Reason (R): Mahapadma Nanda bore the title Sarvakshatrantaka, the destroyer of the Kshatriyas.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (a)
Both are true and R explains A: like Parashurama he destroyed the Kshatriyas (Sarvakshatrantaka), hence Aparoparashurama.

59. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about the last Nanda:
1. Dhana Nanda was called Agrammes by Greek writers.
2. Mahapadma Nanda was ruling Magadha at the time of Alexander's invasion.
3. Chandragupta Maurya overthrew Dhana Nanda in c. 321 BCE.
Which of the statements given above is/are NOT correct?

a. 1 only
b. 2 only
c. 3 only
d. 1 and 2 only

Answer: (b)
Statement 2 is NOT correct: the Nanda on the throne at Alexander's invasion (326 BCE) was Dhana Nanda (Agrammes/Xandrames). Statements 1 and 3 are correct.

60. [Kept own]

Arrange the dynasties of Magadha in chronological order:
1. Nanda
2. Haryanka
3. Shishunaga

a. 3, 2, 1
b. 2, 1, 3
c. 2, 3, 1
d. 1, 3, 2

Answer: (c)
The Haryankas were followed by the Shishunagas and then the Nandas.

61. [Kept own]
Consider the following statements about the Hathigumpha inscription:
1. It is an inscription of Kharavela.
2. It credits a Nandaraja with an irrigation canal in Kalinga.
3. It records the coronation of Chandragupta Maurya at Pataliputra.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a. 1 and 2 only
b. 2 and 3 only
c. 1 and 3 only
d. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)
Kharavela's Hathigumpha inscription credits a Nandaraja with an irrigation canal in Kalinga; it does not record Chandragupta's coronation.

4. Causes of Magadhan Supremacy (PYQs 3 · MCQs 8)

- **Most powerful and richest Mahajanapada** (6th–4th c. BCE); it became the base of the **Mauryan Empire**. Puranas: the first dynasty was the **Brihadratha** (Jarasandha ruled from **Girivraj**).

Factor	Effect
Iron mines nearby (Jharkhand)	Weapons and tools; forest clearing
Alluvial soil, ample rainfall	Agricultural surplus, taxes
Ganga and Son (navigable)	Cheap transport and trade
Elephants from the eastern forests	First large-scale use of war elephants
Naturally fortified capitals	Rajgriha (five hills), Pataliputra (water-fort)
Unorthodox society	Little Vedic hold; ambitious rulers and ministers

- ⚠ **Not a cause:** control of western sea ports, gold mines, superior cavalry or a republican system.
- **Buddhist councils linked to Magadhan kings:** First – **Ajatashatru** (Rajgriha); Second – **Kalashoka** (Vaishali); Third – **Ashoka** (Pataliputra).

~~ Sources: PMF Ancient & Medieval Part 2 p.103-104; NextGen Indian History APPSC Part 1 p.67; app notes 1:25 (sub 0, 2, 7)

62. [PYQ] · State PSC
In which century did the first Magadhan Empire rise?

a. Fourth Century B.C
b. Sixth Century B.C
c. Second Century B.C
d. First Century B.C

Answer: (b)
The first Magadhan empire rose in the 6th century BC under Bimbisara (Haryanka), a contemporary of the Buddha.

63. [PYQ] · APPSC
Between the sixth and the fourth centuries BCE, _____ became the most powerful mahajanapada.

a. Kashi
b. Kuru
c. Matsya
d. Magadha

Answer: (d)
Between the 6th and 4th centuries BCE Magadha became the most powerful Mahajanapada (iron, elephants, fertile land, rivers).

64. [PYQ] · I.A.S. (Pre) 1999
Which one of the following was initially the most powerful city-state in India in the 6th century B.C.?

a. Gandhar
b. Kamboj
c. Kashi
d. Magadha

Answer: (d)
Of the four powers, Magadha emerged as the most powerful in the 6th century BC and founded the first empire; Gandhara, Kamboja and Kashi did not.

65. [New pattern · statements]

Consider the following statements about Magadha:
1. It was the most powerful and richest Mahajanapada of the 6th–4th centuries BCE.
2. According to the Puranas its first dynasty was the Brihadratha.
3. Jarasandha of the Brihadratha line ruled from Pataliputra.
How many of the above statements are correct?

a. Only one
b. Only two
c. All three
d. None

Answer: (b)
Statement 3 is wrong: Jarasandha ruled from Girivraj (Rajgriha). Statements 1 and 2 are correct, and Magadha became the base of the Mauryan Empire. So only two are correct.

66. [New pattern · match]

Match the factors of Magadhan supremacy with their effects:
List-I (Factor)
a. Iron mines nearby
b. Alluvial soil, ample rainfall
c. Elephants from the eastern forests
d. Navigable Ganga and Son
List-II (Effect)
i. Agricultural surplus and taxes
ii. Weapons and tools; forest clearing
iii. First large-scale use of war elephants
iv. Cheap transport and trade
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
b. a-i, b-iv, c-iii, d-ii
c. a-iii, b-i, c-ii, d-iv
d. a-iv, b-i, c-ii, d-iii

Answer: (a)
Iron mines = weapons, tools, forest clearing; alluvial soil and rainfall = surplus and taxes; eastern elephants = first large-scale war elephants; Ganga and Son = cheap transport and trade.

67. [New pattern · assertion]

Assertion (A): Control of the western sea ports was a main cause of the rise of Magadha.
Reason (R): Magadha had iron mines nearby for weapons and tools.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
b. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
c. (A) is true, but (R) is false
d. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: (d)
A is false: the notes list control of western sea ports (like gold mines, superior cavalry or a republican system) as NOT a cause. R is true: nearby iron mines (Jharkhand) gave weapons and tools.

68. [Kept own]

In contrast to the Vedic heartland, what was the nature of the society of Magadha?

a. Dominated by Vedic orthodoxy
b. Matriarchal
c. Unorthodox, with little Vedic hold
d. Purely pastoral

Answer: (c)
Magadha's society was relatively unorthodox with little Vedic hold; iron, rivers, elephants and defensible capitals supported its rise.

69. [Kept own]

Match the following:
List-I (Buddhist Council)
A. First Council
B. Second Council
C. Third Council
List-II (Ruler)
1. Ashoka
2. Ajatashatru
3. Kalashoka
Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a. A-3, B-2, C-1
b. A-2, B-1, C-3
c. A-2, B-3, C-1
d. A-1, B-3, C-2

Answer: (c)
The First Council was held under Ajatashatru, the Second under Kalashoka and the Third under Ashoka.